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APPETIZERS

***Bruschetta**

2-4 Roma tomatoes, diced
¼-1/2 c fresh basil, chopped
½-1 clove minced garlic
1/8-1/4 t ground pepper
1/8-1/4 t salt
2-3 T olive oil
1-2 T balsamic vinegar
Italian bread, French bread, or focaccia bread, sliced thin

Combine all ingredients (except bread). Spritz/drizzle bread with olive oil and toast it under broiler, if desired. Top bread with bruschetta and serve immediately.

Warm Pizza Dip (from *Good Housekeeping* Jan/Feb 2021, p.107)
Takes 30 min - serves 8

8 oz cream cheese, at room temperature
½ c sour cream
1 clove garlic, grated
¾ t dried oregano
pinch of red pepper flakes
kosher salt
6 oz mozzarella cheese, coarsely grated, divided
1 ¼ c pizza or marinara sauce
2 oz mini pepperoni slices
1 baguette, warmed and sliced

1. Heat oven to 400 F. In medium bowl, combine cream cheese, sour cream, garlic, oregano, red pepper flakes and ½ t salt. Fold in 1 c mozzarella and all but 2 T parmesan.
2. Transfer mixture to shallow 1 qt baking dish (or for individual servings, into 8 4-oz ramekins). Top with pizza sauce; sprinkle with remaining mozzarella and Parmesan, then pepperoni. Bake until bubbling and cheese begins to brown, about 15 min (12 min if using smaller ramekins), broiling 1-2 min if needed. Let rest 5 min before serving. Serve with baguette slices for dipping.

Baked Mushrooms (Lindsey Fellars)

12 large mushrooms
3 T melted butter
2 T minced green onions
½ T flour
½ c heavy cream (I've used evaporated milk)
1 t dried parsley
¼ c grated swiss cheese
3 T melted butter
Salt and pepper

Remove stems and reserve. Wash and dry cap of mushrooms. Brush the caps with melted butter and arrange hollow side up in a shallow baking dish. Season lightly with salt and pepper. Wash and dry mushroom stems and mince. Sauté minced stems with green onions in butter for 4-5 minutes or until pieces begin to separate. Lower heat and add flour and stir for 1 minute. Stir in cream and simmer til thickened (1-2 minutes). Stir in parsley, salt and pepper. Fill cap mushroom tops with sauce and then top with cheese and dribble on droplets of melted butter. Bake at 375 for 15 minutes.

Stuffed Jalapeno Peppers (Lindsey Fellars' Dad, Bob)

Jalapeno peppers
Bacon
Cream cheese
Ranch dressing mix (I've even used bottled dressing)
Toothpicks

Quantities will differ depending on how many you want to make! Slice washed jalapenos in half lengthwise (do not remove stems, or the filling will ooze out). Mix enough cream cheese and ranch dressing to fill number of jalapenos being used. Fill jalapenos so that they will close smoothly. Then wrap with bacon and secure with toothpick. BBQ til bacon is cooked. Serve warm.

Ultimate Black Bean Nachos – From *Family Fun* Magazine

1 bag tortilla chips
1 16 oz can black beans, drained
1 16 oz jar mild salsa
1 12 oz can corn, drained
1 bunch green onions, diced
1 c cheddar cheese, grated
1 tomato, chopped

Preheat oven to 375. Put chips on baking sheet. Drain beans and corn. Mix with salsa and green onions. Top each chip with 2 T mixture and sprinkle with cheese. Heat in oven 3-5 minutes. Garnish with tomatoes and serve.

Sheet Pan Chicken Suizas Nachos (from *Good Housekeeping*, Jan/Feb 2020, p. 110)
Takes 35 minutes - serves 6

1 large poblano pepper, halved and seeded
½ c prepared salsa verde
2 T sour cream
2 ½ c fresh cilantro, divided
2 ½ c shredded white-meat rotisserie chicken
6 oz tortilla chips (about 7 cups)
8 oz Muenster cheese, coarsely grated (about 2 cups)
¼ small white onion, finely chopped
4 small radishes, thinly sliced

1. Heat broiler. Arrange poblano, cut sides down, on rimmed baking sheet and broil until charred, 3-5 minutes. Transfer to bowl, cover and let stand 5 minutes. Use paper towel to remove skins, then cut peppers into ¼ in pieces.
2. Reduce oven to 450 F. In blender, puree salsa verde, sour cream, and 2 c cilantro until smooth. Toss with chicken to coat.
3. On same baking sheet, toss chicken with chips, half of Muenster and chopped poblano. Sprinkle remaining cheese on top. Bake until cheese has melted and chicken is hot, 6-7 minutes.
4. Chop remaining ½ c cilantro and toss with onion. Scatter onion mixture and radishes over nachos.

Sheet Pan Barbecue Beef Nachos (from *Good Housekeeping*, Jan/Feb 2020, p. 110)
Takes 40 minutes - serves 8

¼ small red onion, thinly sliced
2 T fresh lime juice
kosher salt
1 T olive oil
1 large yellow onion, finely chopped
2 cloves garlic, pressed
1 lb ground beef
1 c BBQ sauce
½ c canned tomato sauce
6 oz tortilla chips (about 7 cups)
8 oz Monterey Jack cheese, coarsely grated (about 2 c)
3 scallions, thinly sliced
1 ripe avocado, diced

1. Heat oven to 450 F. In small bowl, combine red onion, lime juice and pinch salt and let stand.
2. Heat oil in large skillet on medium. Add yellow onion and ¼ t salt and cook, covered, stirring occasionally, until tender, 6-8 min. Stir in garlic; cook 1 min.
3. Add beef and cook, breaking up into small pieces, 5 min. Stir in BBQ sauce and tomato sauce and simmer until slightly thickened, 4-5 minutes.
4. On rimmed baking sheet, toss chips and half of Monterey Jack. Top with beef mixture and sprinkle remaining cheese on top. Bake until cheese has melted, 3-4 minutes.
5. Top nachos with scallions, avocado and pickled red onion.

Sheet Pan Double Bean Nachos (from *Good Housekeeping*, Jan/Feb 2020, p. 110)
Takes 15 minutes - serves 6

6 oz tortilla chips (about 7 cups)
1 15-oz can low-sodium black beans, rinsed
8 oz extra-sharp Cheddar cheese, coarsely grated (about 2 cups)
1 15-oz can vegetarian refried beans
¼ c sour cream
1 c shredded romaine lettuce
½ c fresh pico de gallo
½ c guacamole

1. Heat oven to 450 F. On rimmed baking sheet, toss chips, black beans and half of Cheddar.
2. Dollop refried beans on top and sprinkle with remaining cheese. Bake until beans are heated through and cheese has melted, 6-7 minutes.
3. Dollop sour cream over nachos and top with lettuce, pico, and guac.

Loaded Bread Dip (From *Blackberry Crumble* by Josi Kilpack)
Serves 4

1 ½ c mayonnaise
1 ½ c sour cream
1 c grated Parmesan cheese
½ onion, diced
1 clove garlic, mashed
1 c cooked, crumbled bacon
3 c shredded cheddar cheese
1 round loaf artisan bread (use smaller rounds for individual dips)

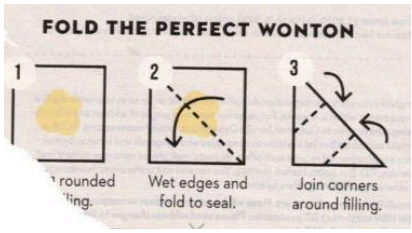
Preheat oven to 350 degrees. In a large bowl, combine all ingredients except bread. Hollow out a round loaf of artisan bread, reserving the bread removed from the center. Spoon the dip into the bread and bake on a cookie sheet for 40 minutes. When done, use the bread you removed to eat the dip.

Pork and Chive Dumplings
Takes 50 minutes total - Serves 6



1 lb ground pork
1 T low-sodium soy sauce
2 t sugar
2 t rice wine
2 t grated fresh ginger
½ bunch chives, sliced (about ½ cup)
4 scallions, thinly sliced (about ½ c)
square dumpling wrappers (abt 30)
chile oil (recipe below), for dipping

1. In medium bowl, combine pork, soy sauce, sugar, rice wine, ginger, garlic, chives and scallions.
2. Line baking sheet with parchment paper. Working in batches, place 1 rounded T filling in center of 1 wrapper. Using fingers, lightly wet edges of wrapper with water. Fold wrapper over to make a triangle and press to seal. Lightly wet 1 bottom corner of triangle, then pinch together to seal. Transfer to prepared sheet. Repeat with remaining filling and wrappers.
3. Add 1 T salt to large pot of simmering water. In 3 batches, cook dumplings, stirring, until filling is cooked through, 3-6 minutes. Using slotted spoon, transfer to paper-towel-lined plate. Serve with Chile Oil if desired. Makes 30 dumplings.



<u>Chile Oil</u>
Takes 10 minutes total - makes 1 cup

¼ c red pepper flakes
3 T toasted sesame seeds
2 t five-spice powder
1 t pepper
2 bay leaves
1 c vegetable oil

1. Combine all spices in a medium heatproof bowl.
2. Heat oil in small saucepan on medium heat until it is hot but not smoking.
3. Pour over the spices and stir to combine; let cool.
4. Discard bay leaves and strain if desired. Refrigerate up to 6 months.

homemade crackers (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale)
Serves 4

2 c whole wheat pastry flour
⅔ c warm water
⅓ c extra virgin olive oil, plus extra for the pan
salt

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. Grease a 17 x 11-inch rimmed baking sheet with oil.
2. In a bowl, combine the flour, water, oil, and 1 teaspoon salt and stir until combined and a dough forms. Place the dough in the center of the prepared baking sheet and roll out roughly with a rolling pin or use your hands, and press it into the corners. No need to be fussy here, rustic is great!
3. Use a knife or pizza cutter to cut even squares, rectangles, or whatever shape takes your fancy. Sprinkle with salt and bake for 15 minutes, or until golden. Set aside to cool (the crackers will harden as they cool). Store in an airtight container for up to 5 days.

(Variations are endless: You can use different flours, add dried herbs, or sprinkle with spices or seeds.)

crispy fried chickpeas (from Maria Rodale's *Scratch*, adapted from Manhattan's *Prune* restaurant)
Serves 4

1 can (14 to 19 ounces) chickpeas, drained and rinsed
1 cup olive oil
Salt

1. Drain the chickpeas on paper towels to remove any excess moisture.
2. In a small pot, heat the oil over medium-high heat until a chickpea thrown into it starts to sizzle.
3. Fry the chickpeas, gently shaking the pot, for 8 to 9 minutes, until deep golden brown. Remove from the oil with a slotted spoon and drain briefly on paper towels, where they'll crisp as they cool. Season with salt, then transfer to a bowl.

TIPS: If you'd rather not fry them, coat the chickpeas in oil, spread them on a baking sheet, and bake in a 375°F oven for 30 minutes, until crispy. You can add a pinch each paprika and cayenne or your favorite spice blend after the chickpeas cool.

Roasted Pumpkin Seeds (from *Good Housekeeping,* October 2019)

1. SCOOP: Spoon out seeds from pumpkin (1 medium pumpkin yields about 2 cups).
2. CLEAN: Transfer seeds to large bowl of water. Scoop out loose seeds that float and separate pulp from remaining seeds. Discard pulp.
3. WASH: Transfer seeds to colander and rinse. Drain, then pat dry with dishtowels.
4. DRY SLOWLY: Spread cleaned seeds on baking sheet and bake at 250 degrees until dry, about 1 hour.
5. SEASON & ROAST: Toss with 2 T olive oil, season and roast at 350 degrees, tossing occasionally, until golden brown and crisp, 20 minutes.
    a. FALL MOCHA - toss with 1 T hot cocoa mix and 1 t ground cinnamon
    b. SWEET HEAT - toss with ¼ c brown sugar and ⅛ t cayenne
    c. CACIO e PEPE - toss with ½ c finely grated romano cheese and 2 t cracked pepper

BACKPACKING MEALS & DUTCH OVEN TIPS

Chicken Alfredo
makes 1 serving

1. Put these ingredients in a freezer Ziploc bag:

1 cup pasta broken in 2"pieces (use pasta that normally cooks on stovetop in 4 min. or less--thin egg noodles, angel hair pasta, or quick-cooking artisan pastas)
1 teaspoon chia seeds or ground flaxseed (optional)
1/4 cup freeze dried chopped chicken *(we used a pouch of cooked chicken, similar to a tuna pouch)*
1/4 cup toasted pine nuts *(we didn't put this in since we didn't have any)*
1/4 cup freeze dried chopped mushrooms *(we didn't add these since we didn't have any)*
1-1/2 teaspoons powdered chicken flavor base (or boullion granules)
3 tablespoons grated Parmesan cheese (the dried, unrefrigerated kind in a can)
2 T instant dried buttermilk powder (or regular powdered milk)
2 T corn starch
2 t freeze dried Italian herb blend (or ¾ t dried Italian herb blend
¼ t garlic powder
⅛ t ground black pepper
¼ t salt (or more to taste)

2. When ready to eat, add 1 ¼ c BOILING water to Ziploc bag. Wrap in towel or clothing for 5-10 minutes to hydrate everything. Mix by squeezing the bag. Then serve/eat.

Thai Peanut Noodles
makes 1 serving

1. Put these ingredients in a freezer Ziploc bag:

1 cup pasta broken in 2"pieces (use pasta that normally cooks on stovetop in 4 min. or less—thin egg noodles, angel hair pasta, or quick-cooking artisan pastas) (*We used rice noodles.)*
1 teaspoon chia seeds or ground flaxseed (optional)
1/4 cup freeze dried chopped chicken *(We used a pouch of cooked chicken, similar to a tuna pouch)*
1/4 cup chopped roasted peanuts
1/4 cup freeze dried mixed vegetables
1-1/2 teaspoons powdered chicken flavor base (or boullion granules)
2 tablespoons PB2 powdered peanut butter
1 ½ t freeze dried cilantro (or ½ t dried cilantro)
¼ t garlic powder
¼ t ground ginger
pinch of ground cayenne pepper (or more if you want it spicier)
⅛ t ground black pepper
¼ t salt (or more to taste)

2. When ready to eat, add 1 c BOILING water to Ziploc bag. Wrap in towel or clothing for 5-10 minutes to hydrate everything. Mix by squeezing the bag. Then serve/eat.

Curry Chicken
makes 1 serving

1. Put these ingredients in a freezer Ziploc bag:

⅔ c instant white rice
¼ c freeze dried chopped chicken *(We used a pouch of cooked chicken, similar to a tuna pouch)*
¼ c chopped roasted cashews
¼ c freeze dried mixed vegetables
1 T freeze dried onions (or 1 t dried onion flakes)
1 ½ t powdered chicken flavor base (or bouillon granules)
1 ½ t curry powder
¼ t garlic powder
⅛ t ground black pepper
¼ t salt (or more to taste)

2. When ready to eat, add 1 ½ c BOILING water to Ziploc bag. Wrap in towel or clothing for 5-10 minutes to hydrate everything. Mix by squeezing the bag. Then serve/eat.

Chicken Couscous
makes 1 serving

1. Put these ingredients in a Ziploc bag:

⅓ c whole wheat cous cous
1 t chia seeds or ground flaxseed (optional)
⅓ c freeze dried chopped chicken *(We used a pouch of cooked chicken, similar to a tuna pouch)*
½ c freeze dried mixed vegetables (*We used a variety of freeze dried items - spinach, carrots, peppers - in quantities to total ½ c)*
1 T freeze dried onions (or 1 t dried onion flakes)
1 ½ t powdered chicken flavor base (or bouillon granules)
1 ½ t freeze dried poultry herb blend (or ¼ t each dried thyme, sage, & parsley)
¼ t garlic powder
⅛ t ground black pepper
¼ t salt (or more to taste)

2. When ready to eat, add 1 ½ c BOILING water to Ziploc bag. Wrap in towel or clothing for 5-10 minutes to hydrate everything. Mix by squeezing the bag. Then serve/eat.

Seasoning a Dutch Oven
Wipe inside and out with 1 T vegetable oil. Put in 350 degree oven (or BBQ grill) for 1 hour. Take out and either repeat or store.

Helpful Dutch Oven equipment
Lid lifter (to check while cooking, without spilling ash inside)
trivet or cork hot plates (to set on after removing from coals)
leather/welding gloves (for working with hot pan and coals)
patio stones (12-14”wide) or dig out a pit (to give you somewhere to use as a work surface
tongs/shovel (to move coals around)

Dutch oven sizes/capacities

Oven Size	**Oven Capacity**	**Number of Servings** (Main dish = 10 oz serving / Side dish = 6 oz serving)
8”	2 quarts	main dishes, 2-6 servings / side dishes, 8-10 servings
10”	4 quarts	main dishes 2-12 servings / side dishes, 16-20 servings
12”	6 quarts	main dishes, 6-18 servings / side dishes, up to 30 servings
12” D	8 quarts	main dishes 8-25 servings / side dishes, up to 40 servings
14”	8 quarts	main dishes 8-25 servings / side dishes, up to 40 servings
14” D	10 quarts	main dishes, 10-35 servings / side dishes, up to 55 servings

Number of briquettes to use when cooking with a dutch oven

Rule of thumb for 350 degrees: double the width of the oven + 2. Here’s how you would divide them top/bottom for something like a cobbler:

Temperature	**8” Oven**		**10” Oven**		**12” Oven**		**14 “ Oven**		**16” Oven**	
Degrees F	**Top**	**Bottom**	**Top**	**Bottom**	**Top**	**Bottom**	**Top**	**Bottom**	**Top**	**Bottom**
300	10	4	12	6	14	8	16	10	18	12
325	11	5	13	7	15	9	17	11	19	13
350	12	6	14	8	16	10	18	12	20	14
375	13	7	15	9	17	11	19	13	21	15

Briquette and Temperature Notes:

- Soup would be flipped (with more briquettes on the bottom). Cake would be the same # coals on top and bottom.
- Adding one set of briquettes (one on top and one on bottom) will raise the temperature of the Dutch Oven approximately 25 degrees. Or conversely, removing one set of briquettes will lower the temperature by 25 degrees.
- Coals can be added when there’s just a little bit of white on them. Then you’ll get a full hour of use out of each one.
- If cooking in the cold/wind, build a small fence around the coals or maybe add a few more coals to compensate.

BELGIAN RECIPES

Les Recettes (recipes that Fabienne made and described to me verbally)

1. White Fish and Veggie Sauce

Boil fish; cook carrots, celery, onions, etc, with crème and butter added to the juice of veggies. Good served with rice.

2. Tomates aux crevettes/thon

Scoop out inside of tomato and fill with shrimp, hard boiled egg, or tuna (mixed with mayo/miracle whip). Serve with lettuce.

3. Tomato soup

Tomatoes, potatoes, onions – cook.

4. Les oeufs soldat

Soft boiled eggs. Eat with bread.

5. Pasta with pesto & mozzarella cheese (& crème)

6. Pain de veau (meatloaf)

Veal, onions, eggs, bread

7. Zucchini (courgette) with meatloaf inside, baked in oven

Prepared whole, cut in half and insides removed (only the seeds). Or substitute zucchini insides for bread. Bake at 300 degrees? To supplement the meal, we had rice with tomato sauce (tomatoes and Italian seasoning).

8. Zucchini and onion soup

1 zucchini, 2 onions, salt, pepper, 1 liter water, cream cheese?

9. Pasta with sauce of onions, tomatoes, basil leaves, and cheese

10. (Ivi's) Waterzooi (soup with chicken, carrots, potatoes)

Tiramissou

Café fort /strong coffee (prepared in liquid form – try with postum or hot chocolate), cooled and put in soup plate.
6 jaunes d'oeuf/eggs yolks
200 gr du sucre
500 gr du Mascarpone (Italian cream cheese)
Une packet de biscuit cuilliere (lady fingers)

Se batter les jaunes d'oeuf avec le sucre
Ajouter 500 gr du Mascarpone
Melanger avec le preparation des oeufs et obtenir une crème.
Prendre les biscuits – prendre un plat
Tromper les biscuits dans le café.
Tapisser (mettre) les biscuits au fond du plat. Coucher du crème. Couches biscuits (et encore du crème si tu veux) et [sprinkle] le tout de Nesquik
Sur frigo 6h

Les Recettes de Kara (former nanny):

Les Biscuits avec chocolat en morceaux

¾ bol de beurre fondu
½ bol de sucre brun
½ bol de sucre blanc
2 cuilleres de vanilla
½ cuillere de sel
2 oeufs

MELANGEZ BIEN ET PUIS AJUTEZ

2 bols de farine
Chocolat en morceaux

Roulez les pates en petites boules. Cuisinez pendant 10-13 minutes á 180° C dans le four.

Quiche

Les pates:
1 bol de farine
½ bol de beurre
1 oeuf

ECRASEZ AVEC UNE FOURCHETTE ET METTEZ DANS LE [PIEPAN]. CUISINEZ POUR 15 MINUTES DANS LE FOUR.

L'interieur:
1 bol du lait
1 bol de yoghurt
2 oeufs
1 bol de fromage, rapé
Du jambon, bien coupé en morceaux
Deux petites courgettes, coupés en morceaux
Un peu d'ail
Un peu de thym
Un peu de basilica
Un peu de sel
Un peu de poivre

MELANGEZ ENSEMBLE ET METTEZ DANS LES PATES. CUISINEZ Á 180° C PENDANT 30-40 MINUTES.

La Tarte Aux Pommes

FAITES LES PATES COMME POUR LE QUICHE, SAUF AJUTEZ ¼ BOL DE SUCRE DANS LA RECETTE. CUISINEZ 15 MINUTES DANS LE FOUR.

Mettez dans les pates:
4-5 pommes, verte – pelés et coupés en grand morceaux
2 cuilleres pleines de cannelle
½ cuillere de noix muscade
¼ cuillere de sel
½ bol de sucre blanc

MÉLANGEZ LES MORCEAUX DE POMME AVEC LE SUCRE ET LES ÉPICES. METTEZ, AU-DESSUS:
½ bol de lait et ¼ bol d'eau

ÉCRASEZ ENSEMBLE:
¾ bol de sucre brun
¾ bol de beurre
¾ bol de farine

METTEZ AU-DESSUS DU MÉLANGE DE POMMES. CUISINEZ LA TARTE DANS LE FOUR PENDANT 30-40 MINUTES OU QUAND ELLE EST BIEN BRUNE.

Tarte aux Chocolat (via Ivi)

4 jaunes d'oeufs (gardes les blancs)
mélange avec:
250 gr sucre 200 gr chocolat noir

COUPÉ EN PETIT MORCEAU ET MÉLANGE AVEC
200 gr margarine

Mets dans un casserole et mets le casserole dans un autre casserole avec de l'eau jusqu'au ça fond. Après, laisse-le froideur et puis tu le mélange avec les oeufs et le sucre. Puis mets une cuilliere a soupe de farine (plat).
Prendre les quatre blanche des oeufs et fait le meringue et puis plie tous ensemble doucement.
Mets dans le four et essuie un peu de margarine pourqu'il ne colle pas (gardes un peu) et laisse cuire a 180° C pour 20-25 minutes. Pas cuire trop longtemps parceque c'est mieux un peu mouillé.
Mets le chocolat mélange qui reste au dessus la tarte après c'est fini.

Recipes from "Everybody Eats Well in Belgium" cookbook by Ruth Van Waerebeek

My Mother's Cream of Tomato Soup (1/2 of this recipe yields 4 medium servings)

5 T butter
1 med onion, finely chopped
1 carrot, peeled and finely chopped
2 lbs ripe tomatoes, peeled, seeded, and coarsely chopped, or 1 can (28 oz) whole tomatoes with their juices, coarsely chopped.
1 ½ t sugar
[pinch of cayenne pepper]
Salt to taste
4 T flour
3 ½-4 c beef or chicken broth
¾ c heavy (or whipping) cream
Fresh ground black pepper, to taste

1. Melt 2 T of butter in large soup kettle over medium heat. Add onion & carrot; cook til soft but not brown, 8-10 minutes.
2. Add tomatoes, sugar, cayenne and a little salt. Cook gently over low heat for 20 minutes, stirring occasionally. Let the mixture cool slightly, then puree it in a blender and set aside.
3. Melt remaining butter in the soup kettle over low heat. Sprinkle flour over butter and stir til smooth. Gradually add the broth while stirring with wire whisk. Continue to do so until a thick, velvety sauce consistency of cream. Still whisking, let boil up once or twice to get rid of any pasty flour taste.
4. Remove the soup from the heat and whisk in tomato mixture. Let rest until just before serving. (Refrigerate after cooling at this point if making ahead.)
5. Gently reheat the tomato soup, but be careful not to boil. Stir in cream. Season to taste with salt and pepper. May garnish with sautéed tomatoes and minced parsley if you'd like.

***Sugar Waffles from Liège** (Makes 10 waffles)
Batter 1:
1 T yeast
¼ c warm water
1 c flour
1 T sugar
1 large egg, beaten
1/3 c milk, warmed to 100°F

Batter 2:
9 T butter, at room temp.
6 T flour
1 t vanilla
¼ t baking powder
(opt. 1 t cinnamon)
Pinch of salt
1 T sugar
¾ c crushed sugar cubes (approx. the size of sunflower seeds)

1. Prepare Batter 1: In a small bowl, dissolve yeast in water with 1 T of the flour and the sugar. Let stand 5 minutes til foamy.
2. Sift remaining flour into large mixing bowl. Make a well in the center and add yeast mixture, egg, and milk. Mix well with a spoon to make a smooth batter. Cover with towel and let rise in warm place til batter has doubled or tripled (200° oven, turned off).
3. Meanwhile, prepare Batter 2: In a medium-sized bowl, mix the butter, flour, salt, vanilla, baking powder, cinnamon (if using), sugar, and sugar cube pieces into a paste.
4. With your hands, work batter 2 into batter 1 (**The batter has always been too sticky for me, so I still use a spoon for this step**) til well mixed. Shape the dough into 10 balls (**Once again, I just scoop it with a measuring cup, not with my hands**). Flatten each ball into a disk and dust lightly with flour.
5. Bake in a medium-hot waffle iron. (Don't let get too hot or sugar will burn.) Bake until waffles are golden brown, but still slightly soft, 3-4 minutes.

Gentse Waterzooi
makes 4 servings

1 whole chicken
salt
pepper
parsley sprigs
thyme sprigs
1 bay leaf
6 c chicken broth
2 leeks
2 small bunch celery
2 onions
4 cloves
2 large carrots
1 c cream

1. Rinse chicken inside and out; season with salt and pepper, inside and out. Tie the parsley & thyme sprigs together with the bay leaf; tuck the bundle inside the chicken. Place chicken, breast side up in a large pot. Add enough chicken broth (about 6 cups) to cover chicken. Add the green part of the leeks, the leaves of the celery, one peeled onion, and the cloves. Simmer for 25 minutes. Remove chicken to cool, and pour the broth through a sieve. Return the sieved broth to the pot.
2. Chop the white part of the leeks, the celery, and the 2nd onion. Slice the carrots. Add the leeks, celery, onion, and carrots; cook 25 minutes longer, or until veggies are tender. Pull chicken meat from bones and return chicken pieces to the pot. Simmer 5 minutes. Once soup is heated through, stir in cream. Sprinkle with parsley and serve with boiled potatoes.

***If you want a thicker soup, make a roux with melted butter and flour, stir into simmering broth, and let thicken before adding the cream.*

BREADS

QUICK BREADS

Easy Pumpkin Loaf

1 c sugar
1 c cooked pumpkin
¼ c oil
3 egg whites (or 2 eggs)
3 T milk
2 c flour
1 t baking soda
1 t baking powder
½ t salt
½ t cinnamon
¼ t nutmeg

Combine sugar, pumpkin, oil, eggs, and milk. Mix well. Add flour, soda, baking powder, salt, and spices. Blend well. Pour into well-greased, floured 9x5x3 loaf pan. Bake at 350 for 1 hour.

***Pumpkin Bread** (pudding and sugars make this more like a cake than a bread!)
Makes 2 big loaves

5 eggs
1 ¼ c oil or melted butter (I use a cube of butter and enough oil to make 1 ¼ c.)
1 (15 oz) can pumpkin
2 c flour
2 c sugar
2 (3 oz) packages *cook and serve* vanilla pudding mix
1 t baking soda
½ t salt
¼ t brown sugar
2 t cinnamon, divided

Beat eggs. Add oil and pumpkin. Mix well. Combine flour, sugar, pudding mix, baking soda, 1 t cinnamon, and salt. Gradually beat into pumpkin mixture. Pour batter into two greased 8x4 loaf pans. Combine brown sugar and 1 t cinnamon. Sprinkle over tops of loaves. Bake at 325 degrees for 75 to 80 minutes.

Easy Pumpkin Chocolate Chip Bread (Kristen Johnson)

1 box of spice cake mix
1 small can of pumpkin
½ c milk chocolate or semi-sweet chips
½ c chopped walnuts (optional)
1-2 eggs (optional: depending on what texture you prefer)

Preheat oven to 350. In a big bowl combine cake mix (leave out the other ingredients called for on the box) and pumpkin. Then add your chocolate chips and nuts. Grease your bread pans. Fill half way and place pans in the oven. Cook large pans 25-27 minutes; small pans 18-22 minutes. Poke with toothpick to make sure it comes out clean and let it cool.

***You can make cupcakes, cookies, or bundt cake with this same recipe. For cupcakes and cookies, bake for 16-21 degrees at 350. For the bundt cake, bake 38-45 minutes.*

***Super Easy Pumpkin Muffins** (Lindsey Fellars)

1 (18.25 oz) pkg spice cake mix
1 (15 oz) can pumpkin

1. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees.
2. In a large bowl, mix together the spice cake mix and canned pumpkin until well blended. Scoop into greased mini-muffin pan.

3. Bake for 8-12 minutes in the preheated oven, or until a toothpick inserted in the center comes out clean. Cool and serve, or store in the refrigerator. This tastes even better the next day. You can also make regular size muffins – just add more time in the oven.

Pumpkin Bread (Cook's Illustrated, Sept & Oct 2012, p. 24)
Makes 2 loaves

Topping
5 T packed light brown sugar
1 T flour
1 T unsalted butter, softened
1 t ground cinnamon
1/8 t salt

Bread
2 c flour
1 ½ t baking powder
½ t baking soda
15 oz can pumpkin
1 t salt
1 ½ t cinnamon
¼ t nutmeg
1/8 t cloves
1 c sugar
1 c packed brown sugar
½ c vegetable oil
4 oz cream cheese, cut into 12 pieces
4 large eggs
¼ c buttermilk

1. FOR THE TOPPING: Using fingers, mix all ingredients together in bowl until well combined and topping resembles wet sand; set aside.
2. FOR THE BREAD: Adjust oven rack to middle position and heat oven to 350 degrees. Grease two 8 ½ by 4 ½ inch loaf pans. Whisk flour, baking powder, and baking soda together in bowl.
3. Combine pumpkin puree, salt, cinnamon, nutmeg, and cloves in large saucepan over medium heat. Cook mixture, stirring constantly, until reduced to 1 ½ c, 6-8 minutes. Remove pot from heat; stir in granulated sugar, brown sugar, oil, and cream cheese until combined. Let mixture stand for 5 minutes. Whisk until no visible pieces of cream cheese remain and mixture is homogeneous.

Whisk together eggs and buttermilk. Add egg mixture to pumpkin mixture and whisk to combine. Fold flour mixture into pumpkin mixture until combined (some small lumps of flour are OK). Scrape batter into prepared pans. Sprinkle topping evenly over top of each loaf. Bake until skewer inserted in center of loaf comes out clean, 45 to 50 minutes. (If using 9x5 pans, check for doneness 5 minutes early.) Let breads cool in pans on wire rack for 20 minutes. Remove breads from pans and let cool for at least 1 ½ hours. Serve warm or at room temperature.

***Zucchini Bread** (Bonnie Parkin)

2 c white flour
1 c whole wheat flour
1 ½ c sugar
1 t salt
2 t cinnamon
½ t soda
½ t baking powder
½ t nutmeg
1 T vanilla
3 eggs
¾ c applesauce
¼ c oil
4 c grated zucchini

Combine and beat sugar, oil, and eggs. Add zucchini, vanilla, and dry ingredients. Heat oven to 400 degrees, turn down to 325. Bake approximately 50 minutes.

Chocolate Zucchini Bread (from "Our Best Bites – Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Rich & gooey – could pass as cake
Makes 2 loaves

2 c flour
2 t cinnamon
1 ½ t baking soda
½ t salt
¼ c plus 2 T unsweetened cocoa powder
½ c canola oil
1 c granulated sugar
¼ c brown sugar
3 eggs
2 t vanilla
½ c sour cream
3 c shredded zucchini
¾ c mini chocolate chips

Topping:
2 T brown sugar
2 T granulated sugar
½ t cinnamon

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Butter and flour 2 loaf pans and set aside (This recipe will fit perfectly in each of a 9 inch pan and 8 inch pan.)
2. Mix topping ingredients in a small bowl and set aside.
3. Place flour, cinnamon, baking soda, salt, and cocoa powder in a small bowl and whisk to combine. Set aside.
4. With a stand or hand mixer beat oil, granulated sugar, brown sugar, and eggs until combined and slightly fluffy, 1-2 minutes.
5. Add vanilla and sour cream and mix until combined. Gently stir in the zucchini. Take a spoonful of the flour mixture and stir in with the chocolate chips (that will keep them evenly distributed). Stir remaining flour mixture into batter and mix just until combined. Add chocolate chips and stir to combine.
6. Divide the batter between the two pans and sprinkle topping over each.
7. Bake for 50-60 minutes. Set your timer for 45 minutes and then keep an eye on the loaves for the remaining time. When they're done, a toothpick should come out without goopy batter on it and the tops will be gorgeous and cracked with sugar. Remove from oven and let them cool on a rack for 5-10 minutes and then remove from pans. You definitely have to eat a slice warm – and slathered with butter.

Good-for-you Corn Bread

1 c cornmeal
1 c flour
¼ c white sugar
1 t baking powder
1 c low-fat buttermilk
1 whole egg
¼ c tub margarine
1 t oil (to grease the pan)

Directions:
1. Preheat oven to 350.
2. Mix together cornmeal, flour, sugar, and baking powder.
3. In another bowl, combine buttermilk and egg. Beat lightly.
4. Slowly add buttermilk and egg mixture to the dry ingredients.
5. Add margarine and mix by hand or with a mixer for one minute.
6. Bake for 20-25 minutes in an 8x8 greased baking dish. Cool.

Per serving: 178 Calories, 6 g fat, 0 mg cholesterol

Whole Wheat Banana Bread (from 365 Days of Slow Cooking)
Makes 8 Generous Slices

1/3 cup butter
2/3 cup sugar
2 eggs
3 ripe bananas, mashed
1 ¾ cup whole wheat flour
2 tsp baking powder
¼ tsp salt
¼ tsp baking soda

Spray 5-quart slow cooker with nonstick spray. Dust with flour. In large bowl, cream the butter with electric mixer until fluffy. Slowly add sugar, eggs, and mashed bananas. Beat until smooth. In small bowl, sift together flour, baking powder, and salt. Slowly beat flour mixture into creamed mixture. Pour into slow cooker. Cover and cook on HIGH for 2-3 hours. Let cool and then turn bread out of crock onto plate or serving platter.
Nutritional information: 292 Calories, 8.5 g fat (13%), 6 g sat fat (30%), 50 mg cholesterol (16%), 290 mg sodium (12%), 46 g carbs (15%), 2 g fiber (8%), 21 g sugar, 5 g protein (10%), 6% vitamin A, 6% vitamin C, 6.5% iron, 2% calcium

Banana-Butterscotch Quick Bread
makes 1 loaf

2 c all-purpose flour
1 t baking powder
½ t baking soda
½ t salt
½ c shortening
½ c granulated sugar
2 large eggs
½ c buttermilk
1/c very ripe bananas, mashed
½ c butterscotch chips

1. Preheat oven to 350; spray loaf pan with cooking spray. In a medium bowl, sift together dry ingredients, excluding sugar.
2. In the bowl of a stand mixer (or in a large bowl using a hand mixer), blend the shortening and sugar until light and fluffy, about 2 minutes. Add the eggs one at a time, mixing well with each addition.
3. Add ⅓ of the dry ingredients and mix well; add half the buttermilk and mix. Add another ⅓ of the dry ingredients, the remaining buttermilk and, finally, the remaining dry ingredients, stirring well with each addition. Gently stir in the fruit and chips.
4. Bake for 55-60 minutes, until a toothpick inserted into the center of the bread comes out clean.
5. Remove the bread from the pan and cool completely on a wire rack for about 30 minutes. Store tightly wrapped in plastic at room temperature, or freeze in a zip-top freezer bag.

***Unbeatable Banana Bread** (Family Fun, April 2006, p. 108)
Makes 1 large loaf, or approximately 10 servings

2 c flour
1 t baking powder
½ t baking soda
½ t salt
½ c unsalted butter, softened
1 c sugar
2 eggs, at room temperature
1 t vanilla extract
3 medium-large very ripe bananas (1 c mashed)
½ c sour cream

1. Heat the oven to 325 degrees. Grease and flour 5x9 loaf pan or 4 small pans. (1/2 recipe makes 1 small loaf from regular size bread pan.)
2. Sift together the flour, baking powder, baking soda, and salt into a medium bowl. In a large bowl, cream the butter using an electric mixer. Gradually add the sugar, scraping down the sides of the bowl as necessary. Add the eggs one at a time, beating well after each addition. Next, add the vanilla extract and blend briefly. Set both bowls aside.
3. Peel the bananas and place them in a separate bowl. Mash them with a fork or a potato masher and measure out 1 cup. Add the sour cream and stir to blend. Set the bowl aside.
4. Using a wooden spoon, blend 1/3 of the dry mixture into the butter-sugar mixture. Add the rest of the ingredients in this order, stirring well after each addition: half the banana mixture, half of the remaining dry mixture, the rest of the banana mixture, the rest of the dry mixture. Next, add in any mix-ins, if desired. (2/3 c mini chocolate chips &/or 1/3 c chopped nuts; or 1 c dried cranberries). The key to a light quick bread is to handle the batter gently, so do not overmix!
5. Scrape the batter into the prepared pan(s) and smooth the top with a spoon. Bake on the center oven rack until knife inserted comes out clean, about 70-75 minutes (45-55 minutes for smaller loaves).
6. Cool for 20 minutes, then remove from pan. Cool thoroughly before slicing.

Chocolate Banana Bread (from *Raised in the Kitchen*)
makes 1 loaf

2 c all-purpose flour
½ c cocoa powder
1 ¼ t baking soda
½ t salt
⅓ c canola oil
1 c sugar
5 T sour cream, at room temperature
2 large eggs, at room temperature
1 ¼ c mashed banana (about 2 very large or 3 small)
1 c mini chocolate chips, divided

1. Preheat oven to 350. Spray 9x5" pan with nonstick cooking spray.
2. In a large bowl, sift together flour, cocoa powder, baking soda, and salt. Set aside.
3. In a medium bowl, whisk together oil and sugar. Add sour cream and eggs and whisk again.
4. Add wet ingredients, mashed bananas, and all but 1-2 T chocolate chips to the dry ingredients and gently fold together with a rubber spatula. Do not overmix.
5. Pour batter into prepared pan and sprinkle top with remaining chocolate chips. Bake 1 hour, tenting with foil for the last 10 minutes. Touch the top, and if it doesn't leave an indentation or sink in, it's done.
6. Remove from oven. Cool 2 minutes and then turn out onto a cooling rack to finish cooling.
7. Serve warm with a swipe of butter. To store, wrap cooled loaf tightly in plastic wrap. It will keep 2-3 days.

Ian Bread (invented/adapted by Mckay & Ian)

2 c whole wheat flour
1 c all-purpose flour
1 ¼ t baking powder
1 ¼ t salt
4 t vegetable oil
⅞ c boiling water
3 T honey
3 T molasses

Mix dry ingredients together. Mix in wet ingredients. Knead a few times. Divide dough in 4 parts and flatten each part into a disk about ¼ inch thick. Bake at 350 degrees about 15 minutes.

Irish Brown Bread

2 ¼ c whole wheat flour
2 ¼ c all-purpose flour
1 ½ c rolled oats
1 t baking soda
1 t salt
1 T sugar
2 ½ c buttermilk

1. Heat oven to 400 degrees. Combine everything except buttermilk and stir with hands. Make a well in the mixture and add 1 ½ c buttermilk.
2. Continue mixing with hands, adding remaining buttermilk. Resulting dough will be wet and very sticky.
3. Dust hands with flour; shape dough into a ball and place on floured cookie sheet. Score deep "x" in top with knife.
4. Bake until golden brown, about 50 minutes. Cool at least 10 minutes before slicing. Makes a crusty dense loaf about 7 inches in diameter.

Sadies's Scrumptulicious Scones (from *English Trifle* book by Josi S. Kilpack)

1 c sour cream (light works fine)
1 t baking soda
4 c all-purpose flour
1 c sugar
2 t baking powder
1 t salt
¼ t cream of tarter
1 c butter
1 egg

Combine sour cream and baking soda in 2 cup bowl or measuring cup (mixture expands, so you'll want to have extra space). Set aside. Whisk together dry ingredients in a large mixing bowl. Cut butter into dry ingredients using a pastry blender until

mixture resembles coarse cornmeal. Add sour cream mixture and egg. Mix until a soft dough forms – use your hands if necessary. Turn dough onto lightly floured surface and knead a few times, then pat or roll until 1-inch thick. Cut into circles or use pica cutter to cut into triangles. Place scones two inches apart on lightly greased baking sheet. Glaze, if desired. Bake at 350 degrees for 20-25 minutes or until bottom edges are golden brown. Makes 8-14, depending on size of scones.

Glaze (optional, but super yummy)
1 egg
1 T whipping cream

Mix together egg and cream. Brush on top of unbaked scones and bake as directed. Sprinkle cooked scones with powdered sugar. Set oven to broil, but leave oven rack in the center position. Put pan in oven, keeping door open about an inch and watch closely. Sugar takes 30-90 seconds to turn a golden brown. Remove scones from oven; serve while still warm.

Garlic Parmesan Focaccia Bread (from *Raised in the Kitchen)*
makes 10 servings

2 cups flour (bread flour or all-purpose is fine)
1 teaspoon kosher salt
1 cup warm water
1 ⅛ teaspoons instant yeast
1/2 teaspoon granulated sugar
Olive oil
3 cloves garlic, minced
2/3 cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese
1 ½ teaspoons Italian seasoning
Flaked sea salt

1. In a glass bowl, combine flour and salt.
2. In a glass measuring cup, mix the warm water, yeast, and sugar. Allow to sit for a minute and then stir into the flour with a wooden spoon until the dough just comes together.
3. Cover the bowl tightly with plastic wrap and place in the fridge for 8 hours or overnight.
4. Remove the bowl from the fridge.
5. In an 8-inch round cake pan, drizzle oil and place the dough in the center, tucking ends under.
6. Cover with plastic wrap and allow to rise 2 hours.
7. Heat the oven to 450 degrees F.
8. Once risen, the dough should fill the pan. Drizzle with additional oil and use your fin-gers to press holes down to the bottom of the pan but not through the dough.
9. Mix garlic, cheese, and Italian seasoning in a bowl.
10. Sprinkle the dough with the garlic mixture and sea salt.
11. Place in the oven and turn down to 425 degrees F. Bake 22 to 24 minutes or until golden.

Tortillas (from *Raised in the Kitchen)*
makes 12 tortillas

6 cups bread flour
2/3 cup plus 2 tablespoons canola or vegetable oil
3 teaspoons salt
4 teaspoons baking powder
2 1/4 cups boiling water

1. In the bowl of a stand mixer fitted with a dough hook, combine flour, salt, baking powder, and oil. Mix on low speed until a dough forms and resembles barely wet sand. You'll know it's ready when you can squeeze it in your hand and have the dough hold together.
2. With mixer on low, add boiling water, 1/2 cup at a time. Once dough is combined, mix on low another 2 to 4 minutes until dough is satiny.
3. Lightly flour or grease your hands. Remove dough to counter, then pinch off a piece of dough just smaller than the palm of your hand. In your hands, knead the dough a few times to form a rounded disc. Place in a greased bowl. Repeat until all dough is used. Cover bowl with a warm, damp paper towel and rest at least 10 to 15 minutes, or up to an hour.

4. When ready to cook, heat a cast-iron pan or griddle to medium heat. On a lightly floured work surface, roll out the dough balls into circles one at a time with a rolling pin until very thin.
5. Cook tortillas on hot griddle until bubbles form.

Quick Buttermilk Cinnamon Bread

4 c flour
2 t baking soda
1 t salt
½ c vegetable oil
1 ½ c sugar
2 c buttermilk
2 eggs
1 T cinnamon
1 c sugar

1. Mix flour, baking soda, and salt in a large bowl. In a small bowl combine oil and sugar; add buttermilk and eggs and mix well; stir into dry ingredients just until moistened.
2. Fill 2 8x4 loaf pans (or 5 small ones) about 1/3 full.
3. Combine cinnamon and remaining 1 c sugar; sprinkle half over the batter; top with remaining batter and cinnamon-sugar; swirl batter with a knife.
4. Bake at 350 degrees, 45-55 minutes or until a toothpick comes out clean; cool in pans for 10 minutes before removing to a wire rack.

Poppy Seed Bread

3 eggs
2 ½ c sugar
1 c oil or melted butter
1 ½ t almond extract
1 ½ t vanilla
1 ½ T poppy seeds
3 c flour
1 t salt
1 ½ t baking powder
1 ½ c milk

Beat eggs. Add sugar, oil, vanilla, almond extract and poppy seeds and set aside. In small bowl, sift together flour, salt, and baking powder. Mix flour mixture with egg mixture, alternating with milk. Pour mixture into 5 small loaf pans (greased and floured). Bake at 350 degrees for 50 minutes. With fork, poke holes in top of the hot bread.

<u>Glaze</u>:
¾ c sugar
¼ c orange juice
½ t vanilla
1 ½ t almond extract
2 T melted butter

Stir glaze together and spoon over hot bread. Cool half hour before removing from pans.

Lemon Poppy Seed Bread

2 c sugar
1 c vegetable oil
3 eggs
1 ½ t vanilla extract
1 t lemon extract
2 T poppy seeds
3 c all-purpose flour
1 ½ t baking powder
1 ½ t salt
1 ½ c milk
<u>Icing</u>
2 T lemon juice
¾ c confectioners' sugar

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Grease and flour 2 loaf pans. Combine sugar, oil, eggs, vanilla and lemon extracts in a large bowl; mix well. Stir in poppy seeds.
2. Sift together flour, baking powder and salt. Add flour mixture and milk to sugar mixture alternately, mixing well after each addition. Divide batter evenly between prepared pans.
3. Bake loaves for 45 minutes or until a toothpick inserted in center comes out clean. Loosen edges from sides of pans.

Cool loaves in pans for 10 minutes. Turn out onto wire racks.

4. For icing, blend lemon juice and confectioners' sugar in a small bowl. Drizzle over warm loaves.

Almond Poppy Seed Bread (from *Blendtec)*
makes 2 loaves

3 large eggs
1 apple, cored and quartered
⅓ c canola oil
½ c water
¼ c almonds
1 c soy milk
1 ½ t lemon juice
1 ½ t almond extract
1 ½ t vanilla extract
1 ¼ c granulated sugar
2 t baking powder
1 t baking soda
2 ½ c all-purpose flour
3 T poppy seeds
3 T soy milk, optional
1 t almond extract, optional
1 ½ c powdered sugar, optional
2 T almonds, sliced, optional

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. To prepare the batter: Add eggs, apple, canola oil, water, and ¼ c almonds to WildSide jar and secure lid. Select "whole juice." Add 1 c soy milk, lemon juice, 1 ½ t almond extract, vanilla extract, and sugar to jar and secure lid. Press "pulse" 3-4 times. Add baking soda, baking powder, and flour to jar and secure lid. Select "batters." Add poppy seeds to jar and secure lid. Press "pulse" 1-2 times.
2. Pour batter into two greased 8x4 loaf pans. Bake for 40-50 minutes or until wooden toothpick inserted comes out clean. Let cool.
3. To prepare glaze (optional): Add 3 T soy milk, 1 t almond extract, and powdered sugar to clean WildSide jar and secure lid. Select "batters" and pour over cooled bread. Sprinkle sliced almonds on top.

***Best Blueberry Muffins** (Cooks Illustrated, May & June 2009, p.21)
Makes 12 muffins

Streusel Topping
3 T granulated sugar
3 T dark brown sugar
Pinch table salt
½ c plus 3 T all-purpose flour
5 T warm, melted unsalted butter

Muffins
2 c (about 10 oz) fresh or frozen blueberries
1 1/8 c plus 1 t sugar
2 ½ c all-purpose flour
2 ½ t baking powder
1 t table salt
2 large eggs
4 T unsalted butter, melted and cooled slightly
¼ c vegetable oil
1 c buttermilk (or ¾ c plain yogurt thinned with ¼ c milk)
1 ½ t vanilla extract

1. FOR THE TOPPING: Stir together dry ingredients, then drizzle with melted butter and toss with fork until evenly moistened and mixture forms large chunks with some pea-sized pieces throughout. Set aside.
2. FOR THE MUFFINS: Adjust oven rack to upper-middle position and heat oven to 425 degrees. Spray standard muffin tin with nonstick cooking spray. Bring 1 c blueberries and 1 t sugar to simmer in small saucepan over medium heat. Cook, mashing berries with spoon several times and stirring frequently, until berries have broken down and mixture is thickened and reduced to ¼ c, about 6 minutes. Transfer to small bowl (I just leave in pan and move off heat) and cool to room temperature, 10-15 minutes.
3. Whisk flour, baking powder, and salt together in large bowl. Whisk remaining 1 1/8 c sugar and eggs together in medium bowl until thick and homogeneous, about 45 seconds. Slowly whisk in butter and oil until combined. Whisk in buttermilk and vanilla until combined. Using rubber spatula, fold egg mixture and remaining cup blueberries (if using frozen berries, after rinsing and patting dry, toss dried berries in flour mixture before adding to egg mixture) into flour mixture until just moistened. (Batter will be very lumpy with few spots of dry flour; do not overmix.)
4. Divide batter equally among prepared muffin cups (batter should completely fill cups and mound slightly). Spoon teaspoon of cooked berry mixture into center of each mound of batter. Using chopstick or skewer, gently swirl berry filling into batter using figure-eight motion. Sprinkle streusel topping evenly over muffins.

5. Bake until muffin tops are golden and just firm, 17-19 minutes. Cool muffins in muffin tin for 5 minutes, then transfer to wire rack and cool 5 minutes before serving.

***Bake mini muffins 9-10 minutes at 425 or 4 mini bread loaves at 375 for 45 minutes.*

Raspberry Yogurt Muffins
Makes 1 dozen

2 c flour
1/3 c sugar
1 t baking powder
1 t baking soda
¼ t salt
¼ c orange juice
2 T oil
½ t almond extract
1 (8 oz) container vanilla yogurt
1 egg
1 c fresh or frozen raspberries

1. Line a 12 cup muffin tin with paper liners. Preheat oven to 400 degrees.
2. In a large bowl, combine flour, sugar, baking powder, baking soda, and salt. Mix well
3. In another bowl, whisk together orange juice, oil, almond extract, yogurt and egg. Add to dry ingredients and stir just until moistened. (Add 1-2 T milk if too dry.) Fold in berries.
4. Spoon into muffin cups. Bake at 400 degrees for about 20 minutes or until golden.

Peach-brown sugar muffins
Makes 1 dozen.

2 c flour
4 T packed brown sugar
1 T baking powder
½ c chopped peaches (fresh or canned)
¼ t baking soda
1/8 t allspice
1 c sour cream
1 egg
4 T melted butter

1. Preheat oven to 425 degrees. Grease 12 regular size muffin-tin cups. In a large bowl, mix flour, brown sugar, and baking powder. Add peaches, baking soda, and allspice. Toss to coat peaches thoroughly.
2. In another bowl combine sour cream, egg, and butter. Add to dry ingredients and stir until moist but lumpy. (Add more sour cream or some milk if too thick, otherwise they'll turn out more like biscuits.)
3. Spoon into greased muffin cups. Bake at 425 degrees 15 minutes or until the top springs back when gently touched.

Healthy Gingerbread Muffins (*Mckay and Lisa liked these*)

½ c coconut oil
⅓ c molasses
1 egg
½ c real maple syrup
½ c light sour cream
½ c milk
1 T fresh ginger paste (or 1 t ground ginger)
1 ½ c all-purpose flour
1 c whole wheat flour
1 ½ t baking soda
½ t salt
2 t cinnamon
turbinado sugar for topping

1. Preheat the oven to 375 degrees. Grease a muffin tin with cooking spray or butter.
2. Melt the coconut oil. In a small bowl, whisk the molasses into the liquid coconut oil.
3. In a mixing bowl, whisk the eggs, maple syrup, sour cream, milk and ginger. Let the mixture sit until it reaches room temperature (this prevents the coconut oil from clumping when you mix it in).
4. Once it reaches room temperature, add the coconut oil and molasses mixture.
5. Add the flour, baking soda, salt and cinnamon. Stir until just combined.
6. Scoop into a muffin tin and sprinkle the tops with turbinado sugar.
7. Bake 17-20 minutes, or until the tops are puffy and firm to the touch. Let cool for a few minutes before serving.

YEAST BREADS & ROLLS

***Multigrain Bread** (Cook's Illustrated, March & April 2006, page 25)
Makes two 9x5 inch loaves

1 ¼ c 7-grain hot cereal mix (Bob's Red Mill or Arrowhead Mills)
2 ½ c boiling water
3 c unbleached all-purpose flour
1 ½ c whole wheat flour
4 T honey
4 T unsalted butter, melted and cooled slightly
2 ½ t instant yeast
1 T salt
¾ c unsalted pumpkin or sunflower seeds (I don't use these because we don't like chunks!)
½ c old-fashioned rolled oats or quick oats

1. Place cereal mix in bowl and pour boiling water over it; let stand, stirring occasionally, until mixture cools to 100 degrees and resembles thick porridge, about 1 hour. Whisk flours in medium bowl.
2. Once grain mixture has cooled, add honey, melted butter, and yeast and stir to combine. Add flours, ½ cup at a time, and knead until dough forms ball; cover bowl with plastic and let dough rest 20 minutes. Add salt and knead til dough clears sides of bowl, about 3 minutes. (If needed, add 2-3 T additional flour. Continue to knead 5 more minutes. Add seeds and knead another 15 seconds. Transfer dough to floured surface and knead by hand until seeds are dispersed evenly and dough forms smooth, taut ball. Place dough into greased container with 4 qt capacity; cover with plastic wrap and rise til doubled, 45-60 minutes.
3. Adjust oven rack to middle position; heat oven to 375 degrees. Spray two 9 x 5 inch loaf pans (or 4 mini loaves) with nonstick cooking spray. Transfer dough to lightly floured surface and pat into rectangles. Fold into shape (like a trifold letter going into an envelope) and roll in oats to coat evenly. Cover lightly with plastic wrap and let rise til almost doubled in size, 30 to 40 minutes. (Dough should barely spring back when poked with knuckle.) Bake until internal temperature registers 200 degrees, 35 to 40 minutes. Remove from pans and cool before slicing, about 3 hours.

Honey Wheat Rolls (from *The $5 Dinner Mom Cookbook*, p. 260)
Makes 12 rolls

1 c hot water
2 c white flour
1 c wheat flour
2 T honey
1 T yeast
1 t sugar
1 t salt
1 t oil

In a mixing bowl, combine the hot water with 1 c of the flour. Add the honey, yeast, sugar, salt, and oil. Whisk together to make a "spongy" dough. Let sit for 10-15 minutes. Grease a baking sheet.

Add the remaining 2 c flour to the spongy dough and stir with a wooden spoon. When the dough becomes thick enough, knead it by hand for 6-8 minutes on a floured surface or in a floured bowl.

Divide the dough ball in half, then again into thirds. Form 12 dough balls into rolls and place on a greased baking sheet. Set aside and let rise for at least 30 minutes in a warm place. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees.

Bake the rolls in the preheated oven for 15-20 minutes, until golden brown on top. Remove from the oven and let cool on a rack.

Serve warm with butter and honey.

Fluffy Whole Wheat Rolls

2 T dry yeast
½ c warm water
¼ c honey
½ c butter
1 c warm water
3 eggs
1 ½ t salt
4-5 c whole wheat flour

Dissolve yeast in ½ c warm water. Cream butter and honey to a fine stream. Add eggs, one at a time and beat. Add yeast mixture. Add flour and salt. Let rise until double. Knead then rest 3 minutes. For rolls - let rise and bake at 350 for 15-20 minutes.

***Soft and Delicious Two-Hour Whole Wheat Bread** (from Stake RS Preparedness night)
Fantastic light and fluffy yummy rolls or bread

½ recipe	Regular recipe
2 c	4 c warm water
1T	2 T yeast
2T + 2 t	1/3 c oil
2T + 2 t	1/3 c honey
1 egg	2 eggs
2T + 2 t	1/3 c potato flakes
1T	2 T gluten flour (this is the ingredient that makes these so soft and smooth)
½ T	1 T salt
3 c	6 c wheat flour
2-2 ½ c	4-5 c unbleached white flour

Dissolve yeast in warm water. Make a sponge using all ingredients down to and including salt. Add about 3 c flour and beat well. Let rest about 10 minutes. Add remaining flour gradually as needed to make a soft dough. Knead on floured board; cover with plastic wrap and let rise until double. Punch down; shape into four loaves; place in greased bread pans. Cover and let rise again until double. Bake for 30 minutes at 350. Remove bread from pans and cool on sides on cooling rack. Store in plastic bags. Makes 4 loaves or 3 dozen rolls (actually more).

Wheat Bread (Sister Hinckley's recipe)

Dissolve 2 packages dry yeast in ½ c water with ½ T honey or sugar. Mix the following ingredients (with the dissolved yeast) in bread mixer:

3 ½ c warm water
1 ½ c dry powdered milk
1 c oil
4 eggs, beaten
¾ c honey
2 T salt
1 or 2 c white flour
About 10 c whole wheat flour

After kneading in a bread mixer, let rise until doubled. Divide into 6 small loaves (or 3 large ones). Knead and shape. Let rise in greased pans. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Reduce to 300 degrees and bake 1 hour (slightly longer for large loaves).

***Whole Wheat Bread** (Sarah Dodson's recipe)
Makes 2 (8x4 inch) loaves
Important Note: To make a 2-loaf recipe of this bread every other day for 1 year (1 loaf a day), you will need 275 lbs of wheat ground into flour, 4 gallons of oil, 46 lbs of honey or sugar, 8 (1 lb) pkgs yeast, 61 cups gluten flour, 3 ⅔ quarts of lemon juice and 7.3 lbs of salt.

3 ½ c whole wheat flour
⅓ c gluten flour*
1 ¼ T instant yeast
2 ½ c steaming hot tap water
1 T salt
⅓ c oil
⅓ cup honey or ½ c sugar
1 ¼ T bottled lemon juice
2 ½ c whole wheat flour

1. Mix together first three ingredients in mixer with dough hook. Add water all at once and mix for 1 minute; cover and let rest for 10 minutes. Add salt, oil, honey (or sugar), and lemon juice and beat for 1 minute. Add last flour, 1 c at a time, beating between each cup. Beat for about 10 minutes until dough pulls away from sides of bowl. THIS MAKES A VERY SOFT DOUGH.
2. Preheat oven for 1 minute to lukewarm and turn off. Turn dough onto oiled counter top; divide and shape into loaves and place into oiled bread pans. Let rise in warm oven for 10-15 minutes until dough reaches top of pan. Do not remove bread from oven; turn oven to 350 F and bake for 30 minutes. Remove from pans, and cool on racks.

**Gluten is a natural protein derived from wheat. It is used in bread to provide elasticity and strength, added texture, and helps retain moisture in breads and doughs. It helps prevent crumbling and extends the shelf life of baked bread.*

Honey Whole Wheat Bread (from *Blendtec.com*)

1 cup warm water
1 tbsp instant yeast
1⁄4 cup honey, divided
2 ¾ cups whole wheat flour
1 tsp kosher or sea salt
1 tbsp canola oil
1 tbsp vital wheat gluten
1 tbsp lemon juice

1. Add flour, salt, and vital wheat gluten to jar in order listed and secure lid. Press "Pulse" 3–5 times to mix and sift dry ingredients. Pour dry ingredients into a separate bowl.
2. Add water, yeast and 1 tbsp honey to jar and secure lid. Press "Pulse" 2 times. Allow the yeast to proof 5–10 minutes.
3. Add remaining honey, oil, and lemon juice to jar and secure lid. Press "Pulse" 2 times. Add ⅓ of dry ingredients to jar and secure lid. Press “Pulse” 2–3 times. Add next ⅓ of dry ingredients to jar and secure lid. Press “Pulse” 4-6 times. Add the last ⅓ of dry ingredients to jar and secure lid. Press "Pulse" 6–8 times until all flour is incorporated and a dough ball forms.
4. Allow dough to rest in jar for 10–15 minutes. Dump dough ball onto oiled surface and shape loaf.
5. Place shaped loaf, seam side down, into 9"x 5" greased loaf pan. Cover loaf pan and allow dough to rise for 20 minutes in a warm place or until dough has topped the pans by approximately one inch.
6. Bake for at 350°F for 20-22 minutes, then increase temperature to 400 degrees and bake until top is golden brown. Remove bread from pan and allow it to cool on a wire rack before slicing.

Whole-Wheat Sandwich Bread (from *Cooks’ Illustrated*)
Makes two 9x5-inch loaves

<u>Biga</u>
2 c (11 oz) bread flour
1 c (8 oz) warm water (100-110 degrees)
½ t instant or rapid-rise yeast

<u>Soaker</u>
3 c (16 ½ oz) whole-wheat flour, plus extra for kneading
½ c wheat germ
2 c (16 oz) whole milk

<u>Dough</u>
¼ c honey
4 t table salt
2 T instant or rapid-rise yeast
6 T unsalted butter, softened
2 T vegetable oil
Bread flour for work surface

1. FOR THE BIGA: Combine bread flour, water, and yeast in large bowl and stir with wooden spoon until uniform mass forms and no dry flour remains, about 1 minute. Cover bowl tightly with plastic wrap and let stand at room temperature (70 degrees) overnight (at least 8 hours and up to 24 hours).
2. FOR THE SOAKER: Combine whole-wheat flour, wheat germ and milk in large bowl and stir with wooden spoon until shaggy mass forms, about 1 minute. Turn out dough onto lightly floured work surface and knead until smooth, 2-3 minutes. Return soaker to bowl, cover tightly with plastic wrap, and refrigerate overnight (at least 8 hours and up to 24

hours).

3. FOR THE DOUGH: Tear soaker apart into 1-in pieces and place in bowl of stand mixer fitted with dough hook. Add biga, honey, salt, yeast, butter, and oil. Mix on low speed until cohesive mass starts to form, about 2 minutes. Increase speed to medium and knead until dough is smooth and elastic, 8-10 minutes. Turn out dough onto lightly floured counter and knead 1 minute. Shape dough into ball and place in lightly greased container. Cover tightly with plastic wrap and allow to rise at room temperature 45 minutes.
4. Gently press down on center of dough to deflate. Holding edge of dough with fingertips, fold partially risen dough over itself by gently lifting and folding edge of dough toward middle. Turn bowl 90 degrees; fold again. Turn bowl and fold dough 6 more times (total of 8 folds). Cover and allow to rise at room temperature until doubled in volume, about 45 minutes.
5. Adjust oven racks to middle and lowest positions, place baking stone on middle rack, and heat oven to 400 degrees. Spray two 8 ½ by 4 ½ inch loaf pans with nonstick cooking spray. Transfer dough to well-floured counter and divide into 2 pieces. Working with 1 ball of dough at a time, pat each into 8 by 17 inch rectangle. With short side facing you, roll dough toward you into firm cylinder, keeping roll taught by tucking it under itself as you go. Turn loaf seam side up and pinch it closed. Place loaf seam side down in prepared loaf pan, pressing gently into corners. Repeat with second ball of dough. Cover loaves loosely with plastic wrap and allow to rise at room temperature until almost doubled in size, 60-90 minutes (tops of loaves should rise about 1 inch over lip of pan).
6. Place empty loaf pan or other heatproof pan on bottom oven rack and bring 2 cups water to a boil on stovetop. Using sharp serrated knife or single-edged razor blade, make one ¼ inch deep slash lengthwise down center of each loaf. Pour boiling water in empty loaf pan in oven and set loaves on baking stone. Reduce oven temperature to 350 degrees. Bake until crust is dark brown and internal temperature registers 200 degrees on instant-read thermometer, 40-50 minutes, rotating loaves 180 degrees and side to side halfway through baking.
7. Transfer pans to wire rack and let cool 5 minutes. Remove loaves from pans, return to rack, and cool to room temperature, about 2 hours.

Best American Dinner Rolls (from *Cooks' Illustrated*, September & October 2006)
makes sixteen 3-inch rolls

¾ c whole milk
6 T unsalted butter, melted, plus 2 T melted, for brushing on rolls before baking
6 T sugar
1 ½ t table salt
2 large eggs, room temperature
2 ¼ t (1 pkt) instant (rapid rise) yeast
3 c (15 oz) unbleached all-purpose flour, plus additional flour as needed

1. TO MAKE THE DOUGH: Bring milk to boil in small saucepan over medium heat; let stand off heat until skin forms on surface, 3-5 minutes. Using soup spoon, skim skin off surface and discard. Transfer milk to bowl of standing mixer and add 6 T melted butter, sugar, and salt; whisk to combine and let mixture cool. When mixture is just warm to the touch (90-100 degrees), whisk in eggs and yeast until combined.
2. Add flour to bowl; using dough hook, mix on low speed on standing mixer until combined, 1-2 minutes. Increase speed to medium-low and knead about 3 minutes more; when pressed with finger, dough should feel tacky and moist but should not stick to finger. (If dough is sticky, add another 1-3 T flour.) Continue to knead on medium-low until cohesive, elastic dough has formed (it should clear sides of bowl but stick to bottom), 4-5 minutes longer.
3. Transfer dough to lightly floured work surface. Knead dough by hand 1-2 minutes to ensure that it is well kneaded. Dough should be very soft and moist but not overly stick. If dough sticks excessively to hands and work surface, knead in flour a T at a time until dough is workable. Lightly spray medium bowl with nonstick cooking spray. Transfer dough to bowl; lightly coat surface of dough with cooking spray and cover with plastic wrap. Let dough rise in warm, draft-free location until double in volume, 2-3 hours.
4. TO SHAPE ROLLS: Coat two 9" round pans with cooking spray; set aside. Turn dough out onto lightly floured surface. Pat dough into rough 12x10" rectangle, gently press out air; starting from edge farthest from you, roll long edge of rectangle into cylinder. Using palms, roll dough back and forth until cylinder is about 18" long and of even thickness.

Using bench scraper or chef's knife, cut cylinder in half crosswise, then cut each half into 8 even pieces (for 16 total).

5. Working with one piece at a time and keeping remaining pieces covered with plastic wrap or kitchen towel, form dough pieces into smooth taut rounds. Set piece of dough on unfloured area of work surface. Loosely cup hand around dough (not directly over it); without applying pressure to dough, move hand in smooth circular motions. (Tackiness of dough against the work surface and circular motion should work dough into smooth, even ball.) Arrange shaped rolls unprepared cake pans (one in center and seven spaced evenly around the edges); cover pans with plastic wrap lightly coated with cooking spray, then cover pans securely with foil. Refrigerate at least 24 or up to 48 hours.
6. TO BAKE THE ROLLS: Remove foil (not plastic wrap) from cake pans; let rolls rise in a draft-free cool room-temperature location until doubled in volume (rolls should press against each other), 6-7 hours. When rolls are nearly doubled in volume, adjust oven rack to low-middle position and heat oven to 400 degrees. Remove plastic wrap. Brush rolls with 2 T melted butter; bake until deep golden brown, 14-18 minutes. Cool rolls in pan on wire rack about 3 minutes, then invert onto plate. Re-invert rolls and cool 10-15 minutes longer. Break rolls apart and serve warm.

***Mary's Rolls** (from Shauni Hawkins)
Makes 4 dozen rolls

2 c water, divided
1 c butter, softened
2 T yeast
¾ c sugar
1 t salt
1 t baking powder
2 eggs
5-8 cups flour (use bread flour)

In a large mixing bowl, mix butter and 1 c of boiling water. Add second c of water and let it cool a little until just warm to the touch. Add sugar and yeast, mix and let sit until foaming (15-20 min). Add eggs, mix well. Add flour, salt, and baking powder. Scrape down sides of bowl after each addition of flour. Start with 5 c of flour, and if needed, add more flour until the dough doesn't stick to your hands. Let rise until double. Punch down. Separate into thirds. Roll into a 12-14 inch circle and cut into 16 pie-shaped wedges. Roll wedges into crescent shape from long side to the point. Place on 3 greased or parchment lined baking sheets. Let rise until double. Bake at 400 degrees for 7-9 min, or until golden brown on top.

***Lion House Crescent Rolls** (from *The Lion House Cookbook*)
makes 3 dozen rolls

2 T yeast
2 c warm water
⅓ c sugar
⅓ c shortening, margarine, or butter
2 t salt
⅔ c nonfat dry milk
1 egg
5-6 cups flour
melted butter or margarine

1. Mix yeast and water and let stand 5 minutes. Add sugar, shortening, salt, dry milk, egg, and 2 c of the flour. Beat together till smooth. Gradually add remaining flour till soft dough is formed.
2. Turn onto a lightly floured surface and knead till smooth and elastic. Place in greased bowl; cover and let rise till double in bulk.
3. Punch down; divide into thirds. Roll out ⅓ of dough into circle; cut into 12 pie-shaped pieces. Starting at wide end, roll up each piece into crescent. Place on greased baking sheet with point on bottom. Repeat with remainder of dough. Brush tops with melted butter or margarine. Let rise till double. Bake at 400 degrees for 15 minutes. Serve warm with Honey Butter, if desired.

<u>Honey Butter</u>

½ c softened butter
¼ t vanilla
1 egg yolk
1 c honey

Whip butter. Add vanilla and egg yolk. Gradually whip in honey till light and fluffy.

***Homemade Potato Rolls** (Aunt Katie's recipe)
makes 48 rolls

¾ c sugar
¾ c shortening *(Katie uses butter flavor shortening or half butter/ half butter shortening)*
3 c scalded milk (instructions below)
1 c potato pearls or flakes
1 T salt (*Katie uses sea salt)*
4 eggs
1 T Instant Yeast or 2 T Fleshmann's yeast
7 c flour
⅓ c additional butter, softened

1. Heat a medium sauce pan over medium heat and add the milk. Cook until the edges begin to foam and froth, but do not allow it to boil. There will be a little layer of the milk "skin" on top. Remove from heat and add the sugar, shortening, potato flakes and salt. Stir thoroughly and allow to cool to lukewarm. Add the yeast. Stir, and then add the eggs, stirring until they are mixed in. Place the flour in a large bowl. Pour the milk mixture in and stir until the dough has come together, but is still soft. (Sometimes we only use like 6-6 ½ c of flour.) This is not like bread dough. It is slightly sticky dough.
2. Cover the bowl with a towel or plastic wrap. Let dough rise for one hour. Push down and divide dough into 3 parts. Roll out one portion at a time to ½" thick and butter ½ of dough with a few pats of butter. Fold the unbuttered dough over the buttered dough and press to seal. Cut into 1" wide strips. Pick up one strip at a time and tie into knots. Place on lightly greased cookie sheet and cover with a towel. Let rise for 1-2 hours more or until doubled in size.
3. Bake at 350 until golden brown, 14-20 minutes.

***Dinner Rolls** *(Heather Jensen's recipe)* - my kids love these

2 T dry yeast
2 C. warm water
2/3 c. sugar
1/3 c. butter
1 tsp salt
2/3 c. dry milk
1 egg
5-6 c. flour

Mix yeast, water and sugar. Sit for 2-3 mins. Until it looks like it's a little bubbly. Add butter, salt and dry milk. Mix until well blended. Add 1 c. flour, mix well, add egg, mix, add rest of flour 1 c. at a time. I have a Kitchen Aid and let it really beat the dough after each cup of flour. I think this makes a huge difference. Stop at 5 cups of flour and check dough. Should be elastic and smooth but not sticky. Can add a little water if too firm. I mix my dough for about 10 minutes, and this makes the rolls a smoother texture. Let rise for about 30 mins. (I heat my oven to 100 degrees and let the dough rise in there, it speeds up the rising process.

Roll out into desired shapes. I like the crescent shape where you divide the dough in half, roll out like pizza dough, cut pizza slices, then roll up wide end to small end. Let rise for another 30 mins. Bake 375 degrees for 11 – 12 mins. depending on your oven.(some ovens may do better at 350 degrees)

Butter surface of rolls right out of oven. Enjoy!

Potato Puff Buns (from Worldwide Ward Cookbook – Mom's Best Recipes, p. 55)
Makes 5-6 dozen dinner rolls or 3-4 dozen cinnamon rolls

6 c warm water
1 c powdered milk
4 T instant yeast
1 c shortening
1 c sugar
2 c mashed potato flakes
4 eggs, beaten
2 T salt
Flour

Combine all ingredients but flour; stir in enough flour to make soft dough. Knead on speed 1 in a bread machine or with an electric mixer for 5 minutes. Let rise until double in size. Roll out for cinnamon rolls or dinner rolls. Let rise again. Bake at 350 for 20-25 minutes.

Shirley's rolls (sent by RuthE)
Prep Time: 4 hrs - Total Time: 4 1/2 hrs

5 -6 cups unsifted flour
1/2 cup sugar
1 1/2 teaspoons salt
2 (1/4 ounce) packages active dry yeast
1 cup milk
2/3 cup water
1/4 cup oleo (*margarine)*
2 eggs (room temperature)

1. In a large bowl, mix 2 cups of flour, sugar, salt and UNDISSOLVED Yeast.
2. Combine, milk water and margarine in a sauce pan.
3. Heat over low heat until very warm (butter does not need to melt).
4. Gradually add to dry ingredients and beat 2 minutes.
5. Add eggs and 3/4 cup flour; beat 2 more minutes.
6. Stir in enough more flour to make a stiff dough.
7. Turn out on a lightly floured board.
8. Knead until smooth and elastic, about 10 minutes.
9. Cover with plastic wrap and then a towel; let rise 20 minutes.
10. Punch down dough.
11. Form into round balls and place in greased pan.
12. Brush with oil.
13. Cover pans (loosely) with plastic wrap.
14. Refrigerate 2 to 24 hours.
15. When ready to bake, remove from refrigerator and uncover CAREFULLY.
16. Let stand at room temperature 10 minutes.
17. BAKE AT 375° for 20 to 25 minutes or until done.
18. When done brush with butter and enjoy

Read more: http://baking.food.com/recipe/shirleys-yummy-dinner-rolls-18351#ixzz1H7VsfGvP

Patricia's Basic Bread Dough (from Martha Stewart Living via **Jeri's blog)**
Makes 1 1/2 lbs. dough - One simple, easy-to-prepare bread dough can be transformed into breads, both sweet and savory, from pizza to dinner rolls.

1 teaspoon active dry yeast
1 teaspoon sugar
1 1/3 C. lukewarm water (about 105 degrees)
2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
1 teaspoon fine sea salt (I use what's in the blue canister, Morton's)
4 C. bread flour, plus more if necessary

1. In the bowl of a heavy-duty electric mixer fitted with a dough hook attachment, combine yeast, sugar, and water, and stir. Let sit until foamy, about 5 minutes. Stir in oil and salt.

2. Add flour, a little at a time, mixing at the lowest speed until the flour has been absorbed, and the dough forms a ball. Continue on lowest speed until soft and satiny but still firm, 4 to 5 minutes. Add more flour, if necessary, to keep the dough from sticking. The dough should be soft.

3. Transfer the dough to a bowl, cover tightly with plastic wrap in the refrigerator. Let the dough rise in the refrigerator until double in bulk, 8-12 hrs. The dough can be kept for 2-3 days in the refrigerator. Simply punch down the dough as it doubles.

NOTE from Jeri: I don't do steps 2 and 3 the way stated above. After the dough becomes a ball, I then knead it in the mixer for 5 minutes on high. I transfer to an oiled bowl and cover loosely with plastic wrap and allow to double in size. I then punch down and shape into loaves and put into greased pans, making sure a little oil in on the tops to avoid drying out. I cover with plastic and allow to raise. Bake at 350 for 30 minutes. ANOTHER NOTE: I usually double this recipe and make 3 loaves out of it.

***Crusty French Bread** (allrecipes.com, made by Shannon Nelson)

1 (.25 ounce) package active dry yeast
1 cup warm water (110 degrees to 115 degrees)
2 tablespoons sugar
2 tablespoons vegetable oil
1 1/2 teaspoons salt
3 cups all-purpose flour
Cornmeal
1 egg white
1 teaspoon cold water

1. In a large mixing bowl, dissolve yeast in warm water. Add the sugar, oil, salt and 2 cups flour. Beat until blended. Stir in enough remaining flour to form a stiff dough.
2. Turn onto a floured surface; knead until smooth and elastic, about 6-8 minutes. Place in a greased bowl, turning once to grease top. Cover and let rise in a warm place until doubled, about 1 hour. Punch dough down; return to bowl. Cover and let rise for 30 minutes.
3. Punch dough down. Turn onto a lightly floured surface. Shape into a loaf 16 in. long x 2-1/2 in. wide with tapered ends. Sprinkle a greased baking sheet with cornmeal; place loaf on baking sheet. Cover and let rise until doubled, about 25 minutes.
4. Beat egg white and cold water; brush over dough. With a sharp knife, make diagonal slashes 2 in. apart across top of loaf. Bake at 375 degrees F for 25-30 minutes or until golden brown. Remove from pan to a wire rack to cool.

Homemade Bread Bowls *(from Six Sisters, I think?)* - these were easy & yummy
Makes 6 bread bowls
½ recipe is perfect for 4 smaller sized soup bowls

2 c + 4 T warm water
2 pkgs active dry yeast (5 ½ t)
½ c butter, melted
2 T granulated sugar
3 t salt
6 ½ c all-purpose flour)

Pour warm water into a stand mixer or large mixing bowl; sprinkle in yeast. Let dissolve a few minutes, until yeast becomes foamy. Add melted butter, sugar, and salt and mix until combined. Gradually add flour. Once combined, allow mixer to knead the dough about 5 minutes. (You can do this by hand instead of using a mixer, but it may get a little tiring.)
Preheat oven to 425 F. Punch dough down and form into 6 balls of equal size. Place on a greased cookie sheet and let rise until doubled (about an hour). Bake 20-25 minutes, or until golden brown (*I cooked for 10 min @ 425 F, then 15 min @ 375 F)*. Let cool and cut off the top remove some of the bread from the inside and fill with soup or dip.

Ciabatta (from *Cook's Illustrated*)
makes 2 loaves

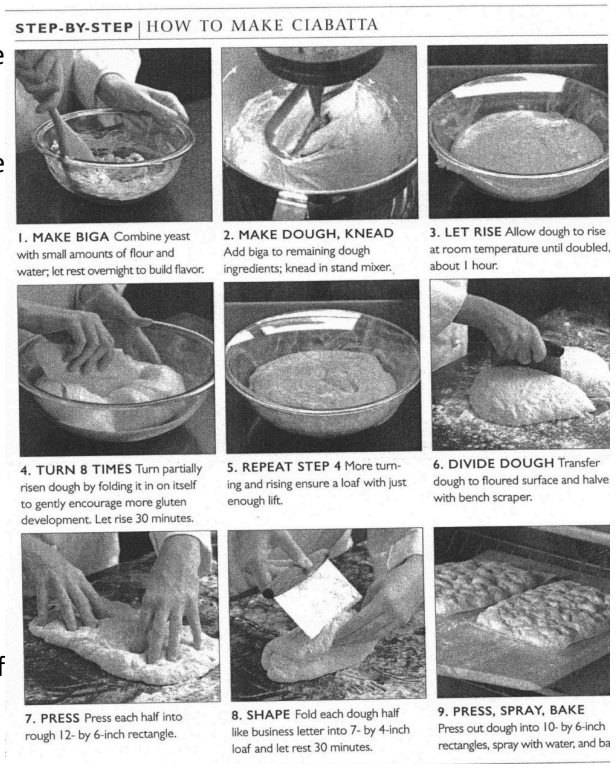
<u>Biga</u>
1 c (5 oz) unbleached all-purpose flour
⅛ t instant or rapid-rise yeast
½ c (4 oz) water, at room temperature

<u>Dough</u>
2 c (10 oz) unbleached all-purpose flour
½ t instant or rapid-rise yeast
1 ½ t table salt
¾ c (6 oz) water, at room temperature
¼ c (2 oz) milk, at room temperature (*you can substitute 2 T nonfat milk powder + ¼ c water)*

1. FOR THE BIGA: Combine flour, yeast, and water in medium bowl and stir with wooden spoon until uniform mass forms, about 1 minute. Cover bowl tightly with plastic wrap and let stand at room temperature (about 70 degrees) overnight (at least 8 hours and up to 24 hours).
2. FOR THE DOUGH: Place biga and dough ingredients in bowl of stand mixer fitted with paddle attachment. Mix on lowest speed until roughly combined and shaggy dough forms, about 1 minute; scrape down sides of bowl as necessary. Continue mixing on medium-low speed until dough becomes uniform mass that collects on paddle and pulls away from sides of bowl, 4-6 minutes. Change to dough hook and knead bread on medium speed until smooth and

shiny (dough will be very sticky), about 10 minutes. Transfer dough to large bowl and cover tightly with plastic wrap. Let dough rise at room temperature until doubled in volume, about 1 hour.

3. Spray rubber spatula or bowl scraper with nonstick cooking spray; fold partially risen dough over itself by gently lifting and folding edge of dough toward middle. Turn bowl 90 degrees; fold again. Turn bowl and fold dough six more times (total of eight turns). Cover with plastic wrap and let rise for 30 minutes. Repeat folding, replace plastic wrap, and let rise until doubled in volume, about 30 minutes longer. Meanwhile, adjust oven rack to lower-middle position, place baking stone on rack, and heat oven to 450 degrees at least 30 minutes before baking.
4. Cut two 12x6 inch pieces of parchment paper and liberally dust with flour. Transfer dough to liberally floured counter, being careful not to deflate completely. Following photos 6 through 9, liberally flour top of dough and divide in half. Turn 1 piece of dough so cut side is facing up and dust with flour. With well-floured hands, press dough into rough 12x6 inch shape. Fold shorter sides of dough toward center, overlapping them like business letter to form 7x4 inch loaf. Repeat with second dough piece. Gently transfer each loaf seaside down to parchment sheets, dust with flour, and cover with plastic wrap. Let loaves sit at room temperature for 30 minutes (surfaces of loaves will develop small bubbles).
5. Slide parchment with loaves onto inverted rimmed baking sheet or pizza peel. Using flour fingertips, evenly poke entire surface of each loaf to form 10x6 inch rectangle; spray loaves lightly with water. Carefully slide parchment with loaves onto baking stone using jerking motion. Spray loaves with water twice more during first few minutes of baking time, then bake until crust is deep golden brown and thermometer inserted in centers of loaves registers 210 degrees (22-25 minutes). Transfer to wire rack, discard parchment paper and cool loaves to room temperature, about 1 hour, before slicing and serving.



A Better Cinnamon Roll (Family Fun February 2009, p.100)

For the dough:
1 c milk
¼ c sugar
1 ½ t salt
2 T unsalted butter
2 c flour (blend of whole wheat and all-purpose)
1 ½ c bread flour
2 ¼ t instant yeast
1 large egg, beaten

For the filling:
4 T unsalted butter, softened
1 c dark brown sugar, packed
1 T ground cinnamon

For the icing:
1 c confectioners' sugar
2 T milk, plus extra for thinning if needed
½ t vanilla extract

1. Combine the milk, sugar, salt, and butter in a microwave-safe glass bowl. Microwave the mixture on high until it's hot, about 1 ½ to 2 minutes. Set it aside and allow the butter to melt and the mixture to cool until it's just warm.
2. In a large mixing bowl, use a wooden spoon to combine the flours, then stir in the yeast. Stir the egg into the milk mixture, then stir the milk mixture into the flours. Continue stirring until the mixture forms a soft dough.
3. Transfer the dough onto a floured surface. Sprinkle it with more flour and pat it into an oval shape. Fold the dough in half and knead it with your knuckles or the heels of your hands. Give it a quarter turn, and repeat. Keep kneading, sprinkling with flour when necessary, until the dough is smooth, not sticky, and elastic (it should bounce back when poked), about 10 minutes.

4. Oil a clean bowl, add the dough, and turn it to coat it with the oil. Cover the bowl with a damp cloth, place it in a warm spot (i.e. a 100 degree oven with open door), and let it rise until it has doubled in bulk, about 45 minutes to an hour.
5. Meanwhile, make the filling. Combine the softened butter, brown sugar, and cinnamon with a fork until well blended.
6. Grease a 9x13 pan and set it aside. Transfer the dough to a flour surface and sprinkle it lightly with flour. Roll it out with a floured rolling pin into a 12x16 inch rectangle.
7. Using your fingers, spread the filling over the dough, leaving a 1 inch strip uncovered at one of the short ends (picture a). Beginning at the opposite end, roll up the dough to make a cylinder (picture b). Pinch the ends and the seam closed with your fingers (picture c).
8. Using a serrated knife, cut the cylinder into 12 rounds. Place each round in the prepared pan. Cover the pan with a damp towel, and let the rolls rise for 45 minutes.
9. Heat the oven to 375. Bake the rolls until light brown, about 18-20 minutes. Allow them to cool in the pan on a rack for 15 minutes.
10. For the icing, whisk together the confectioners' sugar, milk, and vanilla in a bowl. If the mixture is too thick to drizzle, add a few extra drops of milk. Dip a fork into the icing, hold it a couple of inches above the rolls, and drizzle the topping in a zigzag pattern.

NEW YORK CINNAMON-RAISIN BAGELS (From *Cook's Illustrated* | May/June 2015)
MAKES 8 BAGELS - requires refrigerating the shaped bagels for 16 to 24 hours before baking.

1 ¼ cups ice water (10 ounces)
2 tablespoons malt syrup (or 4 t molasses)
2 ⅔ cups (14 2/3 ounces) bread flour (This recipe works best with King Arthur bread flour, although other bread flours will work.)
4 teaspoons vital wheat gluten
2 teaspoons instant or rapid-rise yeast
2 teaspoons salt
2/3cup raisins
1/4cup (1 1/4 ounces) cornmeal
1 teaspoon sugar, plus 1/4 cup (1 3/4 ounces)
1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
1 tablespoon baking soda

1. Stir ice water and malt syrup together in 2-cup liquid measuring cup until malt syrup has fully dissolved. Process flour, wheat gluten, and yeast in food processor until combined, about 2 seconds. With processor running, slowly add ice water mixture; process until dough is just combined and no dry flour remains, about 20 seconds. Let dough stand for 10 minutes.
2. Add salt to dough and process, stopping processor and redistributing dough as needed, until dough forms shaggy mass that clears sides of workbowl (dough may not form one single mass), 45 to 90 seconds. Transfer dough to unfloured counter and sprinkle raisins over dough. Knead until smooth and raisins are evenly incorporated, about 1 minute. Divide dough into 8 equal pieces (3 1/2 ounces each) and cover loosely with plastic wrap.
3. Working with 1 piece of dough at a time and keeping remaining pieces covered, form dough pieces into smooth, taut rounds. (To round, set piece of dough on unfloured counter. Loosely cup your hand around dough and, without applying pressure to dough, move your hand in small circular motions. Tackiness of dough against counter and circular motion should work dough into smooth, even ball, but if dough sticks to your hands, lightly dust your fingers with flour.) Let dough balls rest on counter, covered, for 15 minutes.
4. Sprinkle rimmed baking sheet with cornmeal. Combine 1 teaspoon sugar and cinnamon in bowl. Working with 1 dough ball at a time and keeping remaining pieces covered, coat dough balls lightly with flour and then, using your hands and rolling pin, pat and roll dough into 5-inch rounds. Sprinkle 1/4 teaspoon sugar-cinnamon mixture over each dough round, leaving 1/2-inch border around edges. Starting with edge of dough farthest from edge of counter, roll into tight cylinder. Starting at center of cylinder and working toward ends, gently and evenly roll and stretch dough into 8- to 9-inch-long rope. Do not taper ends. Rolling ends of dough under your hands in opposite directions, twist rope to form tight spiral. Without unrolling spiral, wrap rope around your fingers, overlapping ends of dough by about 2 inches under your palm, to create ring shape. Pinch ends of dough gently together. With overlap under your palm, press and roll seam using circular motion on counter to fully seal. Transfer rings to prepared sheet and cover loosely with plastic, leaving at least 1 inch between bagels. Let bagels stand at room temperature for 1 hour. Cover sheet tightly with plastic

and refrigerate for 16 to 24 hours.

5. One hour before baking, adjust oven rack to upper-middle position, place baking stone on rack, and heat oven to 450 degrees.
6. Bring 4 quarts water, remaining 1/4 cup sugar, and baking soda to boil in large Dutch oven. Set wire rack in rimmed baking sheet and spray rack with vegetable oil spray.
7. Transfer 4 bagels to boiling water and cook for 20 seconds. Using wire skimmer or slotted spoon, flip bagels over and cook 20 seconds longer. Using wire skimmer or slotted spoon, transfer bagels to prepared wire rack, with cornmeal side facing down. Repeat with remaining 4 bagels.
8. Place sheet with bagels on preheated baking stone and pour 1/2 cup boiling water into bottom of sheet. Bake until tops of bagels are beginning to brown, 10 to 12 minutes. Using metal spatula, flip bagels and continue to bake until golden brown, 10 to 12 minutes longer. Remove sheet from oven and let bagels cool on wire rack for at least 15 minutes. Serve warm or at room temperature.

**SHAPING BAGELS LIKE A PRO

Thoroughly working the dough during shaping helps a New York bagel develop its characteristic chew.



1. Pat and roll dough ball (lightly coated with flour) with rolling pin into 5-inch round.



2. Roll into tight cylinder, starting with far side of dough.



3. Roll and stretch dough into 8- to 9-inch-long rope, starting at center of cylinder (don't taper ends).



4. Twist rope to form tight spiral by rolling ends of dough under hands in opposite directions.



5. Wrap rope around fingers, overlapping ends by 2 inches, to create ring. Pinch ends together.



**SECRETS TO A GLOSSY CRUST, GREAT FLAVOR, AND BIG CHEW

Here's how we created the hallmarks of a New York bagel without the ingredients and equipment (or tap water) used by the local pros.

HIGH-PROTEIN DOUGH: Lots of gluten is key to achieving that jaw-working chew, so we used relatively high-protein bread flour supplemented with vital wheat gluten, a powdered form of the protein that is sold in most supermarkets.

COLD FERMENTATION: Proofing the dough overnight in the fridge allows it to develop an especially complex mix of flavor compounds.

ROUGH HANDLING: We roll, stretch, and twist the dough to shape it into rings—actions that help tighten the gluten network and thus yield a bagel with substantial chew.

A BETTER BOIL: Adding baking soda and sugar to the water in the boiling step helps encourage consistent browning.

STEAM TREATMENT: Baking the bagels on a rack set in a rimmed baking sheet (set on a baking stone) and adding a small amount of boiling water creates steam that leads to a crisp, delicate crust.

Cinnamon Swirl Bread (Cooks Illustrated, Mar/Apr 2012)
Makes 2 loaves

Dough
8 T unsalted butter
3 ¾ c bread flour
¾ c nonfat dry milk powder
1/3 c sugar
1 T yeast
1 ½ c warm water
1 large egg, lightly beaten
1 ½ t salt
1 ½ c golden raisins (optional)

Filling
1 c powdered sugar
3 T cinnamon
1 t vanilla extract
½ t salt

1 large egg, lightly beaten ,with a pinch of salt

1. FOR THE DOUGH: Cut butter into 32 pieces and toss with 1 tablespoon flour; set aside to soften while mixing dough. Whisk remaining flour, milk powder, sugar, and yeast together in bowl of stand mixer. Using mixer, fitted with dough hook, add water and egg and mix on medium-low speed until cohesive mass forms, about 2 minutes, scraping down bowl if necessary. Cover mixing bowl with plastic wrap and let stand for 20 minutes.
2. Adjust oven rack to middle position and place loaf or cake pan on bottom of oven. Remove plastic from mixer bowl, add salt, and mix on medium-low speed until dough is smooth and elastic and clears sides of bowl, 7-15 minutes. With mixer running, add butter, few pieces at a time, and continue to knead until butter is fully incorporated and dough is smooth and elastic and clears sides of bowl, 3-5 minutes longer. Add raisins and mix until incorporated, 30-60 seconds. Transfer dough to large greased bowl and, using bowl scraper or rubber spatula, fold dough over itself by gently lifting and folding edge of dough toward middle. Turn bowl 90 degrees; fold again. Turn bowl and fold dough 6 more times (total of 8 folds). Cover tightly with plastic and transfer to middle rack of oven. Pour 3 c boiling water into loaf pan in oven, close oven door, and allow dough to rise for 45 minutes.
3. Remove bowl from oven and gently press down on center of dough to deflate. Repeat folding step, re-cover, and return to oven until doubled in volume, about 45 minutes.
4. FOR THE FILLING: Whisk filling ingredients together until well combined; set aside.
5. Grease two 8.5x4.5 inch loaf pans. Transfer dough to lightly floured counter and divide into 2 pieces. Working with 1 piece of dough, pat into rough 6x11 inch rectangle. With short side facing you, fold long sides in like business letter to form 3x11 inch rectangle. Roll dough away from you into ball. Dust ball with flour and flatten with rolling pin into 7x18 inch rectangle with even ¼ inch thickness. Using spray bottle, spray dough lightly with water. Sprinkle half of filling mixture evenly over dough, leaving ¼ inch border on sides and ¾ inch border on top and bottom; spray filling lightly with water. (Filling should be speckled with water over entire surface.) With short side facing you, roll dough away from you into firm cylinder. Turn loaf seam side up and pinch closed; pinch ends closed. Dust loaf lightly on all sides with flour and let rest for 10 minutes. Repeat with second ball of dough and remaining filling.
6. Working with 1 loaf at a time, use bench scraper to cut loaf in half lengthwise; turn halves so cut sides are facing up. Gently stretch each half into 14 inch length. Line up pieces of dough and pinch 2 ends of strips together. Take piece on left and lay over piece on right. Repeat, keeping cut side up, until pieces of dough are tightly twisted. Pinch ends together. Transfer loaf, cut side up, to prepared loaf pan; push any exposed raisins into seams of braid. Repeat with second loaf. Cover loaves loosely with plastic, return to oven, and allow to rise for 45 minutes. Remove loaves and water pan from oven; heat oven to 350 degrees. Allow loaves to rise at room temperature until almost doubled in size, about 45 minutes longer (top of loaves should rise about 1 inch over lip of pan).
7. Brush loaves with egg mixture. Bake until crust is well browned, about 25 minutes. Reduce oven temperature to 325, tent loaves with aluminum foil, and continue to bake until internal temperature registers 200 degrees, 15-25 minutes longer.
8. Transfer pans to wire rack and let cool for 5 minutes. Remove loaves from pans, return to rack, and cool to room temperature before slicing, about 2 hours.

Pretzels (Lena Dalley at Primary activity)

1. Dissolve **1 T yeast** into **1 ½ c warm water**. Add **1 T sugar**. Stir until yeast is completely dissolved. Add **1 t salt** and mix in **4 c flour**. Knead dough a few minutes until smooth.

2. Divide the dough into 25 small balls and form into pretzels, twists, sticks, letters, numbers, etc. The thicker the shapes or pretzels are, the softer the bread will be. Put shapes on greased cookie sheets. Brush with mixture of **1 egg beaten** with **1 T water**. Sprinkle with coarse salt (or cinnamon and sugar). Bake at 425 degrees for 12-15 minutes.

Cheese Bread Doodles
makes 12 rolls

4 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
1 1/2 nickel-sized drops liquid soy lecithin (*this helps bread stay together, but is optional*)
1 1/2 teaspoons instant yeast
1/2 teaspoon salt
2 cups warm (100 degrees F.) water
1/4 cup granulated sugar
4 cups shredded mozzarella cheese

Pizza Sauce, for dipping

Garlic Butter
4 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted
1 1/2 to 2 teaspoons garlic seasoning with parsley, such as Johnny's Garlic Spread

1. In the bowl of a stand mixer fitted with a dough hook, mix flour, yeast, salt, and sugar to combine. Add soy lecithin and mix again.
2. With the mixer on low, slowly add warm water and mix 2 minutes, until dough is smooth and pulls entirely away from sides of mixing bowl. Cover bowl with a towel and let dough rest 30 minutes.
3. Line a baking sheet with parchment paper.
4. On a lightly floured work surface, roll dough into a large rectangle. Sprinkle heavily with mozzarella cheese and roll up like you would cinnamon rolls. Cut into 1 1/2- to 2-inch slices with unflavored dental floss or a serrated bread knife and place on prepared baking sheet.
5. Bake until golden brown, about 10 minutes.
6. Remove from oven and, while hot, brush with Garlic Butter.

Combine melted butter and garlic seasoning in small bowl and brush over tops of hot cheese doodles. Serve with pizza sauce for dipping.

Wheat Pizza Dough (from *The $5 Dinner Mom Cookbook*, p. 83)

1 c lukewarm water
1 T olive oil
1 c whole wheat flour
2 c white flour
1 pkg yeast
1 T sugar
1 t Italian seasoning
2 T Parmesan cheese
1 t salt
Olive oil and garlic salt (optional)

In a mixing bowl, combine the lukewarm water and 1 c of the white flour. Add the yeast, sugar, salt, and oil. Whisk together to make a “spongy” dough. Let sit for 10-15 minutes.

Add the remaining 2 c of flour to the sponge and stir with a wooden spoon. When the dough becomes thick enough, knead it by hand for 6-8 minutes on a floured surface or in a floured bowl, until it reaches the consistency of soft baby skin. Knead seasonings and Parmesan cheese into the dough. Place in a floured or greased bowl and let rise for 45 minutes to 1 hour.

Once the dough has risen and doubled in size, the dough is ready to be formed. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees. Place the dough on a lightly floured surface. Sprinkle flour over the dough and on the rolling pin. Roll out the dough to the desired size.

Brush the edges of the dough with olive oil and sprinkle with garlic salt, if desired.

Bake the crust for 8 minutes, remove from oven and load with toppings. Bake the full pizza another 8-10 minutes. Slice and serve.

Basic Pizza Dough
makes 1 16-in or 2 12-in or 4 9-in pizzas

1 T active dry yeast
1 c warm water, 105-115 degrees
2 T olive oil
1 T honey
¼ t salt
3-4 c all-purpose flour or half all-purpose and half whole wheat

1. Mix the yeast and water in a small bowl, cover, and let stand until foamy, 5-10 minutes.
2. Mix the oil, honey, salt and yeast mixture in a large mixing bowl. If using a food processor, add 1 c of flour at a time, up to 3 c, mixing well after each addition. You may have to stir in the third cup of flour by hand depending on your machine. Or mix in all 3 c of flour by hand with a wooden spoon.
3. If the dough seems too wet, mix in more flour, ¼ c at a time, until the dough is soft. Turn the dough onto a floured surface and knead in more flour, ¼ c at a time, until the dough is moderately stiff and somewhat firm to the touch, about 6 minutes.
4. Lightly grease pizza pan(s) or cookie sheet(s) with oil. If you are making two or more thin-crust pizzas, divide the dough. With a rolling pin, roll out the dough on a floured surface. Gently stretch the dough to fill the pan(s).
5. Let the dough rise slightly while you make the sauce and continue with the pizza recipe of your choice.

***Indian Flatbread (Naan)** (from Cooks' Illustrated, May & June 2012, p. 23)
Quick method takes 2 hours of total rising time. - Makes 4 pieces

½ c ice water
1/3 c plain whole-milk yogurt (instructions say NOT to use nonfat yogurt)
3 T plus 1 t vegetable oil
1 large egg yolk
2 c (10 oz) all-purpose flour (instructions say that King Arthur brand high-protein all-purpose flour works best)
1 ¼ t sugar
½ t instant or rapid-rise yeast
1 ¼ t salt
1 ½ T unsalted butter, melted

1. In measuring cup or small bowl, combine water, yogurt, 3 T oil, and egg yolk. Process flour, sugar, and yeast in food processor until combined, about 2 seconds. With processor running, slowly add water mixture; process until dough is just combined and no dry flour remains, about 10 seconds. Let dough stand for 10 minutes.
2. Add salt to dough and process until dough forms satiny, sticky ball that clears sides of workbowl, 30-60 seconds. Transfer dough to lightly floured work surface and knead until smooth, about 1 minute. Shape dough into tight ball and place in large, lightly oiled bowl. Cover tightly with plastic wrap and refrigerate for 16-24 hours. (**Or for a faster variation that is a little harder to roll out: After shaping the dough, let it rise at room temperature for 30 minutes. After 30 minutes, fold partially risen dough over itself 8 times by gently lifting and folding edge of dough toward middle, turning bowl 90 degrees after each fold. Cover with plastic wrap and let rise for 30 minutes. Repeat folding, turning, and rising one more time, for total of three 30-minute rises. After the last rise, proceed from step 3.)
3. Adjust oven rack to middle position and heat oven to 200 degrees. Place heatproof plate on rack. Transfer dough to lightly floured work surface and divide into 4 equal pieces. Shape each piece into smooth, tight ball. Place dough balls on lightly oiled baking sheet, at least 2 inches apart; cover loosely with plastic coated with cooking spray. Let stand for 15-20 minutes.
4. Transfer 1 ball to lightly floured work surface and sprinkle with flour. Using hands and rolling pin, press and roll piece of dough into 9-in round of even thickness, sprinkling dough and work surface with flour as needed to prevent sticking. Using fork, poke entire surface of round 20-25 times. Heat remaining 1 teaspoon oil in 12 inch cast iron skillet (or regular frying pan) over medium heat until shimmering. Wipe oil out of skillet completely with paper towels. Mist top of dough lightly with water. Place dough in pan, moistened side down; mist top surface of dough with water; and cover. Cook until bottom is browned in spots across surface, 2-4 minutes. Flip naan, cover, and continue to cook on second side until lightly browned, 2-3 minutes. (If naan puffs up, gently poke with fork to

deflate.) Flip naan, brush top with about 1 t. melted butter, transfer to plate in oven, and cover plate tightly with aluminum foil. Repeat rolling and cooking remaining 3 dough balls. Once last naan is baked, serve immediately.

Naan Bread
Makes 12 servings -- takes 1 hour 25 minutes

<u>For Dough:</u>
2 t active dry yeast
1 t sugar
½ c water, lukewarm
¼ c vegetable oil
1 egg, large
¼ c yogurt, plain
2 ½ c all-purpose flour
½ t salt

<u>Other:</u>
12 t olive oil
4 T butter, melted
2 T parsley, chopped

1. Heat the oven to 200 degrees.
2. In a medium bowl, combine the yeast, sugar and water. Lightly whisk it all together, then let it sit for about 5-10 minutes, or until the yeast dissolves and starts to foam.
3. To the same bowl, add the oil, yogurt, egg and whisk well. Set aside.
4. To the bowl of your mixer, combine the flour with the salt. Add the yeast mixture and mix for a couple minutes, until the dough comes clean from the sides of the bowl. If the dough is too wet, add a bit more flour, starting with a T at a time. The dough should be nice and soft but not sticky.
5. Place the dough in an oiled bowl and cover it with a clean kitchen towel or plastic wrap. Turn OFF your oven, place the bowl inside and allow to rise for about 30 minutes to 1 hour or until doubled in size.
6. After it rises, cut the dough into 12 equal pieces and shape each piece into a small ball.
7. Heat a large cast iron skillet over medium-high heat and add about 1 t of olive oil. Roll out one ball at a time until it's about ⅓ inch thick and about 5 inches in diameter. Add the piece of rolled dough to the hot skillet and cook for about 1 minute. The skillet should be very hot, so you'll see bubbles forming as you cook the dough on the first side. Flip the dough and cook the other side until the bottom is golden.
8. Repeat with the remaining dough until all of the pieces are cooked. Keep the naan covered in a towel so that it doesn't dry out. When all of them are cooked, brush each one with melted butter and garnish with some parsley.

***Homemade Garlic Naan Bread** (from *houseofnasheats.com*)
Makes 8 naan – takes 1 hour 20 minutes, including just 20 minutes hands on
Super EASY and tasty

1 c warm water
2 T honey
2 ¼ t active dry yeast
3 ½ c all-purpose flour
¼ c plain yogurt
2 t salt
½ t baking powder
1 egg
4 T butter
3 cloves garlic minced
chopped fresh cilantro

1. Combine the water and honey in the bowl of a stand mixer and stir until the honey has dissolved. Add the yeast and give it a quick stir, then allow the yeast to proof for 5-10 minutes until foamy.
2. Turn the mixer on to low speed, and gradually add the flour, yogurt, salt, baking powder, and egg. Once those start to come together, increase the mixer speed to medium-low, and continue mixing the dough for 2-3 minutes, until the dough starts looking nice and smooth. The dough may be slightly sticky, but should form into a ball that pulls away from the sides of the bowl.
3. Take the bowl off the stand mixer and pull the dough out to form into a ball with your hands. Add a little oil to the bowl just to coat the bottom and the sides, then return the ball of dough to the ball, giving it a quick turn to coat it lightly in oil. Cover with a damp cloth and place in a warm area to rise for 1 hour, until doubled in size.
4. While the dough is rising, melt the butter in a small pan or in a microwave-safe bowl, then add the chopped garlic and stir so that the butter is infused with the garlic flavor. Set aside to brush on the naan just after cooking. (***Note: If you*

aren't big on garlic, just leave it out and brush your cooked naan bread with melted butter for plain naan bread.)

5. Once the dough has almost doubled in size, transfer it to a floured work surface. Cut into 8 equal size pieces and roll each into a ball with your hands. Then roll out each ball of dough on a floured surface using a rolling pin, forming a circle or oval until the dough is a little less than ¼-inch thick.
6. Heat a large cast-iron skillet or heavy saute pan over medium-high heat. Add one of the rolled-out dough sections to the dry pan and cook, one at a time, for 1 minute, or until the dough begins to bubble on top and the bottom turns lightly golden brown. Flip the dough with a spatula and cook on the second side for 30-60 seconds, or until the bottom is nicely golden brown as well.
7. Transfer to a plate and brush naan lightly with the garlic-infused butter, then sprinkle with a bit of chopped cilantro. Keep cooked naan covered while repeating the process with the remaining dough. Serve warm.

BREAKFAST

***Baked French Toast –** from Julie Ulrich

Loaf French Bread, cut diagonally in 1" slices
4 eggs
1 c milk
¾ c half and half (I use whole milk)
1 t vanilla
1/8 t cinnamon
3/8 c butter
2/3 c brown sugar
1 ½ T corn syrup

The original recipe called for double the ingredients listed above, but it always baked up soggy, so I cut it in half. You could double it if yours turns out dry…

1. Pam 9x13 pan. Arrange bread in bottom.
2. In medium bowl, beat eggs, milk, half and half, vanilla and cinnamon.
3. Pour over bread. Cover and refrigerate overnight.

Next morning:

4. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. In small saucepan, combine remaining ingredients. Heat til bubbling. Pour over bread and egg mixture.
5. Bake in preheated oven uncovered for 40 minutes. Serve with butter, sugar and powdered sugar. (Or just eat as is. One time, I even forgot to pour the sugar/butter mixture before baking, and poured it on after baking and it was yummy.)

"Healthified" Raspberry French Toast Bake
makes 12 servings - takes 65 minutes

<u>French Toast</u>
1 loaf (1 lb) soft French bread (about 18 inches long)
4 oz (half 8 oz pkg) ⅓-less-fat cream cheese (Neufchatel), softened
½ c raspberry preserves
1 c fat-free egg product
1 c fat-free skim milk
1 T sugar
¼ t salt
<u>Sauce</u>
1 bag (10 oz) frozen raspberries, thawed
¼ c sugar
2 t cornstarch

1. Spray bottom and sides of 13x9 inch (3 qt) glass baking dish with cooking spray. Cut bread into 24 (¾-inch-thick) slices. Spread 12 slices with cream cheese. Spread remaining bread slices with preserves; place over cream cheese to make 12 "sandwiches." Arrange in baking dish, pressing together if necessary to fit.
2. In medium bowl, beat egg product, milk, 1 T sugar and the salt with wire whisk until blended. Pour over bread in dish. Let stand 15 minutes or until liquid is absorbed. (If preparing ahead, cover with plastic wrap and refrigerate until time to bake, up to 24 hours. Remove plastic wrap before cooking.)
3. Heat oven to 400 degrees. Cover dish with foil; bake 10 minutes. Uncover; bake 15-20 minutes longer or until golden brown.
4. Meanwhile, in 2-quart saucepan, mix sauce ingredients until blended. Heat to boiling over medium heat, stirring frequently. Boil 30 seconds to 1 minute or just until thickened. Place strainer over medium bowl; pour raspberry mixture into strainer. Press mixture with back of spoon through strainer to remove seeds; discard seeds. Serve sauce over French toast.

Waffle French Toast (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")
Mix 4 eggs and 2 cups milk. Soak thick slices white bread in mixture for 5 minutes. Then cook in waffle iron until crisp.

Nutella-Stuffed French Toast
serves 6

3 eggs
1 ⅓ c milk
½ t vanilla
Dash of cinnamon (optional)
Dash of nutmeg (optional)
Dash of cloves (optional)
Bread
1 jar Nutella
1 c strawberry jam (heated to a thick syrup)
2 bananas, sliced

1. Heat griddle to medium heat. In a blender, mix eggs, milk, vanilla, and spices. Pour egg mixture into a pie tin or other shallow dish. Dip bread into egg mixture, making sure both sides are coated. Cook bread on griddle, 2-3 minutes, or until browned. Turn and cook an additional 1-2 minutes.
2. When all bread slices are cooked, spread a T or so of Nutella between two slices and make a sandwich. Cut sandwich in half diagonally and top with strawberry jam and bananas.

***Cornbread Waffles** *(especially good for chicken & waffles)* - Lisa likes these more than the rest of the family does

1 c flour
1 c cornmeal
1 t salt
1 ½ t baking powder
1 t sugar
1 ⅔ c milk
2 eggs
¼ c butter, melted

Mix dry ingredients. In separate bowl, mix milk & eggs, then add to dry. Gradually stir in melted butter. Cook on waffle iron.

***Cinnamon Pumpkin Waffles** (From Allrecipes.com)
Makes 15 or 16 4" waffles

1 cup whole wheat flour
1/4 cup wheat germ
1/3 cup white sugar
1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
1 teaspoon pumpkin pie spice
1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg
1/2 teaspoon salt
1 tablespoon baking powder
3/4 cup milk
1/2 cup pumpkin puree
2 tablespoons melted butter
2 tablespoons olive oil
1/2 cup unsweetened applesauce
1 egg
1 egg white
1/2 cup chopped pecans

1. Preheat a waffle iron according to manufacturer's instructions. Combine flour, wheat germ, sugar, cinnamon, pumpkin pie spice, nutmeg, salt, and baking powder in a bowl. Set aside.
2. Beat together milk, pumpkin puree, butter, oil, applesauce, whole egg, and egg white. Stir flour mixture into the pumpkin mixture along with the pecans.
3. Ladle the batter onto the preheated waffle iron. Cook the waffles until golden and crisp, 5 to 7 minutes.

Ham & Swiss Waffles (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")

1 ½ c flour
4 t baking powder
2 T sugar
1 t salt
2 eggs
1 ½ c milk
6 T melted shortening
4 T melted butter
½ c diced ham
½ c grated gruyere/swiss

1. Whisk together flour, baking powder, sugar, and salt.
2. Add in eggs, milk, shortening, and butter.

3. Mix in ham and cheese. Season with pepper.
4. Cook in waffle iron until crisp.

Buttermilk Waffles

3 c all-purpose flour
1 T baking powder
3 ½ t baking soda
1 t salt
3 ¼ c buttermilk
12 T unsalted butter, melted and cooled
3 large eggs, slightly beaten
Vegetable oil, for brushing on waffle iron, if necessary

1. Preheat waffle iron; preheat oven to 200 degrees.
2. Whisk together the flour, baking powder, baking soda, and salt in a large bowl; add buttermilk, butter and eggs, and stir until smooth – batter will be thick.
3. Brush waffle iron lightly with oil, if needed, and spoon about ½ c of batter onto waffle iron and spread a little bit; cook.
4. Transfer waffles to a baking sheet and keep warm, uncovered in oven.
5. Serve with butter and maple syrup.

Double Chocolate Waffles with Berry Sauce (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes 12 quarter waffles

2/3 c flour
1/3 c cornstarch
¼ c unsweetened cocoa powder
¾ t baking powder
¾ t baking soda
¼ t salt
1/8 t cinnamon
6 T granulated sugar
1 c milk
1/3 c vegetable oil
1 egg
1 ½ t vanilla
½ c mini chocolate chips
Sweetened whip cream, for garnish (optional)
Cocoa powder, for garnish (optional)
Berry syrup (optional)

1. Preheat waffle iron.
2. Whisk together flour, cornstarch, cocoa powder, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and cinnamon.
3. In a separate bowl, whisk together sugar, milk, oil, egg, and vanilla for about 1 minute or until it gets a little frothy.
4. Slowly add the wet ingredients into the dry ingredients a little at a time, whisking until just combined; be careful not to overmix. Stir in the chocolate chips. This is a pretty thin batter, so don't be expecting pancake batter.
5. You shouldn't have to grease your waffle iron. Ladle batter into waffle iron, being careful not to overfill. Bake according to the instructions for your waffle iron.

Waffled Churros *(Serve with Mexican hot chocolate)*
serves 4-6; takes ~40 min total

<u>Churros</u>
½ c water
4 T unsalted butter
¼ t table salt
½ c all-purpose flour
¼ t grated nutmeg
¼ t finely grated lemon zest
2 large eggs
nonstick cooking spray
<u>Topping</u>
¼ c granulated sugar
½ t ground cinnamon
2 T unsalted butter, melted

1. Preheat a waffle iron, Meanwhile, make the batter by combining the water, butter and salt ina medium saucepan. Bring to a boil over high heat. Stir with a wooden spoon until the butter is melted.
2. Reduce the heat to medium and add all the flour at once, followed by the nutmeg and lemon zest. Beat vigorously with the spoon; cook for 1 minute. Remove the pan from heat; let cool 5 minutes. Thoroughly beat in the eggs, one at a

time. The finished dough will be pasty and tacky.

3. Grease the hot waffle iron with cooking spray. Spoon about 2 T of the dough (this will expand a lot as it cooks) on each section of the iron. Close and cook until the churros are golden brown on the outside, about 5 minutes. While cooking churros, combine sugar and cinnamon. Immediately after removing the cooked churros from the iron, brush their top sides with melted butter and sprinkle them with cinnamon-sugar mixture.
4. You can keep the cooked churros in a warm (less than 200 degrees) oven on a baking sheet for about an hour. They are best eaten shortly after they're made. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Puffed French Toast (from "Our Best Bites – Mormon Moms in the Kitchen") - Aka "Churro Toast"
Makes 30 triangles

2 eggs
2 ½ T sugar
½ t salt
½ t vanilla
2 c milk
1 c flour
2 ½ t baking powder
15 slices Texas-style toast, cut in half diagonally

<u>Cinnamon Sugar</u>:
¾ c sugar
4 t cinnamon

1. In a large skillet or frying pan, heat about ¼ inch of canola oil over medium heat. If you have a candy thermometer, you want to heat the oil to about 375 degrees F. Without a thermometer, test the oil by dripping water in. If it sizzles, it is just right.
2. While the oil is heating, whisk the eggs, sugar, salt, vanilla, milk, flour, and baking powder together in a shallow dish or pie plate.
3. Working quickly, take each half slice of bread and dip both sides in the mixture. Don't allow the bread to become too soaked in the batter. Gently shake the bread to remove excess batter and place in hot oil. Cook until puffed, golden brown, and a nice, crispy crust has formed on each side (probably 3-5 minutes per side; you really need to babysit them and make sure they're cooking correctly) and then remove from oil and drain on a paper towel. While cooking remaining French toast, keep cooked pieces warm in an oven set to the lowest temperature it will go.
4. When ready to serve, roll each piece in cinnamon sugar. If you're feeling really wild, drizzle pieces of toast with a little maple syrup, Buttermilk Caramel Syrup, Strawberry Syrup, or a pat of honey butter.

<u>Buttermilk Caramel Syrup</u>
YUM! - *Makes about 2 cups*

¾ c buttermilk
1 ½ c sugar
½ c real butter
2 T corn syrup
1 t baking soda
1 t vanilla

1. Combine all ingredients except vanilla in a 4 qt pan.
2. Bring mixture to a boil and reduce heat to low – just make sure it's still bubbling. Cook, stirring frequently, for7-9 minutes or until the syrup reaches a rich golden brown. Remove from heat and stir in vanilla.

Golden Puff Pancake (aka "Dutch Baby")
serves 4

3 large eggs
½ c flour
½ c milk
2 T sugar
½ t vanilla extract
½ t salt
2 T butter
powdered sugar
jam or fresh fruit, for serving

In a blender or food processor, combine eggs, flour, milk, sugar, vanilla and salt; blend until smooth. Let batter rest while oven preheats to 425. Place butter in a heavy ovenproof skillet; place in hot oven for 1-2 minutes to melt (do not burn). Carefully

swirl pan to coat with butter; pour in batter. Bake for 18-20 minutes, until pancake is puffy and deeply golden. Cool 5 minutes, then liberally dust with powdered sugar; cut into 4 wedges and serve with jam or fruit.

Chocolate Strawberry German Pancakes

1. Place 2 T unsalted butter in cast iron skillet in oven. Turn oven on to 400, but don't let it burn.
2. Place the following items in a blender for 30 seconds or until smooth:
   ⅔ c whole wheat flour | 2 T sugar | 1 c milk
   ¼ c cocoa powder | ½ t salt | ½ t vanilla
3. Add 4 eggs and blend another 30 seconds.
4. Combine the following items in a small saucepan over medium heat. Cook and stir until syrup starts to form (about 10 minutes)
   1 c sliced strawberries | 1 T unsalted butter | 1 T honey
5. Remove skillet from oven (with mitts!). Tilt to coat sides and bottom with butter. Pour batter into skillet. Spread strawberry mixture evenly over batter.
6. Bake 20-25 minutes until eggs are cooked and center is set.

Blender Wheat Pancakes (yummy way to use up wheat from food storage)
Makes 6-8 pancakes

1 c milk (or 1/3 c dry milk and 1 c water)
1 c uncooked whole wheat
2 eggs
2 T oil
2 t baking powder
2 T honey or sugar
½ t salt

Put milk and wheat in blender. Blend on highest speed for four or five minutes until batter is smooth. Add and blend on low: eggs, oil, baking powder, honey, and salt. Bake on hot griddle.

Whole Wheat Pancakes (from *Pumpkin Roll* by Josi Kilpack)
makes ~16 pancakes

2 c whole wheat flour
⅓ c sugar
2 t baking powder
1 t baking soda
1 t salt
2 eggs
⅓ c oil (or melted butter)
2 c buttermilk or sour milk (for 1 c sour milk, add 1 T white vinegar or lemon juice to 1 c regular milk)

Heat griddle to medium. Combine dry ingredients and whisk together. Add eggs and liquids. Mix well. (Thin batter with water if consistency is too thick.) Drop by ⅓-cup portions on hot, greased griddle. Cook about 3 minutes on one side, until edges begin to look dry. Flip and cook one to two more minutes or until golden brown.

***Pumpkin Spice Pancakes** (*This is easier than the other pumpkin pancake recipe, but not as complex flavors*)
Takes 16 minutes - Serves 4

1 ¼ c white whole wheat flour
2 T sugar
2 ¼ t baking powder
½ t cinnamon
½ t ginger
½ t salt
⅛ t nutmeg
1 pinch of ground cloves
1 c milk
¼ c + 2 T pumpkin puree
2 T canola oil
1 egg
butter, for skillet
maple syrup, for serving
pecans, for serving

1. In a large bowl, whisk together flour, sugar, baking powder, cinnamon, ginger, salt, nutmeg and cloves. In a small bowl, whisk together milk, pumpkin puree, canola oil and egg. Gently fold wet ingredients into dry until combined.
2. Melt a small amount of butter on a griddle or skillet. Ladle batter onto griddle or skillet. Cook pancakes until small bubbles appear on the surface and the bottom is golden brown, then flip, about 3 minutes per side. Serve immediately. Drizzle with maple syrup and top with pecans, if desired.
   **I like them with vanilla or plain yogurt instead of syrup.*

***Peachy Pancakes topped with Vanilla Yogurt**

2 c all-purpose flour
1 T baking powder
2 T sugar
2 eggs
2 c milk
3 T oil
Cooking spray, to coat pan
1 c canned or fresh peaches, chopped into small bits
2 c vanilla yogurt

1. Mix flour, baking powder, and sugar, in a large bowl. Whisk eggs and milk in a separate bowl, then whisk in oil. Pour egg mixture over dry ingredients and stir until everything is moist and the batter is slightly lumpy.
2. Coat skillet with spray. Heat skillet on medium-high and drop about ¼ c batter for each pancake. Gently press about a tablespoon of peach-bits into each pancake. Cook until pancakes bubble on top and brown on bottom. Flip and cook until brown on the other side.
3. Serve pancakes topped with vanilla yogurt or maple syrup. Makes 20 pancakes.

Chocolate Chip-Banana Pancakes
Makes 4 servings

1 ¼ c all-purpose flour
1 T sugar
2 t baking powder
½ t salt
½ t cinnamon
1 ¼ c skim milk
1 small ripe banana, mashed (about ½ c)
1 large egg, lightly beaten
1 t vanilla
1/3 c semisweet chocolate mini morsels, divided

1. Combine flour, sugar, baking powder, salt, and cinnamon in large bowl. After mixing well, stir in milk, banana, egg, and vanilla. Fold in ¼ c chocolate morsels.
2. Spray nonstick skillet with cooking spray. Heat over medium heat. Pour batter onto griddle making 3 inch rounds. Cook about 2 minutes or until tops are bubbly. Flip pancakes and cook for another 2 minutes or until golden.
3. Serve sprinkled with morsels.

Pancakes (from *allrecipes.com*, recommended by Dillon on his mission)

¾ c milk
2 T white vinegar
1 c flour (all-purpose)
2 T sugar
1 t baking powder
½ t baking soda
½ t salt
1 egg
2 T butter, melted
cooking spray

1. Combine milk with vinegar in medium bowl and set aside for 5 minutes to "sour."
2. Combine flour, sugar, baking powder, baking soda, and salt in large bowl. Whisk egg and butter into "soured" milk. Pour the flour mixture into the wet ingredients and whisk until lumps are gone.
3. Heat large skillet over medium heat and coat with cooking spray. Pour ¼ cupfuls of batter onto the skillet, and cook until bubbles appear on surface. Flip.

Perfect Pancakes (from *Family Circle*, Feb 2009, p. 174)
Makes 16 4-in pancakes - 10 minutes prep

1 ½ c all-purpose flour
3 T granulated sugar
4 t baking powder
⅛ t salt
⅛ t ground allspice
2 eggs
1 c milk
¼ c vegetable oil

1. Heat a griddle or large pan to medium heat.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together flour, granulated sugar, baking powder, salt and allspice. Separate eggs and whisk egg yolks in small bowl with milk and oil.
3. With an electric mixer, beat egg whites to stiff peaks, about 1 minute. Stir milk mixture into flour mixture just until combined. Fold in egg whites in two additions, until no white streaks remain.
4. Drop ¼ to ⅓ cup batter onto heated griddle. Repeat, spacing at least 1 inch apart. Cook 1 minute, or until bubbles in batter pop and remain open. Carefully flip pancakes and cook an additional 30 seconds to 1 minute.

Pumpkin Pancakes
Serves 8

2 c flour
¾ c sugar
½ t salt
2 t baking powder
2 t baking soda
1 t cinnamon
½ t nutmeg
¼ t ground cloves
3 eggs
1 c yogurt
¾ c milk
½ t vanilla
1 c pumpkin puree

1. In a large bowl, stir together the flour, sugar, salt, baking powder, baking soda, and spices (may substitute with 1 ½ or 2 t pumpkin pie spice instead).
2. In a separate bowl, beat eggs well with electric hand mixer until frothy; add yogurt, milk, and pumpkin puree. Mix well. Pour the egg mixture into the flour mixture and stir until just blended.
3. Spoon the batter onto preheated, oiled griddle, using ¼ c batter for each pancake. Cook pancakes slowly over a low-medium heat for approximately 4-6 minutes.

Greek Yogurt Pancakes (from *Good Housekeeping*, April 2021)
serves 4 - takes 25 minutes

½ c vanilla Greek yogurt
⅓ c milk
2 large eggs
2 T maple syrup
1 t pure vanilla extract
1 c all-purpose flour
¾ t baking soda
½ t baking powder
¼ t kosher salt
yogurt, strawberries, blueberries and syrup, for serving

1. In large bowl, whisk together yogurt, milk, eggs, syrup and vanilla (first 5 ingredients)
2. In second bowl, whisk together flour, baking soda, baking powder and salt.
3. Add flour mixture to yogurt mixture and mix to combine (batter should be like thick papier-mache)
4. Heat large nonstick skillet on medium.
5. Spoon in enough batter to make 3-4 medium pancakes (about 2 T each) or many smaller ones (about 1 T each) and cook pancakes until bubbles begin to appear around edges and in centers. Using spatula, peek under pancakes to check that they are golden brown, then carefully flip. Cook about 1 min. more depending on size. Transfer to wire rack and cover loosely with foil to keep warm or serve immediately, topped with yogurt, strawberries, blueberries, and syrup.

Banana Buttermilk Pancakes (from *Raised in the Kitchen)*
makes 12 pancakes

2 cups sifted all-purpose flour
2 tablespoons granulated sugar
1 teaspoon salt
2 teaspoons baking powder
1 teaspoon baking soda
2 large eggs, lightly beaten
2 cups buttermilk
2 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted
1 cup sliced bananas

1. Preheat nonstick skillet to medium heat. (350 degrees F. on an electric griddle.)
2. In a medium bowl, whisk together flour, sugar, salt, baking powder, and baking soda; set aside.
3. In a separate bowl, whisk together eggs and buttermilk until completely combined. Drizzle in melted butter as you continue to whisk.
4. Make a well in the middle of the dry ingredients. Pour wet ingredients and bananas into the well and stir with wooden spoon until a few streaks of flour remain. (The more you stir pancake batter, the flatter and tougher the pancakes will be, so be careful not to overmix. It's okay if the batter is lumpy.)
5. Butter the griddle and use a ⅓ cup measure to portion batter onto hot griddle. Cook until bubbles begin to form and pop on top, about 2 to 3 minutes. Flip pancakes and cook until second side is golden brown, about 1 to 2 minutes.

Homemade Pancake Mix (from *Raised in the Kitchen)*
makes 5 ¼ cups of powdered mix

4 cups sifted all-purpose flour
¼ cup granulated sugar
1 cup powdered buttermilk
2 teaspoons salt
4 teaspoons baking powder
2 teaspoons baking soda

In a large bowl, whisk together all ingredients to combine well. Store in an airtight container until ready to use.

Ready to Make Pancakes? *(makes about 15 small pancakes)*
2 eggs
3 cups pancake mix
1 ¼ cups water
2 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted

1. Whisk together eggs and water
2. Fold egg-water mixture into dry pancake mix until batter comes together but is not completely mixed.
3. Add melted butter and stir just to combine. Batter will be lumpy.
4. Scoop ⅓ cup of batter onto a hot, buttered griddle and cook until bubbles form on top. Flip pancakes and cook until golden on the second side.

NOTE: You can use powdered or dehydrated eggs as well. Use 1 T egg powder to 2 T water for a single egg. Multiply accordingly.

Baked Ham and Egg Cups (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes 12 egg cups

I am paraphrasing this recipe to try the idea. Basically, instructions are as follows:

1. Make up recipe for quiche (maybe 1 ½ times the volume for a pie pan? Maybe increase eggs and decrease milk?)
2. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F.
3. Spray 12 cup muffin tin with cooking spray, and place one slice of ham in each well to form a bowl.
4. Evenly divide the egg mixture between the 12 muffin wells (about ¼ cup each). You want them to fill right up to the top.
5. Place in the preheated oven and bake for 15-20 minutes. The tops should be puffed and just barely set on top. Eggs will sink after cooling.

These can be made ahead of time and stored in fridge/freezer. Thaw frozen ones in the fridge overnight. Warm in microwave.

[Easter] Scrambled Egg Nests (from *FamilyFun*, April 2006)
makes 12 nests

1 (3 ½ c) bag of frozen, shredded potatoes, defrosted
⅓ c vegetable oil or butter
½ t salt
¼ t pepper
6 eggs
⅔ c milk
½ c finely diced onions
⅓ c finely diced bell peppers
¾ c diced cooked breakfast sausage/ham
shredded cheddar cheese

1. Heat oven to 400. In large bowl, toss together potatoes, ¼ c of oil or butter, salt & pepper. Spoon about ⅓ c of potato mixture into each cup of a 12 serving muffin tin. Press to sides & bottom of each cup, then bake til golden, about 30-35 minutes. Remove from oven & cool.
2. Whisk together eggs & milk. Heat large saute pan over medium-high heat. Add remaining oil or butter to pan and heat. Add onions & peppers and saute til soft and golden, about 2-3 minutes. Add sausage/ham & cook til heated. Add egg mix and stir til eggs have set and small curds have formed. Season with salt and pepper to taste.
3. Remove potato nests from tin and put on ovenproof platter or cookie sheet. Fill each with some egg mixture, top with sprinkling of cheese, and place in 375 degree oven til cheese is melted, about 2-3 minutes.

Croissant Breakfast Sandwich (from *Raised in the Kitchen)*
makes 6 sandwiches

1 pound ground maple breakfast sausage
2 tablespoons mayonnaise
2 tablespoons yellow or Dijon mustard
2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
8 large eggs
1/4 cup milk
1 cup shredded Colby Jack cheese
Salt and ground black pepper, to taste
6 croissants, split horizontally
6 strips bacon, cooked
Minced chives, for garnishing

1. Form breakfast sausage into 6 rectangular patties to better fit onto the croissants. Cook sausage patties in a large skillet over medium heat until cooked through, about 7 to 8 minutes per side. When cooked through, remove from heat and cover with lid to keep warm until sandwiches are ready to assemble.
2. While sausage cooks, prepare sauce and mix together the ingredients for scrambled eggs. For sauce: whisk together mayonnaise, mustard, and maple syrup in a small bowl; set aside until ready to assemble sandwiches. For eggs: in a large bowl, whisk together eggs, milk, cheese, salt, and pepper. Set aside in refrigerator while sausage finishes cooking.
3. Heat oven to broil. Place croissant halves, open sides up, on baking sheet and toast un-der broiler until golden brown, about 1 to 2 minutes; set aside until ready to assemble sandwiches.
4. Heat a small amount of butter or oil in a nonstick skillet over medium heat. (Alternatively, use nonstick cooking spray.) When pan is hot, pour egg mixture into skillet, let mixture sit a minute or so, then use a rubber spatula to stir and fold until eggs are cooked and scrambled, about 3 to 5 minutes. Remove from heat.
5. Assemble sandwiches: Use 1 tablespoon sauce, a spoonful or 2 of the scrambled eggs, 1 sausage patty, 1 strip bacon, and a sprinkle of chopped chives for each sandwich.

Perfect French Omelets (from *Cooks' Illustrated*, January & February, 2009)
Makes 2

2 T unsalted butter, cut into 2 pieces
6 large eggs, cold
table salt and ground black pepper
½ t vegetable oil
2 T shredded Gruyere cheese
4 t minced fresh chives

1. Cut 1 T butter in half again. Cube remaining T butter into small dice, transfer to small bowl, and place in freezer while preparing eggs and skillet, at least 10 minutes. Meanwhile, place oil in 8-in nonstick skillet and heat over low heat 10 minutes.

2. Crack 2 eggs into medium bowl and separate third egg; reserve white for another use and add yolk to bowl. Add ⅛ teaspoon salt and pinch of pepper. Break yolks with fork, then beat eggs at moderate pace, about 80 strokes, until yolks and whites are well combined. Stir in half of frozen butter cubes.
3. When skillet is fully heated, use paper towels to wipe out oil, leaving thin film on bottom and sides of skillet. Add ½ T reserved butter piece to skillet and heat until foaming subsides, 45-90 seconds. Swirl butter to coat skillet, add egg mixture, and increase heat to med-high. Use 2 chopsticks or wooden skewers to scramble eggs using quick circular motion to move around skillet, scraping cooked egg from side of skillet as you go, until eggs are almost cooked but still slightly runny, 45-90 seconds. Turn off heat (remove skillet from heat if using electric burner) and smooth eggs into even layer using rubber spatula. Sprinkle omelet with 1 T cheese and 2 t chives. Cover skillet with tight-fitting lid and let sit 1 minute for runnier omelet and 2 minutes for firmer omelet.
4. Heat skillet over low heat 20 seconds, uncover, and, using rubber spatula, loosen edges of omelet from skillet. Place folded square of paper towel onto warmed plate and slide omelet out of skillet onto paper towel so that omelet lies flat on plate and hangs about 1 inch off paper towel. Roll omelet into neat cylinder and set aside. Return skillet to low heat and heat 2 minutes before repeating instructions for second omelet starting with step 2. Serve.

***Easy Overnight Oatmeal**
Serves 8-10

4 c milk
½ c brown sugar
2 T melted butter
½ t salt
1 t cinnamon
2 c old-fashioned or steel-cut oats
2 c apple, chopped
1 c raisins

Coat the inside of a 3-4 quart slow cooker with non-stick cooking spray. Combine all ingredients in the slow cooker and mix well. Cover and cook on WARM or LOW setting overnight, or 7-8 hours. In the morning, stir well and scoop into individual bowls. Be careful not to overcook. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Chocolate Covered Strawberry Overnight Oats

1. Add and refrigerate overnight:

½ c oats
½ c unsweetened almond milk
2 t cocoa powder
1 T maple syrup
1 t vanilla
2 t chia seeds

2. Top with these:

¼ c fresh strawberrries, sliced
opt: whipped cream, choc drizzle, choc morsels
**I served this with a scoop (¼-⅓ c?) of plain yogurt.*

High Protein Cranberry Apple Oatmeal
serves 2

¾ c rolled oats
¾ c unsweetened almond milk
2 eggs
1 large banana, mashed
1 t cinnamon
1 t freshly grated ginger
pinch of salt
chopped Granny Smith apple
Chopped fresh cranberries
Chopped toasted pecans
Chia seeds

Mix oats, almond milk, eggs, banana, cinnamon, and ginger together in a medium pot. Heat on medium-high and cook, stirring frequently, about 5 minutes, until eggs are no longer runny and oats are cooked. Divide oatmeal into bowls and top with apples, cranberries, pecans and sprinkle with chia seeds.

Ten Minute Steel-cut Oatmeal (Cook's Illustrated, Sept & Oct 2012, p. 23)
Serves 4

4 c water
1 c steel-cut oats
¼ t salt

1. Bring 3 c water to boil in large saucepan over high heat. Remove pan from heat; stir in oats and salt. Cover pan and let stand overnight.
2. Stir remaining 1 c water into oats and bring to boil over medium-high heat. Reduce heat to medium and cook, stirring occasionally, until oats are softened but still retain some chew and mixture thickens and resembles warm pudding, 4-6 minutes. Remove pan from heat and let stand for 5 minutes. Stir and serve.

Flavored variations:
Apple Cinnamon Steel-cut Oatmeal
Increase salt to ½ teaspoon. Substitute ½ c apple cider and ½ c whole milk for water in step 2. Stir ½ c peeled, grated sweet apple, 2 T packed dark brown sugar, and ½ t ground cinnamon into oatmeal with cider and milk.

Carrot Spice Steel-Cut Oatmeal
Increase salt to ¾ t. Substitute ½ c carrot juice and ½ c whole milk for water in step 2. Stir ½ c finely grated carrot, ¼ c packed dark brown sugar, 1/3 c dried currants, and ½ t ground cinnamon into oatmeal with carrot juice and milk. Sprinkle with chopped toasted pecans.

Pumpkin Spice Baked Oatmeal (these are like the texture of a Clif bar)
8-10 servings

2 eggs
½ c applesauce
½ c oil
¾ c pumpkin
2 ¼ c milk
¼ c maple syrup or regular syrup
½ c brown sugar

Heat oven to 350. Lightly grease a 9x13 pan. Beat the above ingredients until smooth. Then add ingredients below and beat on low until loose batter forms.

2 ½ t pumpkin pie spice
1 T baking powder
1 t salt
½ c wheat flour
4 c quick oats

Pour into dish and bake 30-35 minutes until center is cooked. Serve with yogurt or milk.

Apple Pumpkin Pie Baked Oatmeal (from *bucketlisttummy.com*)
takes 55 minutes - yields 9 bars

2 eggs
1 15oz can pumpkin puree
½ t vanilla extract
¼ c maple syrup
¼ c brown sugar
½ t ground cinnamon
¾ t pumpkin pie spice
½ t salt
¾ t baking powder
1 c vanilla almond milk
2 ½ c old-fashioned oats
1 c apples, chopped

1. Preheat oven to 350 and spray an 8x8 baking dish.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together eggs, pumpkin, vanilla, maple syrup, sugar, cinnamon, pumpkin pie spice, salt and baking powder.
3. Add in almond milk and whisk well.
4. Lastly, add in oats and chopped apples, reserving some for the topping. Stir to combine.

5. Pour batter into baking dish, topping with remaining diced apples.
6. Cook for 40-45 minutes, or until a toothpick comes out clean.

Granola Bars (From Allrecipes.com)

2 cups rolled oats
¾ cup packed brown sugar
½ cup wheat germ
¾ teaspoon ground cinnamon
1 cup whole wheat flour
¾ cup raisins (optional)
¾ teaspoon salt
½ cup honey
1 egg, beaten
½ cup vegetable oil
2 teaspoons vanilla extract

1. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees F (175 degrees C). Generously grease a 9x13 inch baking pan.
2. In a large bowl, mix together the oats, brown sugar, wheat germ, cinnamon, flour, raisins and salt. Make a well in the center, and pour in the honey, egg, oil, and vanilla. Mix well using your hands. Pat the mixture evenly into the prepared pan.
3. Bake for 30 to 35 minutes in the preheated oven, until the bars begin to turn golden at the edges. Cool for 5 minutes, then cut the bars while still warm. Do not allow the bars to cool completely before cutting, or they will be too hard to cut.

***Granola Mix** (from Gayelynn Watson)

11 c old-fashioned oats (or mixture of old-fashioned and quick)
1 c wheat germ (I use wheat flour)
½ lb shredded coconut
1 ½ c raw sunflower seeds
1 c sesame seeds (I don't usually use these)
1 c powdered milk
1 ½ c brown sugar, firmly packed
1 ½ c water
½-2/3 c vegetable oil
½ c honey
½ c molasses (or 1 c honey and no molasses)
1 ½ t salt
2 t cinnamon
3 t vanilla
Raisins, or other dried fruits

Preheat oven to 300 degrees. In a large bowl combine oats, wheat germ, coconut, sunflower seeds, and sesame seeds. Blend well. In a large saucepan, combine brown sugar, water, oil, honey molasses, salt, cinnamon, and vanilla. Heat until sugar is dissolved, but don't boil. Pour syrup over dry ingredients and stir until well-coated. (At this point, I often add more oats if it seems too moist.) Spread into 4 13x9 baking pans (or 2 jelly roll pans). Bake 20-30 minutes, stirring occasionally. Bake 15 minutes longer for crunchier texture. Cool. Add raisins or other dried fruit, if desired. Put in airtight containers and store in a cool, dry place. Use within 6 months. Makes about 20 cups.

***Get-Up-and-Go Granola** (From Taste of Home, Aug & Sept 2013, p. 35) - YUMMY
Makes 7 ½ cups

6 c old-fashioned oats
½ c unblanched almonds, coarsely chopped
¼ c packed brown sugar
¼ c flaxseed
¼ c canola oil
¼ c honey
1 T maple syrup
1 t apple pie spice
½ t salt
½ t vanilla extract
½ c dried cranberries
½ c raisins

1. Preheat oven to 300 degrees. In a large bowl, combine oats, almonds, brown sugar, and flax. In a microwave-safe dish, whisk oil, honey, maple syrup, pie spice and salt. Microwave on high for 30-45 seconds or until heated through, stirring

once. Stir in vanilla. Pour over oat mixture; toss to coat.

2. Spread evenly in a 15x10x1-in baking pan coated with cooking spray. Bake 30-40 minutes or until golden brown, stirring every 10 minutes. Cool completely on a wire rack. Stir in cranberries and raisins. Store in an airtight container.

Coconut Almond Granola
makes 12 cups

4 c old-fashioned rolled oats
2 c sweetened, shredded coconut
2 c sliced almonds
¾ c coconut oil
½ c honey
1 ½ c diced dried apricots
1 c diced dried figs or dates
1 c dried cherries
1 c dried cranberries or blueberries
1 c roasted unsalted cashews

Preheat oven to 350. Toss the oats, coconut and almonds together in a large bowl.
Whisk together the oil and honey in a small bowl. Pour the liquid over the oat mixture, and stir with a wooden spoon until all the oats and nuts are coated. Pour onto a 13x18x1-in sheet pan. Bake, stirring about every 5-10 minutes with a spatula, until the mixture turns an even, golden brown, about 45 minutes. Remove granola from oven and allow to cool, stirring occasionally. Add the fruit and cashews. Store in an airtight container.
Note: the pan will be quite full, but baking the granola in a single pan will keep it from burning. If you want to make a smaller amount, use a smaller pan.

Easy Blender Crepes (from Smith's *mymagazine*)
Makes about 30 crepes - 10 minutes prep time + 2 minutes cooking per crepe

This crepe recipe can be made the night before and stored in the fridge or easily thrown together in the morning. Serve with sweet or savory fillings for the perfect meal. Layer leftovers between parchment paper, and freeze in a resealable plastic bag.

<u>Crepe ingredients</u>
1 stick (8 T) unsalted butter, melted
2 c whole milk
5 eggs
½ t kosher salt
1 ¾ c all-purpose flour
nonstick cooking spray

1. Mix melted butter, milk, eggs, and salt in the blender until just combined but not whipped. Add the flour and blend until fully combined. Refrigerate for 10 minutes to 24 hours. Before using, consistency should be that of thick egg nog. Add milk if too thick, flour if too thin.
2. Heat a 10 in. pan on med high and lightly spray with nonstick cooking spray. With large ladle, add approximately ¼ c batter and swirl around to make an even coating of batter on the bottom of the pan. Cook for about one minute, until edges start to pull away from the pan. Carefully flip crepe by sliding a thin spatula underneath. Cook on the other side until lightly golden. Do the same with remaining batter, stacking crepes on a plate as they are ready. Refrigerate any leftovers in a resealable plastic bag.

<u>Filling ideas</u>

- chocolate hazelnut spread and bananas
- jam and whipped cream or cream cheese
- ricotta cheese and honey or powdered sugar
- eggs and sausage or bacon
- cheese and salsa
- goat cheese, roasted red peppers & arugula

CRAFTS & CONCOCTIONS

KITCHEN SCIENCE

Blobs in a Bottle

This experiment proves oil and water don't mix! They separate because of something called intermolecular polarity, meaning that water and oil molecules don't bond or "stick" together because of their structures. In this demonstration, the dissolving tablet creates gas. As the gas bubbles rise, they bond with some of the water molecules and pull them to the top of the bottle.

Supplies

¾ c water
clean 1 liter clear soda bottle
measuring cup or funnel
vegetable oil
food coloring
seltzer tablets

1. Pour the water into the bottle.
2. Use a measuring cup or funnel to slowly pour vegetable oil into the bottle until it's almost full. Wait fot the oil and water to fully separate.
3. Add 10 drops of food coloring.
4. Break a seltzer tablet in half, drop it into the bottle and watch as the reaction begins. (LEAVE THE LID OFF THE BOTTLE SO IT DOESN'T EXPLODE WITH THE INCREASED PRESSURE FROM THE DISSOLVING TABLET.)

Fantastic Foamy Fountain

This project demonstrates what's called a catalyzed decomposition reaction. It sounds complicated, but it's really simple and fun. The yeast causes the molecules in hydrogen peroxide to release oxygen that's then trapped by the soapy water and creates a fountain of foam. Be sure to do this experiment on a washable surface or a large tray to catch the overflow!

Supplies

safety goggles
½ c 6% hydrogen peroxide liquid
clean 16 oz plastic soda bottle
food coloring
liquid dish soap
small cup
3 T warm water
1 T dry yeast

1. Put on safety goggles while mixing ingredients (They may be removed once reaction has occurred.)
2. **Adults:** Pour the hydrogen peroxide into the bottle.
3. Add 8 drops of food coloring and about 1 T of dish soap. Swish it around in the bottle to mix.
4. In the small cup, combine the warm water and the yeast; mix for 30 seconds.
5. Pour the yeast mixture into the bottle to create a heat-releasing exothermic reaction, and watch the foaminess begin!

CLEANING RECIPES

Stain Remover recipe

1 c powdered Cascade
1 c Clorox 2 (powdered)
5 gal water (hottest out of tap)

Soak several items overnight and launder as usual. NOT for delicates or non-colorfasts. Really good on food stains.

DECORATIONS

Homemade Streamers

8 ½ by 11 sheet of paper cut in half lengthwise. Staple 2 lengths together.

(leave ¼" to ½" between cuts). Stretch for a wishbone look. Twist for an arch.

8 ½ by 11 sheet of paper folded lengthwise

Colorful Creative Salt

Add 5-6 drops food coloring to ½ c household salt. Stir well. Cook in microwave for 1-2 minutes or spread on waxed paper and let air dry. Store in airtight container. Use as you would glitter.

PAINTS & PLAY DOUGH

Finger Paints

3 T sugar
½ c cornstarch
2 c cold water
Food coloring
Liquid dish soap
Plastic or paper cups

Mix sugar and cornstarch together in saucepan. Then stir in the water. Cook over low heat, stirring all the time, until well blended (about 5 minutes).

Remove from stove, cool and pour into the cups.

Add a little food coloring to each cup, then a drop of dish soap. Mix and you're ready to paint.

Bubble Fun!

1 c liquid dishwashing detergent (Joy or Dawn work best)
8 c water
1 c karo syrup

Mix all the ingredients together in a large bowl.

Bubble Soap

Mix 1 c dish washing liquid, 1/8 c water, and a few drops of glycerine (available at any pharmacy) for longer lasting bubbles. Make bubble blowers from a straw, a kitchen funnel, or a thin wire shaped in creative forms.

Peanut Butter Playdough (2 recipes)

1 c peanut butter
1 c karo syrup
1 ¼ c powdered milk
1 ¼ c powdered sugar

OR

½ c peanut butter ½ c nonfat dry milk 2/3 T honey

Mix. Roll. Play. Eat. Can also use chocolate chips, pretzels, raisins, etc. to decorate.

Homemade Paint

Mix 1 t water, 1 t dish washing liquid, and ½ t food coloring.

Soapy Finger Paint

Whip 1 c soap flakes with ½ c water. Tint with food coloring or dry tempera paint. Paint on white shelf paper or waxed paper.

Finger Paint

Mix 2 c flour with 2 t salt. Add 2 ½ c cold water. Stir until smooth. Gradually add this mixture to 2 c boiling water. Boil until smooth and thick. Add food coloring, then stir until smooth.

Paste

Mix ½ c flour with ½ c water until smooth. Store in covered container. For more durable paste, add ½ c flour to 1 c boiling water. Stir over low heat until thick and shiny.

Play Dough

Mix 2 c flour, 1 c salt, 4 t cream of tartar, 2 c water, 2 T salad oil, and food coloring. Cook in a saucepan over medium heat until dough follows spoon and leaves side of the pan. Cool and knead. Store in airtight container.

Kool-Aid Playdough

Mix 1 c flour, ½ c salt, 3 T oil, and 1 small pkg of kool-aid. Add 1 c boiling water. Knead mixture until it forms a soft dough.

"Eye Slime" (from *Good Housekeeping*, October 2019)

1. Squeeze 5 oz glue into a bowl.
2. Add 1 T baking soda.
3. Add a small amount of green glitter paint, putting in more until you get your desired color.
4. Stir until combined, then mix in 3 T saline solution.
5. Roll slime in hands until it no longer sticks -- this can take as long as 5 minutes. (Hint: if it is still too sticky, add more saline solution.)
6. Add googly eyes and done!

DESSERTS

BROWNIES & COOKIES

***Perfect Chocolate Chip Cookies** (Brenda Labit's recipe)

1 ½ c all-purpose flour
1 t baking soda (MAKE SURE IT ISN'T EXPIRED OR IT WON'T WORK!!)
½ t salt
½ c unsalted butter, room temperature (not melted or even softened)
½ c firmly packed light brown sugar
6 T granulated sugar
1 large egg
1 t vanilla extract
2 ¼ c semisweet chocolate chips (Ghirardelli was recommended) *1 ½ c was a good amount of chips*

1. Preheat the oven to 350 F and line 2 baking sheets with parchment paper or spray with non-stick spray (To get best results, use parchment paper.)
2. In a medium bowl, sift the flour, baking soda and salt together.
3. In another large bowl, using an electric mixer at medium speed, beat together the butter, and sugars until smooth and mixed together well.
4. Add the egg and vanilla and mix on low speed until mixed in.
5. Gradually add the flour mixture and mix in until just incorporated. Do not keep mixing - do not overmix.
6. Add chocolate chips and stir with a wooden spoon, again no overmixing, just until incorporated.
7. Chill dough if dough is warm.
8. Using a small or large ice cream scoop or heaping tablespoon, drop the dough onto the prepared baking sheets, 6-8 per pan, depending on size you are making. (I scooped out a large ice cream scoop amount and broke it in ½ to make 2 balls. They baked up about 3" wide, taking ~12 minutes to bake.)
9. Bake the cookies, 1 sheet at a time, until the bottoms and edges are lightly browned and the tops feel firm when lightly touched.
10. Small cookies bake 8-10 minutes. Large cookies bake 10-13 minutes.
11. Let the cookies cool for 5 minutes on the baking sheets, then transfer the cookies to wire racks to cool completely.
12. Makes 18-30 cookies, depending on the size.

***Chocolate Chip Cookies** ("Uncle Scott's" recipe)
makes 4-5 dozen

1 c margarine
1 c sugar
1 c brown sugar, packed
2 eggs
2 t vanilla
1 t soda
1 t salt
3 ⅜ c flour
12 oz semi-sweet chips

1. Heat oven to 375. Mix thoroughly everything but flour and chips until creamy. Stir in the rest.
2. Bake on ungreased cookie sheet, 8-10 minutes or until golden brown.

Nestle Pan Cookies

2 ¼ c flour
1 t soda
1 t salt
1 c butter
¾ c sugar
¾ c brown sugar
1 t vanilla
2 eggs
12 oz choc chips

Mix all ingredients, adding chips last. Preheat oven to 375. Press in 15x10 jelly roll pan. Bake 20-25 min.

Mrs. Field's Chocolate Chip Cookies *(from Eleanor's recipe file)*

1 c brown sugar
1 c white sugar
1 c butter
2 eggs
½ t salt
1 t baking powder
1 t baking soda
1 t vanilla
1 ½ c oatmeal, ground in blender (measure first)
1 ½ c nuts (optional)
1 12-oz package of chocolate chips
3 c flour

chocolate chip molasses cookies (from Maria Rodale's *Scratch)*
makes 4 dozen cookies

2 sticks (8 ounces) unsalted butter, at room temperature
3/4 cup sugar
1/2 cup molasses
1/4 cup whole milk
1 large egg
1 teaspoon pure vanilla extract
2 ¼ cups white or whole wheat flour
1/2 teaspoon baking soda
1/2 teaspoon salt
9 ounces semisweet chocolate chips
1 cup chopped walnuts (optional)

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. Line 2 large baking sheets with parchment paper.
2. In a large bowl, using a hand mixer, beat the butter and sugar until pale and creamy. Beat in the molasses.
3. Add the milk and egg, beating well. Beat in the vanilla.
4. Add the flour, baking soda, and salt and beat to form a smooth dough. Fold in the chocolate chips and walnuts (if using).
5. Drop the dough by tablespoons onto the lined baking sheets, allowing room to spread. Bake, in batches if necessary, for 10 minutes, until golden. Transfer to a wire rack to cool.

Giant Chocolate Chip Caramel Skillet Cookie
16 servings

2 large eggs, beaten
1 c unsalted butter
2 c brown sugar
2 ½ t vanilla
3 c flour
1 ½ t baking soda
½ t salt
½ c semi-sweet chocolate chips
1 c Hershey's Caramel Kisses
½ c caramel sauce or salted caramel sauce

1. Preheat oven to 350.
2. Melt butter in a cast iron skillet over medium heat. Pour melted butter into a mixing bowl and set skillet aside. (If you are using a baking dish instead of a skillet, butter can be melted in the microwave.)
3. Stir brown sugar into the melted butter.
4. Add eggs and vanilla; mix well. Add flour, baking soda and salt; mix until combined.
5. Stir in chocolate chips and Hershey kisses.
6. Press half of the cookie dough into the skillet and cover with caramel sauce.
7. Then top with the remaining cookie dough, pressing evenly around pan.
8. Bake for 25-30 minutes or until edges are golden brown and caramel is bubbly. Serve hot.

***Chocolate Peanut Butter Swirls** (Nana's recipe - Lisa's favorite cookies, growing up)

½ c shortening (or ¼ c margarine and ¼ c shortening)
½ c white sugar
½ c brown sugar
½ c peanut butter
1 egg
1 ½ c flour
1 t soda
1 t salt
1 pkg chocolate chips

1. Cream shortening, sugars, peanut butter, & egg. Add dry ingredients except chips.
2. Divide dough and roll between 2 sheets of wax paper. Melt chips with a little water. Spread ½ on each peanut butter roll. Roll up and put in the fridge until chilled.
3. Slice about 1" thick and bake on lightly greased cookie sheet for 10 minutes at 375 degrees.

Chocolate Peanut butter Wheels
makes 32 cookies

1 c all-purpose flour
½ c whole-wheat flour (or whole-wheat pastry flour)
½ c unsweetened Dutch-processed cocoa powder
½ t baking soda
1 stick unsalted butter
¼ c peanut butter
½ c brown sugar
1 egg 1 T milk
1 t pure vanilla extract
¾ c sifted powdered sugar
½ c peanut butter
granulated sugar

1. Preheat oven to 350. In a medium bowl, stir together flours, cocoa powder and baking soda; set aside.
2. In a large mixing bowl, beat butter and ¼ c peanut butter with an electric mixer on medium to high speed for 30 seconds. Add sugar; beat until combined. Beat in egg, milk and vanilla. Beat in as much of the flour mixture as you can with the mixer. Stir in any remaining flour mixture. Shape into 32 balls (~1.25 in each); set aside.
3. For filling, in a medium bowl, combine powdered sugar and the ½ c peanut butter until smooth. Shape into 32 balls (~¾ in each). For each cookie, slightly flatten a chocolate ball and top with a peanut butter ball. Shape chocolate dough completely around filling; roll into a ball. Place 2 in apart on ungreased cookie sheet. Lightly flatten with bottom of a glass dipped in granulated sugar.
4. Bake about 8 minutes or just until set and slightly cracked. Cool on cookie sheet for 1 minute. Transfer to a wire rack; cool. Store any leftovers in an airtight container.

Peanut Butter Cookie Candy Bars
makes 36 servings

<u>Cookie Base</u>
1 pouch (1 lb 1.5 oz) Betty Crocker peanut butter cookie mix
3 T vegetable oil
1 T water
1 egg
<u>Filling</u>
⅓ c light corn syrup
3 T butter or margarine, softened
3 T peanut butter
1 T plus 1 ½ t water
1 ¼ t vanilla
dash salt
3 ½ c powdered sugar
<u>Caramel Layer</u>
1 bag (14 oz) caramels, unwrapped
2 T water
1 ½ c unsalted dry-roasted peanuts
<u>Topping</u>
1 bag (11.5 oz) milk chocolate chips (2 cups)

1. Heat oven to 350. Spray bottom only of 13x9 pan with cooking spray. In large bowl, stir cookie base ingredients until soft dough forms. Press dough in bottom of pan. Bake 12-15 minutes or until light golden brown. Cool completely, about 30 minutes.
2. In large bowl, beat all filling ingredients except powdered sugar with electric mixer on medium speed until creamy and smooth. Gradually beat in powdered sugar until well blended (filling will be thick). Press filling over cookie base. Refrigerate while preparing caramel layer.
3. In 2 quart saucepan, heat caramels and 2 T water over low heat, stirring constantly, until caramels are melted. Stir in peanuts. Spread evenly over filling. Refrigerate about 15 minutes or until caramel layer is firm.
4. In small microwavable bowl, microwave chocolate chips uncovered on High 1-2 minutes, stirring once, until melted. Spread evenly over caramel layer. Refrigerate about 1 hour or until chocolate is set. For bars, cut into 9 rows by 4 rows. Store covered at room temperature.

Peanut Butter Truffle Brownies

Brownie Base	Filling	Topping
1 box (1 lb 6.5 oz) Betty Crocker Original Supreme brownie mix	½ c butter, softened	1 c semisweet chocolate chips
Water, vegetable oil and eggs called for on brownie mix box	½ c creamy peanut butter	¼ c butter
	2 c powdered sugar	
	2 t milk	

1. Heat oven to 350. Grease bottom only of 13x9 pan with cooking spray or shortening. (For easier cutting, line pan with foil, then grease foil on bottom only of pan.
2. In medium bowl, stir brownie mix, pouch of chocolate syrup, water, oil and eggs until well blended. Spread in pan. Bake 28-30 minutes or until toothpick inserted 2 inches from side of pan comes out almost clean. Cool completely, about 1 hour.
3. In medium bowl, beat filling ingredients with electric mixer on medium speed until smooth. Spread mixture evenly over brownie base.
4. In small microwavable bowl, microwave topping ingredients uncovered on High 30-60 seconds; stir until smooth. Cool 10 minutes; spread over filling. Refrigerate about 30 minutes or until set. For brownies, cut into 9 rows by 4 rows. Store covered in refrigerator.

Game-Changing Peanut Butter Bars
Makes 20 bars

1 c butter, melted	2 c powdered sugar	1 ½ c chocolate chips
2 c graham cracker crumbs	1 c + 4T peanut butter, divided	

1. In a medium bowl, mix together the butter, graham cracker crumbs, powdered sugar, and 1 c peanut butter until well blended. Press evenly into the bottom of an ungreased 9x13 pan.
2. Microwave the chocolate chips with 4 T peanut butter on high for 1 minute. Stir. Continue microwaving and stirring every 30 seconds until smooth. Spread over the prepared crust. Refrigerate for at least one hour before cutting into squares and serving. Store bars in airtight container in refrigerator.

***Peanut Blossom Cookies**
Makes about 4 dozen cookies

1 bag (8 oz) Hershey Kisses	1/3 c granulated sugar	1 ½ c all purpose flour
½ c shortening	1 egg	1 t baking soda
¾ c creamy peanut butter	2 T milk	½ t salt
1/3 c packed light brown sugar	1 t vanilla	Granulated sugar

1. Heat oven to 375. Remove wrappers from kisses.
2. Beat shortening and peanut butter in large bowl until well blended. Add 1/3 c granulated sugar and brown sugar; beat until light and fluffy. Add egg, milk, and vanilla; beat well. Stir together flour, baking soda, and salt; gradually beat into peanut butter mixture.
3. Shape dough into 1-inch balls. Roll in granulated sugar; place on ungreased cookie sheet.
4. Bake 8-10 min or until lightly browned. Immediately press kisses into centers of cookies; cookie will crack around edges. Remove from cookie sheet to wire rack. Cool completely.

***Aunt Katie makes this same recipe but puts the dough ball into a mini muffin tin and then presses a mini Reese's Peanut Butter Cup into it while it is still warm.*

No-Bake Cookies with Peanut Butter (Nana's recipe)

4 c white sugar
½ c cocoa
1 c margarine
1 c milk

Bring ingredients to a boil and boil for 2 minutes. Then add:

2 c peanut butter
5 ½ c quick oats
2 t vanilla

Drop by spoonfuls on wax paper and let cool.

flourless peanut butter cookies (from Maria Rodale's *Scratch)*
makes 44 cookies

2 cups chunky or smooth peanut butter
2 cups packed light brown sugar
1 cup coarsely chopped salted roasted peanuts
2 large eggs
1 teaspoon baking soda

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line 2 baking sheets with parchment paper.
2. Place the peanut butter, sugar, peanuts, eggs, and baking soda in a bowl and mix to combine.
3. Roll tablespoons of the dough into balls and place on the lined baking sheet. Flatten by creating a crosshatch pattern on each cookie with a fork. Bake, in batches if necessary, for 9 to 12 minutes, until golden. Let the cookies cool on the baking sheet for a few minutes before transferring to a wire rack to cool completely.
4. If desired, sandwich the cookies with frosting

Homemade "Oh Henry!"

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees.
2. Grease a 9x13 pan.
3. Mix:
   4 c quick oats ½ c sugar 1 c brown sugar
4. Add: 1 c melted butter
5. Press the mixture into the pan.
6. Bake for 20 min, then cool 20 min.
7. Melt 6 oz chocolate chips and 1 c crunchy peanut butter in saucepan over medium heat, stirring to blend.
8. Spread over cooked base, and refrigerate 1 hour.

***Andes Fudge Cookies** (Eleanor's recipe)

¾ cup margarine or butter
1 ½ cup brown sugar
2 ½ Tablespoons water
2 cups chocolate chips
2 eggs
2 ½ cups flour
½ tsp salt
1 ¼ teaspoons of baking soda
Andes Mints

1. Cook butter, brown sugar, and water until sugar is melted. Remove from heat and add chocolate chips. Pour into bowl. Let cool for 10 minutes. Beat in eggs, one at a time on high speed. Reduce speed, add dry ingredients.
2. Chill dough for 2 hours. Roll into balls. Preheat oven to 350. Line cookie sheet with foil. Drop dough on foil. Bake 8-10 minutes.
3. Place Andes mint on each cookie while still warm. Smear over cookie.

***Rocky Road Brownies** (Nana's recipe)

Brownie Base
2 c sugar
⅓ c cocoa
2 sticks (1 cup) margarine
4 eggs
1 ½ c flour
2 t vanilla
mini marshmallows

Frosting
2 c powdered sugar
3 T milk
¼ c cocoa
¼ c margarine, softened
1 t vanilla

1. For Brownie Base: Mix together sugar and cocoa. Add margarine with mixer. Add eggs, one at a time. Mix well. Add flour and vanilla. Spread on a greased and floured 17.5x11.5" cookie sheet. Bake at 350 for about 20 minutes. Spread top with marshmallows and return to the oven (to melt the marshmallows) for 3-5 minutes.
2. For frosting: Mix all frosting ingredients together and frost brownies when cool.

Cream Cheese Swirl Brownies

1 pkg Betty Crocker dark chocolate fudge brownie mix
6 oz cream cheese, softened
¼ c sugar
½ t vanilla
1 egg
½ c semisweet chocolate chips

Prepare fudgelike brownies in 13x9 pan as directed on pkg, except reserve 1 c batter. Spread remaining batter in pan. Beat cream cheese until creamy; gradually beat in sugar. Beat in vanilla and egg until smooth; stir in chocolate chips. Drop cream cheese mixture by tablespoonfuls onto batter in pan; carefully spread over batter. Drop reserved batter by tablespoonfuls on top. Gently swirl through batter. Bake 35-40 minutes or until edges begin to brown; cool. Store tightly covered.

To adapt recipe for holidays, add food coloring of choice to cream cheese mixture before adding chocolate chips. Proceed as usual.

Chewy Brownies (from *MARTHASTEWART.COM*)
makes 16

7 T unsalted butter, room temperature, plus more for baking pan
¾ c plus 2 T unbleached all-purpose flour
¼ t baking powder
½ t kosher salt
7 oz unsweetened chocolate, finely chopped (1 ⅓ c)
3 T safflower or coconut oil
1 c granulated sugar
1 c packed light-brown sugar
3 large eggs, room temperature

1. Preheat oven to 350. Butter a 9-inch square baking pan. Line with parchment, leaving a 2-inch overhang on two sides; butter parchment.
2. In a medium bowl, whisk together flour, baking powder, and salt. In a heatproof bowl set over a pot of simmering water, melt chocolate and butter with oil. Remove from heat. Add both sugars and whisk 10 seconds. Add eggs and whisk vigorously until glossy and smooth, 45 seconds. Using a rubber spatula, stir in dry ingredients. Pour batter evenly into prepared pan, smoothing top with spatula.
3. Bake until set and a tester inserted in center comes out with moist crumbs, 35-40 minutes. Let cool in pan on a wire rack 20 minutes, then remove using parchment; let cool completely on rack before cutting into squares. Brownies can be store in an airtight container up to 2 days.

Black Bean Brownies (from lovinglifeonemealatatime.blogspot.com)

1 Can Black Beans, drained
3 Eggs
3 Tbsp Oil (I used coconut, but whatever you have will work)
1/3 Cup cocoa + 1 Tbsp
Pinch of salt
2 tsp Vanilla
¾ Cup Sugar + 2 Tbsp
1 tsp Baking Soda
Chocolate Chips (I put ½ cup in the batter and melted 1/3 cup on the top)

Preheat oven to 350. Spray an 8 inch baking pan with non stick cooking spray. In a food processor (I used my vitamix), puree black beans until smooth then add remaining ingredients, except chocolate chips. Pulse until well combined. Fold in chocolate chips if you're using them, then pour batter into pan. Bake at 350 for 30-40 minutes, until toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean. Sprinkle more chocolate chips on top to melt if desired.

chocolate brownies with salted caramel frosting (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale)
makes 16 brownies

Butter and flour, for the pan
9 tablespoons unsalted butter, chopped
6 ounces unsweetened chocolate, chopped
3/4 cup sugar
3/4 cup whole milk or buttermilk
3 large eggs
2 teaspoons pure vanilla extract
1 ½ cups all-purpose flour
3/4 teaspoon baking powder
1/4 teaspoon salt
Salted Caramel Frosting (below)

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Grease and flour an 8 X 8-inch* baking pan.
2. In a heatproof bowl, combine the butter and chocolate and set over a small saucepan of gently simmering water. Stir until melted and smooth. Set aside to cool to room temperature.
3. In a large bowl, beat together the sugar, milk, eggs, and vanilla. Stir in the melted chocolate mixture. Add the flour, baking powder, and salt and mix just until combined.
4. Pour the batter into the prepared pan and smooth the top. Bake for 15 minutes*, or until crisp around the edges but still soft in the middle.
5. Let cool completely in the pan before frosting. Cut into 16 squares to serve.

**I had to cook them longer than 25 minutes and they were still gooey in the middle of the pan, so maybe use a bigger pan so they aren't so thick?*

<u>Salted Caramel Frosting</u>
2 tablespoons unsalted butter
1/4 cup packed dark brown sugar
3 tablespoons whole milk or cream
2 teaspoons pure vanilla extract
1/4 teaspoon sea salt
2 cups powdered sugar, sifted

1. In a small saucepan, melt the butter over medium-low heat. Add the brown sugar and milk and cook for 1 minute, or until the sugar melts. Remove from the heat and set aside to cool a little.
2. Transfer the butter mixture to a bowl. Using a hand mixer on high speed, beat in the vanilla and salt. Reduce the speed to low, gradually add the powdered sugar, and beat until light and fluffy, about 5 minutes. For a creamier frosting, add a little more milk or cream.

Chocolate Chip Cheesecake Bars ("Yummy and easy")

½ c cold butter
1 pouch Betty Crocker oatmeal chocolate chip cookie mix
1 egg
2-8 oz pkgs cream cheese, softened
1 c sugar
2 eggs
1 t vanilla

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Spray 13x9 pan.
2. In large bowl, cut butter into cookie mix. Stir in 1 egg til crumbly. Spoon 3 c crumb mix into pan. Press firmly. Bake 15 minutes.
3. In small bowl, beat cream cheese, sugar, 2 eggs, and vanilla on medium speed til smooth. Pour over cookie crust. Spoon remaining crumb mixture over top.
4. Bake 25-30 minutes or til golden brown and firm to touch. Cool 30 minutes. Refrigerate 2+ hours before serving.

***Rich Chocolate Chip Toffee Bars**

2 ⅓ c flour
⅔ c brown sugar, packed
¾ c butter or margarine
1 egg, slightly beaten
2 c semi sweet chips, divided
14 oz sweetened condensed milk
1 ¾ c Skor (toffee) bits, divided

1. Grease 13x9 pan. Combine flour & brown sugar in large bowl. Cut in butter until coarse crumbs are formed. Add egg; mix well. Stir in 1 ½ c chocolate chips.
2. Set aside 1 ½ c of the mixture. Press remaining mixture into pan bottom. Bake 10 minutes.
3. Pour condensed milk evenly over hot crust. Top with 1 ½ c Skor (toffee) bits. Sprinkle the rest of the dough crumb mixture (1 ½ c set aside in step 2) over top. Then sprinkle with remaining ½ c chocolate chips.
4. Bake 25-30 minutes or until golden. Sprinkle the rest of the Skor (toffee) bits. Cool completely before cutting.

Carmelitas (from *Raised in the Kitchen* by Carrian Cheney)
Makes 21-24 bars

<u>Crust and Topping</u>
2 cups all-purpose flour
2 cups old-fashioned rolled oats
1/4 teaspoon salt
2 teaspoons baking soda
2 cups firmly packed brown sugar
1 ⅓ cups butter, melted

<u>Filling</u>
1 ½ (11-ounce) bags Kraft Caramels, unwrapped
1/2 cup evaporated milk
1/4 cup heavy cream
1 cup milk chocolate chips
1 cup semisweet chocolate chips

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Line a 9x13-inch baking pan with parchment paper or aluminum foil, leaving a 2-inch overhang on each side for easy lifting later. Spray paper or foil with nonstick cooking spray. (You can use a smaller pan but will end up with thicker, and fewer, bars.)
2. In a large bowl, mix together flour, oats, salt, baking soda, brown sugar, and melted butter until combined well. Sprinkle half of the mixture in prepared pan, pressing down to cover the bottom, and bake 10 minutes. When 10 minutes are up, remove from oven but do not turn off oven.
3. While oat mixture bakes, place unwrapped caramels, evaporated milk, and cream in a saucepan over low heat. Stir frequently until caramels are melted and mixture is thoroughly combined.
4. Sprinkle chocolate chips over baked mixture and then pour melted caramel evenly over the chips. Sprinkle remaining oat mixture over caramel and bake 15 minutes.
5. Let cool completely in pan on wire rack. Use parchment paper to lift out of pan and cut into bars when ready to serve.

Brownie variations (from Brownie mix boxes)

<u>Meltaway Mint Brownies</u>: Make brownies as directed on box. Pour half the recipe into pan, then layer with ½ c quartered unwrapped peppermint patties. Pour remaining batter over top and bake as directed.

Easy Raspberry Brownies: Bake dark chocolate brownies as directed, then frost with: 8 oz cream cheese, ½ c powdered sugar, ½ c raspberry jam. Drizzle with: 1 oz unsweetened baking chocolate and 1 T butter or margarine, melted in microwave on 50 %. Store covered in refrigerator.

Better-Than-Anything Brownies

1 pkg German chocolate cake mix
¾ c butter, melted
1 (5.75 oz) can evaporated milk, divided
1 (14 oz) bag caramels
1 (8 oz) bag Heath toffee bits, divided
1 (12 oz) bag milk chocolate chips, divided

1. Grease a 9x13 pan. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. In a large bowl, mix together cake mix, melted butter, and ⅓ c evaporated milk. Press half of this mixture into prepared pan. Bake 6 minutes.
2. Meanwhile, melt together caramels and remaining evaporated milk in a small saucepan over med-low heat, stirring often. Remove brownies from oven after 6 minutes and sprinkle on half the bag of Heath Toffee bits. Pour melted caramel over toffee bits. Sprinkle on half the bag of chocolate chips. Spread the remaining batter on top (this is easiest if you take pieces of the batter, flatten each individual piece in your hands and place on top). Sprinkle remaining toffee bits and chocolate chips on top. Bake 20 minutes. Cool before cutting.

Fudgy Brownies (from *Six Sisters*?)

Brownies
1 c margarine, melted
8 T cocoa powder
2 c granulated sugar
4 eggs
1 t vanilla extract
2 ½ c all-purpose flour
1 c chopped walnuts (optional)
pinch salt

Frosting
4 c powdered sugar
¼ c margarine, softened
3 T cocoa powder
¼ c hot water
1 t vanilla extract

1. Preheat oven to 325 degrees. Grease a 9x13-in pan; set aside. Combine melted margarine and cocoa powder and set aside. Combine sugar and eggs in a separate mixing bowl. Stir in margarine and cocoa mixture. Blend well. Add vanilla, flour, nuts (if using), and salt. Pour into prepared pan and bake 30-40 minutes or until a toothpick inserted in the center comes out clean.
2. For frosting, mix all ingredients together, spread over hot brownies and serve.

Willcocks' Waffle Cookies
Makes 2 dozen

½ c melted margarine
¾ c sugar
2 beaten eggs
4-6 T cocoa
1 ½ c flour
1 t vanilla

Mix wet then add dry. Heat waffle iron. Drop 1 teaspoon per section. Cook 50-60 seconds. Cool, frost (optional), enjoy.

***Indoor S'mores with Golden Grahams**

6 cups miniature marshmallows
1 ½ c milk chocolate chips (or substitute six Hershey bars (1.55 oz each), broken into small pieces)
5 T butter or margarine
1 t vanilla
8 c golden grahams cereal (one 13 oz box)

1. Melt 5 c marshmallows (save 1 c for later), milk chocolate chips, and butter in 3 qt saucepan over low heat, stirring occasionally. Remove from heat. Stir in vanilla. Butter 9x13 pan.
2. Pour cereal into large bowl. Pour marshmallow mixture over cereal; stir until evenly coated. Stir in remaining marshmallows.
3. Press mixture into pan with buttered back of spoon. Cool until as firm as you'd like. Cut into 24 bars. Store loosely covered at room temperature.

***Sugar Cookies** (Nana's recipe, which is actually Aunt Barbara's recipe)
makes 2-3 dozen

¾ c shortening or margarine
1 c sugar
2 eggs
1 t vanilla
2 ½ c flour
1 t salt
1 t baking powder

Cream shortening, sugar, eggs and vanilla. Stir in the rest. If you are going to roll out the dough and use cookie cutters, chill dough for an hour first. Otherwise, drop into ungreased cookie sheet and bake at 400 degrees 6-8 minutes. Mix powdered sugar and milk for easy glaze or decorate with frosting.

Copycat Swig Cookies *(I made these for Andrea Rossean's baby shower and they were very soft and tasty.)*
Makes 36

Cookie Ingredients*:*
1 c butter, room temperature
¾ c vegetable oil
1 ¼ c sugar
¾ c powdered sugar
2 T water
2 eggs
½ t baking soda
½ t cream of tartar
1 salt
5 ½ c flour

Frosting ingredients*:*
6 T butter, room temperature
½ c sour cream
3 c powdered sugar
½ t salt
3-4 T milk
½ t almond extract
food coloring, if desired.

1. Begin by creaming together butter, oil, sugars, water & eggs in your mixer. Mix for a few minutes until well combined.
2. In a separate bowl, combine dry ingredients and slowly add to butter mixture
3. Mix all ingredients until they are well-combined. Dough should not be sticky.
4. Roll dough into 1.5 inch balls and place on a greased cookie sheet.
5. To give the cookies their cracked edges, place ¼ c sugar and a pinch of salt in a separate bowl. Place the bottom of a glass into the mixture and then press it onto your ball of dough. The diameter of the bottom of the glass I used was 2.5 inches.
6. Press cookies until they are a bit wider than the glass bottom diameter (my cookies were about 3 inches in diameter) and cook at 350 for 8 minutes. Cookies end up being about 3.5 inches in diameter after being baked.
7. Let cool and place in fridge.
8. For the frosting, mix butter, sour cream, powdered sugar, salt, 1 drop of food coloring and almond extract. Mix well and add the desired amount of milk you want to get it the thickness you want. I only added a few tablespoons.
9. Spread frosting on cookies right before serving.

Caramel Frosted Brown Sugar Drops (from Jenny McCulloch- "better than plain sugar cookies")

2 1/4 c. all purpose flour
1 t. baking soda
1/4 t. salt
1 c. softened butter
1 1/3c. packed brown sugar
2 eggs
1 1/2 t. vanilla
2/3 c. sour cream

Caramel Frosting (tastes almost like a maple bar):
7 T. butter
3/4 c. brown sugar
1 T. light corn syrup
1 2/3 c. powdered sugar
1 1/4 t. vanilla
1c. chopped pecans, optional. (I opted not to)

1. Bake at 350 degrees on greased cookie sheets 9-12 min, turn sheets halfway through cooking.
2. Combine dry ingred (except sugar) and set aside. In a mixer beat butter and b. sugar on medium speed until blended and fluffy. Beat in eggs and vanilla until evenly incorporated. Lightly beat in half the flour mixture. Add s.cream, blend well, add remaining flour mixture & 3/4c. pecans.
3. Drop 1/8c. sized scoops onto sheets 2 1/2'' apart, pat the tops of dough until flat. bake until lightly tinged brown at edges. Let stand on wire rack 1-2 min, then remove from cookie sheet and cool.
4. Frosting: Melt butter in pan over med-high heat. Bring to a boil, simmer gently, stir occasionally until it turns slightly golden and smells 'fragrant', about 3 min or so. Stir in brown sugar and cook 1 min. Stir in 2 1/2 T. hot water and the corn syrup until mixture is well blended & sugar dissolved. Vigorously stir in powdered sugar and vanilla until smooth. Let stand until stiff enough to spread. 2-4 m.
5. Spread over cookies. If the frosting gets too stiff to spread, add more hot water.

Fanciful Fruit Pizza (Pillsbury.com)

1 roll (16.5 oz) refrigerated sugar cookies
1 8 oz pkg cream cheese
1/3 c sugar
½ t vanilla
1 c fresh or canned peach slices, drained, cut into thinner slices
1 c halved or quartered strawberries
1 c fresh or frozen blueberries
½ c apple jelly

1. Heat oven to 350 degrees. Grease 12-inch pizza pan or spray with cooking spray. Press cookie dough evenly in bottom of pan to form crust.
2. Bake 16-20 minutes or until golden brown. Cool completely, about 30 minutes.
3. In small bowl, beat cream cheese, sugar, and vanilla with electric mixer on medium speed until fluffy. Spread mixture over cooled crust. Arrange fruit over cream cheese.
4. Stir jelly until smooth; spoon or brush over fruit. Refrigerate until chilled, at least 1 hour. Cut into wedges or squares. Store in refrigerator.

***Snickerdoodles** (Nana's recipe)
makes 5 dozen

1 c shortening
1 ½ c white sugar
2 eggs
2 ¾ c flour
2 t cream of tartar
1 t baking soda
½ t salt
2 T sugar
2 t cinnamon

Cream shortening. Add 1 ½ c sugar and eggs and beat until fluffy and light. Sift together flour, cream of tartar, soda, and salt and stir in. Roll into balls the size of small walnuts and roll in cinnamon/sugar mixture. Place about 2" apart on ungreased cookie sheet. Bake until lightly browned, but still soft at 350 degrees for 8-10 minutes. Cookies puff up at first, then flatten out as they cool.

Snickerdoodle Blondies (from *Six Sisters*?)
makes 24 bars

1 c salted butter, room temperature
2 eggs
2 c light brown sugar
1 T vanilla extract
2 ⅔ c all-purpose flour
2 t baking powder
Cinnamon topping:
2 T sugar + 2 t ground cinnamon

Preheat oven to 350. Combine butter, eggs, brown sugar, and vanilla. Combine flour and baking powder in separate bowl and stir into egg mixture. Spread in a greased 9x13 dish. The batter will be thick, almost like a cookie mixture. Combine cinnamon topping ingredients and sprinkle over top. Bake 25-30 minutes, or until top springs back when pressed. Once it cools, it will harden more.

***Ginger Cookies** (our favorite Ginger Snap recipe - in *Christmas Recipes from the Lion House*)
makes 4 dozen cookies

¾ c shortening
1 c sugar
¼ c molasses
1 egg
2 c flour
2 t baking soda
¼ t salt
1 ½ t ginger
1 t cinnamon

1. Cream shortening and sugar. Add molasses and egg and beat well.
2. Sift flour, baking soda, salt, ginger, and cinnamon, and add gradually to creamed mixture. Chill dough. (I rarely chill it before scooping.)
3. Mold dough into balls; place on lightly greased cookie sheet. Bake at 350 degrees for 8-10 minutes. Don't overbake. (Take out when they still look a bit soft on top.) Cool on wire rack. Store in covered container.

***Homemade Oreos** (Nana's recipe)

1 pkg devil's food cake mix
2 eggs
⅔ c shortening

1. Beat the eggs slightly, add the cake mix and the cold shortening. Use a pastry blender and finish up with your hands. In a few minutes, the sugar in the cake mix melts and the whole thing comes together in a nice firm ball.
2. Heat the oven to 375. Grease cookie sheet and make small balls of dough about the size of a cherry. Bake 8-9 minutes. They'll look soft but don't overcook! Remove carefully and let cool. When all done and cool, use frosting to make sandwiches out of the cookies.

Cake Mix Cookies

1 cake mix, any flavor
½ c margarine, softened
2 eggs

1. Mix the softened margarine into the cake mix. Add the eggs and stir until moistened.
2. Drop by spoonfuls onto a cookie sheet. Bake at 350 degrees for 10 minutes.

***Pumpkin Chocolate Chip Cookies** (Jeri Breshears' recipe)

1 ½ c sugar
½ c shortening
1 egg
1 c canned pumpkin
2 ½ c flour
½ t salt
1 t nutmeg
1 t cinnamon
1 t baking soda
1 t baking powder
½-1 c chocolate chips
½ c nuts (optional)

1. Mix together and drop by teaspoonsfuls onto greased cookie sheet.
2. Bake at 325-350 for 10-12 minutes
3. Can frost with cream cheese frosting if desired.

Zookies (from *Family Fun* Magazine)
makes about 50 cookies

½ c butter, softened
½ c brown sugar
1 egg
½ t vanilla extract
1 c flour
½ t baking soda
¼ t salt
1 small zucchini, shredded
1 c oatmeal
½ c raisins
¾ c shredded coconut (optional)
½ c butterscotch chips

1. Cream butter & sugar in large bowl. Add egg & vanilla and beat well.
2. Sift flour, soda, & salt and add to wet mixture.
3. Add remaining ingredients. Mix thoroughly.
4. Drop onto greased cookie sheets. Bake at 350 for 12-14 minutes.

Cowboy Coconut Bars (from MarthStewart.com)
Makes 16 bars - takes 3 hours

<u>Crust</u>
2 sticks unsalted butter, room temperature, plus more for pan
2 c all-purpose flour
1 c old-fashioned oats
¾ t coarse salt
¾ c packed light-brown sugar

<u>Filling</u>
1 stick unsalted butter
½ c packed light-brown sugar
½ c granulated sugar
¼ c heavy cream
½ t coarse salt
½ t pure vanilla extract
1 c semisweet chocolate chips (6 oz)

1 c pecans, toasted and coarsely chopped
1 c large unsweetened coconut flakes (or for chewier bars, substitute with sweetened shredded coconut)

1. CRUST: Preheat oven to 375. Butter a 9x13 pan and line with parchment, leaving a 2" overhang on long sides. Whisk together flour, oats, and salt.
2. Beat butter with brown sugar on medium speed in a mixer fitted with a paddle attachment until light and fluffy, about 2 minutes. Reduce speed to low and add flour mixture, 1 c at a time, until dough comes together in large clumps.
3. Firmly press dough into bottom of prepared pan. Pierce all over with a fork. Bake until golden brown, 18-20 minutes. Transfer to a wire rack; let cool slightly. Reduce oven temperature to 325.
4. FILLING: Combine butter, sugars, cream, and salt in a medium saucepan; bring to a boil over medium-high. Cook, stirring constantly, until mixture coats the back of a spoon, about 2 minutes. Remove from heat; stir in vanilla.
5. Scatter chocolate chips and pecans on top of crust. Drizzle with caramel and sprinkle with coconut. Bake until coconut is golden and caramel is bubbling, about 20 minutes. Let cool completely in pan on a wire rack before cutting into bars.

Apple-Raspberry Bars
Makes 16 bars - 1 hour 30 min total prep time

1 c all-purpose flour
1 c almond meal
½ t salt
½ t baking powder
1 c + 1 T sugar, divided
8 T butter, melted and cooled
1 egg
1 t finely grated lemon zest
¼ t almond extract
3 tart, firm apples, cored, peeled and very thinly sliced
6 oz (1-1 ½ c) raspberries
½ t cinnamon
¼ t nutmeg

1. Preheat oven to 375. Grease 9x9 baking pan with cooking spray. In large bowl, whisk ingredients flour through baking powder, plus ½ c sugar. In small bowl, whisk butter, egg, zest and extract until smooth. Pour over flour mixture; work with hands to make soft dough. Pat ⅔ of dough in pan, prick all over with fork, and bake until browned, 15-20 minutes.
2. In large bowl, toss fruit with spices and ½ c sugar. Scatter over bottom crust; crumble remaining dough on top. Sprinkle with remaining 1 T sugar. Bake until top is golden brown, 30 minutes. Cool completely; cut into 16 bars.

Perfect Lemon Bars (from Sherilyn Riboldi)
Takes 1 hr 10 minutes total - Makes 24 bars

Crust ingredients:
1 c butter, room temperature
½ c powdered sugar
2 c all-purpose flour
Filling ingredients:
6 large eggs, room temperature
3 cups sugar
2 T lemon zest (*Sherilyn used 2 limes/recipe instead)*
1 c fresh lemon juice
1 c all-purpose flour
powdered sugar, for dusting

1. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees. Grease a 9x13 pan. *(If you double the recipe, use a cookie sheet.)* To make the crust, beat together the butter and powdered sugar until fluffy. Gently stir in the flour just until combined. Press the dough into the bottom of the 9x13 pan. Bake at 350 degrees for 16-18 minutes or until lightly browned. Let cool completely.
2. Meanwhile, to make the filling, whisk together the eggs, sugar, lemon zest, lemon juice, and flour. Pour over the cooled crust. Bake at 350 degrees for 30-35 minutes or until the filling is set. Let cool. Dust with powdered sugar before serving. Store in the refrigerator.

Lemon Bars (from Shannon Nelson)

<u>Crust</u>
1 c butter or margarine
2 c flour
½ c powdered sugar
<u>Top filling:</u>
4 eggs
2 c sugar
1 t baking powder
5 T flour
⅔ c lemon juice

Knead and mix crust ingredients together well. Pat into a buttered 9x13 pan (8x8 for ½ recipe) and bake 20 minutes at 350. Mix together and pour on top of baked crust. Bake 30 minutes at 350. When cool, sprinkle top with powdered sugar.

Blueberry Muffin Tops (From *Blackberry Crumble* by Josi Kilpack)
These are really yummy. The blueberry texture is imperceptible in the cookies. They taste like little coffeecakes.
Makes 3 dozen

½ c shortening (I used butter flavor)
¼ c butter
1 egg
1 c sugar
1 t vanilla
1t lemon juice
2 T milk
2 c flour
1 ½ t baking powder
½ t salt
1 c fresh or frozen blueberries (no need to thaw)

1. Preheat oven to 375 degrees. In a large bowl, cream the shortening, butter, egg, sugar, vanilla, lemon juice, and milk. In a separate bowl, combine dry ingredients. Add to shortening mixture until just mixed. Fold in blueberries, careful not to crush the berries. The batter might be a bit crumbly.
2. Drop by teaspoonfuls (or 1 inch scoops) onto parchment or silicone-mat baking sheet (blueberries stick like crazy).
3. Bake 12-15 minutes or until muffin tops are golden brown. Cool on cookie sheet for two minutes before moving to a rack to cool.
4. Optional: Mix all glaze ingredients together (below) and drizzle over warm cookies. (streusel might be yummy, too)

Optional Glaze:

1 ½ T butter
1 c powdered sugar
2 T lemon juice

***Cinnamon Chip Cookies** (from Heather Wall/Angie Nash)

1 c butter
1 c sugar
1 c brown sugar
2 eggs
1 t vanilla
1 t baking soda
1 t baking powder
1 t salt
2 c flour
2 ½ c oatmeal (blend half of it into flour)
1 bag cinnamon chips

Cream together butter and sugars. Add eggs and vanilla; mix well. Mix in all the dry ingredients, then stir in cinnamon chips. Bake at 375 for 11-12 minutes or until they are done.

***Oatmeal Scotchies** (*This is a Nestle recipe, but was a favorite of the Campbell family that Lisa used to babysit for.)*
makes about 4 dozen cookies

2c all-purpose flour
1 t baking soda
½ t salt
½ t cinnamon
1 c butter, softened
¾ c sugar
¾ c firmly packed brown sugar
2 eggs
1 t vanilla extract
3 c oats
1 12-oz pkg (2 c) Nestle Butterscotch Chips

1. Preheat oven to 375. In small bowl, combine first 4 ingredients; set aside. In large bowl, combine butter, sugar, brown sugar, eggs, and vanilla extract; beat until creamy. Gradually add flour mixture. Stir in oats and butterscotch chips.
2. Drop onto ungreased cookie sheets. Bake 7-8 minutes (for chewier cookies) or 9-10 minutes (for crispier cookies).

**For pan cookie: spread in 15 ½ x 10 ½ x 1 inch baking pan. Bake at 375 for 18-22 minutes. Cool completely, then cut.

Soft Oatmeal Cookies (Ruth Ellis' recipe)
Makes 36-60 cookies, depending on the size

1 c butter, softened
1 c white sugar
1 c packed brown sugar
2 eggs
1 t vanilla extract
2 c all-purpose flour
1 t baking soda
1 t salt
1 ½ t ground cinnamon
3 c quick cooking oats
Raisins or nuts, optional

1. In a medium bowl, cream together white sugar, butter, and brown sugar. Beat in eggs one at a time, then stir in vanilla.
2. Combine flour, cinnamon, baking soda, and salt. Stir into the creamed mixture. Mix in oats. If you are using nuts or raisins, mix into dough, combining well. Cover, and chill dough for at least one hour.
3. Preheat the oven to 375 degrees. Grease cookie sheets. Roll dough in balls, and place 2 inches apart on cookie sheets.
4. Bake 8-10 minutes. Allow cookies to cool on sheet for 5 minutes before transferring to a wire rack to cool completely.

CAKES & FROSTINGS

***Pumpkin Dessert** (from Katie)

Crust:
1 yellow cake mix (reserve 1 cup)
½ c melted butter (or margarine)
1 egg

Filling:
1 29 oz can pumpkin
1 ½ c canned milk
1 ½ c sugar
4 eggs
1 t salt
1 t ginger
2 t cinnamon
¼ t cloves
1 t vanilla

Topping:
1 c reserved cake mix
¼ c sugar
1 t cinnamon
¼ c melted butter

1. Mix crust ingredients and press into greased 9x13 pan
2. Beat first 4 filling ingredients slightly then add remaining filling ingredients.
3. Pour filling mixture over crust mix already pressed into pan.
4. Mix topping until crumbly and sprinkle over filling.
5. Bake at 350 degrees 1 hour or until knife inserted in center comes out clean.
6. Cool and serve with whipped cream. (or a tall glass of milk…or a scoop of ice cream)

***Pumpkin Roll** (from Camille Smith in New Jersey)

3 eggs
1 c sugar
2/3 c canned pumpkin
1 c cake flour
1 t baking soda
2 t cinnamon
1 c walnut pieces (*I never add nuts!*)
½ t allspice
½ t nutmeg
powdered sugar
cream cheese filling

Heat oven to 375 degrees. Line jelly roll pan with foil *(use cheap foil - heavy duty doesn't peel well)*. Spray generously with cooking spray. Beat eggs in large bowl on high speed for 5 minutes until thick and lemon colored. Gradually beat in sugar and pumpkin. Gradually add flour, baking soda, & cinnamon, beating just until batter is smooth. Pour evenly into pan. Sprinkle with walnuts (*yuck*). Bake 10-15 minutes, or until pick inserted comes out clean. Immediately loosen from edges of pan, invert onto towel generously sprinkled with powdered sugar. Carefully remove foil. While hot, carefully roll cake and towel from narrow end. Cool on rack. Unroll; spread with cream cheese filling. Roll up; wrap in plastic wrap. Refrigerate 2 hours. Sprinkle with powdered sugar. Keep refrigerated. (Also freezes well.)

Cream Cheese Filling
1 ½ c powdered sugar
1 pkg (8 oz) cream cheese (softened)
¼ c. margarine (softened)
¾ t vanilla

Beat on medium speed until smooth. *(I almost always use the less fat cream cheese and it tastes just as yummy.*)

***Pumpkin Orange Poppy Seed Cake** - *"delicious"*

1 pkg yellow cake mix
1 ¼ c pumpkin
3 large eggs
⅔ c orange juice
¼ c poppy seeds

Glaze
1 ½ c powdered sugar
2-3 T orange juice

1. Preheat oven to 350. Grease and flour 12-cup bundt pan.
2. Combine cake mix, pumpkin, eggs, and orange juice in large mixer bowl. Beat on low speed until moistened. Beat on medium speed for 2 minutes. Add poppy seeds; mix until blended.

3. Pour into prepared bundt pan. Bake for 35-40 minutes or until wooden pick inserted in cake comes out clean.
4. Cool in pan on wire rack to cool completely. Drizzle with glaze.

Carrot Layer Cake (from *Cook's Illustrated*, May & June 2012)
serves 10-12

Cake
1 ¾ c (8.75 oz) all-purpose flour
2 t baking powder
1 t baking soda
1 ½ t ground cinnamon
¾ t ground nutmeg
½ t salt
¼ t ground cloves
1 ¼ c packed (8.75 oz) light brown sugar
¾ c vegetable oil
3 large eggs
1 t vanilla extract
2 ⅔ c shredded carrots (4 carrots)
⅔ c dried currants (*or can substitute raisins, Craisins, dried apricots/blueberries/cherries)*

Frosting
16 T unsalted butter, softened
3 c (12 oz) powdered sugar
⅓ c buttermilk powder
2 t vanilla extract
¼ t salt
12 oz cream cheese, chilled and cut into 12 equal pieces
2 c (8 oz) pecans, toasted and chopped coarse

1. FOR THE CAKE: Adjust oven rack to middle position and heat oven to 350 degrees. Grease 18x13 inch rimmed baking sheet, line with parchment paper, and grease parchment. Whisk flour, baking powder, baking soda, cinnamon, nutmeg, salt, and cloves together in large bowl.
2. Whisk sugar, oil, eggs, and vanilla together until mixture is smooth. Stir in carrots and currants. Add flour mixture and fold with rubber spatula until mixture is just combined.
3. Transfer batter to prepared baking sheet and smooth surface with offset spatula. Bake until center of cake is firm to touch, 15-18 minutes. Cool in pan on wire rack for 5 minutes. Invert cake onto wire rack (do not remove parchment) and then reinvent onto second wire rack. Cool cake completely, about 30 minutes.
4. FOR THE FROSTING: Using stand mixer fitted with paddle, beat butter, sugar, buttermilk powder, vanilla, and slat on low speed until smooth, about 2 minutes, scraping down bowl as needed. Increase speed to medium-low; add cream cheese, 1 piece at a time; and mix until smooth, about 2 minutes.
5. Transfer cooled cake to cutting board, parchment side down. Using sharp chef's knife, cut cake and parchment in half crosswise and then lengthwise to make 4 equal rectangles, about 6x8 inches each.
6. Place 6x8 inch cardboard rectangle on cake turntable or plate. Place 1 cake rectangle, parchment side up, on cardboard and carefully remove parchment. Using offset spatula, spread ⅔ c frosting evenly over cake layer. Repeat with two more layers of cake, frosting each layer with ⅔ c frosting and pressing gently on each layer to level. Place last rectangle of cake on top and frost top of cake with 1 c frosting. Use remaining frosting to coat sides of cake. (It's fine if some crumbs show through frosting on sides, but if you go back to smooth top of cake, be sure that spatula is free of crumbs.)
7. Hold cake with 1 hand and gently press chopped pecans onto sides with other hand. Chill for at least 1 hour before serving. (*The cake may be refrigerated for up to 24 hours before serving*.)

Carrot Cake with Cream Cheese Frosting - T*his recipe was titled "Mother's Carrot Cake (small size)" and was given to Eleanor by Lisa, but Lisa has no idea where it came from, nor any recollection of making it...Apparently it was good, though!*
serves 6-8

Cake
1 c all purpose flour
½ c sugar
½ c packed brown sugar
1 t ground allspice
¼ t salt
½ c vegetable oil
2 eggs
1 ½ c grated carrots

Frosting
2 T butter, softened
2 oz cream cheese, softened
1 c powdered sugar
½ t vanilla extract
2-4 t milk
2 T chopped walnuts, optional

1. Preheat oven to 350. In a large bowl, combine the flour, sugars, baking soda, allspice and salt. Beat in oil (batter will be stiff). Add eggs one at a time, beating well after each addition. Stir in carrots.
2. Pour into a greased 8-inch square baking dish. Bake at 350 for 35-40 minutes or until a toothpick inserted near the center comes out clean. Cool on a wire rack.
3. For frosting, in a small bowl, cream butter and cream cheese until smooth. Gradually beat in powdered sugar and vanilla. Add enough milk to achieve spreading consistency. Spread over cake. Sprinkle with walnuts (*gross!)* if desired. Store in the refrigerator.

Spice Cake with Cream Cheese Frosting (from *Cooks' Illustrated*, January & February 2008, p. 25)
Serves 12-14

Cake
2 ¼ c unbleached all-purpose flour, plus extra for dusting pans
1 T ground cinnamon
¾ t ground cardamom
½ t ground allspice
½ t ground cloves
¼ t ground nutmeg
16 T unsalted butter (2 sticks), softened
½ t baking powder
½ t baking soda
½ t table salt
2 large eggs plus 3 large yolks, at room temperature
1 t vanilla extract
1 ¾ c granulated sugar
2 T light or mild molasses
1 T grated fresh ginger
1 c buttermilk, at room temperature

Frosting
5 T unsalted butter, cut into 5 pieces, softened
1 ¼ c confectioners' sugar
8 oz cream cheese, cut into 4 pieces, softened
½ t vanilla extract
¾ c coarsely chopped walnuts, toasted (optional)

1. FOR THE CAKE: Adjust oven rack to middle position and heat oven to 350 degrees. Grease and flour 13x9 inch baking pan. Combine spices in small bowl; reserve ½ t for frosting.
2. Heat 4 T butter in 8-in skillet over medium heat until melted, 1-2 minutes. Continue to cook, swirling pan constantly, until butter is light brown and has faint nutty aroma, 2-4 minutes. Add spices and continue to cook, stirring constantly, 15 seconds. Remove from heat and cool to room temperature, about 30 minutes.
3. Whisk flour, baking powder, baking soda, and salt in medium bowl. In small bowl, gently whisk eggs, yolks, and vanilla to combine. In standing mixer fitted with paddle attachment, cream remaining 12 T butter with sugar and molasses at med-high speed until pale and fluffy, about 3 minutes, scraping down sides and bottom of bowl twice with rubber spatula. Reduce to medium speed and add cooled butter and spice mixture, ginger, and half of egg mixture; mix until incorporated, about 15 seconds. Repeat with remaining egg mixture; scrape down bowl again. Reduce to low speed; add about ⅓ flour mixture, followed by half of buttermilk, mixing until just incorporated after each addition, about 5 seconds. Repeat using half of remaining flour mixture and all of remaining buttermilk. Scrape bowl and add remaining flour mixture; mis at medium speed until batter is thoroughly combined, about 15 seconds. Remove bowl from mixer and fold batter once or twice with rubber spatula to incorporate any remaining flour.
4. Transfer batter to prepared pan; zigzag tip of metal spatula through batter, pulling it to pan edges. Lightly tap pan against counter 3 or 4 times to dislodge any large air bubbles; smooth surface with spatula.
5. Bake until toothpick inserted in center of cake comes out clean, 32-37 minutes. Cool cake to room temp in pan on wire rack, about 2 hours.
6. FOR THE FROSTING: In bowl of standing mixer fitted with paddle attachment, beat butter, sugar, and reserved ½ t spice mixture at med-high speed until light and fluffy, 1-2 minutes. Add cream cheese one piece at a time, beating thoroughly after each addition. Add vanilla and beat until no lumps remain, about 30 seconds.
7. Run paring knife around edge of cake to loosen from pan. Using spatula, spread frosting evenly over surface of cake. Sprinkle cake with walnuts, if using. Cut into squares and serve.

Winter Crisp ("hearty and filling")

<u>For filling</u>:
½ c sugar
3 T flour
1 t lemon peel, grated
¾ t lemon juice
5 c sliced apples, unpeeled
1 c cranberries *(I used craisins, but maybe add water with them?)*

<u>For topping</u>:
2/3 c rolled oats
1/3 c brown sugar, packed
¼ c whole wheat flour
2 t ground cinnamon
1 T soft margarine, melted

1. Prepare filling by combining sugar, flour, and lemon peel in medium bowl. Mix well. Add lemon juice, apples, and cranberries. Stir to mix. Spoon into 6 c baking dish.
2. Prepare topping by combining oats, brown sugar, flour, and cinnamon in small bowl. Add melted margarine. Stir.
3. Sprinkle topping over filling. Bake in 375 degree oven for approximately 40-50 minutes or until filling is bubbly and top is brown. Serve warm or at room temperature. Top with whipped topping, if desired.

New York-Style Crumb Cake (from *Cook's Illustrated*, May & June 2007)
serves 8-10

<u>Crumb Topping</u>
⅓ c (2 ⅔ oz) granulated sugar
⅓ c (2 ⅔ oz) dark brown sugar
¾ t ground cinnamon
⅛ t salt
8 T (1 stick) unsalted butter, melted and still warm
1 ¾ c (7 oz) cake flour

<u>Cake</u>
1 ¼ c (5 oz) cake flour *(regular flour will make cake dry & tough)*
½ c (3.5 oz) granulated sugar
¼ t baking soda
¼ t salt
6 T (¾ stick) unsalted butter, cut into 6 pieces, softened but still cool
1 large egg plus 1 large yolk
1 t vanilla extract
⅓ c buttermilk (*can substitute equal amount of plain, low-fat yogurt)*
powdered sugar for dusting

1. FOR THE TOPPING: Whisk sugars, cinnamon, salt, and butter in medium bowl to combine. Add flour and stir until mixture resembles thick, cohesive dough; Set aside to cool to room temperature, 10-15 minutes.
2. FOR THE CAKE: Adjust oven rack to upper-middle position and heat oven to 325 degrees. Cut 16-inch length parchment paper or aluminum foil and fold lengthwise to 7-inch width. Spray 8-inch square baking dish with nonstick cooking spray and fit parchment into dish, pushing it into corners and up sides; allow excess to overhang edges of dish.
3. In bowl of standing mixer fitted with paddle attachment, mix flour, sugar, baking soda, and salt on low to combine. With mixer running at low speed, add butter one piece at a time; continue beating until mixture resembles moist crumbs, with no visible butter chunks remaining, 1-2 minutes. Add egg, yolk, vanilla, and buttermilk; beat on medium-high speed until light and fluffy, about 1 minute, scraping once if necessary.
4. Transfer batter to baking pan; spread batter into even layer. Break apart crumb topping into large pea-sized pieces and spread in even layer over batter, beginning with edges and then working toward center. Bake until crumbs are golden and wooden skewer inserted into center of cake comes out clean, 35-40 minutes. Cool on wire rack at least 30 minutes. Remove cake from pan by lifting parchment overhang. Dust with powdered sugar just before serving.

***This recipe can be doubled and baked in 9x13 pan. If doubling, increase baking time to 45 minutes.*

Lemon-Blueberry Pound Cake (from *Taste of Home*, February/March 2013)
serves 12

⅓ c butter, softened
4 oz cream cheese, softened
2 c sugar
3 eggs
1 egg white
1 T grated lemon peel
2 t vanilla extract
2 c fresh or frozen unsweetened blueberries
3 c all-purpose flour, divided
1 t baking powder
½ t baking soda
½ t salt
1 c (8 oz) lemon yogurt

<u>Glaze</u>
1 ½ c powdered sugar
¼ c lemon juice

1. Grease and flour a 10-inch fluted tube pan (bundt pan). In a large bowl, cream the butter, cream cheese and sugar until blended. Add eggs and egg white, one at a time, beating well after each addition. Beat in lemon peel and vanilla.
2. Toss blueberries with 2 T of the flour. In another bowl, mix remaining flour with baking powder, baking soda and salt; add to creamed mixture alternately with yogurt, beating after each addition just until combined. Fold in blueberry mixture.
3. Transfer the batter to prepared pan. Bake at 350 for 55-60 minutes or until a toothpick inserted in center comes out clean. Cool in the pan 10 minutes before removing to wire rack; cool for 15 minutes.
4. In a small bowl, mix powdered sugar and lemon juice until smooth. Gradually brush onto warm cake, about ⅓ at a time, allowing glaze to soak into cake before adding more. Cool completely.

Apple Streusel Cake *(Delicious -- everyone liked this)*
makes 6 servings (or 12 muffins)

<u>Crumb Topping</u>
½ c flour
¼ c brown sugar
¼ c sugar
1 t cinnamon
¼ t ground ginger
¼ t allspice
¼ t cloves
4 T butter

<u>Cake</u>
1 banana (the riper, the better)
1 ½ t vanilla extract, to taste
1 t almond extract
½ c milk (or almond milk, if desired)
4 T butter, melted
1 ½ c flour
¾ c sugar
2 t baking powder
½ t salt
4 apples, peeled and sliced or 1 (16 oz) can canned apples, drained*

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Grease an 8x8 glass baking dish, a 9 in pie dish, or 12 medium size muffin tins.
2. To make crumb topping, mix all topping ingredients together (except butter) in a medium bowl. Add butter and cut together with dry ingredients until mixture is crumbly. Set aside.
3. To make the cake, in a large mixing bowl, mash banana with a fork. Mix in vanilla, almond extract, milk, and butter; mix well. Add in dry ingredients and mix until just combined.
4. Spread half of batter in the bottom of the greased pan. Arrange apple slices on top of batter, then cover with dollops of remaining batter, smoothing as well as possible over the apples. Sprinkle the crumb topping evenly over the top.
5. Bake 40 minutes. Remove from oven and allow to cool at least 15 minutes before serving. Serve warm or cold, with or without vanilla ice cream.

***If using apple pie filling in place of apples, decrease sugar in the cake to ⅓ c*
***For more flavor in the cake itself, sprinkle ½ c of the crumb topping over the apples before adding the second layer of cake batter.*

"Healthified" Fresh Apple Cake (from *BettyCrocker.com*) - This was dense, moist, and yummy. It might be more appealing if the apples were blended or grated instead of chopped.

¾ c sugar
¾ c brown sugar
1 c buttermilk
½ c canola oil
2 t vanilla
2 eggs
1 ½ c all-purpose flour
1 ½ c whole wheat flour
1 t baking soda
1 T ground cinnamon
½ t salt
3 c finely chopped unpeeled apples (3 medium)
1 c chopped walnuts

1. Heat oven to 350 F. Spray bottom only of 13x9 inch pan with cooking spray.
2. In large bowl, beat sugars, buttermilk, oil, vanilla and eggs with electric mixer on low speed 20-30 seconds or until blended. Add all remaining ingredients except apples and walnuts; beat on low speed about 1 minute or until blended. Stir in apples and walnuts. Spread batter in pan.
3. Bake 40-45 minutes or until toothpick inserted in center comes out clean. Cool in pan on cooling rack 1 hour.

Apple Upside-Down Cake (from *Cooks' Illustrated*, Sept & Oct 2009, page 23)
Serves 8
**You will need a 9 inch cake pan with 2 inch sides (line a springform pan with foil so it doesn't leak if using one), or an 8x8 square pan.

Topping
4 T unsalted butter, cut into pieces, plus extra for pan
4 granny smith or golden delicious apples (about 2 lbs), peeled and cored
2/3 c packed light brown sugar
2 t juice from 1 lemon

Cake
1 c all-purpose flour
1 T cornmeal (optional)
1 t baking powder
½ t salt
¾ c sugar
¼ c brown sugar
2 large eggs
6 T unsalted butter, melted and cooled slightly
½ c sour cream
1 t vanilla extract

1. FOR THE TOPPING: Butter bottom and sides of cake pan; set aside. Adjust oven rack to lowest position; heat to 350.
2. Halve apples from pole to pole. Cut 2 apples into ¼ inch-thick slices; set aside. Cut remaining apples into ½ inch-thick slices. Heat butter in 12-inch skillet over med-high heat. When foaming subsides, add ½ inch-thick slices and cook, stirring 2 or 3 times, until apples begin to carmelize, 4 to 6 minutes. (Do not fully cook apples.) Add ¼ inch-thick apple slices, brown sugar, and lemon juice; continue cooking, stirring constantly, until sugar dissolves and apples are coated, about 1 minute longer. Transfer apple mixture to prepared pan and lightly press into even layer. Set aside while preparing cake.
3. FOR THE CAKE: Whisk flour, cornmeal (if using), baking powder, and salt together in medium bowl; set aside. Whisk granulated sugar, brown sugar, and eggs together in large bowl until thick and homogeneous, about 45 seconds. Slowly whisk in butter until combined. Add sour cream and vanilla; whisk until combined. Add flour mixture and whisk until just combined. Pour batter into pan and spread evenly over fruit. Bake until cake is golden brown and toothpick inserted into center comes out clean, 35-40 minutes.
4. Cool pan on wire rack 20 minutes. Run paring knife around sides of cake to loosen. Invert onto plate or tray. Let cake cool at least 20 minutes, cut into pieces, and serve.

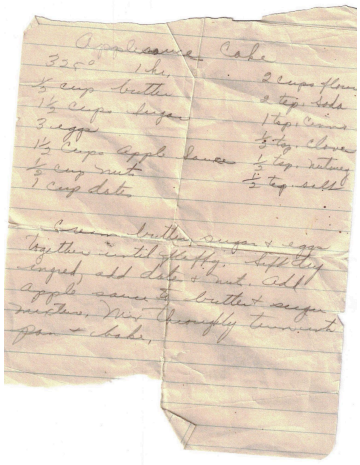
Apple Cupcakes with Cider Frosting
Makes 12-14

Cake ingredients:
3 c apple cider
½ c canola oil
½ c applesauce
¾ c brown sugar
2 large eggs
2 c flour
¾ c sugar
1 T baking powder
½ t salt
¾ t cinnamon
¼ t *each* nutmeg and allspice
2 medium apples, peeled and diced
Frosting ingredients:
8 oz cream cheese, softened
½ c butter, softened
4 c powdered sugar

1. Preheat oven to 350 F and position rack in center. Lightly grease or add liners to cupcake pan. In medium saucepan, boil cider until reduced to ¾ c. Set aside.
2. In medium bowl, whisk oil with eggs. Add ½ c reduced cider; refrigerate remaining ¼ c. In large bowl, whisk together flour with allspice. Add oil mixture; fold with rubber spatula until smooth. Fold in diced apples. Spoon into muffin tin, making each about ⅔ full. Bake until toothpick inserted in center of cupcake comes out clean, 20-25 minutes.
3. For frosting: Beat cream cheese and butter with electric mixer until creamy. Beat in powdered sugar; in slow drizzle, beat in reserved reduced cider. Spread over cooled cupcakes. (Opt: garnish with a sprinkle of cinnamon) Store for up to 4 days.

Aunt Louise's Applesauce Cake (sent by Ruth Ellis in 2016)

½ c butter
1 ½ c sugar
3 eggs
1 ½ c applesauce
½ c nuts
1 c dates
2 c flour
2 t soda
1 t cinnamon
½ t cloves
½ t nutmeg
½ t salt



1. Heat oven to 325 degrees.
2. Cream butter, sugar, and eggs together until fluffy. Sift dry ingredients; add dates and nuts. Add applesauce to butter & sugar mixture. [Then mix with dry ingredients.] Mix thoroughly, turn into pan & bake 1 hour.

Apple Coconut Crisp

4 large apples (granny smith)
½ c sweetened flaked coconut
1 T flour
⅓ c brown sugar
½ c butterscotch or carmel ice cream topping
½ t cinnamon
⅓ c flour
½ c quick rolled oats
2 T butter or margarine

1. In 1 ½ quart baking dish that fits into the crock pot, combine apples, coconut, 1 T flour, brown sugar, and cinnamon. Drizzle with ice cream topping.
2. Combine remaining ingredients in small bowl with pastry fork and sprinkle over apple mixture.
3. Cover and cook on high 2 ½-3 hours until apples are tender. Serve with ice cream or whipped topping.

Mandarin Snowflake Delight (*we ate this at a RS mtg and it was so yummy I asked for the recipe)*

<u>Cake</u>
1 white or yellow cake mix
1 11-oz can mandarin orange slices + juice
3 egg whites or whole eggs
½ c vegetable oil

<u>Topping</u>
1 (8 or 9 oz) carton cool whip
1 (15 ¼ oz) can crushed pineapple in own juice
1 (3 oz) pkg vanilla instant pudding mix
1 c flaked coconut

1. Combine all cake ingredients; mix for 2 minutes on medium. Pour into greased 9x13 pan. Bake at 350 for 25-30 minutes. Cool in pan.
2. Combine all topping ingredients in bowl, reserving ½ c coconut. Mix well. Spread on top of cake. Sprinkle remaining coconut on top of cake.

** Can make the night before. It's better if covered and refrigerated overnight (or at least several hours before serving).*

Layered Pumpkin Cheesecake (Betty Crocker Holiday 2006)

<u>Crust</u>:
2 c gingersnap cookie crumbs (about 32 cookies)
¼ c butter or margarine, melted

<u>Filling</u>:
4 pkgs (8 oz each) cream cheese, softened
1 ½ c sugar
4 eggs
1 c canned pumpkin
1 ½ t ground ginger
1 t cinnamon
1 t nutmeg

1. Heat oven to 300. Grease 9-inch springform pan. Wrap foil around pan to catch drips. In small bowl, mix cookie crumbs and butter. Press crumb mixture in bottom and 1 inch up side of pan. Bake 8-10 min or until set. Cool 5 min.

2. In large bowl, beat cream cheese with electric mixer on medium speed just until smooth and creamy; do not overbeat. On low speed, gradually beat in sugar. On low speed, beat in eggs, one at a time, just until blended. Spoon 3 cups of the cream cheese mixture into pan; spread evenly.
3. Stir pumpkin, ginger, cinnamon, and nutmeg into remaining cream cheese mixture; mix with wire whisk until smooth. Spoon over mixture in pan.
4. Bake 1 hour 25 min to 1 hour 30 minutes, or until edges are set but center of cheesecake still jiggles slightly when moved.
5. Turn oven off; open oven door at least 4 inches. Leave cheesecake in oven 30 minutes longer. Remove from oven; place on cooling rack. Without releasing side of pan, run knife around edge of pan to loosen cheesecake. Cool in pan on cooling rack 30 minutes. Cover loosely; refrigerate at least 6 hours but no longer than 24 hours.
6. Run knife around edge of pan to loosen cheesecake again; carefully remove side of pan. Place cheesecake on serving plate. Store cheesecake covered in refrigerator. *16 servings*

Philadelphia Chocolate Vanilla Swirl Cheesecake ("yummy" – can make ½ recipe in pie pan or cheesecake pan)
15 minutes prep, plus baking and refrigeration - Makes 16 servings

20 oreo cookies, crushed (about 2 cups)
3 T butter, melted
4-8 oz pkgs cream cheese, softened
1 c sugar
1 t vanilla
1 c sour cream
4 eggs
6 squares (1 oz each) semi-sweet baking chocolate, melted & cooled

1. Preheat oven to 325. Line 13x9 pan with foil, with ends of foil extending over sides of pan. Mix cookie crumbs with butter; press firmly onto bottom of prepared pan. Bake 10 minutes.
2. Beat cream cheese, sugar and vanilla in large bowl with electric mixer on medium speed until well blended. Add sour cream; mix well. Add eggs, one at a time, beating on low speed after each addition just until blended. Remove 1 c of the batter; set aside. Stir melted chocolate into remaining batter in large bowl; pour over crust. Top with spoonfuls of the remaining 1 c plain batter; cut through batters with knife several times for swirled effect.
3. Bake 40 minutes or until center is almost set. Cool. Refrigerate at least 4 hours or overnight. Use foil handles to lift cheesecake from pan before cutting to serve. Store any leftover cheesecake in refrigerator.

Raspberry-Lemon Cheesecake Bars
Takes about 6 hours, including refrigerating - Makes 18 servings

2 c graham cracker crumbs
1 c plus 2 T sugar, divided
6 T butter, melted
3 c (12 oz) raspberries, divided
1 T each zest and juice from 1 lemon
4 pkg (8 oz each) cream cheese, softened
4 eggs

1. Heat oven to 325 F
2. Line 13x9 inch pan with foil, with ends of foil extending over sides (so you can lift it out of the pan)
3. Combine graham crumbs, 2 T sugar, and butter; press onto bottom of prepared pan. Bake 10 minutes.
4. Reserve ½ c raspberries and t lemon zest for later use.
5. Beat cream cheese, lemon juice, remaining zest and remaining sugar in large bowl with mixer until blended. Add eggs, 1 at a time, mixing on low speed after each just until blended. Gently stir in remaining raspberries; pour over crust.
6. Bake 35-40 minutes or until center is almost set. Cool completely.
7. Refrigerate 4 hours. Top with reserved raspberries and lemon zest. Use foil "handles" to remove cheesecake from pan before cutting into bars.

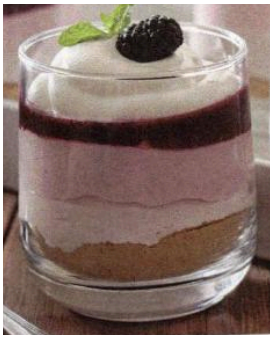
Cheesecake in a Cloud (Easy cheesecake substitute)

1. Mix a few spoonfuls each of Cream Cheese Spread with Cool Whip. Spoon onto plate (or into a dessert bowl). Make a depression in the center.
2. Sprinkle in crumbs to coat middle and sides of cream cheese mixture
3. Spoon filling into center of dessert dish.

Ingredient suggestions:

Cream cheese flavor	**Type of crumbs**	**Filling**
Strawberry	Oreo	Crushed pineapple/strawberries
Honey nut	Graham cracker	Apple pie filling
Regular	Oreo	Cherry pie/strawberry
Pineapple	Graham cracker	Tropical fruit cocktail, drained

No-Bake Ombre Blackberry Cheesecakes
Takes 50 minutes total - serves 4



1 c graham cracker crumbs
1 c fresh blackberries, plus more for garnish
1 c heavy whipping cream
½ c granulated sugar, divided *(29 g of sugar/serving)*
½ t vanilla extract
8 oz cream cheese, softened
sprigs of mint, for garnish

1. Evenly distribute the graham cracker crumbs between 4 clear glass/plastic serving cups, and set aside. Puree 1 c blackberries in a food processor and set aside.
2. In a stand mixer with the whisk attachment (or using a hand mixer), beat the heavy cream, ¼ c sugar and vanilla until stiff peaks form, about 2 minutes. Set the whipped cream aside in a clean bowl. Clean the mixer, and beat the cream cheese and remaining ¼ c sugar (with paddle attachment or hand mixer) until totally smooth, about 3-4 minutes.
3. Reserve ¼ c of the prepared whipped cream. Add the rest to the cream cheese mixture, then mix on low speed for an additional 1-2 minutes until totally incorporated. Divide this mixture evenly between 2 bowls. Add a scant tablespoon of the berry puree to 1 bowl, and 2-3 T to the other. Mix each bowl well to make 2 shades of purple cheesecake filling.
4. To assemble, spoon or pipe the light purple cheesecake mixture evenly over the graham cracker layer. Repeat with the darker purple mixture, and finish with the remaining berry puree. Use the reserved whipped cream to top each cheesecake, and garnish with fresh blackberries and sprigs of mint. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Chocolate Raspberry Cheesecake

6 oz cream cheese, softened
1 14 oz can sweetened condensed milk
1 egg
3 T lemon juice
1 t vanilla extract
1 c fresh or frozen raspberries
1 6 oz ready-made graham cracker pie crust
2 oz semisweet chocolate
¼ c whipping cream

1. Heat oven to 350. With mixer, beat cream cheese until fluffy. Gradually beat in sweetened condensed milk until smooth.

2. Add egg, lemon juice, and vanilla. Mix well.
3. Press raspberries firmly into bottom of crust, reserving a few whole berries for garnish. Slowly pour cheese mixture over fruit.
4. Bake 30-35 minutes or until center is almost set. Cool.
5. Chocolate glaze: In small saucepan, over low heat, melt chocolate with whipping cream. Stir until thickened and smooth. Remove from heat. Glaze over cheesecake; chill. Garnish as desired.

Deep Dark Chocolate Cheesecake
serves 12 - needs to chill overnight before spreading topping and serving

Crust
24 chocolate wafer cookies (from 1 9oz pkg)
1 T sugar
¼ c butter, melted

Filling
10 oz dark chocolate (bittersweet), chopped
4 pkg (8 oz each) cream cheese, room temperature
1 ¼ c plus 2 T sugar
¼ c unsweetened cocoa powder
4 large eggs

Topping
¾ c whipping cream
6 oz dark chocolate (bittersweet), chopped
1 T sugar

1. Preheat oven to 350 F. Butter 9 in diameter springform pan with 3 inch high sides. Chop cookies in food processor until finely ground; blend in sugar. Add melted butter and process until well blended. Press crumbs evenly onto bottom (not sides) of prepared pan. Bake just until set, about 5 minutes. Cool while preparing filling. Maintain oven temperature.
2. Stir 10 oz chopped chocolate in metal bowl set over saucepan of simmering water until melted and smooth. Remove bowl from over water; cool chocolate until lukewarm but still pourable. Blend cream cheese, sugar and cocoa powder in processor until smooth. Blend in eggs, one at a time. Mix in lukewarm chocolate. Pour filling over crust; smooth top. Bake until center is just set and just appears dry, about 1 hour. Cool 5 minutes. Run knife around sides of cake to loosen. Chill overnight.
3. Stir whipping cream, 6 oz chocolate and sugar in heavy medium saucepan over low heat until smooth. Cool slightly. Pour over center of cheesecake, spreading to within ½ inch of edge and filling any cracks. Chill until topping is set, about 1 hour.
4. Release pan sides. Transfer cheesecake to platter. Top with chocolate curls. Let stand 2 hours at room temperature before serving. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Blackout Cake (from *Family Circle* Feb 2010, p. 196)
Makes 16 servings - Prep 30 minutes - Bake at 350 for 35 minutes - Chill 4 hours

Frosting
1 ¼ c sugar
3 T cornstarch
3 c whole milk
6 oz unsweetened chocolate, chopped
1 t vanilla extract

Cake
4 oz bittersweet chocolate, chopped
1 t vegetable oil
2 c flour
½ c cocoa powder
2 t baking powder
½ t baking soda
½ t salt
½ c unsalted butter, softened
1 c sugar
¾ c light-brown sugar
2 eggs
1 t vanilla extract
1 c buttermilk

1. **Frosting**: In a medium-size heavy-bottomed saucepan, whisk sugar and cornstarch. Gradually add milk, whisking constantly to keep mixture from getting lumpy.
2. Transfer saucepan to stove, and heat over medium heat, stirring constantly with wooden spoon. Bring to a simmer, then add chocolate. Cook 3 minutes or until chocolate is melted. Stir in vanilla. Pour into a bowl; cover surface with

plastic wrap. Refrigerate until cold, about 4 hours or overnight.

3. **Cake**: Heat oven to 350. Coat two 8x2 inch round baking pans with cooking spray. Line bottoms with wax paper; spray paper.
4. Microwave chocolate and oil for 1 minute; stir until smooth. If needed, heat an additional 15 seconds. Cool slightly.
5. In medium-size bowl, mix flour, cocoa powder, baking powder, baking soda and salt. In large bowl, beat with mixer on medium speed the butter and sugars until well combined. Add eggs, one at a time, beating well after each. Beat in melted chocolate and vanilla.
6. On low speed, beat flour mixture into butter mixture, alternating with buttermilk, beginning and ending with flour. Spread into pans.
7. Bake at 350 for 30-35 minutes or until toothpick inserted in centers tests clean. Cool cakes in pans on wire racks 15 minutes. Turn cakes out onto racks; cool layers completely.
8. Cut each cake layer in half horizontally for a total of 4 layers; crumble 1 cake layer into crumbs and set aside. Place 1 cake layer cut-side down on a serving platter. Spread with 1 heaping cup frosting and top with another cake layer. Repeat with 1 heaping cup frosting and last cake layer. Spread remaining frosting over top and sides of cake. Sprinkle cake crumbs over top and side of cake, pressing gently to adhere.

Per Serving: 370 calories; 17 g fat (10 g sat); 7 g protein; 54 g carbohydrate; 3 g fiber; 210 mg sodium; 45 mg cholesterol

Old-Fashioned Chocolate Layer Cake (from *Cooks' Illustrated*, March & April 2006, p. 23)
Serves 10-12

<u>Cake</u>

12 T (1 ½ sticks) unsalted butter, very soft, plus extra for greasing pans
1 ¾ c (8 ¾ oz) unbleached all-purpose flour, plus extra for dusting pans
4 oz unsweetened chocolate, coarsely chopped
¼ c (¾ oz) Dutch-processed cocoa powder
½ c hot water
1 ¾ c (12 ¼ oz) sugar
1 ½ t baking soda
1 t table salt
1 c buttermilk
2 t vanilla extract
4 large eggs, plus 2 large egg yolks

<u>Frosting</u>

16 oz semisweet chocolate, finely chopped
8 T (1 stick) unsalted butter
⅓ c sugar
2 T corn syrup
2 t vanilla extract
¼ t table salt
1 ¼ c cold heavy cream

1. FOR THE CAKE: Adjust oven rack to middle position; heat oven to 350 degrees. Grease two 9-in round by 2-in high cake pans with softened butter; dust pans with flour and knock out excess. Combine chocolate, cocoa powder, and hot water in medium heatproof bowl; set bowl over saucepan containing 1 inch of simmering water and stir with rubber spatula until chocolate is melted, about 2 minutes. Add ½ c sugar to chocolate mixture and stir until thick and glossy, 1-2 minutes. Remove bowl from heat and set aside to cool.
2. Whisk flour, baking soda, and salt in medium bowl. Combine buttermilk and vanilla in small bowl. In bowl of standing mixer fitted with whisk attachment, whisk eggs and yolks on medium-low speed until combined, about 10 seconds. Add remaining 1 ¼ c sugar, increase speed to high, and whisk until fluffy and lightened in color, 2-3 minutes. Replace whisk with paddle attachment. Add cooled chocolate mixture to egg/sugar mixture and mix on medium speed until thoroughly incorporated, 30-45 seconds, pausing to scrape down sides of bowl with rubber spatula as needed. Add softened butter one T at a time, mixing about 10 sec after each addition. Add about ⅓ of flour mixture followed by half of buttermilk mixture (batter may appear separated). Scrape down sides of bowl and add remaining flour mixture; mix at medium-low speed until batter is thoroughly combined, about 15 seconds. Remove bowl from mixer and fold batter once or twice with rubber spatula to incorporate any remaining flour. Divide batter evenly between prepared cake pans; smooth batter to edges of pan with spatula.
3. Bake cakes until toothpick inserted into center comes out with a few crumble attached, 25-30 minutes. Cool cakes in pans 15 minutes, then invert onto wire rack. Cool cakes to room temperature before frosting, 45-60 minutes.
4. TO MAKE FROSTING: Melt chocolate in heatproof bowl set over saucepan containing 1 inch of barely simmering water, stirring occasionally until smooth. Remove from heat and set aside. Meanwhile, heat butter in small saucepan over med-low heat until melted. Increase heat to medium; add sugar, corn syrup, vanilla, and salt and stir with heatproof

rubber spatula until sugar is dissolved, 4-5 minutes. Add melted chocolate, butter mixture, and cream to a clean bowl of standing mixer and stir to thoroughly combine.

5. Place mixer bowl over ice bath and stir mixture constantly with rubber spatula until frosting is thick and just beginning to harden against sides of bowl, 1-2 minutes (frosting should be 70 degrees). Place bowl on standing mixer fitted with paddle attachment and beat on med-high speed until frosting is light and fluffy, 1-2 minutes. Stir with rubber spatula until completely smooth.
6. TO FROST CAKE: Place one cake layer on serving platter or cardboard round. Spread 1 ½ c frosting evenly across top of cake with spatula. Place second cake layer on top, then spread remaining frosting evenly over top and sides of cake. Cut into slices and serve.

***Chocolate Bundt Cake** (Renae Boyer's recipe)

1 pkg Devils Food cake mix
1 small pkg instant chocolate pudding
1 c sour cream
4 eggs
½ c oil
½ c water
1 c chocolate chips

Mix all (except chocolate chips) for 4 minutes. Then, add chips. Pour into well-greased and floured bundt pan. Bake 350 degrees for 50 minutes. Cool. Sprinkle with powdered sugar. **Also yummy served with Mint Chocolate syrup (below)

<u>Mint Chocolate Syrup</u> (Renae Boyer's recipe)

1 c heavy cream (I've used evaporated milk)
1/3 c light corn syrup (+more to adjust consistency)
1 12 oz bag semisweet chocolate chips
1 t peppermint extract

In small saucepan, combine heavy cream and corn syrup. Stir to combine, and bring just to a boil over medium-high heat. Remove from heat, and add chocolate and peppermint extract. Whisk until chocolate is melted. If necessary, adjust consistency with additional corn syrup.

**This recipe works to make any sort of thick, smooth chocolate "ganache" frosting. Use any kind of chocolate chips with milk or cream and a little bit of corn syrup. Extracts or flavoring are optional.

Chocolate-Mayonnaise Cake (from *Southern Living*, February 2015, p.133)

2 c flour
2/3 c unsweetened cocoa
1 t baking soda
1 t ground cinnamon
¼ t salt
¼ t baking powder
Shortening
3 large eggs
1 2/3 c firmly packed light brown sugar
2 t vanilla extract
1 c mayonnaise *(I used reduced fat)*
1 1/3 c hot water

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Whisk together flour and next 5 ingredients in a medium bowl. Grease (with shortening) and flour a 13x9 inch pan.
2. Beat eggs, sugar, and vanilla at medium-high speed about 3 minutes or until mixture is very light brown and ribbons form when beater is lifted. Add mayonnaise, and beat at low speed just until blended. Add flour mixture and 1 ⅓ c hot water alternately, mixing after each addition. Pour batter into prepared pan.
3. Bake at 350 degrees for 30-35 minutes or until a wooden pick inserted in center comes out clean. Cool completely on a wire rack (about 1 hour). Spread with chocolate-cream cheese frosting.

Chocolate Cream Cheese Frosting (from *Southern Living*, February 2015, p.133)
This actually makes more than is needed to frost this cake…maybe make only half?

1 (8 oz) pkg cream cheese, softened
½ c butter, softened
2 t vanilla extract
1 (32 oz) package powdered sugar
½ c unsweetened cocoa
5-6 T heavy cream *(I used milk)*

Beat first 3 ingredients at medium speed until creamy. Whisk together powdered sugar and cocoa in a medium bowl; gradually add to butter mixture alternately with 5 T cream. Beat at low speed until blended after each addition. (If needed, add up to 1 T cream, 1 t at a time, to reach desired consistency.) Increase speed to medium, and beat 1-2 minutes or until light and fluffy.

Triple Chocolate Buttermilk Pound Cake (from *Southern Living*, February 2015, p.106)

Cake:
2 c flour
¾ c unsweetened cocoa
½ t baking powder
1 t salt
1 ½ c butter, softened at room temperature
3 c sugar
5 large eggs, at room temperature
1 ¼ c buttermilk
2 t vanilla extract
1 c 60% cacao bittersweet chocolate morsels
Shortening

Chocolate Glaze:
¾ c semisweet chocolate morsels
3 T butter
1 T light corn syrup
½ t vanilla extract

Buttermilk Glaze:
1 c powdered sugar
1-2 T buttermilk
¼ t vanilla extract

1. Prepare cake: Preheat oven to 325. Whisk together flour and next 3 ingredients. Beat 1 ½ c butter in a medium bowl at medium-high speed until smooth. Gradually add sugar, beating until light and fluffy. Add eggs, 1 at a time, beating just until yolk disappears. Combine 1 ¼ c buttermilk and next 2 ingredients. Add flour mixture to egg mixture alternately with buttermilk mixture, beginning and ending with flour mixture. Beat at low speed after each addition. Fold in bittersweet chocolate morsels. Pour batter into a well-greased (with shortening) and floured 12-cup Bundt pan. Sharply tap pan on counter to remove air bubbles.
2. Bake at 325 for 1 hour and 15 minutes to 1 hour and 25 minutes or until a wooden pick inserted in center comes out clean. Cool in pan on a wire rack 20 minutes. Remove from pan; cool completely on rack.

***My pampered chef bundt pan was too small so I put the extra batter in a bread pan and baked it for 60-65 minutes and the bundt for 70-75.* If using 24 mini bundt pans, cook for 26-30 minutes.

3. Prepare Chocolate glaze: Combine semisweet chocolate morsels, 3 T butter, and 1 T corn syrup in a microwave-safe glass bowl. Microwave at Medium power 1-1 ½ minutes or until morsels begin to melt, stirring after 1 minute. Stir until smooth. Stir in ½ t vanilla.
4. Prepare Buttermilk Glaze: Whisk together powdered sugar, 1 T buttermilk, and ¼ t vanilla in a small bowl until smooth. Add up to 1 T buttermilk, if desired. Drizzle warm glazes over cooled cake.

Red Velvet Trifle (from *Family Circle,* Feb 2014)
makes 16 servings

Cake
2 ½ c all-purpose flour
¼ c unsweetened cocoa powder
1 t baking soda
½ t salt
2 sticks (1 c) unsalted butter, softened
1 ½ c packed light brown sugar
3 large eggs
1 c sour cream blended with ¼ c milk and 1 bottle (1 oz) red food coloring
2 t vanilla extract

Filling and Topping
1 pkg (8 oz) Neufchatel cheese, softened
1 ½ c heavy cream
2 c plus 2 T confectioners' sugar
½ c sour cream
½ c milk
¾ t vanilla extract

1. Heat oven to 350. Coat a 13x9 pan with nonstick baking spray with flour.
2. CAKE: In a medium bowl, whisk together flour, cocoa, baking soda and salt. In a large bowl, beat butter until smooth. Beat in brown sugar until light colored and fluffy, 2 minutes. Beat in eggs, one at a time. On low, beat in half the flour mixture. Scrape down side of bowl and beat in sour cream mixture, followed by remaining half of the flour mixture. Stir in vanilla.
3. Spread batter into prepared pan and bake at 350 for 35-40 minutes, until a toothpick inserted in center of cake comes out clean. Cool in pan on a wire rack for 10 minutes, then turn out onto rack and cool completely.
4. FILLING AND TOPPING: In a bowl, beat together Neufchatel, butter and ¾ c of the heavy cream until smooth. On low, beat in 2 cups of the confectioners' sugar, the sour cream, milk and ½ t of the vanilla extract.
5. Trim edges from cake and cut cake into 1 ½-in cubes (set aside 1 cube for topping). Place ⅓ of the cake cubes in a trifle dish or large bowl. Top with half the filling. Repeat layering with cake cubes and remaining filling, then top with remaining ⅓ of the cake. Beat remaining ¾ c heavy cream with remaining 2 T confectioners' sugar and ¼ t vanilla. Spread over top of trifle. Crumble reserved cake cube over trifle. Cover with plastic and refrigerate overnight.

Ice Cream Cake Roll
makes 10 servings

¾ c all-purpose flour
⅓ c cocoa powder
1 t baking powder
pinch salt
4 eggs
¾ c granulated sugar
2 t vanilla
2 T powdered sugar
3 c mint chip ice cream, softened
chocolate syrup, for serving

1. Heat oven to 350 degrees. Coat a 15x10x1 inch jelly roll pan with nonstick cooking spray. Line bottom of pan with waxed paper. Spray paper.
2. Stir together flour, cocoa powder, baking powder and salt. In a large bowl, beat eggs with an electric mixer on medium speed for 5 minutes, until very light yellow. Gradually add granulated sugar, beating until smooth. Beat in vanilla.
3. Fold four mixture into egg mixture until no lumps remain. Pour into prepared pan, spreading level. Bake at 350 for 12 minutes or until cake springs back when lightly touched.
4. Dust a clean kitchen towel with powdered sugar. Turn cake out onto towel. Roll up towel and cake from short end; cool completely.
5. Unroll; spread with softened ice cream to within 1 inch of edges. Reroll cake without towel; wrap in plastic wrap. Freeze at least 4 hours or overnight. If frozen overnight, let stand at room temperature 20 minutes before serving. To serve, carefully remove plastic wrap and drizzle cake with chocolate syrup.

Lava Cakes
Makes 6 servings (though, I've made more by adjusting serving sizes)
Prep: 15 minutes - Chill: 45 minutes - Bake: 13 minutes

¾ c (4 ½ oz) semisweet chocolate pieces
2 T whipping cream
1 c (6 oz) semisweet chocolate pieces
¾ c butter
3 eggs
3 egg yolks
1/3 c granulated sugar
1 ½ t vanilla
1/3 c flour
3 T unsweetened cocoa powder
Powdered sugar (optional)
Raspberries (optional)

Directions:
1. For filling, in a small heavy saucepan combine the ¾ c chocolate pieces and whipping cream. Cook and stir over low heat until chocolate melts. Remove pan from heat. Cool, stirring occasionally. Cover and chill about 45 minutes or until firm.

2. Meanwhile, in a medium heavy saucepan, cook and stir the 1 c chocolate pieces and the butter over low heat until melted. Remove from heat; cool.
3. Form chilled filling into 6 equal-sized balls; set aside. Lightly grease and flour six ¾ c soufflé dishes or six 6-oz custard cups. Place dishes or cups in a 15x10x1 inch baking pan; set aside.
4. In a mixing bowl, beat eggs, egg yolks, granulated sugar, and vanilla with an electric mixer on high speed 5 minutes or until lemon-colored. Beat in cooled chocolate-butter mixture on medium speed. Sift flour and cocoa powder over mixture; beat on low speed just until combined. Spoon 1/3 c batter into dishes. Place 1 ball of filling into each dish. Spoon remaining batter into dishes.
5. Bake in a 400 degree oven about 13 minutes or until cakes feel firm at edges. Cool in dishes 2-3 minutes. Using a knife, loosen cakes from sides of dishes. Invert onto dessert plates. If desired, dust with powdered sugar and garnish with raspberries. Serve immediately.

**Make-ahead directions: Prepare as above through step 4. Cover and chill until ready to bake or up to 4 hours. Let stand at room temperature for 30 minutes before baking as directed.

Chocolate Mud Cake (cooked in crockpot) —From *Family Fun* magazine
6-8 servings

1 c flour
2 t baking powder
6 T butter
1/3 c semi-sweet chocolate chips
2/3 c sugar
3 T cocoa
1 T vanilla
¼ t salt
1/3 c milk
1 egg yolk
1/3 c sugar
1/3 c brown sugar
1/3 c cocoa
1 ½ c hot water

1. Spray crockpot with cooking spray.
2. Whisk together flour and baking powder in medium bowl.
3. In large bowl, melt butter and chocolate chips. Mix well.
4. Whisk (into chocolate): 2/3 c sugar, 3 T cocoa, vanilla, salt, milk, and egg yolk.
5. Add the flour mixture and stir till thoroughly mixed.
6. Pour the batter into the crockpot and spread evenly.
7. In medium bowl, whisk together 1/3 c sugar, brown sugar, 1/3 c cocoa, and hot water. Stir till dissolved. Pour over batter in crock pot.
8. Cover and cook on high 1 ¼-2 ¼ hours, depending on size of pot. Will appear to be floating on molten chocolate when done and nearly all edges will pull away from sides of pot. Turn off power and remove lid when done. Cool 25 minutes, then serve with whip cream or ice cream.

Better Than Anything Cake

1 box German chocolate cake mix
1 can sweetened condensed milk
1 bottle Mrs. Richardson's butterscotch/caramel topping
1 (8 oz) container Cool Whip
3 Skor/toffee candy bars, or pkg Skor bits

Bake cake according to directions in 9x13 pan. When you take it out of the oven, poke holes all over it. (The end of a wooden spoon works well.) Pour condensed milk over the cake. Then pour ¾ jar of butterscotch/caramel topping. Let the cake sit in the fridge (overnight is good). When ready to serve, spread Cool Whip on top and sprinkle with broken Skor bits.

Chocolate-Peppermint Poke Cake (from bettycrocker.com)



Cake
1 box Betty Crocker® SuperMoist® chocolate fudge cake mix + ingredients called for on mix box

Filling
1 box (4-serving size) white chocolate instant pudding and pie filling mix
2 cups milk
½ teaspoon peppermint extract

Frosting
¼ teaspoon peppermint extract
1 container Betty Crocker® Whipped milk chocolate frosting
¾ cup coarsely chopped chocolate-covered peppermint patties (8 candies)

1. Heat oven to 350°F (325°F for dark or nonstick pan). Spray bottom only of 13x9-inch pan with baking spray with flour. Make and bake cake mix as directed on box for 13x9-inch pan. Cool 15 minutes. With handle of wooden spoon, poke top of warm cake every 1/2 inch.
2. In medium bowl, beat filling ingredients with whisk about 2 minutes. Immediately pour over cake. Cover loosely; refrigerate about 2 hours or until chilled.
3. Stir 1/4 teaspoon peppermint extract into frosting. Spread frosting over top of cake. Sprinkle with peppermint patties. Store covered in refrigerator.

Chocolate Cupcakes with Penuche Filling (from bettycrocker.com)



Cupcakes
1 box Betty Crocker® SuperMoist® chocolate fudge cake mix
Water, vegetable oil and eggs called for on cake mix box
1 teaspoon vanilla

Filling and Garnish
1 cup butter or margarine
2 cups packed brown sugar
½ cup milk
4 cups powdered sugar
1 oz grated semisweet baking chocolate, if desired

1. Heat oven to 350°F (325°F for dark or nonstick pans). Place paper baking cups in each of 24 regular-size muffin cups. Make and cool cupcakes as directed on box for 24 cupcakes--except add vanilla to batter.
2. Meanwhile, in 2-quart saucepan, melt butter over medium heat. Stir in brown sugar. Heat to boiling, stirring constantly; reduce heat to low. Boil and stir 2 minutes. Stir in milk. Heat to boiling; remove from heat. Pour mixture into medium bowl; refrigerate 1 hour or until lukewarm, about 90°F.
3. Beat powdered sugar into cooled brown sugar mixture with electric mixer on low speed until smooth. If filling becomes too stiff, stir in additional milk, 1 teaspoon at a time. If filling is too soft, cover; return to refrigerator 15 minutes to firm up.
4. Remove paper baking cups from cupcakes. Using serrated knife, cut each cupcake in half horizontally, being careful not to break either half. Place heaping 1 tablespoon filling on each cupcake base. Replace rounded cupcake tops. Pipe or spoon rounded 1 tablespoon frosting onto cupcake tops. Garnish with grated chocolate. Store in airtight container at room temperature.

Devil's Food Cake (from Josi Kilpack's *Devil's Food*)
serves 12

1 c sour milk (1 c milk + 2 t vinegar or lemon juice OR 1 c buttermilk)
2 c flour
2 c sugar
⅔ c unsweetened cocoa
½ t salt
2 eggs
1 c vegetable oil
1 t vanilla
1 c boiling water
1 t baking soda

1. If making your own sour milk, mix milk & acid in small bowl. Set aside for 5 minutes.
2. In large bowl, mix all ingredients except water and soda. Mix til smooth. Add soda to boiling water. Add soda/water mixture to batter. Mix well. Batter will be thin.
3. Pour into a greased and floured 9x13 pan (or 2 rounds with wax paper cut to fit bottom to prevent sticking). Bake at 350 for 35-45 minutes until middle is set. (With round pans, let cool 5 minutes before removing.)

Sandra's Chocolicious Frosting (from Josi Kilpack's *Devil's Food*)
enough to cover 2 9" rounds or a 9x13 cake

½ c butter
2 T shortening
1 c baking cocoa
8 oz cream cheese
3 c powdered sugar
1 t vanilla

Melt butter and shortening. Whisk in cocoa and stir until smooth. Let cool til cool enough to touch. Add cream cheese and mix thoroughly. Add powdered sugar and vanilla. Mix well.

Foolproof Chocolate Frosting (from *Cook's Illustrated*, March & April 2008)
makes about 3 cups

20 T (2 ½ sticks) unsalted butter, softened (60-65 degrees)
1 c (4 oz) powdered sugar
¾ c Dutch-processed cocoa
pinch table salt
¾ c light corn syrup
1 t vanilla extract
8 oz chocolate, melted and cooled slightly (*can use milk, semisweet, or bittersweet chocolate - cool to 85-100 degrees before adding*)

In food processor, process butter, sugar, cocoa, and salt until smooth, about 30 seconds, scraping sides of bowl as needed. Add corn syrup an vanilla and process until just combined, 5-10 seconds. Scrape sides of bowl, then add chocolate and pulse until smooth and creamy, 10-15 seconds. Frosting can be used immediately or held up to 3 hours. (For longer storage, refrigerate the frosting, covered, and let stand at room temperature for 1 hour before using.)

Chocolate Cupcakes (From *Savoring the Seasons with Our Best Bites*, p. 53)
Makes 14-16 cupcakes

½ c sugar
½ c packed brown sugar
¼ c plus 2 T cocoa powder
¾ c flour, lightly spooned into measuring cups and leveled
1 t baking soda
½ t baking powder
½ t salt
1 egg
½ c buttermilk
½ c canola oil
½ t vanilla
½ c boiling water

1. Heat oven to 350 degrees. Line muffin tin with baking cups.
2. Combine sugars, cocoa, flour, baking soda, baking powder, and salt in a large bowl. Add egg, buttermilk, oil, and vanilla and combine. Add water and beat on medium speed for 2 minutes. The batter will be thin. Fill cups ¾ full with batter.
3. Bake 15-20 minutes or until a toothpick comes out clean. Cool completely and decorate as desired.

(To make these into mint or cherry, make as directed, but dip cooled cupcakes in ganache, then frost with buttercream frosting with flavor or candies or 1 c pitted diced cherries and 1 t almond extract.)

Peanut Butter Cup Cupcakes (From *Savoring the Seasons with Our Best Bites*, p. 57)
Makes 24 cupcakes

1 yellow or white cake mix
1 c sour cream (NOT fat free)
3 eggs
¼ c canola oil
¾ c creamy peanut butter
1 t vanilla
24 unwrapped mini Reese's
½ recipe chocolate frosting
½ recipe peanut butter frosting

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Line muffin tins.
2. Combine all cupcake ingredients, except the peanut butter cups, in a large bowl. Mix on medium-low for 30 seconds. Turn to high speed and beat another 3 minutes.
3. Fill each cup halfway with batter. Top with an unwrapped Reese's and then add remaining batter. Make sure the peanut butter cups are covered and the muffin cups are about ¾ full. Bake 18-22 minutes or until tops are golden. Remove from oven and cool completely.
4. While the cupcakes are cooling, prepare frostings. For both frostings, combine and whip until light and fluffy, adding additional milk as needed. (Evaporated milk is a good way to add richness to frostings. Regular milk substitutes just fine.)
5. To frost with two flavors, fill two separate bags with each frosting and then set them both inside of another bag fitted with a large tip.

<u>Chocolate Frosting</u>
½ c melted butter
¼ c plus 2 T cocoa powder
1 lb powdered sugar
¼ c plus 2 T evaporated milk
1 t vanilla extract

<u>Peanut Butter Frosting</u>
1 c creamy peanut butter
½ c butter, softened
4 c powdered sugar
2 t vanilla extract
4-6 T (or more) of milk

***Chocolate Zucchini Cake** (from blendtec.com) - DIVINE

1⁄2 c butter, softened
1⁄2 c plain/vanilla no-fat Greek yogurt
1 cup granulated sugar
2 large eggs
1 tsp vanilla extract
1⁄2 cup low-fat buttermilk
2 small zucchini, trimmed and quartered (about 3-4 cups)
2 ½ cups all-purpose flour
1⁄2 tsp ground cinnamon
1 tsp kosher or sea salt
1⁄4 cup unsweetened cocoa powder
1 tsp baking soda
1 tsp baking powder
1⁄4 cup brown sugar
3⁄4 cup walnuts *(I use pecans)*
1⁄2 cup semi-sweet chocolate chips

1. Pre-heat oven to 350° F.
2. Add butter, yogurt, sugar, eggs, vanilla, buttermilk and zucchini to WildSide+ jar and secure lid. Select "Batters" cycle (if you don't have a "Batters" cycle, blend on a Medium to Medium-Low speed (speed 4) for 30 seconds).
3. Add flour, cocoa powder, cinnamon, salt, baking soda and baking powder to jar and secure lid. Press "Pulse" 8-10 times until ingredients are incorporated.
4. Pour batter into greased 9x13 non-stick pan.
5. For crumb topping, add brown sugar and walnuts to clean WildSide+ jar and secure lid. Press "Pulse" 3-5 times until nuts are chopped to desired texture.
6. Add brown sugar nut mix to chocolate chips and sprinkle evenly on top of cake.
7. Bake for 40-45 minutes until done. Allow to cool for at least one hour before cutting.

***Oatmeal Cake** (Angie Smith's recipe)

1 ¼ c. boiling water
1 c quick oats
½ c butter
1 c brown sugar
1 c white sugar
2 eggs
1 t vanilla
1 ¾ c. sifted flour
1 t cinnamon
1 t soda

1. Mix boiling water with oats. Set aside to cool slightly.
2. Cream butter, sugars, eggs, and vanilla. Then add flour, cinnamon, & soda.
3. Add cooled oat mixture.
4. Spread in greased & floured 9x13 pan.
5. Bake at 350 degrees for 30 minutes or until set. Prepare coconut frosting (below) while cake is baking.
6. Frost as soon as cake is finished baking. Put back in the oven close to the broiler for 45 seconds to 1 minute til lightly browned (watch closely!). Serve warm or cold.

Coconut Frosting:
½ c butter
1 c brown sugar
½ c nuts (chopped) – *I actually don't use these when I make it*
1 c coconut
2 egg yolks *(I use 1 whole egg)*

Dutch Oven Cobbler

2-3 cans pie filling
1 box cake mix
½ to 1 cube margarine

1. Season Dutch oven with margarine (only use as much as you need). Add pie filling and bring to boil. Prepare cake mix according to package directions. Pour evenly over pie filling. Bake until done.
2. Use 6-8 coals on bottom; 15-22 coals on top.

[Dutch Oven] Jordan River Mud (recipe from Steve and Nancy McLain)
cooking time 40 minutes - dutch oven size 12 inch

1 chocolate cake mix
1 ⅓ c water
⅓ c vegetable oil
3 eggs
10 oz bag miniature marshmallows
½ c dry baking cocoa
2 c brown sugar
4 c hot water
2 t vanilla
1 pkg chocolate chips
1 pkg cool whip

1. Line dutch oven with foil and preheat. Blend cake mix, water, vegetable oil, and eggs. Pour the prepared batter into the preheated oven. Sprinkle the marshmallows over top.
2. Mix the cocoa, brown sugar, hot water, and vanilla to make the "mud." Pour over the marshmallows.
3. Cover the oven with 8-10 coals on the lid and 8 coals on the bottom and bake about 40 minutes.
4. Remove the lid about 5 minutes before baking time is up and sprinkle on the chocolate chips. Allow the chocolate chips to melt for a few minutes. Serve with cool whip.

Sour Cream Cake – yummy
Serves 12

3 c flour
¼ t baking soda
1 c butter, softened
3 c sugar
6 eggs
1 c sour cream
1 t almond extract

Preheat oven to 325 degrees. Mix the flour and baking soda together and set aside. Cream the butter and sugar in a mixing bowl until light and fluffy. Add the eggs one at a time, beating well after each addition. Add the flour mixture and sour cream alternately one third at a time, beating well after each addition. Stir in the almond extract. The batter will be very thick. Spoon into a greased and floured Bundt pan. Bake for 1 ¼ hours. Cool in the pan for 10 minutes. Invert onto a wire rack to cool completely.

Serving suggestion: top with fresh fruit and powdered sugar.

Lemon Cupcakes with Strawberry Frosting
1 hour + cooling / makes 12 cupcakes

<u>cupcakes</u>
1 ¼ c flour
1 ½ t baking power
½ t salt
¾ c sugar
6 T unsalted butter, at room temp
1 T finely grated lemon zest PLUS 2 T lemon juice
1 t vanilla
2 large eggs
½ c whole milk

<u>strawberry buttercream</u>
½ c unsalted butter, at room temp
6 oz confectioners' sugar
2 T heavy cream, room temp
1 t vanilla
⅛ t salt
¾ c freeze-dried strawberries, finely crushed, plus more for sprinkling

1. Make cupcakes: Heat oven to 350 F. Line 12-cup muffin pan with paper liners
2. In medium bowl, whisk together flour, baking powder and salt. In large bowl, using electric mixer, beat sugar, butter, lemon zest and juice and vanilla until light and fluffy, about 3 minutes. Beat in eggs 1 at a time.
3. Reduce mixer speed to low and alternately add flour mixture and milk, mixing just until incorporated. Divide batter among muffin-pan cups (filling about ⅔ full). Bake until wooden pick inserted into center comes out clean, 18-22 minutes. Transfer to wire rack to cool completely.
4. Make buttercream: Using electric mixer, beat butter and sugar in large bowl 2 minutes. Add cream, vanilla and salt and continue beating 1 min. Fold in crushed strawberries.

***Glazed Lemon Cake** (From *Savoring the Seasons with Our Best Bites*, p. 50) - YUM
Serves 10-12

1 box yellow cake mix
1 (3.4 oz box) lemon instant pudding
¾ c milk
¾ c vegetable oil
4 eggs
6 T butter, melted
6 T fresh lemon juice
3 c powdered sugar
Whipped topping or whipped cream for serving

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Spray 9x13 pan with nonstick cooking spray and set aside.
2. Ignore ingredients on cake mix and pudding boxes. Combine dry cake mix, dry pudding mix, milk, oil, and eggs. Beat 30 seconds on low and 2 minutes on medium-high. Pour into pan and bake according to cake mix box instructions, until a skewer comes out clean.
3. When cake is almost finished, combine melted butter, lemon juice, and powdered sugar and whisk until smooth. When cake is baked, use a skewer or large fork to poke holes all over the hot cake. Pour glaze over cake and let soak into holes. If desired, reserve a small amount of glaze to drizzle over finished pieces of cake. Let cool to room temperature, or chill, if desired. Cut into squares and serve with whipped cream.

(You can also replace the pudding and milk with a 3 oz box of lemon jello and water.)

Neapolitan Cupcakes (From MarthaStewart.com)
Makes 12 - takes 1 hr 25 min

1 ¾ c all-purpose flour
2 t baking powder
1 t coarse salt
1 stick unsalted butter, room temperature
1 c sugar
3 large eggs, room temperature
1 t pure vanilla extract
⅔ c buttermilk, room temperature
¼ c Dutch-process cocoa powder
2 oz semisweet chocolate (61% cacao), chopped
Fresh-Strawberry Buttercream (recipe below)

1. Preheat oven to 350. Line 12 muffin cups with paper liners. Whisk together flour, baking powder, and salt.
2. Beat butter with sugar on medium speed in a mixer fitted with the paddle attachment until light and fluffy, about 5 minutes. Add eggs, one at a time, beating until combined after each addition and scraping down sides of bowl as needed. Beat in vanilla. Reduce speed to low and add flour mixture in two batches., alternating with buttermilk and beginning and ending with flour.
3. Whisk together cocoa powder and ¼ c hot water in a small bowl until smooth. Transfer 1 heaping cup (10 oz) batter to a medium bowl. Add cocoa mixture and stir until just combined; fold in chopped chocolate.
4. Divide chocolate batter evenly among muffin cups. Top with remaining vanilla batter. Bake rotating pan halfway through, until golden brown and a tester inserted in centers comes out clean, 20-22 minutes. Let cool completely in pan on a wire rack before removing. Spread with frosting just before serving.

Fresh-Strawberry Buttercream (to go with Neapolitan Cupcakes, above)
Makes 4 cups frosting - takes 35 minutes

8 oz strawberries, hulled and coarsely chopped (1 ½ c)
4 large egg whites, room temperature
1 ¼ c sugar
3 sticks unsalted butter, cut into tablespoons, room temperature

1. Puree strawberries in a blender (you should have about ¾ c puree). Combine egg whites and sugar in a mixer bowl set over (not in) a pot of simmering water and whisk constantly until sugar is dissolved and mixture is warm. (It should feel completely smooth when rubbed between your fingertips.)
2. Transfer bowl to mixer fitted with the whisk attachment. Starting on low speed and gradually increasing to medium-high, beat until stiff, glossy peaks form. Continue beating until bottom of bowl is cool to the touch, about 15 minutes.
3. Reduce speed to medium-low and beat in butter, a few tablespoons at a time, until combined. Scrape down sides of bowl. Slowly add strawberry puree, beating until combined. (If buttercream appears curdled, increase speed to medium-high and beat until smooth.) Buttercream can be stored at room temperature if used same day, or refrigerated in an air-tight container up to 3 days, or frozen up to 1 month. Before using, bring to room temperature and beat on low speed in a mixer fitted with the paddle attachment until smooth again, about 5 minutes.

Strawberry Buttercream (from *Raised in the Kitchen,* by Carrian Cheney)
takes 10 minutes; makes 4 to 5 cups

2 cups unsalted butter, at room temperature
2/3 cup seedless strawberry jam
6 cups powdered sugar, sifted
1 teaspoon vanilla extract

In the bowl of stand mixer fitted with the whisk attachment, beat butter on medium-high speed until smooth, about 1 minute. Add vanilla and strawberry jam and beat to combine, about 30 seconds. Add powdered sugar, 1 cup at a time, beating well on medium speed after each addition. Continue beating 4 to 5 minutes, until light and fluffy.

Mug Cakes

Red Velvet Mug Cake

6 T all-purpose flour
2 T granulated sugar
1 t unsweetened cocoa powder
¼ t baking powder
⅛ t salt
⅓ c whole milk
2 T unsalted butter, melted
2 t pure vanilla extract
1 t red food coloring
3 T powdered sugar
1 T cream cheese, at room temperature

In 12-oz mug, whisk together flour, sugar, cocoa powder, baking powder and salt. Stir in milk, butter, vanilla and food coloring. In small bowl, mix together confectioners' sugar and cream cheese until smooth, then drop into mug and push down until covered by batter. Microwave on High until just cooked through, about 1 ½ min.

Blueberry-Lemon Mug Cake

½ c all-purpose flour
2 T granulated sugar
¼ t baking powder
⅛ t salt
⅓ c whole milk
2 T unsalted butter, melted
2 t pure vanilla extract
1 t lemon zest
¼ c fresh or frozen blueberries (frozen blueberries retain their shape better than fresh)

In 12-oz mug, whisk together flour, sugar, baking powder and salt. Stir in milk, butter, vanilla and lemon zest. Fold in blueberries. Microwave on High until just cooked through, 1 ½-2 min.

Chocolate Mug Cake

¼ c all-purpose flour
2 T granulated sugar
2 T cocoa powder
¼ t baking powder
⅛ t salt
⅓ c whole milk
2 T unsalted butter, melted
2 t pure vanilla extract
4 squares caramel, quartered
¼ c toasted pecans, chopped

In 12-oz mug, whisk together flour, sugar, cocoa powder, baking powder and salt. Stir in milk, butter and vanilla. Fold in caramel and pecans. Microwave on High until just cooked through, about 1 ½ min.

Buttercream Frosting

makes enough for 13x9 inch cake, 24 cupcakes, or 2 round 8-inch cakes

1 c unsalted butter, softened
4 t vanilla extract
5 c powdered sugar
3 T milk

In a stand mixer using the paddle attachment (or in a large bowl using a hand mixer), beat the butter and vanilla extract. Add the powdered sugar, about ½ c at a time, and beat until smooth. Gradually pour in the milk and beat to desired consistency. (5 g saturated fat and 25 g sugar per serving)

Chocolate Frosting

makes enough for 13x9 inch cake, 24 cupcakes, or 2 round 8-inch cakes

½ c salted butter, softened
¼ c unsweetened cocoa powder
½ c semi-sweet chocolate chips, melted
1 ½ t vanilla extract
½ t salt (optional
3 c powdered sugar
¼ c milk

In a stand mixer using the paddle attachment (or in a large bowl using a hand mixer), beat the butter, cocoa powder, melted chocolate chips, vanilla extract and salt, if using. Add the powdered sugar ½ c at a time, and beat until smooth. Gradually pour in milk and beat to desired consistency. (3 g saturated fat and 17 g sugar per serving)

Cream Cheese Frosting
makes enough for 13x9 inch cake, 24 cupcakes, or 2 round 8-inch cakes

1 c unsalted butter, softened
1 pkg (8 oz) cream cheese, softened
1 t vanilla extract
2 c powdered sugar

In a stand mixer using the paddle attachment (or in a large bowl w/ an electric mixer), beat the butter, cream cheese and vanilla extract until smooth. Add the powdered sugar, about ½ c at a time, and beat until desired consistency.

Cake decorating ideas:

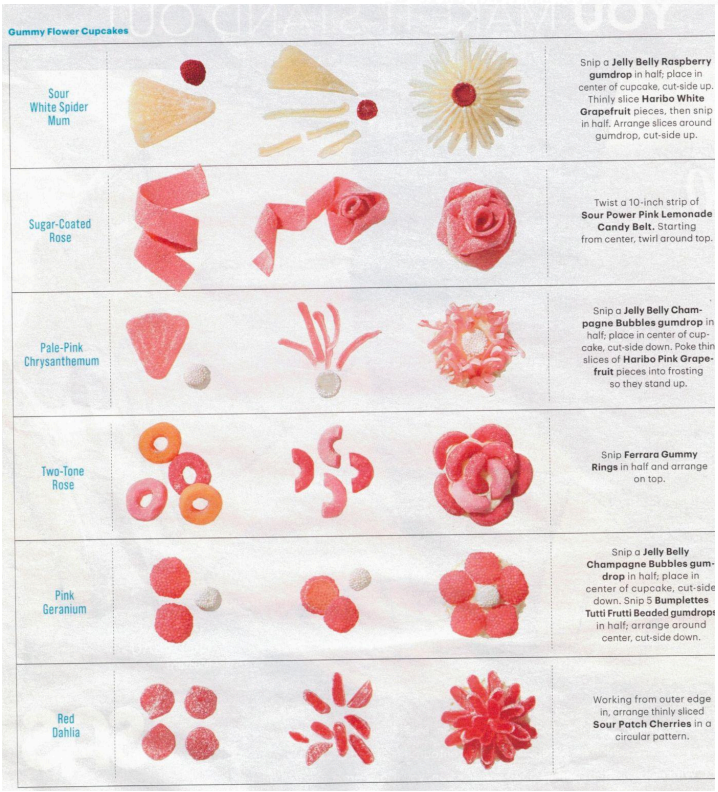


1 SAY IT WITH BUNTING
Not comfortable writing with icing? Not a problem! Spell out "HAPPY BIRTHDAY" on miniature construction paper bunting and suspend between two straws or kebab skewers perched atop the cake.

2 HIGHLIGHT A MILESTONE
Print out a large number and trace the outline on waxed paper. Then cut it out. Speed is key here, so gently place the stencil over a freshly iced cake and work quickly to top with sprinkles or a dusting of powdered sugar before the icing hardens. Then gently remove the stencil.

3 SHOW 'EM YOUR GOOD SIDE
For fun and flavorful décor, the sides have it. Try coating just the sides of a round cake with your favorite cereal. Create a sophisticated look with chocolate puffed cereal or brighten it with colorful rice crisps.

4 AN OMBRE EFFECT
You only need one shade of food coloring to create this stunning cake. Dye white icing in three different shades of one color, making one light, one medium and one dark. Star tip the sides, getting lighter as you work your way to the top.



Gummy Flower Cupcakes

Sour White Spider Mum — Snip a **Jelly Belly Raspberry gumdrop** in half; place in center of cupcake, cut-side up. Thinly slice **Haribo White Grapefruit** pieces, then snip in half. Arrange slices around gumdrop, cut-side up.

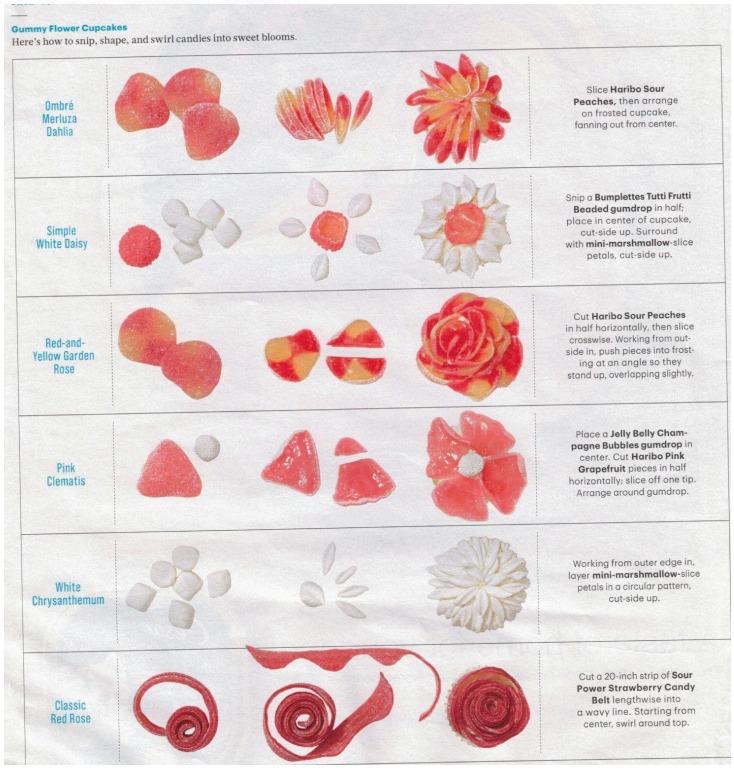
Sugar-Coated Rose — Twist a 10-inch strip of **Sour Power Pink Lemonade Candy Belt.** Starting from center, twirl around top.

Pale-Pink Chrysanthemum — Snip a **Jelly Belly Champagne Bubbles gumdrop** in half; place in center of cupcake, cut-side down. Poke thin slices of **Haribo Pink Grapefruit** pieces into frosting so they stand up.

Two-Tone Rose — Snip **Ferrara Gummy Rings** in half and arrange on top.

Pink Geranium — Snip a **Jelly Belly Champagne Bubbles gumdrop** in half; place in center of cupcake, cut-side down. Snip 5 **Bumplettes Tutti Frutti Beaded gumdrops** in half; arrange around center, cut-side down.

Red Dahlia — Working from outer edge in, arrange thinly sliced **Sour Patch Cherries** in a circular pattern.



Gummy Flower Cupcakes
Here's how to snip, shape, and swirl candies into sweet blooms.

Ombré Merluza Dahlia — Slice **Haribo Sour Peaches**, then arrange on frosted cupcake, fanning out from center.

Simple White Daisy — Snip a **Bumplettes Tutti Frutti Beaded gumdrop** in half; place in center of cupcake, cut-side up. Surround with **mini-marshmallow**-slice petals, cut-side up.

Red-and-Yellow Garden Rose — Cut **Haribo Sour Peaches** in half horizontally, then slice crosswise. Working from outside in, push pieces into frosting at an angle so they stand up, overlapping slightly.

Pink Clematis — Place a **Jelly Belly Champagne Bubbles gumdrop** in center. Cut **Haribo Pink Grapefruit** pieces in half horizontally; slice off one tip. Arrange around gumdrop.

White Chrysanthemum — Working from outer edge in, layer **mini-marshmallow**-slice petals in a circular pattern, cut-side up.

Classic Red Rose — Cut a 20-inch strip of **Sour Power Strawberry Candy Belt** lengthwise into a wavy line. Starting from center, swirl around top.

PIES, PASTRIES & SWEETBREADS

***Croissants** (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook*, p.66)
Start to finish: 10-24 hours; Hands-on time: 1 ½ hours)
Makes 20 croissants

1 (2 ¼ t) pkg active dry yeast
2 T sugar
1 ½ c warm milk (110 degrees)
3 ½ c unbleached all-purpose flour, plus more as needed
2 ½ t salt
½ lb plus 4 T (2 ½ sticks) unsalted butter, chilled
1 large egg, beaten with 2 T water

1. In a small bowl, combine, but do not stir, the yeast, sugar, and warm milk. Let it sit undisturbed for 5 minutes, at which time the top of the milk will be foamy and the yeast activated. Stir to dissolve the sugar.
2. In a large mixing bowl or stand mixer, combine the flour and salt. Make a well in the center of the flour and add the yeast mixture. If you are using a stand mixer, attach the paddle and mix on speed 2 until the dough comes together, about 1 or 2 minutes. Change to the dough hook and knead for about 2 minutes. If you are making the dough by hand, mix the dough with a wooden spoon until combined, then turn it out onto a work surface and knead until the dough is smooth and elastic, about 4 minutes.
3. Place the dough in a large (12 c) bowl and cover with plastic wrap. Let rise in a warm place (75 degrees) until it triples in size, about 2 ½ hours.
4. Punch the dough down to deflate it and let it rise again until it doubles in size, about 1 ½ hours.
5. Deflate the dough by loosening up the sides with a rubber scraper. Cover with plastic wrap and refrigerate for 30 minutes.
6. Remove the dough from the refrigerator and turn it out onto a floured surface. Roll the dough out into a rectangle measuring 20x14 inches.
7. Flour a work surface near the dough and lay out the butter, with two sticks side by side and the half stick across the top end to form what looks like a letter T. Flour the butter. (The flour keeps the butter from melting and becoming messy, so use however much sticks on the butter.) Pound it with a rolling pin, trying to keep it together in one piece until it measures roughly 14x12 inches. (It's okay if the butter breaks into pieces--just push it back together.)
8. Lay the butter on the top ⅔ of the dough, leaving a 1-inch border around the edges. The bottom third of the dough won't have any butter on it. Starting at the bottom third that isn't covered with butter, fold the dough into three layers, like a business letter. Fold the dough up and over to cover part of the butter-covered dough. Pat down to secure it and fold the other end of the butter-covered dough up and over the previous fold. You now have three layers of dough covering two layers of butter. This is turn #1.
9. To make the next turn, position the dough so that an open end faces you, then roll out the dough with a rolling pin into a rectangle about 18x10 inches. Brush any flour from the top of the dough with a dry pastry brush. Fold it into thirds as before. Wrap the dough in plastic wrap and place it in a bag. At this point, you can store the dough in the refrigerator overnight to bake the next day or, to continue with the recipe, chill the dough for 1 hour.
10. When you're ready to proceed, remove the dough from the refrigerator, unwrap it, and let it sit for 10 minutes to warm up. Roll out the dough again into an 18x10 inch rectangle. Fold it into thirds, roll it out again, and fold it into thirds one more time, for a total of four turns. Rewrap the dough and chill for 1 hour.
11. About 2 hours before you are ready to bake the croissants, remove the dough from the refrigerator, unwrap it, and let it sit for 10 minutes to warm up.
12. On a lightly floured surface, roll out the dough into a 30x5-inch rectangle. Cut the dough in half crosswise, making two 15x5 inch rectangles, and refrigerate one half while you use the other to shape your first batch.
13. Roll the dough into a 25x5 inch rectangle and cut it into 5 (5-inch) squares. Refrigerate 4 squares while you work with one.
14. Cut the square on the diagonal to make 2 triangles and use your rolling pin to roll out each triangle so that, from the wide end to the tip, it is about 7 inches long. (*Note from Lisa: to make chocolate croissants, but the squares lengthwise instead and roll them up envelope style with dark chocolate inside.)*
15. Using your fingers, roll each dough triangle from the wide end to the tip into a tube, then bend the two ends down to

form a crescent shape. Arrange the croissants on a parchment paper-lined sheet pan about 3 inches apart. Repeat with the remaining squares. *While you work, it is important to keep the dough cold. If it starts to look oily or becomes difficult to work with, return it to the refrigerator to firm things up.*

16. Cover the croissants with a clean kitchen towel and let them rise for 1 hour. Preheat oven to 450 degrees.
17. Brush the risen rolls with the egg wash and bake them for 12-15 minutes. Serve hot or at room temperature.

***MAKE AHEAD: Since they are so full of butterfat, croissants freeze surprisingly well. Freeze BAKED croissants on a baking sheet, then transfer them to a freezer bag and keep frozen for up to 2 weeks. To reheat them, place them, still frozen, on a baking sheet and warm them up in a 400 degree oven for 5 minutes. Croissants can also be frozen UNBAKED. Thaw on a parchment-lined baking sheet in the refrigerator overnight.*

Mini Pain au Chocolat (from *Family Circle*, Feb 2014)
makes 12 servings

1 pkg (17.3 oz) frozen puff pastry, thawed (*don't thaw completely or they will stick when rolled!)*
1 egg, beaten with 1 T water
¾ c (4.5 oz) Ghirardelli bittersweet chocolate morsels
2 T seedless raspberry jam or orange marmalade
1 T sugar

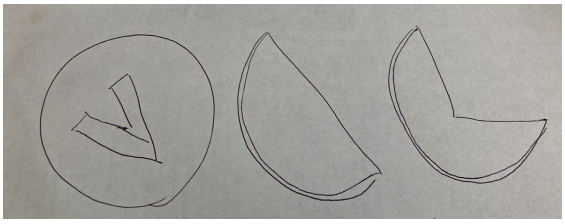
1. Heat oven to 400. Unfold pastry sheets on a cutting board and cut each into 6 equal pieces. Roll one piece out lengthwise to 7 inches.
2. Brush edges with egg wash. Place scant tbsp chocolate in center of pastry. Top with ½ t raspberry jam or orange marmalade. Starting on a short side, fold one end over chocolate, then fold over other end to resemble an envelope.
3. Place on a baking sheet. Repeat with all pastry pieces, chocolate, and jam/marmalade. Brush pastries with egg wash; top with sugar.
4. Bake at 400 degrees for 15 minutes or until puffed and golden brown. Cool slightly before serving.

Berry Croissant Panini (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")
Spread inside of 4 split croissants with marshmallow creme.
Fill with bittersweet chocolate chunks & sliced strawberries
Cook in panini press.

Sweet Fortune Cookies (from *Family Fun*, February 2007)
makes about 16 cookies

chilled 9" pie crust (dough)
cornstarch
pre-written paper fortunes (use non-toxic pen to write on paper slips)
colored decorating sugar

1. Place chilled crust dough on a cornstarch-dusted surface. Cut out 3"wide circles w/ a cookie cutter or drinking glass.
2. Place fortunes in center of each dough circle. Fold the circle in half, then pinch & fold the ends together.



3. Brush the top of each cookie w/ water, then sprinkle colored sugar on top. Place cookies on ungreased cookie sheet about 1" apart, sugar side up.
4. Bake til lightly browned, about 20 minutes, and let them cool before removing them from the pan.

Cinnamon Crisps (from *Family Fun,* February 2007)
makes 6 servings

4 T butter
6 6" flour tortillas
2 T sugar
¼ t cinnamon

1. Heat oven to 450. Melt butter in large baking sheet in oven, about 2 minutes. Place tortillas in baking pan (they may overlap), turning each once to coat sides with butter.
2. Stir together sugar and cinnamon and sprinkle the mixture evenly over the tortillas. Bake til golden & puffed in spots, about 7 minutes. Serve them warm, possibly with ice cream on top.

Saltine Symphonies (from Shannon Nelson)

1 sleeve Saltines (35 small squares)
1 c butter
1 c brown sugar
½ t vanilla
16-20 oz Symphony plain bars (any kind of chocolate will work, but these have the best flavor)

Chop chocolate into small pieces and set aside. Line cookie sheet with foil and spray well with nonstick cooking spray. Place saltines side-by-side so they are touching (makes it easier to spread the toppings), salt side up. In a saucepan, melt butter and brown sugar. Boil 2-3 minutes stirring constantly. Remove from heat and stir in vanilla. Pour over saltines, spread to evenly cover, and bake 4-6 minutes at 400 F. Watch for bubbling. Sprinkle chocolate on top, spread around when melted. Leave on pan 1 minute, then take crackers off and put on wax paper (not touching) to cool. Can cool in the fridge to set faster.

Disneyland Churros *(Posted by Disneyland during 2020 Pandemic closure)*

1 c water
8 T butter
¼ t salt
¾ t cinnamon, divided
1 ¼ c all-purpose flour
3 eggs
1 ½ c vegetable or canola oil
½ c sugar

1. Combine water, butter, salt, & ¼ t cinnamon in 1.5qt saucepan over medium heat. Bring to rolling boil.
2. Reduce heat to low.
3. Add flour & stir vigorously until mix forms a ball. Remove from heat & rest 5-7 minutes.
4. Add eggs, one at a time & stir until combined. Set aside.
5. Heat oil in medium skillet over med-high heat or until 350 degrees.
6. Spoon dough into piping bag w/ star tip. Pipe 1 inch strip of dough over saucepan, cut with knife and drop into hot oil. Repeat until pan is full (w/ room to fry).
7. Fry until golden brown. Remove with slotted spoon. Drain on paper towel.
8. Mix sugar w/ ½ t cinn in medium bowl. Toss in churro bites until coated.
9. Serve with favorite chocolate dipping sauce.

Churros with Chocolate Dipping Sauce
(makes 16-20 churros)

<u>Churro ingredients</u>*:*
1 c water
½ c unsalted butter
¼ t salt
1 c all-purpose flour
3 eggs
1 t vanilla extract
1 c granulated sugar
1 T ground cinnamon
vegetable oil for frying

1. In a saucepan, bring water, butter and salt to a boil. Reduce heat and add flour, a little at a time. With a wooden spoon, stir vigorously until all the flour is completely incorporated and you have a smooth dough, about 5 minutes. The churro dough will begin to pull away from middle of saucepan. Remove from heat; allow to cool 5 minutes.
2. Add eggs and vanilla extract, and continue to beat well with wooden spoon until dough is smooth.
3. Spoon dough into piping bag fitted with large star tip; set aside. Combine sugar and cinnamon in a bowl.
4. Add oil, about 2 inches deep, to a Dutch oven or large saucepan. Using a deep-fry thermometer, heat oil to 375 degrees.
5. Carefully hold piping bag above oil and pipe 3-4 churros, 5 inches in length. Do not overcrowd the Dutch oven as this will cause the oil temperature to drop and the churros will absorb the oil and become soggy. Fry until golden brown, about 2-3 minutes.
6. Drain on paper towels and roll in cinnamon/sugar mixture.
7. Serve warm with chocolate dipping sauce. Store leftovers in airtight container.

Chocolate dipping sauce *(makes 1 cup)*:

½ c semi-sweet chocolate, chopped
pinch ground cinnamon
scant ¼ t vanilla extract
1 c heavy cream

1. To make chocolate dipping sauce, combine chocolate, cinnamon and vanilla in a bowl. In a small saucepan over low heat, warm heavy cream. Pour heavy cream over chopped chocolate, allow it to sit for 1 minute and whisk until smooth. Serve with warm churros. Refrigerate leftovers.

Easy Halloween Donuts

Thaw Rhodes "Texas Rolls." Press index fingers into center of each roll and stretch to donut shape. Place on baking sheet sprayed with nonstick spray and let rise until double. Fry on medium high in 2" of canola oil for 15 seconds each side.

Chocolate Icing

Mix 4 T cocoa, 6 T milk, & ½ c margarine. Heat to boil. Remove and beat in 1 t vanilla and 4 cups powdered sugar.

Donut Holes

makes ~2 dozen - takes about 25 minutes

vegetable oil, for frying
2 c flour
¼ c sugar
1 ½ T baking powder
½ t salt
1 c milk
1 egg, beaten
½ t vanilla
4 T butter, melted

1. Add the oil to a saucepan until it is about 1-2 inches deep, and set the pan over med-high heat. Heat the oil to 350 degrees and adjust heat to maintain that temperature as you are frying the donuts. (A temperature that's too low or too high can result in uneven cooking.)
2. In a large mixing bowl, combine the flour, sugar, baking powder and salt. Whisk well to blend, and set aside. In a second, smaller mixing bowl, combine the milk, egg and vanilla. Whisk the wet ingredients until well-incorporated and smooth.
3. Pour the milk mixture into the larger mixing bowl that contains the dry ingredients, and stir until just combined. Do not over mix or the donut holes won't be as tender. Add the butter and mix again until just combined.
4. Using a small cookie scoop or rounded tablespoon, drop the dough in roughly 1 ½ T size balls (no larger!) into the hot oil. Fry the donut holes, turning occasionally, until they are golden brown on all sides, about 3-5 minutes total.
5. Transfer the finished donut holes to a paper towel-lined baking sheet to absorb any surface grease. Let the donut holes stand until cool enough to handle. Serve immediately with a dipping sauce. Alternatively, you can dust them with powdered sugar or roll them in granular sugar.

Dark Chocolate Dipping Sauce

½ c semisweet chocolate chips
¼ c heavy cream

- Combine chocolate and cream in a microwave-safe bowl. Microwave on high for 10 seconds, then remove and stir. Repeat this process until the chocolate has mostly melted. Serve immediately.

Salted Caramel Sauce

1 c sugar
6 T cold butter, cubed
½ t salt
½ t vanilla
½ c heavy cream

1. Add the sugar to a saucepan set over medium high heat. Let the sugar cool without stirring until it has melted and just browns at the edges of the pan, 3-5 minutes. Swirl the pan gently (and carefully) until the sugar is an even amber color, roughly another minute.
2. Add the butter, salt and vanilla and whisk carefully to combine. Add the cream and stir very carefully (it will bubble and splatter) until combined. Transfer to a heat-safe bowl and allow the sauce to cool. Serve immediately.

Raspberry Dipping Sauce

8 oz jar seedless raspberry jam (or apricot or strawberry)
½ t vanilla extract

- Add the raspberry jam to a small saucepan over medium heat. Cook, stirring often, until the jam has loosened to a thin, sauce-like consistency. Stir in the vanilla and let stand about 10 minutes before serving.

Cinnamon Baked Doughnuts

Makes 12 servings

Baking spray with flour
2 c all-purpose flour
1 ½ c sugar
2 t baking powder
1 t ground cinnamon
½ t ground nutmeg
½ t kosher salt
1 extra-large egg, lightly beaten
1 ¼ c whole milk
2 T unsalted butter, melted
2 t pure vanilla extract

Topping

8 T unsalted butter
½ c sugar
½ t ground cinnamon

1. Heat oven to 350. Spray 2 doughnut pans well with baking spray. Into a large bowl, sift together flour, sugar, baking powder, cinnamon, nutmeg and salt. In a small bowl, whisk together egg, milk, melted butter and vanilla. Stir wet mixture into dry ingredients until just combined.
2. Spoon batter into prepared baking pans, filling each one a little more than ¾ full. Bake at 350 for 17 minutes, until a toothpick comes out clean. Allow to cool for 5 minutes, then tap doughnuts out onto a sheet pan.
3. Topping: Melt butter in an 8-in saute pan. Combine sugar and cinnamon in a small bowl. Dip each doughnut first in butter and then in cinnamon sugar, either on one side or both sides.

***Sweet Potato Pie with Cornmeal Pastry** *(½ of this recipe fills a shallow pie tin)*

Prep Time: 30 min Total Time: 4 hours 15 min Makes: 8 servings

Cornmeal Pastry

⅔ c all-purpose flour
⅓ c cornmeal
¼ t salt
⅓ plus 1T shortening
2-3 T cold water

Filling and Topping

2 eggs
2 c mashed cooked sweet potatoes
¾ c granulated sugar
1 ⅔ c evaporated milk
1 t ground cinnamon
½ t salt
½ t ground ginger
¼ t ground cloves

sweetened whipped cream, if desired

Cinnamon-Pecan Streusel

⅓ c packed brown sugar
⅓ c chopped pecans
1 T butter or margarine, softened
½ t ground cinnamon

1.In medium bowl, mix flour, cornmeal and 1/4 teaspoon salt. Cut in shortening, using pastry blender (or pulling 2 table knives through ingredients in opposite directions), until particles are size of small peas. Sprinkle with water, 1 tablespoon at a time, tossing with fork until all flour is moistened and pastry almost cleans side of bowl (1 to 2 teaspoons water can be added if necessary).

2.Gather pastry into a ball. Shape into flattened round on lightly floured surface. Wrap in plastic wrap; refrigerate about 45 minutes or until dough is firm and cold, yet pliable. This allows the shortening to become slightly firm, which helps make the baked pastry more flaky. If refrigerated longer, let pastry soften slightly before rolling.

3.Heat oven to 425°F. With floured rolling pin, roll pastry into round 2 inches larger than upside-down 9-inch deep-dish glass pie plate. Fold pastry into fourths; place in pie plate. Unfold and ease into plate, pressing firmly against bottom and side. Trim overhanging edge of pastry 1/2 inch from rim of plate. Fold and roll pastry under, even with plate; flute as desired.

4.In medium bowl, beat eggs slightly. Stir in remaining filling ingredients except whipped cream. Pour into pastry-lined pie plate.

5.Bake 15 minutes. Reduce oven temperature to 350°F. Bake 35 minutes longer.

6.In small bowl, mix all streusel ingredients until crumbly. Sprinkle streusel over pie. Bake about 10 minutes longer or until knife inserted in center comes out clean. Place pie on cooling rack. Cool completely, about 2 hours. Serve with whipped cream. Sprinkle whipped cream with cinnamon for a restaurant-fancy finish.

Easy as pie pie crust (Julie Parker's recipe)
yields 3 or 4 8 inch pie crusts

4 cups unbleached white flour
2 cups butter flavored crisco (regular crisco works w/ slightly different flavor)
1 tsp salt
1 cup LUKEWARM water

1. Add flour to large mixing bowl, add salt, stir to mix in.
2. Add crisco, MIX WITH CLEAN **HANDS**. (the restaurant lady who gave us the recipe said this was the key to it working in well – **using your hands to mix it**, not a fork or spoon.
3. Add tepid water; **mix with hands** **just add enough of the water til it is the right consistency, it may or may not take the full cup.
4. Dough should be divided into 3 or 4 balls. (The dough can be easily frozen and used at a later time. To freeze, I seal it in two freezer bags, to help it not get frostbitten. To use after freezing, allow to thaw on its own just sitting on counter for several hours. Thawing in the microwave DOES NOT WORK!!)

***Pecan Pie** (Recipe from Karo Syrup Bottle)

9" unbaked pie crust
3 eggs, slightly beaten
1 c light corn syrup
2 T margarine, melted
1 t vanilla
1 ½ c pecan halves

Combine all ingredients except pecans and blend well. Then stir in pecans. Bake in 350 degree oven 50-55 minutes or until knife ½ way between center and edge comes out clean. Cool

***NOTE: I usually end up baking it longer than it says because the knife never comes out clean, but then it is overcooked. It will always be liquidy, but will solidify when it cools.*

Pecan Tart (from *Recipes from the Roof*)
10-14 servings

Crust:
½ c butter, softened
½ c granulated sugar
1 egg
1 egg yolk
½ t almond extract
1 T heavy whipping cream
2 c flour
1 c whole pecans

Filling:
½ c granulated sugar
1 egg
½ c corn syrup
1 T melted butter
1 t vanilla

For the crust:
In a mixing bowl, combine butter and sugar and then add egg, egg yolk, almond extract, and cream. Mix together and beat until smooth. Add flour and mix well. Roll dough and put into well-greased, 9 inch fluted tart pan. Put pecan nuts on top of prepared dough.

For the filling:
In a bowl, combine all ingredients and mix with a spoon until sugar dissolves. Pour filling over nuts.

Bake at 350 degrees F for 45-50 minutes.

French Tart (Sherilyn Riboldi)

All fruit must be very dry or filling will become watery. Suggested fruits: peaches, mandarin oranges, strawberries, blueberries, blackberries, bananas. Your favorite pastry crust recipe will work great. Feel free to experiment with any type of crust. (i.e.: regular pastry crust, vinegar pastry crust, pressed chocolate cookie & cake crumbs, and ground/pressed breakfast cereal)

1 12oz. bag white chocolate chips
¼ c. heavy whipping cream
8 oz cream cheese
baked pastry shell
fruit of choice
¼ to ½ c. apple jelly

1. Heat white chocolate and whipping cream in microwave, stirring every 30 seconds, until combined and smooth. With a blender, add cream cheese and whip until stiff peaks form. Spread cream mixture in baked tart shell. One recipe fills a 10" tart of about 1 ½ to 2" depth.
2. Cover pastry crème with enough fruit to be completely covered.
3. Heat apple jelly until thin enough to brush onto fruit. With a pastry brush, thoroughly cover all the fruit to prevent browning and to create a fancy shine.
4. Refrigerate at least one hour before cutting into pie shaped wedges to serve.

Crock Pot Peach Pie

30 oz canned sliced peaches w/ juice
2 T melted butter
1 t vanilla extract
1 ½ c baking mix (Bisquick?)
½ c brown sugar, firmly
½ t ground cinnamon
¼ t ground nutmeg
¼ t ground allspice

Use a 4 qt slow cooker. Put the peaches into the stoneware. In a separate bowl, mix the melted butter with the vanilla and the dry ingredients. Stir with a fork to combine; it will be crumbly. Pour the mixture on top of the peaches, and press down with your hands (or a spatula if you don't want to get gooky). Cover and cook on high for 4 hours. The pie is done when it has begun to brown on the edges and the fruit is bubbly and has caramelized a bit.

***Peaches and Cream Pie** (Aunt Sim's recipe - *this is Ian's favorite thing to do with nectarines or peaches)*

Basic Pastry:
1 ½ c flour
¼ c shortening, chilled
Scant ½ t salt
¼ c cold butter
1 ½ t sugar
3-4 T ice water

Fillings:
6 oz cream cheese, softened
1 c chopped peaches
2 T milk
½ c granulated sugar
1 t grated lemon rind
1 T lemon juice
3 T confectioners' sugar
1 T water
1/8 t salt
5 c sliced peaches
½ t vanilla extract

1. Preheat oven to 425 degrees. Line a 9 inch pie pan with the pastry; prick well with a fork and crimp the edges. Fill the pan halfway with dry beans or pastry weights and bake until the pastry is nicely browned, about 15 minutes. Remove the pan to a wire rack. When cool, remove the weights.
2. In a mixing bowl, combine the cream cheese, milk, lemon rind, confectioners' sugar, salt, and vanilla and mix well with a fork. Spread this mixture evenly over the bottom of the baked pie shell and chill until set, about 1 hour.
3. Meanwhile, in a medium, heavy saucepan, combine the chopped peaches, the granulated sugar, lemon juice, and water. Place over low heat and cook, stirring constantly and crushing the peaches against the side of the pan with the back of the spoon, until the mixture is thick and syrupy, about 10 minutes. Cool to lukewarm.
4. Arrange the sliced peaches, overlapping them, over the cheese mixture. With a spoon, drizzle the cooked mixture over the sliced peaches, covering them completely to prevent browning. Chill the pie until serving, at least 2 hours.

Fresh Peach Pie
makes 2 pies

1 c sugar
2 T cornstarch
2 c water
1 (6 oz) pkg peach-flavored gelatin
4 c peeled and sliced fresh peaches (can used canned, but not recommended)
2 pre-baked 9 in pie crusts

1. In a medium saucepan, combine sugar, cornstarch, and water. Bring to a boil, whisking consistently until mixture becomes thick and clear. Add gelatin and mix well. Remove from heat and set aside. Allow mixture to cool, but not set -- about 15 minutes.
2. While glaze is cooling, peel and slice the peaches. Once glaze has cooled, add peaches. Mix well. Divide filling between the two pie crusts. Cover with plastic wrap and chill until set -- at least 2 hours. Garnish with whipped cream.

**You can add ½ c raspberries to the peaches. Yum!*

Blackberry Tart
makes 5-6 servings

1 refrigerated rolled pie crust
9 oz blackberries, divided
⅜ c powdered sugar, divided
1 ½ T fresh lime juice, divided, plus zest for sprinkling
8 oz mascarpone cheese, at room temperature
2 ¼ t chopped fresh mint, plus more for sprinkling

1. Heat oven to 425 F. Fit piecrust into bottom and up sides of tart pan (with removable bottom). Trim excess. Place on rimmed baking sheet; prick bottom with fork. Line with parchment, leaving 2 in overhang. Then fill with pie weights. Bake until beginning to brown around edges, 12-15 minutes. Remove parchment and weights. Bake until light golden brown, 4-5 minutes; cool.
2. In blender, puree 3 oz blackberries, 1 T sugar, and 2 ¼ t lime juice. Using fine-mesh sieve, strain into small bowl; discard seeds.
3. Using electric mixer fitted with whisk attachment on medium speed, whisk together mascarpone and ¼ c sugar until

stiff peaks form. Fold in blackberry puree.

4. In bowl, toss mint, remaining 6 oz berries, 1 T sugar, and 2 ¼ t lime juice; let sit 5 min. Spread mascarpone mixture in crust. Top with berries and juices. Sprinkle with lime zest and mint.

Chocolate Chip Raspberry Tart - *I made this for a Christmas dessert and it wowed everyone*
serves 12

1 pkg (17.5 oz) Chocolate Chip Cookie Mix *(I used oatmeal chocolate chip)*
½ c butter, softened
1 egg
1 container (8 oz) mascarpone cheese
½ c whipping cream
½ c powdered sugar
2 t orange rind, finely grated
1 T fresh orange juice
3 ½ pints fresh raspberries, washed and dried
2 T semi-sweet chocolate chips
1 t vegetable oil

1. Heat oven to 350. Combine cookie mix, butter and egg until soft dough forms. Pres dough into 9" tart pan with removable bottom.
2. Bake 20 minutes or until cookie base is golden brown. Cool completely.
3. Meanwhile, beat mascarpone cheese, cream, powdered sugar, orange rind and orange liquer/juice until fluffy (about 1-2 minutes).
4. Spread cheese mixture over cooled cookie base. Top with raspberries.
5. In a small, microwave-safe bowl, combine chocolate chips and oil. Microwave on high 20-30 seconds or until chips can be stirred smooth. Drizzle over raspberries.

***Quick Cinnamon Rolls** (This was the recipe Lisa's family made all growing up -- I think it came from the *Children's Friend* Magazine, Funstuf section back in the 1980's.)

⅓ c sugar
3 T yeast
½ c oil
1 ¼ c warm water
2 beaten eggs
1 ½ t salt
5 ¼ c sifted flour
¼ c melted butter
1 ½ T cinnamon
½ c sugar

<u>Glaze</u>
2 c powdered sugar
¼ c hot water
1 t butter

1. In large bowl, mix sugar, yeast & oil with warm water until dissolved. Grow 15 minutes.
2. Blend eggs in yeast mixture. Add salt to flour, then add gradually to yeast mixture to make soft dough. Knead 5 minutes on lightly floured surface.
3. Roll ¼ " thick. Brush with butter and sprinkle with cinnamon and sugar.
4. Roll up dough and slice 1" thick. Place in ungreased rectangle pan. Let rolls rest 10 minutes.
5. Bake at 425 degrees 10-15 minutes.
6. Mix glaze ingredients and drizzle over warm rolls.

Glazed Cinnamon Rolls (from Bread flour bag)
*I use this recipe to make easy cinnamon bread by putting in bread pans after step 4***

1 c water
2 T margarine or butter, softened
3 c Bread flour
¼ c sugar
1 t salt
2 ½ t yeast
Filling (⅓ c sugar + 2 t ground cinnamon)
2 T margarine or butter, softened
Vanilla Glaze (1 c powdered sugar, ½ t vanilla, + 1-2 T milk)

1. Measure all ingredients except filling, 2 T margarine, and vanilla glaze into bread machine (or combine in bowl manually).
2. Select dough/manual cycle (or mix and knead, then let rise)
3. Prepare filling. Grease 9x9 pan.
4. Flatten dough with hands or rolling pin into 9 inch square on lightly floured surface. Spread with 2 T margarine. Sprinkle with filling. Roll dough up tightly; pinch edge of dough into roll to seal. Cut roll into 1 inch slices. Place in pan. Cover and let rise in warm place 1-1 ¼ hours or until double. (***Alternatively, for yummy cinnamon bread, put whole roll in greased bread pan without slicing. Bake 30-40 minutes, then glaze.)*
5. Heat oven to 375. Bake 25-30 minutes or until golden brown. Mix glaze ingredients until smooth and thin enough to drizzle. Drizzle vanilla glaze over warm rolls (*or bread loaves*). Serve warm. Makes 9 rolls.

***Easy Raspberry Cream Cheese Sweetrolls**
Makes ~12 rolls

1 loaf frozen bread dough
<u>For cream cheese filling</u>*:*
4 oz softened cream cheese
lemon zest from ½ lemon
1 ½ T sugar
½ t vanilla
<u>For raspberry filling</u>*:*
1 ½-2 c frozen raspberries (crumbled distributes better)
½ T cornstarch
scant pinch salt
1 ½ T sugar
<u>For glaze</u>*:*
lemon zest from ½ lemon
⅛ c cream
½ c powdered sugar

1. Defrost 1 loaf frozen bread dough 8 hours or overnight
2. Combine all ingredients for cream cheese filling
3. In separate bowl, combine all ingredients for raspberry filling
4. Roll out dough into 12x16(ish) rectangle. Spread with cream cheese. Sprinkle raspberry mixture over top.
5. Roll up tightly from the long side. Slice ~1". Place in greased 8x8 pan. Let rise 30-45 minutes.
6. Bake 30-35 minutes at 375 degrees.
7. Pour glaze over top after rolls are slightly cooled.

***Raspberry Cream Cheese Coffeecake**
serves 8-10

<u>Coffeecake</u>
1 3 oz cream cheese
¼ c margarine (½ stick)
2 c Bisquick
¼ c milk
½ c raspberry jam
<u>Frosting</u>
1 c powdered sugar
1-2 T milk
½ t vanilla

1. In a medium bowl, cut cream cheese and margarine into Bisquick until crumbly. Stir in ¼ c milk. Turn onto lightly floured surface and knead 8-10 times.
2. On waxed paper, roll out dough to 12x8 rectangle. Invert it onto greased cookie sheet. Remove paper and spread jam down center. Make 2 ½" long cuts 1" apart. Fold strips over filling. Fold up top & bottom first and then cover with

side strips.
3. Bake in preheated 375 oven for 20 minutes or until golden brown. Let cake cool 5 minutes before frosting.
4. Stir together sugar, milk & vanilla and drizzle over slightly cooled cake.

***Sticky Buns** - *Jensen Christmas morning tradition!*

16-18 Rhodes frozen white rolls
1 pkg (3 oz) Butterscotch *Cook n' Serve* Pudding
¾ c brown sugar
1 t cinnamon
½ c melted butter

Spray bundt pan with Pam. Drop rolls to form single layer. Mix dry stuff and sprinkle over the rolls. Pour butter over all. Cover with plastic wrap and refrigerate overnight. Uncover and put in cold oven set to 375 degrees for 30 minutes.

Kneaders Raspberry Bread Pudding

1 ½ loaves aged white bread
1 qt heavy cream
3 c sugar
1 egg
1 t vanilla
5 c raspberries, fresh or frozen
1 c sugar
½ c apple juice
For Vanilla Cream Sauce*:*
1 ⅓ c butter
5 T flour
3 c heavy cream
½ t salt
2 t vanilla
⅔ c sugar

1. In a large bowl, combine cream, sugar, egg, & vanilla. Beat well.
2. Cut bread into 1 ½" cubes & add to cream mixture, coating well.
3. Let bread sit in cream mixture for 30 minutes, stirring every 5 minutes to allow cream to absorb
4. After 30 minutes, in a separate bowl, mix raspberry, sugar, & apple juice.
5. Layer 9x13 pan ¾ full with bread mix & pour fruit filling over bread mix, spreading evenly. Top with remaining bread.
6. Bake 40 minutes at 375 degrees.
7. Serve warm topped with vanilla cream sauce. (Chill before slicing if you want nice square pieces.)

To make sauce:

1. Melt butter. Add flour to butter, then stir 10 minutes (but don't brown).
2. Add cream, salt, and sugar & stir until thick. Add vanilla at end.

Blueberry (or Raspberry?) **Chocolate Pie** (from *Better Homes & Gardens*, July 2016)
total time - 3 hrs / makes 8 servings

1 recipe of Sour Cream Cookie Dough (below)
1 c semisweet chocolate pieces
1 egg
½ c sugar
3 T all-purpose flour
1 lemon, juiced
6 cups fresh blueberries

1. Preheat oven to 450. Prepare Sour Cream Cookie Dough. On well-floured surface, roll out half of the dough to form a 12-in circle. Line 9-in pie plate with dough. Trim and flute edge. Line with double thickness of foil. Bake 8 minutes; carefully remove foil. Bake for 3-4 minutes more or until golden. Remove; sprinkle with chocolate pieces. Set aside.
2. Reduce oven to 375. Roll remaining dough to ⅛-inch thickness. Cut into star shapes using assorted size cutters. In small bowl, whisk together egg and 1 T water. Arrange cutouts 2 inches apart on parchment-paper-lined cookie sheets. Brush cutouts with egg mixture. Bake for 7-9 minutes or until edges are lightly browned. Remove; cool on wire rack.
3. For filling, in large saucepan, stir together sugar, flour, and lemon juice. Add 4 c of the blueberries. Cook and stir over medium heat until just thickened and bubbly. Remove from heat. Stir in remaining berries. Pour into crust. Bake about 10 minutes or just until berries are heated through. Covering edge of pie with foil if necessary to prevent overbrowning. Remove to wire rack. Top with cookie cutouts; cool completely.

Sour Cream Cookie Dough
½ c butter (softened)
½ c sugar
½ t baking powder
⅛ t baking soda
dash of salt
1 egg yolk
¼ c sour cream
1 t vanilla
2 c all-purpose flour

In mixing bowl, beat butter with mixer 30 seconds. Add sugar, baking powder, baking soda, and salt; beat until combined. Add egg yolk, sour cream, and vanilla; beat until combined. Beat in all-purpose flour. Divide in half; wrap and chill until easy to handle.

Blueberry-Cardamom Crisp with Oat-Pistachio Topping
Serves 6 - Total prep time 40 minutes

16 oz frozen blueberries
½ t ground cardamom
1 T sugar
pinch of kosher salt
⅓ c all-purpose flour
⅓ c rolled oats
⅓ c packed light brown sugar
6 T unsalted butter, cubed
⅓ c dry roasted salted shelled pistachios
1 container vanilla bean ice cream (optional, for serving)

1. Preheat oven to 350.
2. Toss blueberries with cardamom, sugar and salt. Stir to coat berries, then transfer to 1 quart baking dish.
3. In bowl of food processor, combine flour, oats, brown sugar, butter and pistachios. Pulse about 20 times or until clumps start to form. Sprinkle mixture over blueberries.
4. Bake 30 minutes or until top is golden brown and fruit is bubbly. Cool slightly and serve warm with ice cream, if desired.

Poppy Seed Blueberry Rolls (from *Good Housekeeping*, April 2020, p.110)
makes about 8

For Dough
6 T unsalted butter, at room temp, cut into small pieces
1 ¼-oz pkg (2 ¼ t) active dry yeast (non rapid-rise)
⅓ c granulated sugar
¾ c whole milk, at room temp
2 large eggs, divided
3 ½ c all-purpose flour, divided, plus more for surface
1 t poppy seeds
1 t kosher salt
¼ t baking soda

For Filling
4 T unsalted butter, at room temp
½ c packed light brown sugar
2 t ground cinnamon
2 c fresh blueberries

For Frosting
4 oz cream cheese, at room temp
1 c powdered sugar
½ t pure vanilla extract
1 t finely grated lemon zest plus 1 T juice
Poppy seeds, for sprinkling

1. Make Dough: In large bowl; place butter yeast, granulated sugar, milk, and 1 egg. Add 3 ¼ c flour, poppy seeds, salt and baking soda. Using hands, bring ingredients together to form cohesive dough. Sprinkle some of remaining ¼ c flour on work surface and knead dough until soft but not sticky, adding a little extra flour if necessary. Transfer to clean bowl, cover tightly with plastic wrap and refrigerate 2 hr or up to 12 hr.
2. Make Filling: In bowl, combine butter, brown sugar and cinnamon.
3. Make Frosting: In bowl, place cream cheese and sift powdered sugar over top. Add vanilla, lemon zest and lemon juice and mix to combine. Leave at room temp up to 3 hours or refrigerate up to 12 hrs.
4. Lightly dust work surface with flour. Roll dough into 12x16 in rectangle. Spread with cinnamon mixture and scatter

blueberries on top. Starting from long end, roll dough into tight log. Cut log into 8 pieces and transfer to 9x13 in baking dish; let rise at room temp until rolls touch and are puffed and no longer cool to the touch, 1 ½ hr.

5. Heat oven to 375. Lightly beat remaining egg and gently brush all over tops and sides of rolls. Bake until rolls are light golden brown inside, 30-35 min., covering with foil if outer parts begin to brown too quickly. Transfer to wire rack. Spread with cream cheese frosting and sprinkle with poppy seeds if desired.

***Blackberry Crumble** (From *Blackberry Crumble* by Josi Kilpack)
Divine! The berries melt in your mouth.
Serves 6

4 c fresh or frozen blackberries (or any berry)
2 T flour
3 T sugar
½ c butter
½ c flour
½ c rolled oats
½ c brown sugar
½ t nutmeg
½ t cinnamon
1 t salt

Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Mix berries, 2 T flour, and 3 T sugar together in large bowl. Spread in an 8x8 pan. In a mixing bowl, combine remaining ingredients; adjust spices to taste. Use a pastry cutter to cut ingredients together until pea-sized crumbles form. Sprinkle over the top of the berry mixture. Bake for 45-55 minutes or until crumb topping is browned. Let cool slightly. Serve warm topped with vanilla ice cream or whipped cream, if desired.

Nectarine-Raspberry Cornmeal Crisp (from Martha Stewart.com) -- *this was YUMMY*
Serves 8 - 65 minutes total prep

<u>Filling</u>
1 ½ lbs nectarines (about 5), cut into ½ inch wedges
6 oz raspberries (about 1 ⅓ cups)
⅔ c granulated sugar
1 T cornstarch
¼ teaspoon coarse salt

<u>Topping</u>
1 stick unsalted butter, room temperature
½ c packed light-brown sugar
¾ c all-purpose flour
½ c fine yellow cornmeal
½ t coarse salt

1. FILLING: Preheat oven to 375. Combine fruit, granulated sugar, cornstarch, and salt. Transfer to a 9" square (or other 1 ½ qt) baking dish.
2. TOPPING: In a large bowl, beat butter with brown sugar on medium speed until light and fluffy. Work flour, cornmeal, and salt in with your hands until large clumps form. Scatter over filling.
3. Bake until center is bubbling, 40-50 minutes. Let crisp cool slightly before serving.

***Libby's Famous Pumpkin Pie**
Makes 8 servings (16 servings with double recipe)

<u>Ingredients for single pie recipe</u>*:*
1 unbaked 9-inch (4 cup volume) pie shell; refrigerated, frozen, or homemade.
¾ c granulated sugar
½ t salt
1 t ground cinnamon
½ t ground ginger
¼ t ground cloves
2 eggs
1 ¾ c (15 oz can) solid pack pumpkin
1 ½ c (12 oz can) evaporated milk

<u>Ingredients for double recipe</u>*:*
2 unbaked 9-inch (4 cup volume) pie shells
1 ½ c sugar
1 t salt
2 t cinnamon
1 t ginger
½ t cloves
4 eggs
1 can (29 oz) pumpkin
2 cans (12 oz ea) evaporated milk

1. Combine sugar, salt, cinnamon, ginger, and cloves in small bowl. Beat eggs lightly in large bowl. Stir in pumpkin and sugar mixture. Gradually stir in evaporated milk. Pour into pie shell.
2. Bake for 15 minutes in preheated 425 degree oven. Reduce temperature to 350; bake for 40-50 minutes or until knife inserted near center comes out clean. Cool on wire rack.

***For 2 shallow pies with single pie recipe*, substitute two shallow 9 inch pie shells (2 cup volume). Bake in preheated 425 degree oven for 15 minutes. Reduce temperature to 350 degrees; bake for 20-30 minutes or until pies test done.
**For lower fat/calorie pie, substitute evaporated lowfat milk.

Whipped Pumpkin Pie (from *Allrecipes.com)*

<u>Crust</u>:
3 c graham cracker crumbs
⅔ c white sugar
¾ c butter, melted

<u>Filling</u>:
1 (8 oz) pkg cream cheese, at room temperature
½ c white sugar
1 (15 oz) can pumpkin puree
1 (8 oz) container frozen whipped topping, thawed
½ t ground nutmeg
½ t pumpkin pie spice

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees
2. Combine crust ingredients in a mixing bowl and mix until evenly moistened, then press into the bottom and halfway of the sides of a 9-in springform pan. Place pan on a baking sheet.
3. Bake the crust in the preheated oven until lightly browned and toasted, about 10 minutes. Remove from the oven and allow crust to cool.
4. Beat cream cheese and ½ c sugar together in a large bowl until light and fluffy, 2-3 minutes. Beat in pumpkin puree until completely incorporated.
5. Fold whipped topping into pumpkin mixture; stir in nutmeg and pumpkin pie spice. Pour pumpkin mixture into graham cracker crust. Cover pie with plastic wrap and refrigerate overnight. Gently remove pie from springform pan.

Streusel-topped Pumpkin Chocolate Chip Muffins (from *Savoring the Seasons with Our Best Bites,* p. 140)
Makes 24 muffins *(+24 mini muffins)*
These were similar to the spice cake pumpkin cupcakes with butterscotch & chocolate chips in the cupcake recipe book.

1 spice cake mix
15 oz can pumpkin
1 c sour cream
¼ c vegetable oil
3 eggs
1 t vanilla
12 oz pkg chocolate chips

<u>Streusel Topping</u>
(½ recipe is enough)
¼ c flour
½ c sugar
1 t pumpkin pie spice
3 T butter

1. Ignore directions on the cake mix box. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Line muffin tins.
2. Combine cake mix, pumpkin, sour cream, oil, eggs, and vanilla in a large bowl. Mix 30 seconds on low and then 2-3 minutes on medium until the batter is smooth. Mix in chocolate chips. Divide batter evenly into cupcake liners.
3. FOR THE TOPPING: Whisk together flour, sugar, and pumpkin pie spice and then cut in butter with 2 knives until mixture resembles coarse crumbs. Sprinkle topping over batter.
4. Bake muffins 20-30 minutes or until tops are golden brown and a toothpick comes out clean. Cool on a wire rack before serving.

Sweetheart Custard Dessert (Renae Boyer's recipe)

Pastry for double-crust pie
Confectioner's sugar

Custard:
2/3 c sugar
3 T cornstarch
¼ t salt
1 1/3 c milk
2 egg yolks
¼ c lemon juice
1 T butter
1 c heavy whipping cream
¼ c confectioners' sugar

Topping:
2/3 c sliced fresh strawberries
2 T semisweet chocolate chips
1 t shortening

Roll out each pastry between waxed paper into 12 inch circle. Use round or cut into 2 heart shapes. Place on greased and floured baking sheets; prick with a fork. Bake at 450 degrees for 7-9 min. Remove to wire racks and sprinkle with confectioners' sugar.

Meanwhile, in a saucepan, combine the sugar, cornstarch and salt; gradually stir milk until smooth. Cook and stir over medium heat until thickened and bubbly. Reduce heat; cook and stir 2 min longer. Remove from the heat. Combine the egg yolks and lemon juice. Stir a small amount of hot filling into egg yolk mixture; return all to pan. Stirring constantly, bring to a gentle boil; cook and stir for 2 minutes. Remove from heat. Stir in butter. Cover; refrigerate until cool.

In a mixing bowl, beat the cream and confectioners' sugar until stiff peaks form. Gently whisk the lemon custard, then fold in whipped cream.

Place one pastry on serving plate; spread with half of the custard and half of the strawberries. Top with remaining pastry; spread with remaining custard. Arrange remaining berries over filling. In a microwave-safe bowl, melt chocolate chips and shortening. Drizzle over the top. Refrigerate until serving. (This gets soggy if stored too long, so eat within a day or so!)

***Spiced Apples -- Apple pie filling** (Shelly Shoell)
Makes 7 quarts

4 c sugar
1 c corn starch
3 t cinnamon
1 t nutmeg
1 t salt
Approximately 30 apples

1. Combine all ingredients except apples.
2. Add 10 c water. Cook until thick, stirring occasionally.
3. Add 3 t lemon juice. Fill quart jars 1/3 full of this sauce.
4. Slice apples. Pack apples in tightly.
5. Process 40 minutes.

***Apple Crisp**

½ c margarine, melted
2 cans chunky applesauce or 1 can/jar apple pie filling
½ pkg any kind of cake mix except chocolate (*yellow cake mix is my favorite)*

Put apples in bottom of buttered 9x13 pan. Sprinkle ½ pkg of cake mix over apples. Drizzle melted margarine over top and bake 45 minutes at 350. Serve with ice cream or Cool Whip.

Dutch Oven Caramel Apple Pie (from Nancy McLain)

18 Rhodes AnyTime! Cinnamon rolls, thawed but still cold
2 Granny Smith apples, peeled and diced
½ c brown sugar
1 t cinnamon
½ c graham cracker crumbs
¼ c chopped pecans

Caramel icing:
2 packets cream cheese frosting (included with rolls)
1/3 c caramel ice cream topping

1. Cut each roll into 4 pieces and arrange in the bottom of a 14-inch dutch oven lined with aluminum foil or sprayed with cooking spray. In a bowl, combine apples, brown sugar, cinnamon, cracker crumbs, and pecans. Sprinkle evenly over cut rolls. Cover with lid and bake at 350 degrees for 25-30 minutes.
2. For icing, combine cream cheese frosting with caramel topping. Drizzle over pie while still warm.

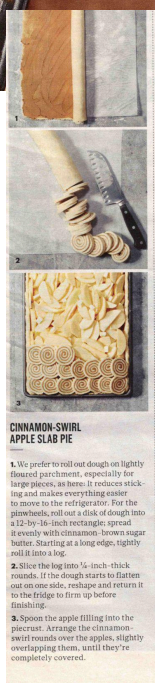
**Dutch oven temperature control using briquets:*
350 degrees in a 14 inch dutch oven, oven top 18, oven bottom 10

Cinnamon-Swirl Apple Slab Pie (from *MarthaStewart.com)*
serves 16 - total time 3:40 + cooling



3 T unbleached all-purpose flour, plus more for dusting
2 recipes Pate Brisee, each shaped into a rectangular disk (see recipe below)
4 T unsalted butter, room temperature, plus 2 T, refrigerated and cut into small cubes
½ c packed light-brown sugar
1 t ground cinnamon
½ t kosher salt
4 lbs assorted apples, such as Jonagold, Cortland, Granny Smith, and Empire, peeled, cored, and cut into ¼ inch slices
2 T fresh lemon juice
6 T granulated sugar
1 t pure vanilla extract
1 large egg, lightly beaten
fine sanding sugar, for sprinkling

1. On a lightly floured piece of parchment, roll one disk of dough into a 12x17 inch rectangle. Transfer crust to a 10 ½ x 15 ¼ inch rimmed baking sheet or jelly-roll pan and press into bottom edges and up sides. Fold overhang under and around edge. Refrigerate 30 minutes.
2. In a small bowl, combine room-temperature butter, brown sugar, cinnamon, and ¼ t salt. On a lightly floured piece of parchment, roll second disk of dough into a 12x16 inch rectangle. Evenly spread butter mixture over dough all the way to ends, then, starting at a long edge, tightly roll into a log. Transfer to a baking sheet and refrigerate until firm, about 30 minutes.
3. Preheat oven to 425 with a rack in lower third and a foil-lined baking sheet on a rack below. In a large bowl, toss together apples, lemon juice, granulated sugar, flour, remaining ¼ t salt, and vanilla. Fill piecrust with apple mixture and dot with cold butter.
4. Cut dough log into ¼ inch slices, rotating each slice to keep slices round. (You'll need 63 slices total.) Arrange slices over apple mixture, slightly overlapping, in nine rows of seven. Refrigerate until firm, about 30 minutes.
5. Brush top of pie with egg wash and sprinkle with sanding sugar. Bake until top crust is just set, 20 minutes. Reduce temperature to 375 and continue baking until crust is golden brown and juices are bubbling, about 1 hour. Let cool completely on a wire rack. Slab pie tastes best the day it's made.


CINNAMON-SWIRL APPLE SLAB PIE

1. We prefer to roll out dough on lightly floured parchment, especially for large pieces, as here: It reduces sticking and makes everything easier to move to the refrigerator. For the pinwheels, roll out a disk of dough into a 12-by-16-inch rectangle; spread it evenly with cinnamon–brown sugar butter. Starting at a long edge, tightly roll it into a log.

2. Slice the log into ¼-inch-thick rounds. If the dough starts to flatten out on one side, reshape and return it to the fridge to firm up before finishing.

3. Spoon the apple filling into the piecrust. Arrange the cinnamon-swirl rounds over the apples, slightly overlapping them, until they're completely covered.

Pate Brisee (Pie Crust)
makes enough for one 9" double crust pie, or one 10 ½ by 15 ¼ inch single crust slab pie

2 ¼ c unbleached all-purpose flour
1 ½ t kosher salt
1 T sugar
2 sticks cold unsalted butter, cut into small pieces
7-8 T ice water

1. Pulse flour, salt, and sugar in a food processor until combined. Add butter and pulse until mixture resembles coarse meal with some pea-size pieces remaining. Drizzle 5 T water over mixture; pulse several times to combine. Add more water, 1 T at a time, and pulse until mixture holds together when pinched.
2. For a 9" pie, shape dough into two disks and wrap each in plastic. For a slab pie, shape dough into a rectangle and wrap in plastic. REfrigerate at least 1 hour and up to 1 day, or freeze up to 3 months; thaw overnight in refrigerator before using.





Mom's Maple-Apple Pie (from *Taste of Home*, February/March 2013)
makes 8 servings

1 c sugar
2 T all-purpose flour
1 ½ t ground cinnamon
½ t ground nutmeg
¼ t salt
6 medium tart apples, peeled and thinly sliced (about 2 ¼ lbs)
1 T lemon juice
1 pkg (14.1 oz) refrigerated pie pastry
2 T butter
3 T maple syrup, divided
warm maple syrup, optional

1. In a small bowl, combine the first five ingredients. In a large bowl, toss apples with lemon juice. Add sugar mixture; toss to coat.
2. Unroll one pastry sheet into 9-in pie plate; trim even with rim. Add filling. Dot with butter; drizzle with 2 T maple syrup. Unroll remaining pastry; place over filling. Trim, seal and flute edge. Cut slits in top. Brush pastry with 1 T maple syrup.
3. Bake at 425 for 40-45 minutes or until crust is golden brown and filling is bubbly. Cover pie loosely with foil during the

last 20 minutes if needed to prevent overbrowning. Remove foil. Cool on wire rack. If desired, serve with warm maple syrup.

Double Crunch Pie
serves 6

1 (3.8 oz) pkg instant chocolate pie filling
8 oz whipped topping
1 (6 oz) prepared chocolate crumb piecrust (or make your own from 1 ⅓ c Oreo crumbs and ½ c melted butter)
15 Oreos, crushed into chunks
½ c chocolate chips
½ c peanut butter chips

1. Prepare pie filling in a large bowl according to pkg directions. Fold whipped topping into pie filling; stir until well blended.
2. Spread pie filling mixture evenly in piecrust. Chill in freezer until slightly set, about 10 minutes.
3. Combine cookie chunks, chocolate chips and peanut butter chips in a small bowl. Sprinkle over pie filling. Refrigerate until ready to serve.

**You can prepare this up to 24 hours ahead. Store, covered, in the refrigerator until ready to serve.

Butterscotch-Banana Cream Pie
serves 6

1 (9-in) graham cracker piecrust
3 bananas, sliced
1 (4 oz) pkg butterscotch cook-and-serve pie filling (can use instant butterscotch pudding)
2 c milk
1 ½ c whipped topping

1. Line graham cracker piecrust with bananas.
2. Prepare pie filling according to pkg directions, using 2 c milk. Chill for 20 min to thicken. Pour pie filling over bananas.
3. Spread whipped topping over pie filling. Chill until serving time.

Whipped Cream

1 c whipping cream
2 T sugar
½ t vanilla

Chill beaters, and bowl first. Whip all ingredients on medium until soft peaks form.

Chocolate Whipped Cream

1 c whipping cream (cold)
2 T sugar
3 T cocoa powder

Chill beaters and bowl. Can mix sugar and cocoa before adding cream, or add just before cream stiffens. Whip all ingredients on high speed until soft peaks form. Perfect topping for ice cream cakes. Also nice as a lighter option than frosting.

HOLIDAY TREATS & IDEAS

Carnation Famous Fudge
Makes 2 lbs

2 T butter or margarine
2/3 c evaporated milk
1 ½ c granulated sugar
¼ t salt
2 c miniature marshmallows
1 ½ c semi-sweet chocolate chips
1 t vanilla extract

Butter 8-inch square pan. In medium saucepan, combine butter, evaporated milk, sugar, and salt. Bring to a boil over medium heat, stirring constantly. Boil 4-5 minutes, stirring constantly; remove from heat. Stir in marshmallows, chocolate chips, and vanilla. Stir vigorously for 1 minute or until marshmallows melt completely. Pour into pan. Cool and cut into squares. (For thicker fudge, use a 7x5 inch loaf pan.)

Peanut-Mallow Fudge
yields 48 pieces

½ c creamy peanut butter
⅔ c powdered sugar
½ c butter
3 c granulated sugar
1 c evaporated milk
1 bag (10.5 oz) miniature marshmallows
1 c semisweet chocolate chips
8 oz sweet baking chocolate, chopped
1 oz unsweetened baking chocolate, chopped
1 t vanilla
⅔ c dry-roasted peanuts

1. LIne bottom and sides of 13x9 inch pan with foil, leaving 1 inch of foil overhanging at 2 opposite sides of pan; grease foil with butter. In medium bowl, stir peanut butter and powdered sugar until well blended. Shape into 24 (1 inch) balls. Place balls evenly in foil-lined pan.
2. In 5-6 quart saucepan, cook butter, granulated sugar and evaporated milk over medium-high heat, stirring constantly, until sugar is dissolved. Heat to full boil, stirring constantly. Reduce heat to medium. Boil uncovered without stirring 3 minutes. Remove from heat.
3. Stir in 3 cups of the marshmallows until melted. Add chocolate chips, sweet chocolate, and unsweetened chocolate, stirring rapidly until all chocolate is melted and mixture is smooth. Stir in vanilla. Quickly pour mixture over peanut butter balls in pan. Press peanuts and remaining marshmallows into top of fudge. Cool completely, about 1 ½ hours.
4. Using foil handles, lift fudge from pan to cutting board; remove foil from sides of fudge. Cut into 8 rows by 6 rows.

***Holiday Peppermint Fudge** (Mckay's favorite -- Sometimes ½ recipe of this is enough!)

4 c sugar
10 oz. evaporated milk
1 c butter
2 c semi-sweet chocolate chips
7 oz jar marshmallow crème
½ t peppermint extract
2/3 c red and white peppermint candy, coarsely broken *(or I've used Andes holiday baking chips)*

1. Combine sugar, milk, and butter in a heavy 3 qt saucepan; bring to a boil over medium-high heat, stirring constantly. Reduce heat to medium; heat and stir for 10 minutes.
2. Remove from heat; add chocolate chips, marshmallow crème and peppermint extract. Stir until chocolate and crème are melted and mixture is smooth; pour into a buttered, aluminum foil lined 13x9 baking pan.
3. Sprinkle with candies; cover and refrigerate until set. Cut into squares to serve. Makes 5-6 dozen.

***Hard tack Candy** (Dillon's favorite)

2 c granulated sugar
2/3 c light corn syrup
¾ c water
1 dram (1 tsp) LorAnn Gourmet Flavoring (cinnamon is YUMMY!)
¼ t LorAnn Gourmet Liquid Food
Coloring (we just use regular food coloring)
Powdered sugar

In saucepan, mix together sugar, corn syrup, and water. Stir over medium heat until sugar dissolves. Bring mixture to a boil without stirring. When syrup temperature reaches 260 degrees, add color. Do not stir; boiling action will incorporate color into syrup. Remove from heat at 300 degrees or when drops of syrup form hard, brittle threads in cold water. After boiling action ceases, add flavoring, and stir. USE CAUTION WHEN ADDING FLAVORING TO AVOID RISING STEAM. Pour syrup into lightly oiled candy molds or onto greased cookie sheet and score to mark squares. When cool, break into pieces and dust with powdered sugar to prevent sticking. Store in airtight container.

Tip: Wipe up spills and wash utensils quickly as prolonged contact (of plastic and counter tops) with flavoring will damage them.

***Holiday Wreaths**
Makes 16 wreaths. Can also be molded into one big wreath and sliced to serve.

1/3 c margarine or butter
1 t vanilla
1 pkg (10 oz, or about 40) regular marshmallows, or 4 c miniature marshmallows
1 t green food coloring
6 c corn flakes
Red cinnamon candies

1. In large saucepan, melt margarine over low heat. Add marshmallows and stir until completely melted. Remove from heat. Stir in food coloring.
2. Add corn flakes cereal. Stir until well coated.
3. Using ¼ c dry measure coated with cooking spray, evenly portion warm cereal mixture. Using buttered fingers, quickly shape into individual wreaths. Use end of spoon to make center hole. Dot with cinnamon candies. Use frosting to hold candies in place.

Chocolate Pomegranate Clusters

1 c semisweet or dark chocolate chips
1 large pomegranate

1. Slice pomegranate into quarters. Soak the quarters in a bowl of water for about 5 minutes. Gently break the pomegranate apart under the water. The seeds will fall to the bottom, the rest will float. Remove the rind and membranes.
2. Remove the seeds from the bowl and pick out any debris. Spread them on a paper towel-lined plate and blot gently with more paper towels. Transfer the seeds to fresh paper towels and allow them to air dry for three hours. Any residual moisture will prevent the chocolate from binding to the seeds, leaving you with a crumbly mess instead of a cluster.
3. Line a mini muffin pan with mini muffin cup liners. Pour the chocolate chips into a heavy-duty zip top bag and shake them down into one corner. Microwave in short intervals, removing and kneading the bag every 15-20 seconds, until the chocolate is smooth and viscous. Squeeze the chocolate down into one corner of the bag, then snip about ⅛ inch off of the edge for a makeshift piping bag.
4. Drizzle some chocolate into the bottom of a muffin cup. Add a layer of pomegranate seeds. Drizzle with more chocolate. Repeat until you have four layers of chocolate and three layers of seeds. Repeat in each muffin cup until you've used all the pomegranate and chocolate. Allow the clusters to harden in a cool, dry place.

Cunningham Candy Cane Cake (from Josi Kilpack's *Candy Cane Caper)*
Very Sweet & Rich

Chocolate Cake
2 cups flour
2 cups sugar
¾ cup cocoa powder
2 teaspoon baking soda
1 teaspoon salt
2 large eggs
1 cup buttermilk
1 cup vegetable oil
1 teaspoon vanilla
1 cup boiling water

Frosting
1 ½ cups salted butter
1 ½ cups vegetable shortening
10 to 11 cups powdered sugar, divided
1 tablespoon peppermint extract
¾ cup water or milk, divided
red food coloring
¾ cup cocoa

Chocolate Ganache
1 (6-ounce) bag semisweet chocolate chips
½ cup heavy whipping cream

Additional Ingredients
2 to 3 candy canes, chopped

To make the chocolate cake layers

1. Prepare three 8-inch cake pans with parchment paper circles in the bottom, and grease the sides. Preheat oven to 300 degrees F.
2. Add all dry ingredients to a large bowl and combine. Add eggs, buttermilk, vegetable oil, and vanilla to the dry ingredients and mix well.
3. Slowly add water (use a ladle to make sure batter doesn't splash as water is added). Mix well.
4. Divide batter evenly between cake pans and bake for 30 to 33 minutes, or until a toothpick comes out with a few crumbs. Remove cakes from oven and allow to cool in the pans for 10 minutes. Remove cakes from pans and set on cooling racks to cool completely.

To make the icing

5. In a large bowl, beat together butter and shortening until smooth. Slowly add 4 cups (1 pound) powdered sugar. Mix until smooth. Add peppermint extract and ½ cup of milk or water. Mix until smooth.
6. Add another 4 cups (1 pound) powdered sugar and mix until smooth. Add additional powdered sugar until proper consistency is reached. Add remaining ¼ cup of water or milk and mix until smooth.
7. Remove 1 ½ cups of icing and dye it red with red food coloring.

To assemble the cake

8. When the cakes are cool, remove the tops of the cakes with a large serrated knife so they are flat. Place the first layer of cake on serving plate. Spread the red icing into an even layer on top of the cake. Place the second layer of cake on top of the red icing and spread with white frosting. Top cake with third layer of cake.
9. Add cocoa to remaining icing, and mix until well combined. (You may need to add another 2 to 3 tablespoons of water or milk to get the icing to a nice, spreadable consistency.)
10. Frost the outside of the cake with the chocolate buttercream.

To make the ganache

Note: Don't make until cake is frosted. The ganache sets up fast.

11. Place chocolate chips in a medium-sized bowl. In a separate bowl, microwave heavy cream until it just begins to boil.
12. Pour heated cream over chocolate chips and cover bowl with clear wrap. Allow to sit for 5 to 7 minutes, then whisk until smooth.
13. Pour ganache on top of the cake, then use an offset spatula to spread it to the outer edges of the cake, pushing it over the edges in some spots to make drips of ganache down the sides.
14. Top the cake with chopped candy canes. Allow ganache to set, then refrigerate cake until ready to serve.

Peppermint Ribbon Cake (from *Taste of Home*)
yields 12 servings

1 pkg (18.25 oz) white cake mix
½ t peppermint extract
½ t red food coloring
½ c plus 2 T crushed peppermint candies, *divided*
1 c powdered sugar
1 T milk

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Prepare cake batter according to pkg directions. Transfer 1 c to a small bowl; stir in the extract, food coloring and ½ c crushed candies.
2. Spoon 2 c of remaining batter into a greased and floured 10 in fluted tube pan (*bundt pan*). Carefully top with peppermint batter; do not swirl. Top with remaining plain batter.
3. Bake at 350 for 35-45 minutes or until a toothpick inserted near the center comes out clean. Cool for 10 minutes before removing from pan to a wire rack to cool completely.
4. Combine powdered sugar and milk; drizzle over cake. Sprinkle with remaining crushed candies.

Candy Cane Crinkles (from Josi Kilpack's *Candy Cane Caper*)
Makes approximately 4-dozen 1-inch scoop cookies

2 cups granulated sugar
1 cup butter, room temperature
1 tablespoon vanilla extract
2 large eggs
1/2 teaspoon kosher salt
1/2 teaspoon baking powder
1/2 teaspoon baking soda
3 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
1 cup vanilla chips
10 full-sized candy canes, unwrapped and crushed (about 2/3 cup)
1/2 cup powdered sugar

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Prepare baking sheets with parchment paper.*
2. Combine sugar and butter, and mix with electric mixer until light and fluffy. Add vanilla extract and eggs. Mix until combined, scraping down sides as needed. Add salt, baking powder, baking soda, flour, vanilla chips, and crushed candy canes (powder and all).
3. Pour powdered sugar onto a large plate. Scoop 1 tablespoon or use a 1-inch scoop of dough and roll into a ball. Roll in powdered sugar until coated. Place on baking sheet and repeat with remaining dough.
4. Bake for 9 to 11 minutes or until bottoms are barely brown and cookies look matte.
5. Remove from oven and cool cookies about 3 minutes before transferring to cooling rack.

*The candy cane pieces will melt, which is why you need parchment paper or a silicone mat. If neither of those is available, simply grease the pan before baking and cross your fingers.

Note: You can crush candy canes in a food processor, just don't turn them to dust. You want the pieces to be smaller than a pea, but still be chunky. You can also crush them by hand by double-bagging zip-top bags and using a hammer or rolling pin to achieve the right texture.

Note: These are also good with just lemon-flavored baking chips.

Valentine special effects (Renae Boyer's enrichment demonstration)

- Serve sorbet in goblets with sparkling cider poured over top.
- If you don't have varied height platters, serve desserts on regular platters set on upside down vases or candlesticks.
- Make small individual cakes
- Cut twinkies on angles, turned and placed together to form a heart. Top with strawberries and cream, drizzled with chocolate sauce.
- Decorate anything with heart mold chocolates or chocolate shavings.

Chocolate Heart Cake (from *Good Housekeeping*, Jan/Feb 2021)
Serves 16

2 ½ c all-purpose flour
1 ¼ c unsweetened cocoa powder
2 ¼ c granulated sugar
¾ c packed brown sugar
2 ¼ t baking soda
¾ t baking powder
¾ t kosher salt
1 ½ c whole milk
¾ c canola oil
3 large eggs
1 ½ t pure vanilla extract
1 ¼ c boiling water

<u>Frosting and Decorations</u>
2 8-oz pkgs cream cheese, at room temperature
½ c (1 stick) unsalted butter, at room temperature
2 c confectioners' sugar
sprinkles, nonpareils, and hearts, for decorating



1. Heat oven to 350. Coat one 9-in square pan and one 9-in round cake pan with nonstick cooking spray. Line bottoms with parchment; spray parchment.
2. In large bowl, whisk together flour, cocoa, granulated and brown sugars, baking soda, baking powder and salt. In medium bowl, whisk together milk, oil, eggs and vanilla extract and mix into flour mixture until fully incorporated. Mix in boiling water (batter will be thin).
3. Divide batter among prepared pans and bake until wooden pick inserted in centers comes out clean, 35-40 minutes. Let cool 10 minutes in pans before transferring to wire rack to cool completely.
4. Meanwhile, using electric mixer, beat cream cheese and butter in large bowl until smooth. Beat in confectioners' sugar until light and fluffy, about 3 minutes.
5. Place square cake on large board or serving platter, orienting like a diamond. Cut round cake in half. Use some frosting to stick round halves to 2 sides of square to make a heart. Frost top (and sides, if desired) with remaining frosting. Decorate with sprinkles, etc.

St. Patrick's Green Smoothie Pancakes (Blendtec recipe)

1 c low-fat milk
1 c wheat berries
2 c spinach, packed
2 T flaxseeds
3 large eggs
2 T granulated sugar
1 banana
2 t vanilla extract
1 T baking powder

1. Add milk, wheat berries, spinach, and flax seeds to FourSide or WildSide jar and secure lid. Press "speed up" to Speed 9 and run full cycle. Add remaining ingredients to jar and secure lid. Select "batters". Allow batter to rest 5 minutes.
2. Heat griddle or other pan over medium to medium high heat and grease. Pour approximately ¼ c batter onto heated pan and cook approximately 1 minute or until bubbles break the surface of the pancake and the underside is golden brown. Flip and cook for approximately 30 seconds. Repeat with remaining batter.
3. Serve immediate, or keep warm in the oven at 200 degrees, loosely wrapped in foil.

***Variation: substitute 1 ⅓ c of flour in place of wheat berries.*

***Chex Muddy Buddies**
Makes 18 - ½ c servings

9 c chex cereal, any combination
1 c semisweet chocolate chips
½ c peanut butter
¼ c butter or margarine
1 t vanilla
1 ½ c powdered sugar

1. Into large bowl, measure cereal; set aside.
2. In 1-qt microwavable bowl, microwave chocolate chips, peanut butter and butter uncovered on high 1 minute; stir. Microwave about 30 seconds longer or until mixture can be stirred smooth. Stir in vanilla. Pour mixture over cereal, stirring until evenly coated. Pour into 2-gallon resealable food-storage plastic bag.

3. Add powdered sugar. Seal bag; shake until well coated. Spread on waxed paper to cool. Store in airtight container in refrigerator.

Fudge Easter Eggs (Sister Kau)

In large bowl put:	In saucepan put:	1/8 t salt
½ c margarine, cut up	4 ½ c sugar	1 can evaporated milk
18 oz chocolate chips	½ t cream of tartar	

1. Put saucepan on medium high heat. Stir frequently until mixture just boils. Then count exactly seven minutes while regularly stirring. Take off heat and pour over ingredients in bowl. Stir until both have melted and mixture is smooth. Add 1 t vanilla. Cool to room temperature and put in refrigerator for about two hours. Then shape into eggs and place in waxed paper lined pan. Refrigerate until ready to coat.
2. To coat: melt 1 cup milk or semisweet chocolate chips in double boiler over hot water. Add about 1/3 c shortening to melted chocolate to keep it from hardening too fast. Spread in a pan. With hands, frost eggs until well coated. When coating has set, decorate as desired.

Chocolate Peanut Butter Eggs
makes 28 eggs

1 c creamy peanut butter	1 package (12 oz) semi-sweet	28 lollipop sticks
½ c butter flavor shortening, divided	chocolate chips	decorator sprinkles
3 c powdered sugar		

Line baking sheet with wax paper. Beat peanut butter, ¼ c shortening, and sugar in bowl on medium low speed. Form heaping tablespoons of mixture into egg shapes. Place on baking sheet; freeze 1 hour. Microwave chocolate and remaining shortening in bowl on high for 30 seconds; stir. Microwave additional 30 seconds. Insert sticks into bottom center of each egg. Dip egg into chocolate; coat completely. Return to baking sheet. Sprinkle with decorator sprinkles. Chill 30 minutes. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Caramel Apples

1. For each apple, melt 10 unwrapped caramels and 1 ½ t water (50 caramels and 2 T water) in saucepan over medium-low heat, stirring until caramels are melted and smooth.
2. Dip apples into melted caramel, spooning caramel over apples to coat. Allow excess caramel to drip off, scraping bottom if necessary, and decorate (with sprinkles, crushed cookies, nuts, drizzled chocolate) if desired.
3. Place on greased wax paper to cool about 15 minutes.

Tip: If caramels are hard to unwrap, put them in the freezer for 20 minutes, then wrapping will easily peel off.

ICE CREAM

***Fruit Ice Cream** (Julie Bowlden's recipe)

Juice of 3 lemons
Juice of 3 oranges
3 bananas, mashed
3 c milk (1/2 condensed better)
3 c whipping cream
3 c sugar

Mix half the sugar with milk and cream. Mix the other half with fruit and juices. Then combine both. Pour into ice cream freezer and turn on. Makes one gallon. Peaches, berries, etc. may be substituted for or combined with the bananas.

***Ben & Jerry's Raspberry Ice Cream** (yummy!)
Makes 1 quart

1 pt raspberries
2 large eggs
1 ½ c sugar
2 c heavy cream
½ lemon (juice of)
1 c milk

1. Toss raspberries, ¾ c sugar, and lemon juice in bowl. Cover and refrigerate 2 hours, stirring every 30 minutes.
2. Whisk eggs until light and fluffy, 1-2 minutes. Whisk in remaining sugar, little at a time, til completely blended. Pour in cream and milk and whisk to blend.
3. Mash raspberry mixture til pureed and stir into cream mixture.
4. Freeze in ice cream freezer.

Dole Whip Copycat

5 oz unsweetened almond milk
5 oz coconut milk
½ c pineapple juice
2 ½ c frozen pineapple chunks *(you can make variations by using 1 c pineapple + 1 c strawberry OR 1 c pineapple + 1 c mango)*
¼ t stevia (or your sweetener of choice)
1 pinch salt

1. Add ingredients to wildside Blendtec jar in order listed (use half ingredients in twister jar)
2. Blend on Med Low (speed 3) for 20 seconds then increase speed to Med High (speed 6) for another 30 seconds or until smooth. you may experience cavitation during blending. If so, you can wait until it catches again or stop blending, remove the jar, shake the contents back down to the blade, replace it and continue blending.
3. Transfer pineapple mixture to a large plastic bag and place in freezer for 30-60 minutes. Cut off one tip of bag and pipe into serving dishes.

(Serving size ½ c: 1 g fat, 1 g fiber, 10 g sugar)

Strawberry Banana Ice Cream

2 c milk
2 c sugar
½ t salt
6 eggs, beaten
5-6 ripe bananas, mashed
1 T vanilla
2 c crushed strawberries
4 c light cream or half and half

Combine milk, sugar, and salt in heavy saucepan or double boiler. Over medium heat, bring mixture almost to a boil; remove from heat. Beat eggs. Pour about one cup hot milk into eggs, stirring eggs well. Pour egg mixture back into hot milk; return saucepan to the heat; stirring constantly, cook until thick or a minimum 165 degrees. Do not boil or custard may curdle. Remove from heat, stir in mashed bananas and vanilla. Cool. Stir in strawberries and cream. Pour mixture into 6 qt ice cream freezer and freeze as directed.

No-Churn Mango-Berry Ice Cream
Serves 4

1 ½ lbs frozen raspberries
½ lb frozen mango
½ c sweetened condensed milk (7 oz)
½ t kosher salt

1. In a food processor, pulse fruit, scraping side of bowl often, until finely chopped and fluffy.
2. Add sweetened condensed milk and salt and pulse, occasionally scraping side of bowl, until mixture is smooth and whirring around blade in continuous wave.
3. Transfer mixture to 9x5 in loaf pan. Freeze, uncovered until set, about 4 hours. If not serving immediately, cover tightly with plastic wrap and freeze up to 2 weeks. Makes about 5 cups.

***230 cal, 3.5 g fat, 5 g protein, 290 mg sodium, 8 g fiber, and 51 g carbs in each 1.25 c serving.*

Berry Orange Sorbet – From *Family Fun* Magazine
Makes about 6 servings

1 ¼ c water
½ c sugar
1 ½ c fresh or thawed raspberries or blackberries
1 c orange juice
2 T fresh lemon juice

1. Combine 1 c water and sugar in small saucepan. Bring to a simmer and continue simmering about 3 minutes, stirring often, until sugar dissolves. Remove from heat and cool.
2. Put berries and ¼ c water in food processor. Puree 30 seconds. Strain in sieve to remove seeds.
3. Mix all together in a pitcher, then pour into 2 ice cube trays. Freeze about 6 hours.
4. When ready to serve, chill serving dishes and food processor parts. Put frozen cubes in and pulse in short bursts to make smooth sorbet.

Blueberry-Lemon Sorbet
makes about 3 ½ cups

¼ c apple juice or white grape juice
¼ c raw, unfiltered honey
3 ½ c (18 oz) fresh blueberries, divided
1 large lemon
⅛ t salt

1. In a small saucepan, warm juice and add honey; stir until completely dissolved. Combine with 3 c blueberries in a food processor and puree until smooth.
2. Zest and juice the lemon. Add lemon juice and salt to blueberry mixture and pulse to combine. Pour into a prepared ice-cream-maker canister; stir in all but 1 t of lemon zest, and freeze according to manufacturer's directions.
3. To serve, place one scoop in each serving dish and garnish with remaining lemon zest and remaining blueberries. Serve immediately.

***For a smoother texture, strain the blueberries through a fine-mesh sieve before freezing. For a blueberries-and-cream variation, substitute milk or cream for the grape juice, omit the lemon, and add ½ c Greek yogurt.*

Peach Freeze

3 c peeled, sliced, ripe peaches
5 t lemon juice
½ c plain, low-fat yogurt
¼ c superfine sugar

In medium bowl, toss peaches with 3 t lemon juice to prevent fruit from darkening. Drain peaches and arrange in single layer on baking sheet. Freeze. Put frozen peaches in blender to chop fine. Add yogurt, sugar, and remaining 2 t lemon juice; process until smooth. Transfer to freezer container; freeze until firm. Or; process in ice cream freezer as manufacturer directs.

Peach Cinnamon Ice Cream

4 c peeled, diced fresh peaches
1 c peach nectar
½ c sugar
3 egg yolks
4 c milk
1 c ½ and ½
1 t lemon juice
½ t cinnamon

1. Combine 1st three ingredients in a medium bowl then process peach mixture, in batches, in a blender or food processor until smooth. Set aside.
2. Whisk yolks and milk in saucepan over medium heat; cook, stirring constantly, 20 minutes or until thick and it coats a spoon. DO NOT BOIL.
3. Remove from heat; whisk in peach mixture, ½ & ½, lemon juice, and cinnamon. Cover and chill 4 hours.
4. Pour mixture into ice cream maker and freeze.

Snickerdoodle Ice Cream (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes 1 ½ quarts

1 ½ c 2% milk
1 c sugar
2 eggs, room temperature
1 c heavy cream
2 t cinnamon
1 t vanilla
About 1 1/2 -2 cups chopped sugar cookies, snickerdoodles, or shortbread cookies

1. Combine milk and sugar in a medium saucepan. Heat over medium until bubbles form around the edges. Remove from heat.
2. In a small mixing bowl, whisk the eggs thoroughly. Very slowly, add ½ of the hot milk mixture, whisking the eggs constantly.
3. Return the pan with remaining milk mixture to stove top and then whisk the egg and milk mixture back into the saucepan, whisking constantly. Add the whipping cream. Over medium-low heat and stirring constantly, continue heating the custard mixture to 160 degrees F. It will start to thicken quickly; remove from heat when your finger leaves a track on a spoon coated in the custard mixture.
4. Whisk in cinnamon and vanilla. Place the custard in an airtight container and chill in the refrigerator several hours.
5. When ready to make the ice cream, pour the chilled custard into an ice cream maker and freeze according to the manufacturer's instructions. When the ice cream is almost done, add chopped cookies. Transfer the ice cream to an airtight container and freeze at least 1-2 hours (but no longer than 4-5 days) before serving.

Hot Fudge Sauce (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes about 2 cups

3 oz semisweet or dark chocolate (3 1-oz squares or ½ c chips)
¼ c butter
1 can sweetened condensed milk

1. If you're using squares of chocolate, cut into pieces and set aside.
2. In a small saucepan, heat the butter and condensed milk over medium-low until the butter melts and the milk is warm. Add the chocolate and stir until the chocolate is completely melted and smooth. Remove from heat.
3. Serve as desired. Store leftovers in an airtight container for 1-2 weeks.

Buttermilk-Blackberry Pops (from *Southern Living*, July 2014, p.102)
Makes eight 4 oz ice pops

1 ½ c fresh blackberries
6 T frozen orange juice concentrate, thawed
1 ½ c whole buttermilk
1 (8 oz) container sour cream
1/3 c honey
8 wooden craft sticks

1. Process first 2 ingredients in a food processor or blender until smooth. Whisk together buttermilk and next 2 ingredients.
2. Pour mixtures alternately into 8 ice pop molds or paper cups. Swirl mixtures gently, and insert wooden craft sticks. Freeze 8 hours or until completely frozen.

Melon Berry Blast Pops
makes 4 popsicles

2 c cubed watermelon
2 c raspberries
½ c full-fat canned coconut milk
2 T honey
1 T freshly squeezed lime juice

Blend watermelon, raspberries, coconut milk, honey and lime juice in blender. Pour mixture through fine sieve into pitcher, pressing it through with back of spoon as necessary. Then pour puree into popsicle molds and freeze until firm. Dip bottoms of molds in hot water for 20 seconds to help loosen pops.

OTHER DESSERTS

Cannoli (demonstrated by Brother Nash at a Relief Society activity)

Filling:

16 oz ricotta cheese (measure with a scale)
13 oz cream cheese (softened) - *NOT reduced fat*
1-2 drops cinnamon oil
zest of 1 orange
8 oz mascarpone cheese *(about $6/container)*
5 oz powdered sugar

Cream the ricotta, cream cheese, zest, and cinnamon oil together until well blended. Add mascarpone and sugar and mix until incorporated without over-blending.

Shells:

2 c all-purpose flour
1 ½ T sugar
pinch of salt
2 T butter
2 egg yolks *(save egg whites)*
½ c marsalla/grape juice/amaretto

Sift together the flour, sugar, and salt. Cut butter into flour mix. Beat in marsalla/grape juice/amaretto and yolks until dough is formed. On a lightly floured surface, roll out dough about ⅛ in and cut with a 3 inch circular cutter. Using cannoli rollers, roll the circle until it is slightly football shaped and then wrap it around the roller and seal together using either egg white (saved from yolks) or water. Drop shells into a 320 degree deep fryer until golden brown.

Chocolate Dessert Crepes

1 c flour
1 ½ c milk
1/3 c choc drink mix (Quik)
2 eggs
1 T oil
1 t vanilla

Combine all and beat til blended. Cook. Makes 16-18. Grease skillet each time. Fill with vanilla or chocolate filling (below).

**To make crepe cups, press cooked crepe lightly in generously greased custard cup. Bake at 375 degrees til crisp, 20-22 min.

Chocolate Filling (Vanilla is same but 1/3 c sugar and no chocolate)
Makes 1 ½ cups

½ c sugar
3 T flour
¼ t salt
1 ¼ c milk
1 beaten egg
1 T butter/marg
1 t vanilla
1 1 oz square unsweetened chocolate, cut up

1. Combine sugar, flour and salt. Slowly add milk and chocolate; mix well. Cook and stir medium heat til thick and bubbly; cook and stir 2 minutes more.
2. Gradually stir HALF the hot mixture into egg; return to pan. Cook and stir til just boiling.
3. Stir in butter and vanilla; cover surface with clear plastic wrap and cool. DO NOT STIR.

**Stir ½ c small marshmallows into chilled filling and spoon about 3 T into each crepe. Top with scoop of vanilla ice cream.

Dessert Crepes
Makes 16-18 crepes

1 c flour
1 ½ c milk
2 eggs
2 T sugar
1 T oil
1/8 t salt

**Try serving dessert crepes as strawberry shortcake stacks, or try with custard filling instead of cool whip. Or use in recipe below.

Cheese Blintzes

1 beaten egg
12 oz dry cottage cheese (rinse and drain regular cottage cheese)
2 T sugar
½ t vanilla
Dash cinnamon
12 dessert crepes
2 T butter
Canned fruit pie filling
Sour cream

1. Make dessert crepes (recipe above) and set aside.
2. Beat together egg, cottage cheese, sugar, vanilla, and cinnamon til nearly smooth.
3. Spoon some cheese mixture in center of unbrowned side of crepe. Fold in edges to form a square packet.
4. Cook crepe packets on both sides in skillet in butter til heated through. Serve hot crepes with warm pie filling and sour cream. Makes 6 servings.

Bittersweet Chocolate Pudding (from *Family Circle*, Feb 2008)
makes 6 servings, takes 2 hours

¾ c sugar
¼ c cornstarch
2 T unsweetened cocoa powder (plus more for dusting) - *Dutch-processed cocoa will give a richer, more luxurious flavor*
pinch ground nutmeg
3 ½ c milk
4 oz bittersweet chocolate, chopped
1 t vanilla extract
whipped cream or whipped topping, for serving (optional)

1. In a medium-size heavy-bottomed saucepan, whisk together the sugar, cornstarch, cocoa powder and nutmeg. Gradually add milk, whisking constantly to keep mixture from getting lumpy.
2. Transfer saucepan to stovetop, and heat over medium heat, stirring constantly with a wooden spoon. Bring to a boil (about 10 minutes), then boil 2 minutes.
3. Remove from heat and add chopped chocolate. Stir until all pieces are melted. Stir in vanilla. Strain into a large bowl, then either cover surface with plastic wrap or divide into individual cups and cover. Refrigerate until cold, about 2 hours. Serve with shipped cream or whipped topping, dusted with cocoa, if desired.

Pumpkin Pie Parfait
Makes 4 (8 oz) servings

1 c heavy cream, cold
2 T + ⅓ c sugar, divided
1 t vanilla
4 oz cream cheese, softened
½ c canned pumpkin puree
½ t cinnamon
¼ t nutmeg
¼ t ginger
18-20 ginger snap cookies, broken into pieces

1. Pour heavy cream into a cold stainless steel bowl and beat with an electric mixer until it begins to thicken. Slowly add 2 T sugar and vanilla. Continue beating until cream forms soft peaks. Place in fridge.
2. In another large bowl, beat cream cheese. Slowly add ⅓ c sugar; mix until smooth. Add pumpkin, cinnamon, nutmeg, and ginger until combined. Gently fold in ⅓ portion of the whipped cream into the pumpkin mixture.
3. Assemble the parfaits by layering the broken cookies, pumpkin mixture and whipped cream. Repeat once or twice depending on the size of the glass. Garnish with cookie crumbs, if desired.

(Yields 1 ½ c pumpkin filling plus 1 ½ c whipped cream.)

Baked Apples – over coals or in oven

1 baking apple per person (Golden Delicious, Rome, etc.)
Brown sugar
Raisins
Chopped nuts
Cinnamon
Butter
Heavy-duty aluminum foil

Peel top half of apple and core. Place apple in center of large piece of foil. Fill cored center of apple with brown sugar, raisins, nuts, and cinnamon. Place 1 t butter on top of the apple. Seal the apple in the foil, making sure no liquid or steam can escape. Place foil on the coals, turning occasionally. It will take about 20-30 minutes for the apple to cook.

Caramels (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes about 117 1x1 inch caramels

1 c butter
2 c sugar
2 c light corn syrup
2 c heavy whipping cream, divided
2 t vanilla

1. Combine butter, sugar, corn syrup, and 1 c whipping cream in a large heavy stockpot. Cook over medium-low heat, stirring gently, until sugar dissolves.
2. Turn heat to medium and cook until candy thermometer reaches 224 degrees F., stirring occasionally. Stir in the remaining 1 c whipping cream. Continue to cook over medium heat until thermometer registers 245 degrees F. Add vanilla.
3. Pour mixture into greased 9x13 pan (or line with wax paper to make it easier to remove and clean up). Cool overnight and then cut into squares. Wrap individually in wax paper.

**For fun variation, dip cooled caramels halfway or entirely in melted chocolate and cool on wax paper sprayed with cooking spray.

NO-BAKE PEANUT BUTTER CUPS (from *melskitchencafe.com* via Sarah Reimschussel)
yield: 12 PEANUT BUTTER CUPS prep time: 1 HR 20 MINS

<u>Chocolate Mixture:</u>
1/3 cup (75 g) coconut oil
1/3 cup (85 g) peanut butter (natural or creamy - see note)
1/3 cup pure maple syrup (see note)
1/3 cup (28 g) cocoa powder, natural, dark or Dutch-process
1/2 teaspoon vanilla extract
Pinch salt
3/4 cup (64 g) unsweetened shredded coconut or quick oats (see note)
<u>PB Mixture:</u>
1/3 cup (85 g) peanut butter (natural or creamy - see note)
1 tablespoon pure maple syrup
1/2 to 1 tablespoon coconut oil

1. Line a 12-cup muffin tin with muffin liners.
2. For the chocolate mixture, in a medium microwave-safe bowl, add the coconut oil, peanut butter, maple syrup, and cocoa powder. Microwave for 30-45 seconds, stir, and continue cooking in 20 second intervals until the mixture is melted and smooth.
3. Stir in the vanilla, salt and coconut (the mixture may be runny; that's ok). Scoop the mixture evenly into the bottom of the muffin liners. Refrigerate while making the peanut butter topping.
4. For the peanut butter mixture, in a small microwave-safe bowl, add the peanut butter, maple syrup and coconut oil. Microwave until melted and smooth (don't over heat).
5. Scoop the peanut butter mixture on the top of the chocolate mixture (it's ok if the chocolate layer isn't fully set up).
6. Refrigerate until set up, about an hour. Keep refrigerated and serve chilled.

***Microwave Caramel Popcorn** (from Lisa's Freshman roommate, Teresa)

¼ c corn syrup
1 c brown sugar
¼ t salt
½ c (1 stick) margarine
½ t baking soda
1 batch of popcorn, popped

1. Combine first 4 ingredients in medium glass bowl. Microwave 3 minutes on high. Stir. Microwave 1 minute. Stir, then add baking soda. Stir 1 minute or until a creamy brown sugar.
2. Pour over popcorn in a brown paper sack. Stir with 2 forks to spread caramel evenly. Cook 50 seconds in paper bag (may need to roll edges down so it fits in the microwave). Shake bag well. Pour into bowl. Let cool and eat.

***I like to leave it in the bag for awhile after cooking so that it is easy to shake it occasionally while it cools. This breaks it up so that it doesn't cool into a big chunk.*

DRINKS

SMOOTHIES, SLUSHES, MILKSHAKES, & ICES

Smoothie Recipes
(from April 2005 Family Fun Magazine)

*Purple Mango
1 cup pineapple juice
½ cup orange juice
1 cup frozen blueberries
1 cup cubed frozen mango

Cherry Vanilla
1 cup apple juice
½ cup low-fat vanilla yogurt
1 t vanilla extract
1 ½ c frozen pitted cherries

*Pineapple Crush (my favorite)
½ c orange juice
½ c pineapple juice
1 c frozen pineapple chunks
½ frozen very ripe medium banana

Pink Banana
1 c apple juice
2 oz soft silken tofu (about ¼ c)
[maybe substitute yogurt?]
1 c frozen strawberries
1 frozen very ripe banana

Smoothie Recipes (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")

Honeydew Almond
2 c chopped honeydew
1 c almond milk
1 c ice
honey to taste

Grape
2 c red grapes
1 c concord grape juice
1 ½ c ice

Lemon Poppy Seed
2 t poppy seeds
zest & juice of ½ lemon
1 c plain yogurt
⅓ c sugar
½ c milk
½ c ice

Kiwi Strawberry
1 c strawberries
2 kiwis
2 T sugar
2 c ice

Peach Mango Banana
1 c each peaches & mango
1 c plain yogurt
1 c ice
½ banana
sugar to taste

Creamy Melon
½ chopped cantaloupe
1 pint vanilla frozen yogurt
½ c milk

Smoothie Recipes (from Good Housekeeping July/August 2020)

Razzle-Dazzle Smoothie
Serves 1
½ c low-fat milk
½ c nonfat Greek yogurt
2 c frozen raspberries
2 bananans, cut into pieces and frozen

Mango Madness Smoothie
Serves 1
1 c orange juice
½ c coconut yogurt
1 ½ c frozen mango
1 medium carrot, coarsely grated

Strawberry Fields Smoothie
Serves 1
½ c coconut water
½ c coconut yogurt
1 c strawberries
½ c frozen peaches

Green Machine Smoothie
Serves 1
1 c unsweetened almond milk
1 ½ bananas, cut into pieces and frozen
3 c baby spinach
2 T almond butter
2 pitted dates
2 T chia seeds

Pineapple-Cucumber Smoothie (from Good Housekeeping, July/Aug 2021, p. 108)
Serves 2

1 Persian cucumber, chopped
1 frozen banana, halved
1 c frozen pineapple chunks
1 c baby spinach
½ c plain Greek yogurt
¼ c unsweetened almond milk or water

Peach-Mango Smoothie (from Good Housekeeping, July/Aug 2021, p. 108)
Serves 2

1 c frozen sliced peaches
1 c frozen mango chunks
½ c plain Greek yogurt
⅓ c coconut water

Key Lime-Banana Smoothie
1 container (6 oz) Key Lime Pie yogurt
1 ripe banana, sliced
½ c milk
1 T lime juice
¼ t dry lemon-lime flavored soft drink mix
1 c vanilla frozen yogurt

1. In blender, place all ingredients except frozen yogurt. Cover; blend on high speed until smooth.
2. Add frozen yogurt. Cover; blend until smooth.

Oatmeal Peach Smoothie
1 c low-fat milk or almond milk
½ c quick oats
1 c frozen sliced peaches
dash of almond or vanilla extract
1 T honey, plus more for drizzling
dash of cinnamon, plus more for serving

Combine all ingredients in a blender and puree until smooth and frothy. Pour into a glass; drizzle with honey and sprinkle with cinnamon. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Tangy Fruit "Shakes"
makes 2 servings

1 medium banana
½ c quartered strawberries
½ c pineapple or mango cut into chunks
¾ c orange juice
1 c ice

Put all ingredients into blender; puree until very smooth and thick

Fresh Lemon Slush (from Provost Science Fair 2008)

½ c lemon juice
½ c sugar
1 c water
1 t grated lemon peel
2 c ice cubes

Blend together. Yum!

Brazilian Lemonade (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Serves 4-6

1 cup sugar
6 cups cold water
4 juicy limes (smooth, thin-skinned limes are the juiciest and least bitter)
6 T sweetened condensed milk

1. Mix cold water and sugar very well and chill until ready to use. This step can be done ahead of time.
2. Wash limes thoroughly with soap. (You need the soap to get the wax and pesticides off the limes because you're using the whole lime.) Cut the ends off the limes and then cut each lime into eighths.
3. Place half of the limes in your blender. Add half of the sugar water, place the lid on your blender and pulse 5 times.
4. Place a fine-mesh strainer over a pitcher (the one you'll serve the lemonade in) and pour the blended mixture through the strainer and into the pitcher. Use a spoon to press the rest of the liquid into the pitcher. Dump the pulp and residue in the strainer into the trash. Repeat with remaining limes and sugar water.
5. Whisk in sweetened condensed milk.
6. Serve immediately over lots of ice. This does not keep well, so while you can mix the sugar and water ahead of time and slice the limes, don't mix them in the blender until you are ready to serve.

Mango-Buttermilk Shakes (from *Southern Living*, February 2015, p. 107)
Makes 3 cups

4 c frozen diced mango
1 c buttermilk
1 T sugar
½ t vanilla extract

Process in blender until smooth. Add up to 2/3 c more buttermilk, 1 T at a time, until desired consistency is reached.

Optional: stir in ½ t ground cardamom, if desired. (*I felt like it stole the show, but Mckay liked it. I thought the mild creaminess was nice without the zing.)*

Blackberry-Coconut Shake
serves 4

1 ½ c low-fat coconut ice cream or sorbet
1 c low-fat (1%) milk of unsweetened rice milk
1 small banana, peeled, sliced, and frozen
1 ½ c (6-7 oz) fresh blackberries
2 T shredded coconut, for garnish

In a blender, combine ice cream or sorbet, milk, banana, and all but 8 blackberries. Puree until thick and smooth. Divide mixture among cold glasses. Sprinkle with shredded coconut, garnish with reserved blackberries, and serve immediately.

***Banana Milkshake** (Uncle Scott's recipe)

1 frozen banana (previously peeled)
1 c milk
1 t vanilla
⅓ c sugar
2 T orange juice

***Orange Julius**
makes 4 servings

1 c milk
3 T orange juice concentrate
¼ t vanilla
¼ c sugar
10 ice cubes

Blend milk, concentrate, vanilla, and sugar in blender. Add ice cubes one at a time.

Strawberry Granita
Makes 8 servings

2 c water
1 ½ c sugar
2 lbs frozen strawberries
2 T balsamic vinegar
1 lime, for zest strips (optional)

In a saucepan, bring first two ingredients to a boil to create a simple syrup, allow to cool. Puree syrup, strawberries and vinegar in a blender until smooth. Pour into roasting pan or freezer-safe casserole dish. Freeze for 1 hour. Stir mixture with fork until it looks like shaved ice. Continue to freeze and repeat stirring process twice more at 30 minute intervals. Serve in martini glass with sliced strawberries and 1 lime cut into fine strips or zest for garnish, if desired.

Smoothie recipes (from Eleanor's ward Enrichment meeting)

Dannon Smoothie
1 c Dannon Light n' Fit Vanilla Yogurt
½ c juice (orange, cranberry, grapefruit, pineapple)
½ c diced fruit (bananas, peaches, blueberries, strawberries)
½ c ice cubes

Lemon Louie
2 c lemonade
1 c lemon yogurt
1 ½ c frozen pineapple chunks
1 c pineapple sherbet

Pour all liquid ingredients into the blender. Add all frozen ingredients. Blend at MIX setting for 30 seconds then blend at SMOOTH setting until smooth. While the machine is running, move the stir stick around counter-clockwise to aid mixing. Serve immediately. Each recipe serves 3-5.

Peach Refresher
2 c peach nectar or apple juice
1 c vanilla frozen yogurt
½ banana
1 c peach yogurt
1 ½ c frozen peach slices

Pour all liquid ingredients into the blender. Add all frozen ingredients. Blend at MIX setting for 30 seconds then blend at SMOOTH setting until smooth. While the machine is running, move the stir stick around counter-clockwise to aid mixing. Serve immediately. Each recipe serves 3-5.

Banana Split Smoothie
1 c milk
1 ½ c frozen banana slices
½ c pineapple chunks
5 frozen strawberries
1 ½-2T sweetened cocoa powder (to taste)

Raspberry Cream
1 c orange juice
1 c raspberry yogurt
1 c vanilla frozen yogurt
½ frozen banana
1 ½ c frozen raspberries.

Pour all liquid ingredients into the blender. Add all frozen ingredients. Blend at MIX setting for 30 seconds then blend at SMOOTH setting until smooth. While the machine is running, move the stir stick around counter-clockwise to aid mixing. Serve immediately. Each recipe serves 3-5.

Mango Tango
1 c pineapple juice
1 c orange juice
½ frozen banana
1 c pineapple sherbet
1 ½ c frozen mango slices.

Pour all liquid ingredients into the blender. Add all frozen ingredients. Blend at MIX setting for 30 seconds then blend at SMOOTH setting until smooth. While the machine is running, move the stir stick around counter-clockwise to aid mixing. Serve immediately. Each recipe serves 3-5.

Fruit Smoothie
1 c fresh strawberries, sliced and hulled
20 oz pineapple chunks, drained
1 med banana
1 c skim milk
8 oz fat-free strawberry yogurt
¼ c honey
1 t lime juice

In food processor or blender, combine strawberries, pineapple chunks, bananas, milk, yogurt, honey, and lime juice. Process until smooth. Pour into glasses. 6 servings.

Strawberry Raspberry
1 ½ c orange juice
1 banana
1 c frozen strawberries
1 c frozen raspberries

Orange Banana
1 c orange juice
½ c plain or vanilla yogurt
1 ½ c frozen banana slices
Sprinkle of nutmeg (for top, optional)

Blackberry
¾ c apple juice
½ c plain yogurt
1 ½ c frozen blackberries or boysenberries
1 banana

Apricot Peach
1 ½ c apricot nectar
1 ½ c frozen peaches

Pina colada
1 ½ c pineapple juice
1/3 c coconut milk
½ c frozen pineapple chunks
1 T shredded unsweetened coconut (optional)

Chocolate Banana
1 c milk
3-4 T chocolate syrup
1 ½ c frozen banana slices
¼ t cinnamon (optional)

Peanut Butter Banana
1 c milk
¼ c peanut butter
1 ½ c frozen banana slices

Blueberry Banana
½ c milk
½ c vanilla yogurt
1 banana
1 ½ c frozen blueberries

Orange Razz
1 c orange juice
1 c frozen raspberries
1 c frozen vanilla yogurt

100% Fruit Smoothie

2 navel oranges, peeled & chunked
1 c frozen raspberries
1 c frozen blueberries

Puree until smooth and serve immediately.

Pumpkin Pie Milkshake
Makes 2

1/3 c pumpkin puree
¼-1/2 c milk
¾ t vanilla
½ t cinnamon
1/16 t ground cloves
1/16 t nutmeg
2 T brown sugar
2 c vanilla ice cream
1-2 graham crackers

Put everything but the graham crackers into the blender. Start with ¼ c milk and slowly add more if needed to make the blender process it all. Sprinkle crushed graham crackers on top before serving.

***Pumpkin Pleaser** (*Blendtec* recipe)

¾ c orange juice (for less citrus taste, substitute milk for part or all the orange juice)
1 c low-fat vanilla yogurt
1 c pumpkin puree
1 t pumpkin pie spice
2 bananas, quartered and frozen
1 c ice cubes

Add ingredients to WildSide Jar and secure lid. Select "Smoothie" and serve.

(For a Cranberry Orange Smoothie, substitute the pumpkin puree and pumpkin pie spice with 1 c cranberries and 1 t vanilla extract.)

***Chocolate Peanut Butter Smoothie** (*Blendtec* recipe)

½ c milk
1 ½ T peanut butter
1 T honey
½ T cocoa powder
1 banana
1 c ice cubes

Add ingredients to FourSide Jar in the order listed and secure the lid. Select "Sauces" and serve.

After-School Strawberry Shake
Makes 3 servings

1 pint strawberries, stemmed
2 medium bananas
3 c ice cubes, divided
½ c nonfat strawberry or plain yogurt
½ c orange juice
2 T honey

Place all ingredients except 1 ½ c ice in blender; blend on high speed until smooth, scraping down occasionally. Add remaining ice; continue to blend until smooth. Serve in tall glasses.

Mango-Pineapple Sorbet (from "Our Best Bites – Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes about 3 cups
3 c diced mango (about 3 medium mangoes)
¾ c sugar
¼ c fresh lime juice
1 (8 oz) can crushed pineapple, including juice

1. In a food processor (or good blender), puree the mangoes (Maybe puree the pineapple too? The kids didn't like the chunks). Add the sugar and lime juice and process to combine. Transfer to a bowl and stir pineapple in with the juice.
2. Pour the mixture into an ice cream maker and freeze according to the manufacturer's instructions for about 30 minutes or until the sorbet is frozen (but still soft). Transfer to an airtight container and freeze until ready to serve.
3. To serve the following day, set out on counter for about 15 minutes to soften.

Berry Good Slush

1 c low fat vanilla yogurt, divided
½ c applesauce, divided
1 c Libby's Juicy Juice, Berry – divided
2 whole strawberries (optional)

1. Spoon half of each ingredient into sandwich size Ziploc bags. Seal and Shake to mix.
2. FREEZE bags for about 35 minutes or until slushy. Spoon into 2 glasses. Garnish with strawberries; serve. Makes 2 servings.

Dole Sunrise Smoothie (from Disneyland's Tiki Room)
Makes 4 servings

1 c pineapple juice
1 c vanilla yogurt
1 c frozen strawberries, partially thawed
2 ripe, medium bananas, peeled

Combine all ingredients in blender and blend until smooth.

Mango Lassi (Family Fun magazine, February 2007)
Makes 2-3 large servings

1 ripe mango, peeled and cut into 1-inch chunks (about 1 cup)
½ c plain, whole milk yogurt
½ c milk
1 T sugar
10 ice cubes
(We usually add a pinch of ground cardamom.)

Place all ingredients in a blender and process on high about 1 minute. Serve immediately.

Spinach Smoothie
serves 2

In blender, puree:
2 c baby spinach
2 c coconut water or milk
1 c banana
1 c frozen mango
1 c frozen pineapple

Green Smoothie Recipe – adapted from Erin Eastland's recipe

1 ½ c water
½ c yogurt (vanilla, plain, or Greek – if more sugar add less sweetener)
1/8 c agave nectar (unless very sweet yogurt)
Optional add-ins: ¼ whole lemon, including peel; 2-3 T fresh flax oil; 1 T coconut oil; ½ avocado

1. Add water, yogurt and greens (spinach, kale, etc) to the 3 ½ c line. Puree 90 seconds until very smooth.
2. Add frozen fruit to fill blender and puree.

Easy Watermelon Granita *Refreshing!*
Fill blender with ⅔ watermelon, ⅓ ice, and 1-2 T lime juice. Blend and enjoy.

Watermelon Granita

¼ whole seedless watermelon, cut into chunks (about 4 cups)
1 whole lime, juiced
⅛ c (2T + 2t) sugar

Place watermelon, lime juice, and sugar in a blender. Process until smooth, and then pour into an 8x8 baking dish. Freeze for 2-3 hours, and then begin the process of lightly scraping the top, frozen layer. Return pan to freezer with the shaved ice on top; remove a couple of hours later and continue scraping. Repeat the occasional scraping process until the entire mixture is shaved. Store, covered in plastic wrap, until serving. Serve in pretty glasses with a twist of lime.

Fruit Slush (from Taste of Home Simple & Delicious Cookbook, p. 102)
6-8 servings

3 c water
1 c sugar
1 can (20 oz) crushed pineapple, undrained
1 can (6 oz) frozen orange juice concentrate, thawed
1 medium ripe peach, chopped OR 2/3 c slices frozen peaches, thawed and chopped

In a large saucepan over medium heat, bring water and sugar to a boil. Remove from the heat. Cool for 10 minutes. Add the pineapple, orange juice concentrate and peach; stir well. Pour into a freezer container; freeze for at least 12 hours or overnight. May be frozen for up to 3 months. Remove from freezer one hour before serving.

Frozen Lemonade Slushy
In blender: 1 c fresh lemon juice, sugar to taste (up to ½ c), ice cubes and chilled water "to the fill line"; blend until slushy. For variation add some strawberries or mint to the blender.

Peach Icee

1 (29 oz) can sliced peaches in heavy syrup
6 c crushed ice
4 T sugar
2 T lemon juice
½ c apple juice or any favorite juice

Puree sliced peaches, lemon juice, apple juice and sugar. Add crushed ice and blend until smooth.

Raspberry Lime Slush (from Taste of Home Simple & Delicious Cookbook, p. 194)
6 servings

¾ c sugar
2 cups water, divided
1 c fresh or frozen raspberries, thawed
½ c lime juice
3 c ginger ale, chilled

1. In a small saucepan, combine sugar and ½ c water. Cook and stir over high heat until sugar is completely dissolved. Remove from the heat. Press raspberries through a sieve; discard seeds.
2. In a large bowl, combine the raspberry puree, sugar syrup, lime juice and remaining water. Transfer to a 1-qt freezer container. Cover and freeze for 12 hours, stirring occasionally. May be frozen for up to 3 months.
3. To serve, combine the raspberry mixture and ginger ale in a 2 qt pitcher. Or for one serving, combine ½ c raspberry mixture and ½ c ginger ale in a glass.

Lemon Ice Cubes

Freeze fresh lemons and put juice in ice cube trays (add lemon zest for tanginess). When frozen, you can store them in a plastic bag in the freezer. Drop in water or another beverage for added flavor.

Amount of water per 1 cup of fruit:

Honeydew	5 oz	Mango	4 oz	Nectarines	4 oz
Peaches	5 oz	Pineapple	4 oz	Tomato	3 oz
Strawberries	5 oz	Papaya	4 oz	Raspberries	3 oz
Watermelon	5 oz	Blueberries	4 oz		

SODAS, PUNCHES, & WARM DRINKS

Lemon Water (from Josi Kilpack's *Wedding Cake*, p. 188)
Makes 2 quarts

6 c water
1 c white sugar
1 t lemon extract
1 t citric acid**
1 ½-2 c ice

Mix the first four ingredients until sugar is dissolved, about a minute. Before serving, add ice and stir.
**If you leave out the citric acid, reduce sugar to ½ cup.

Homemade Lemonade
Heat 1 c sugar and 1 c water in sauce pan until sugar dissolves. Add 1 c fresh lemon juice to the syrup. Then add 3-4 c cold water. Serve garnished with lemon slices, if desired.

Classic Lemonade

8 c water
1 c sugar
1 c freshly squeezed lemon juice (from about 12 lemons)

In a saucepan over medium-high heat, combine water and sugar and bring to a simmer. Cook, stirring, until the sugar dissolves, about 2 minutes. Refrigerate until cold. Combine the chilled sugar water and lemon juice in a pitcher and stir well. Pour into tall, ice-filled glasses to serve.

Variations:
Watermelon Lemonade
Puree seedless watermelon and freeze in ice cube trays. Chill your classic lemonade with the watermelon cubes for an infusion of sweet melon flavor.
Cucumber & Herb Lemonade
Before you make the classic lemonade, muddle the sugar with mint, thyme and basil. Proceed as instructed with the herb-infused sugar. Garnish each glass with thin slices of cucumber (in the glass).
Limeade
Simply substitute lime juice for the lemon juice (in the classic lemonade recipe). For an even more interesting twist, make a sweet-and-salty limeade by stirring in a pinch of salt (1/16 t) to a glass just before serving. This version is especially popular in hot climates because a little salt makes the drink even more refreshing. (Similar to a sports drink, the sodium helps balance the body's electrolytes.

***Grandma Juice** (Sister Wishart's secret recipe)
makes about 10 regular size water bottles

2 Great Value brand "energy peach/mango" individual size drink mix packets
1 Great Value brand "orange early rise" 2 qt size packet
½ bottle Mango Peach V8 Juice
2 liters Orange Soda (any brand)

Mix powdered drink packets as per package directions. Then combine all ingredients together and pour into individual serving bottles.

Sister Wishart made this for her grandson when he was 12 years old and was playing in a tournament. They were in a hurry to leave, so she threw whatever she had in the cupboard together to make a drink for him. He wanted it at every game thereafter.

His brother liked it too, and eventually, when he was playing volleyball at BYU, his teammates started asking for it. She made some for the entire team for every game -- home or away for 4 years; then another 4 years for the other grandson; and even a few more years after her grandson wasn't playing at BYU anymore!

***Horchata**
Makes 6 servings

1 c rice
1 c water
4 c milk
½ c sugar
1 t vanilla
½ t cinnamon

Place rice in a bowl with enough hot water to cover. Let sit overnight on counter. The next day, remove water. Place rice, ½ c fresh water, & 2 c milk in blender. Blend until ground. Add sugar, vanilla, & cinnamon. Add remaining milk and water. Blend. Strain through cheesecloth. Serve chilled.

Instant Horchata (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")
Sweeten a pitcher of rice milk with sugar, then add a pinch of cinnamon.

Easy Maple Horchata (from *Good Housekeeping* Jan/Feb 2021, p. 108)
5 minutes to prepare - serves 1

Whisk together 1 c unsweetened rice milk, 1 t each maple syrup and pure vanilla extract and ¼ t ground cinnamon. Serve over ice and sprinkle with more cinnamon.

Celebration Punch

1 6 oz can lemonade concentrate, thawed
1 15 oz pkg reduced-sugar strawberries, thawed
12 oz sparkling white grape juice

Combine the lemonade concentrate, strawberries, and sparkling white grape juice in a blender. Whirl until smooth. Pour into punch cups and serve immediately.

Orange Blossom Punch
Serves 12

3 c orange juice
1 10 oz can frozen strawberry or peach daiquiri mix concentrate, thawed
2 c cold water
1 750 ml bottle sparkling white grape juice, chilled
Ice cubes

1. In a punch bowl, combine orange juice and thawed concentrate
2. Add 2 c cold water
3. Stir to combine
4. Gently add grape juice, but do not stir
5. If desired, garnish with strawberries and orange wedges

Icy Holiday Punch (*From December 2016 Taste of Home Magazine)*

1 pkg (6 oz) cherry Jell-o
¾ c sugar
2 c boiling water
1 can (46 oz) unsweetened pineapple juice
6 c cold water
2 liters ginger ale, chilled

1. Dissolve 1st 3 ingredients. Stir in pineapple juice and cold water. Freeze overnight.
2. Remove 2 hours before serving. Place in punchbowl; stir in ginger ale just before serving.

Quick Cranberry Punch

1 can (6 oz) frozen pink lemonade concentrate, thawed
1 bottle (32 oz) cranberry juice cocktail, chilled
2 cans (12 oz each) ginger ale, chilled

In large pitcher, make lemonade as directed on can. Stir cranberry juice cocktail and enough ice to chill. Just before serving, stir in ginger ale.

Raspberry Punch (Crowd Sized)

4 pkgs (10 oz each) frozen raspberries, thawed and undrained
1 can (6 oz)frozen lemonade concentrate, thawed
1 bottle (2 l) ginger ale, chilled

Cook raspberries in large pot over medium heat for 10 minutes, stirring frequently; cool slightly. Push through strainer with large spoon to remove seeds. Refrigerate raspberry juice at least 2 hours. In punch bowl or large pitcher, mix raspberry juice and lemonade concentrate. Stir in ginger ale. Serve immediately over ice.

Slow Cooker Spiced Cranberry-Apple Cider

⅓ c packed brown sugar
2 t whole allspice
4 sticks cinnamon (3 inch)
1 bottle (48 oz) apple cider (6 cups)
1 bottle (48 oz) cranberry juice cocktail (6 cups)

1. In 4-5 quart slow cooker, mix all ingredients. Cover; cook on low heat setting 4-6 hours. Before serving, remove allspice and cinnamon.

**Fresh orange slices add a pretty touch of color to this ruby-red drink. Add them to cider in slow cooker just before serving.

Cranberry Citrus Warmer

32 oz cranberry juice cocktail
2 c orange juice
½ c honey
½ c lemon juice
½ c lime juice
3 whole cloves
2 cinnamon sticks
32 oz ginger ale

1. In large saucepan or pot combine all ingredients except ginger ale. Over medium heat, simmer about 15 minutes to blend flavors. Remove spices with a spoon.
2. Just before serving, add ginger ale; heat through. Serve hot. Garnish as desired.

Sunkist Sunset (for diet, substitute sugar free/diet ingredients)

½ c cranberry juice cocktail
½ c Country Time Lemonade
½ t Rose's brand Grenadine
1 c ice cold Sunkist orange soda
1 lemon wedge for garnish

Make decorative ice cubes, half with the cranberry juice and half with the lemonade (approximately 16 cubes). Spoon the grenadine syrup into a 12 oz glass so it drips down to create the "Sunset". Alternately place 4 each of each flavor of ice cubes in the glass, slowly pour the orange soda over the cubes and garnish with a lemon wedge.

Hot Cranberry Punch (from 6th ward enrichment)

8 c hot water
1 ½ c sugar
4 c cranberry juice concentrate
¾ c orange juice concentrate
½ c lemon juice
½ c red hot candies

In a 5 quart slow cooker, combine water, sugar, and juices. Stir until sugar is dissolved. Add red hot candies. Cover and cook on low for 2-3 hours, or until heated through. Stir before serving.

A&W Root Beer

¾ c granulated sugar
¾ c hot water
1 l cold seltzer water
½ t plus 1/8 t root beer concentrate
(McCormick is best)

Dissolve the sugar in hot water. Add the root beer concentrate and let cool. Combine the root beer mixture with cold seltzer water, drink immediately, or store in fridge in tightly covered container. Makes 5 cups.

***Homemade Rootbeer** (This is our favorite root beer recipe)
½ of this recipe fits perfectly in our 3 gallon orange Gott.

6 c white sugar
3 1/3 gallons cold water
1 (2 oz) bottle root beer extract (McCormick is the only one that tastes right)
4 lbs dry ice

Combine water and sugar in large cooler. Stir to dissolve sugar completely. Stir in the root beer extract, then carefully place dry ice in and cover loosely with lid (if sealed too tightly, pressure will build up). Let the mixture brew an hour before serving. Leftover root beer can be stored in gallon milk jugs.

Sugarless Hot Chocolate Mix

Put two 30 serving containers of Nestle's sugarfree Quik into a large bowl. (You could substitute the same amount of regular Quik if you don't care about the sugar.) Add one twenty quart box of instant non-fat dry milk. Mix well. Store in air-tight containers.

To drink: Heat one mug of water. Add 1/3 cup (+/-) of mix and stir well.

No fat, no sugar, and plenty of calcium.

Melinda's French Chocolate (from Josi Kilpack's *Devil's Food*)
serves 8

1 jar (16 oz) hot fudge sauce
1 pint whipping cream
¼ c powdered sugar
1 t vanilla
3 quarts milk, heated

Heat hot fudge in microwave til warm and thin enough to pour, but not too hot. In mixing bowl, whip cream; add powdered sugar and vanilla when cream begins to thicken. When cream is at soft-peak stage, slowly add hot fudge sauce, continuing to whip together. Serve by spooning desired amount of French chocolate mixture into a mug and adding heated milk. Stir til combined.

Luscious Hot Chocolate (From *LDS Living* Magazine, Nov/Dec 2008)

1 c milk
1 c half and half
1 oz semisweet chocolate, chopped
1 oz unsweetened chocolate, chopped
8 t sugar
½ t vanilla

Heat all ingredients except vanilla in a saucepan on medium-low heat until chocolates melt and sugar dissolves. Pour half of the mixture into a blender and mix until frothy. Return to the saucepan and add vanilla. Stir briefly and serve.

Hot Vanilla (instead of Hot Cocoa)
makes 6 drinks

6 c milk, divided
12 t sugar, divided
1 T vanilla, divided
½ c whipping cream
1 T chocolate syrup (plus extra for drizzling)
dash of cinnamon (plus extra for garnishing)

For each hot vanilla, microwave 1 c milk & 2 t sugar for 90 seconds. Stir in ½ t of vanilla extract. Top with a dollop of chocolate cream (recipe below), a drizzle of chocolate syrup, and a dash of cinnamon.

Topping: Whip whipping cream until frothy. Add chocolate syrup and a dash of cinnamon.

Old-fashioned Hot Cocoa with Homemade Marshmallows (From *LDS Living* Magazine, Nov/Dec 2008)

<u>Old-fashioned Hot Cocoa</u>
3 T unsweetened cocoa powder
¼ c sugar
4 c milk
¼ t vanilla

Combine sugar and cocoa powder in small bowl. Heat milk in saucepan to scalding. Stir 1/3 c hot milk into cocoa-sugar mixture, and then pour back into the saucepan. Stir until blended, then add vanilla and garnish with homemade marshmallows.

<u>Homemade Marshmallows</u>
3 T powdered gelatin
2 c cold water
2 c sugar
2 egg whites
2 ½ c confectioners' sugar, sifted
Butter

In a medium saucepan soak gelatin in the cold water for approximately 10 minutes. When gelatin has softened, add the regular sugar and gently dissolve over low heat. Remove from the heat and cool to room temperature.

Beat egg whites until stiff peaks form and then fold in 2 c of sifted confectioners' sugar. Put mixer on low speed and slowly add cooled gelatin mixture. Increase the speed and beat until white and thick, and the mixture is approximately double in size.

Line a deep 8x8 inch baking dish with foil, grease slightly with butter, and coat with part of the remaining confectioners' sugar. Pour marshmallow mixture in and top with more sifted confectioners' sugar. Let sit for at least 3 hours. The marshmallow should be light and spongy when ready.

Loosen marshmallow from edges of tray and invert onto large cutting board. Slowly remove foil and use a large knife to cut the marshmallows into cubes. Dredge each piece in confectioners' sugar.

Raspberry Hot Chocolate (From *LDS Living* Magazine, Nov/Dec 2008)

2 c cream
1 c milk
2 T sugar
½ t salt
6 oz bittersweet chocolate, finely chopped
1 T butter
1 c raspberries
Whipped cream

In saucepan combine cream, milk, sugar, and salt until hot, but do not boil. Add chocolate and butter and reduce heat to simmer. Stir until chocolate is melted. Puree 1 c raspberries and pour into the mixture, stirring until smooth. Pour into mugs and garnish with whipped cream and fresh raspberries.

White Peppermint Hot Chocolate (From *LDS Living* Magazine, Nov/Dec 2008)

6 hard peppermint candies, finely crushed
2/3 c whipping cream
3 ½ c milk
8 oz white chocolate, chopped
½ t peppermint extract

Beat cream with crushed candies until stiff peaks form. Refrigerate at least one hour. In the meantime, heat milk on medium-low heat. Mix in chocolate and whisk until smooth. Add peppermint extract and stir thoroughly. Pour into cups and top with peppermint whip cream mixture.

Peanut Butter Hot Chocolate (From *LDS Living* Magazine, Nov/Dec 2008)

4 squares baker's chocolate
2 c milk
2 T peanut butter
Marshmallows

Break chocolate squares and melt in saucepan with milk. Do not boil. Stir in peanut butter until mixture is smooth. Pour into mugs and garnish with marshmallows.

Ways to dress up cocoa (From *LDS Living* Magazine, Nov/Dec 2008)

1. Get richer flavor by using milk instead of water or for extra rich, put a teaspoon of sweet butter in bottom of mug.
2. Garnish with cream and sprinkles or powder.
3. Moisten rim and dip in crushed candies or colored sugars.

ENTREES

ALL-INCLUSIVE MEALS

***Pizza Margherita** (Cooks Illustrated, July and August 2006, p. 11)
Makes 2 12-inch pizzas

Dough
1 ¼ t instant yeast
1 c water, room temperature
1 ¾ c unbleached all-purpose flour
1 c cake flour (*I used ALL all-purpose*)
1 ½ t table salt
2 t sugar

Topping
1 28 oz can diced tomatoes
½ t sugar
1 small garlic clove, minced or pressed through garlic press (optional)
¼ c chopped fresh basil leaves
Table salt
4 oz fresh mozzarella, cut into 1 inch chunks
2 t extra-virgin olive oil

1. FOR THE CRUST: Adjust oven rack to lowest position, set pizza stone on oven rack, and heat oven to 500 degrees. (*Since the dough must rise first, don't heat the oven until after rising*!) In liquid measuring cup, whisk yeast into water to dissolve. In food processor fitted with metal blade, process flours, salt, and sugar until combined, about 5 seconds. With machine running, slowly add liquid through feed tube; continue to process until dough forms satiny, sticky ball that clears sides of workbowl, 1 ½ to 2 minutes. (If after 1 minute dough is sticky and clings to blade, add 1 to 2 tablespoons flour and continue processing. If dough appears dry and crumbly, add 1 to 2 tablespoons water and process until dough forms ball.) Divide dough in half and shape into 2 smooth, tight balls. Place on floured counter or baking sheet, spacing them at least 3 inches apart; cover loosely with plastic wrap coated with nonstick cooking spray and let rise until doubled in volume, about 1 hour.
2. FOR THE TOPPING: In clean bowl of food processor, process tomatoes until crushed, two or three 1-second pulses. Transfer tomatoes to fine-mesh strainer set over bowl and let drain at least 30 minutes, stirring occasionally to release liquids. Just before shaping pizzas, combine drained tomatoes, sugar, garlic (if using), 1 T basil, and ¼ t salt in bowl.
3. TO SHAPE AND COOK THE PIZZAS: When dough balls have doubled in size, dust dough liberally with flour and transfer balls to well-floured work surface. Press one ball into 8-inch disk. Using flattened palms, gently stretch disk into 12-inch circle, working along outer edge and giving disk quarter turns. Lightly flour pizza peel; lift edges of dough round to brush off any excess flour, then transfer dough to peel. Spread thin layer of tomato topping (about ½ cup) over dough with rubber spatula, leaving ½-inch border around edge. Slide onto stone and bake until crust begins to brown, about 5 minutes. Remove pizza from oven with peel, close oven door, and top pizza with half of cheese chunks, spaced evenly apart. Return pizza to stone and continue cooking until cheese is just melted, 4-5 minutes more. Transfer to cutting board; sprinkle with half of remaining basil, 1 t olive oil, and pinch of salt. Slice and serve immediately. Repeat step 3 to shape, top, and bake second pizza.

Thin-Crust Pizza (from *Cook's Illustrated*)
makes 2 13-inch pizzas

Dough
3 c (16.5 oz) bread flour, plus more for work surface
2 t sugar
½ t instant or rapid-rise yeast
1 ⅓ c (about 10.5 oz) ice water (*this helps prevent overheating the dough while in the food processor)*
1 T vegetable oil, plus more for work surface
1 ½ t table salt
Sauce
1 (28 oz) can whole peeled tomatoes, drained
1 T extra-virgin olive oil
1 t red wine vinegar
2 medium garlic cloves, minced
(about 2 t)
1 t table salt
1 t dried oregano
¼ t ground black pepper
Cheese
1 oz finely grated Parmesan cheese (about ½ c)
8 oz shredded whole-milk mozzarella (about 2 c)

1. FOR THE DOUGH: In a food processor fitted with metal blade, process flour, sugar, and yeast until combined, about 2 seconds. With machine running, slowly add water through feed tube; process until dough is just combined and no dry flour remains, about 10 seconds. Let dough stand 10 minutes.
2. Add oil and salt to dough and process until dough forms satiny, sticky ball that clears sides of workbowl, 30-60 seconds. Remove dough from bowl, knead briefly on lightly oiled countertop until smooth, about 1 minute. Shape dough into tight ball and place in large, lightly oiled bowl. Cover tightly with plastic wrap and refrigerate for at least 24 hours and up to 3 days.
3. FOR THE SAUCE: Process all ingredients in food processor until smooth, about 30 seconds. Transfer to medium bowl or container and refrigerate until ready to use.
4. TO BAKE THE PIZZA: One hour before baking pizza, adjust oven rack to second highest position (rack should be about 4-5 inches below broiler), set pizza stone on rack, and heat oven to 500 degrees. Remove dough from refrigerator and divide in half. Shape each half into smooth, tight ball. Place on lightly oiled baking sheet, spacing them at least 3 inches apart; cover loosely with plastic wrap coated with nonstick cooking spray; let stand for 1 hour.
5. Coat 1 ball of dough generously with flour and place on well-floured countertop. Using fingertips, gently flatten into 8-inch disk, leaving 1 inch of outer edge slightly thicker than center. Using hands, gently stretch disk into 12-inch round, working along edges and giving disk quarter turns as you stretch. Transfer dough to well-floured peel and stretch into 13-inch round. Using back of spoon or ladle, spread ½ c tomato sauce in thin layer over surface of dough, leaving ¼-inch border around edge. Sprinkle ¼ c parmesan evenly over sauce, followed by 1 c mozzarella. Slide pizza carefully onto stone and bake until crust is well browned and cheese is bubbly and beginning to brown, 10-12 minutes, rotating pizza halfway through. Remove pizza and place on wire rack for 5 minutes before slicing and serving. (Repeat step 5 to shape, top, and bake second pizza.)

Notes from Cook's Illustrated: additional toppings are always an option, but only if they're prepared correctly so they don't make the pizza soggy. If adding vegetables, aim for a maximum of 6 oz thinly sliced veggies per pizza, spread out in a single layer. If using mushrooms, they should be lightly sauteed or microwaved 1-2 minutes before using. Delicate leafy greens and herbs (like spinach and basil) are best placed beneath the cheese to protect them, or added raw to the fully cooked pizza. Use no more than 4 oz meat per pizza. Meat should be precooked and drained.

Homemade Pizza (by Trina Smith - *from RS $5 ward cookbook)*

1 package yeast in 3/4 cup warm water.
Mix 2 cups flour, 1 T. baking powder, 1/2 t. salt, 1/4 shortening

Add yeast and water mixture. Beat vigorously 2 minutes. Knead until smooth.
Spread on a greased pizza pan and top with sauce and pizza fixings.
Bake 425 degrees for 110-15 minutes.

Optional Homemade Sauce: 1 8 oz can tomato sauce, 1/4 c. water, 1/4 t. each of salt and pepper, 1/2 t. oregano, 1/2 t. basil, 2 t. finely chopped onion, 1 t. parsley, 1/8 t. minced garlic.

Bacon-Chicken Club Pizza – *This was <u>very</u> yummy!*

12 in (prebaked) pizza crust *(I've used naan bread or tortillas)*
4 oz cream cheese, softened
1 shallot, minced
2 c shredded rotisserie chicken
1 ½ c shredded Monterey Jack cheese
1 c shredded sharp cheddar cheese
8 slices ready to serve bacon, cut into 1 inch pieces
¼ c sour cream
3 T milk
2 t ranch salad dressing mix
1 c shredded lettuce
1 plum tomato, seeded and chopped

1. Preheat oven to 425. Combine cream cheese & shallot and spread over crust(s).
2. Top with chicken, cheeses, and bacon. Then bake @ 425 degrees until edges are lightly brown & cheese is melted, 12-15 minutes.
3. Combine sour cream, milk, and ranch mix.
4. sprinkle cooked pizzas with lettuce and tomatoes and drizzle with ranch dressing.

Caprese Waffles
Serves 4

1 c waffle mix, prepared according to pkg directions
¼ c grated pecorino
2 T olive oil
1 T red wine vinegar
¼ t salt
¼ t pepper
1 small shallot, finely chopped
1 lb mixed-color cherry tomatoes (halved)
4 oz salami (cut into small cubes)
¼ c fresh basil, torn
8 oz fresh mozzarella, torn

1. Fold pecorino into prepared waffle mix, then cook 2 waffles in waffle maker.
2. In bowl, whisk together olive oil, vinegar, salt, pepper, and shallot.
3. Toss vinegar mixture with tomatoes, salami, basil, and mozzarella.
4. Spoon over waffles.

Red and White Lasagna (from American Beauty lasagna noodle box)
10-12 servings

12 lasagna noodles
1 15 oz container ricotta cheese
1 10 oz package frozen chopped spinach, thawed and well drained
2 c (8 oz) shredded mozzarella cheese
½ c shredded Parmesan cheese, divided
2 eggs
1 lb Italian sausage or ground beef, cooked and drained
1 (26 oz) jar marinara pasta sauce
1 (16 oz) jar alfredo pasta sauce

1. Cook pasta according to package directions. Preheat oven to 350. In large bowl, combine ricotta cheese, spinach, mozzarella cheese, 2 T Parmesan cheese and eggs; mix well.
2. In a 15x9 pan, spread 1 c marinara sauce. Layer 4 lasagna noodles over sauce. Top with half cheese mixture, 1 c marinara sauce and all the cooked sausage. Layer 4 more lasagna noodles, remaining cheese mixture and remaining marinara sauce. Top with 4 remaining lasagna noodles. Spread Alfredo sauce evenly on top; sprinkle with remaining Parmesan cheese.
3. Cover; bake 40 minutes. Uncover, bake an additional 15 minutes or until hot and bubbly. Let stand 10 minutes before cutting.

Classic Meat Lasagna (from Family Circle Feb 2010, p. 201)
Makes 12 servings - Prep 30 minutes - Cook 43 minutes - Bake at 350 for 60 minutes

1 T olive oil
1 lrg onion, chopped
4 finely chopped garlic cloves
2 ¼ lbs ground meat loaf mix (beef, pork, and veal)
1 can (28 ½ oz) crushed tomatoes
1 can (15 ½ oz) crushed tomatoes
2 T tomato paste
1 t dried Italian seasoning
1 t sugar
1 t salt
¼ t black pepper
5 T chopped fresh basil
12 traditional lasagna noodles
1 container (15 oz) ricotta cheese
2 eggs
1/3 c shredded Parmesan cheese
3 c shredded mozzarella cheese
2 c shredded Italian cheese blend

1. Heat oil in large saucepan over medium heat. Add onion and garlic. Cook for 5 minutes, stirring occasionally.
2. Crumble in ground meat and cook for an additional 8 minutes, breaking up with a wooden spoon. Add tomatoes, tomato paste, Italian seasoning, sugar, salt and black pepper. Simmer with cover slightly ajar for 15 minutes, stirring occasionally. Uncover and simmer for 15 additional minutes. Stir in 3 T of the basil.
3. Meanwhile, cook lasagna noodles following package directions. Drain and rinse briefly under cold water. Heat oven to 350. Coat a 13x9x2 inch baking dish with cooking spray.
4. In a medium-size bowl, combine the ricotta cheese, eggs, Parmesan cheese, and remaining 2 T of basil. Set aside.
5. Spread 1 c of sauce over the bottom of the prepared baking dish. Place 3 cooked noodles over the sauce. Evenly spoon the ricotta mixture over the noodles. Top with 3 more noodles and 3 cups of the meat sauce. Layer 3 noodles over sauce, then sprinkle on shredded mozzarella. Top with the 3 remaining noodles and 2 c of the meat sauce.
6. Sprinkle shredded Italian cheese blend evenly over the last meat sauce layer and loosely cover with foil. Bake at 350 for 30 minutes. Uncover and bake for additional 30 minutes, until bubbly.
7. Cool 10 minutes before serving. Reheat extra sauce and serve on the side.

Per serving: 551 calories; 30 g fat (15 g sat); 37 g protein; 26 g carbs; 3 g fiber; 830 mg sodium; 142 mg cholesterol

Shortcut Basil Pesto Lasagna
serves 6 - takes 1 hour total

8 oz shredded mozzarella cheese
1 tub (5 oz) Shredded Parmesan Cheese
1 tub (15 oz) ricotta cheese
2 eggs
1 pkg (12 oz) frozen spinach, thawed and drained
2 jars (15 oz each) Basil Pesto Alfredo Cream Sauce, divided *(Smith's sells this in Private Selection brand)*
1 pkg oven ready lasagna noodles (approximately 15 noodles)
chopped, fresh parsley (optional)

1. Preheat oven to 37t. Coat 9x13 pan with cooking spray.
2. In medium bowl, combine mozzarella and Parmesan. In large bowl, beat ricotta, eggs and spinach until smooth. Add half shredded cheese mixture.
3. Spread 1 c alfredo sauce in bottom of dish. Lay 3 noodles overtop. (Noodles won't touch; they'll expand as they cook.) Top with 1 c spinach mixture and small handful shredded cheese. Then top with ½ c alfredo sauce, 3 more noodles, 1 c spinach mixture and handful shredded cheese. Repeat layering 2 more times. Top with noodles, remaining alfredo and remaining cheese.
4. Cover with foil; bake 25 minutes. Uncover; bake 15 minutes longer until lightly browned and bubbling at edges. Let rest 10 minutes before serving. Slice into squares, garnishing with parsley, if desired. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Vegetable Lasagna Roll-Ups
serves 6

6 whole wheat lasagna noodles, cooked al dente and drained
1 c low-fat ricotta cheese
½ c part-skim mozzarella cheese, shredded and divided
2 T freshly grated Parmesan cheese
1 egg white, slightly beaten
1 t dried parsley
½ t dried basil
freshly cracked pepper, to taste
1 ½ t olive oil
2 cloves garlic, sliced
½ c red pepper, diced
½ c zucchini, diced
½ c mushrooms, sliced
1 c fresh spinach, chopped
cooking spray
1 ½ c tomato sauce

1. Preheat the oven to 400 F. Combine ricotta, ¼ c mozzarella, Parmesan, egg white, parsley, basil, and pepper. Refrigerate until ready to use.
2. Heat a nonstick skillet to med-high heat. Add oil. Saute garlic for 1 minute. Add red pepper, zucchini and mushrooms; saute for 3 minutes. Add spinach and saute just until spinach is wilted. Allow the vegetable mixture to cool,; drain well

and then combine with cheese mixture.

3. Distribute the cheese and vegetable mixture on the noodles. Roll up the noodles. Spray a glass baking dish with cooking spray. Place the lasagna rolls in the dish. Pour ¼ c of tomato sauce over each one. Cover and cook for 20 minutes. Remove the cover, garnish with remaining mozzarella cheese and bake an additional 5-10 minutes. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Easy Cheesy Ravioli Casserole
Serves 8-10

1 T olive oil
1 medium-size yellow onion, chopped
2 cloves garlic, minced
2 jars pasta sauce
¾ c dry red wine
8 oz can tomato sauce
1-2 t dried basil or Italian herb blend, or 1-2 T chopped fresh basil
50 oz frozen ravioli
2 c shredded mozzarella cheese
½ c freshly grated/shredded Parmesan cheese

1. Coat a large slow cooker with nonstick cooking spray.
2. In a large, deep skillet or Dutch oven, heat the oil over med-high heat. Add the onion and cook, stirring a few times, until softened, about 5 minutes. Add the garlic and cook for 1 minute more; don't allow it to burn. Add the pasta sauce, wine, and tomato sauce. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat to a simmer, and cook, stirring occasionally, for 3-5 minutes more. Taste the sauce. If desired, add the basil.
3. Pour 2 c of the sauce into the cooker. Add ½ the ravioli, then sprinkle with half the mozzarella and 2 T of the Parmesan. Add 2 more cups of the sauce, the last ½ of the ravioli, the remaining mozzarella, and 2 T of the Parmesan. Cover with the remaining tomato sauce.
4. Cover and cook on HIGH for 2 ½ - 3 ½ hours, or LOW for 5-6 hours. The casserole is done when a ravioli from the center of the casserole is hot throughout. Sprinkle with the remaining ¼ c of Parmesan, cover, and let cook 10 minutes more.

Ravioli (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
takes 2 hours - yields 6 servings

<u>Cheese Filling</u>
1 large egg
2 c ricotta cheese, drained
1 c shredded mozzarella cheese
½ c minced flat-leaf parsley
½ t salt
freshly ground black pepper
plain breadcrumbs, as needed

<u>Meat Filling</u>
1 T olive oil
½ lb ground veal
½ lb ground pork
1 c dry white wine
salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 garlic cloves, minced
1 oz prosciutto or ham, minced
½ c minced flat-leaf parsley
½ c grated Parmigiano-Reggiano cheese
½ c ricotta cheese
1 large egg
plain breadcrumbs, as needed

<u>Ravioli Assembly</u>
1 ¼ lbs Basic Egg or Spinach Pasta dough *(recipe below)*
Cornmeal, for dusting
2 T salt

1. Prepare the sauce of your choice. Prepare your choice of fillings.

CHEESE FILLING: Combine the egg, ricotta, mozzarella, parsley, salt, and pepper to taste in a large bowl. If the mixture appears too loose to work with, add breadcrumbs, 1 T at a time, allowing the mixture to sit for a few minutes after each addition to absorb the moisture.

MEAT FILLING: Heat the oil in a large, deep skillet. Add the veal and pork and cook for about 5 minutes, or until the meat loses its color, breaking up any clumps as it cooks. Add the wine and salt and pepper, then turn the heat to low. Cook, stirring

occasionally, until the meat is tender, about 45 minutes. Add the garlic and prosciutto/ham and cook for another 5 minutes. Remove from the heat and cool slightly, then add the parsley, Parmigiano-Reggiano, ricotta, and egg. If mixture is too loose and there is too much liquid, add the breadcrumbs, about 1 T at a time. If you like a finer texture to your filling, pulse it several times in a food processor until it is the desired texture.

2. To assemble the ravioli: Prepare the dough as directed in the recipe (below), rolling it out to about 1/8 -inch thickness.
3. Have a small bowl with water and a pastry brush handy. Dust your work surface lightly with flour and lay out a long sheet of pasta. Fold it in half and use your fingernail or a toothpick to mark the dough at the halfway point. Open the strip of dough out again and brush the top surface very lightly with water. Drop small spoonfuls of the filling about 1 ½ inches apart on one half of the pasta sheet, leaving at least a ½-inch border around the edges. Fold the other half of the sheet over the filling, making sure all the filling is covered.
4. Using your index finger, gently press out air pockets around each mound of filling. Use a sharp knife, pizza cutter, or ravioli cutter to cut in between the pockets of filling, forming squares, where the dough has been pressed down to create a seal. Press down on the edges with your finger to make a tight seal.
5. Dust a sheet pan with cornmeal to prevent the ravioli from sticking and lay them out on the sheet, making sure not to let them touch. Repeat with the remaining dough and filling.
6. To cook the pasta, bring 6 quarts of water to a gentle boil. Add the salt and drop the ravioli into the water in batches (about 16 ravioli to a batch), being careful not to allow the water to come to a violent boil. Cook the ravioli until just tender, 4-6 minutes. Remove the cooked ravioli with a slotted spoon and continue with the remaining ravioli. Drain well. Serve with pasta sauce.

***If ravioli falls apart, here are some possible reasons why:*

- *The seal on your ravioli may not be adequate. If they are coming apart, wet your finger with a little water, run it along the edge of the ravioli, and reseal.*
- *There are air pockets in the ravioli. Air expands when it's hot and if it is trapped in your ravioli, it will explode in boiling water. Make sure you carefully work your finger tightly around each mound of filling to push the air from the inside out to the edge of the pasta.*
- *Your water is boiling too violently and the force of the boil is bursting your ravioli open. Make sure the water is at a gentle boil.*

Basic Egg Pasta (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
takes 1 hour 20 minutes - yields ~1 ¼ lbs

2 ¾ c unbleached all-purpose flour, plus more if necessary
1 t plus 2 T salt
4 large eggs

1. Combine the flour, 1 t of salt, and the eggs in the bowl of a food processor and pulse several times until clumps of moist dough form. **
2. Turn the dough out onto a lightly floured work surface, gather it into ball, and knead until smooth, about 3 minutes, sprinkling lightly with flour if the dough sticks. Wrap the dough in plastic and let it rest at room temperature for at least 20 minutes.
3. Cut the dough into 4 equal pieces and cover each piece with plastic wrap to prevent it from drying. Set the pasta machine to its widest setting. Working with one piece at a time, flatten the dough into a rectangle and run it through the machine. Fold the dough in thirds, as if you are folding a letter. Dust the outside lightly with flour and, putting the shorter end through first, run it through the roller again. Repeat this process until the dough is smooth and elastic. It may take 3 or 4 times. (This is a continuation of the kneading process. It gives the dough a chance to absorb more flour if it is too sticky.)
4. Pass the dough through the machine, without folding it, using the narrower settings, one time through each setting. Dust lightly with flour as needed to prevent sticking, until the pasta sheet is the desired thickness.
5. Place the sheet on a lightly floured work surface. Repeat with the remaining dough. If the dough tears at any time during the rolling process, just fold it in half, dust both sides with flour, and run it through the setting you were just on one more time. (If you are making ravioli, stop here and continue with the directions in that recipe.)
6. Let the pasta sheets rest until they become slightly dry but are still pliable, about 20 minutes. Cut the sheets to the

desired length. Fit the machine with the desired cutter and run the sheets through.
7. Using floured hands, toss the strands to separate.
8. Cook the pasta in a 6-quart pot of boiling water with the 2 T of salt, stirring occasionally, for 3-5 minutes, or until just tender and no longer rubbery. Drain and serve with desired sauce.

***You can use a stand mixer with a dough hook to make the dough. You can also do it the old-fashioned way: make a mound of flour on the counter, make a well in the mound, add the salt and eggs, and carefully mix together with a fork. Slowly incorporate the flour from the outside of the well into the center. Once the mixture is thick enough to knead, continue to incorporate the flour into the dough with your hands. Knead until smooth and elastic.*

Easy Chicken Pesto Stuffed Peppers - very tasty

4 medium sweet yellow/orange peppers
1 ½ c shredded rotisserie chicken
1 ½ c cooked brown rice
1 c pesto
½ c shredded Havarti cheese
fresh basil leaves (optional)

1. Turn on oven broiler. Cut peppers in half, lengthwise & remove seeds. Broil skin side up 4" from heat til skin blisters (~5 minutes). Then remove peppers and reduce oven temperature to 350 degrees.
2. Mix chicken, brown rice, and pesto together. When peppers are cool enough to touch, fill them with this mixture. Bake until heated through. (~5 minutes).
3. Sprinkle Havarti cheese on tops and bake til melted (~3-5 minutes).
4. Sprinkle with fresh basil before serving.

Italian Orzo Stuffed Peppers - YUMMY
Takes about 1 hour to prepare - Serves 4 (*½ recipe was more than enough to fill 4 peppers)*

4 red bell peppers
2 T olive oil
1 small yellow onion, diced
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 lb italian sausage
8 oz (approx 1 cup) diced tomatoes
8 oz (approx 1 heaping cup) orzo, cooked and cooled
8 oz ricotta cheese
4 oz grated mozzarella cheese
2 T grated Parmesan
2 T dry Italian seasoning

1. Preheat oven to 350. Cut tops off peppers, deseed.
2. In saute pan, over medium heat, add oil, onion, and garlic. Saute for 2 minutes. Add sausage and cook through to 160 degrees. Add tomato and cook 2 minutes.
3. Remove from heat and allow to cool. Add orzo, cheeses and seasoning, and stir to combine.
4. Stuff peppers and bake until heated through, about 30 minutes.

Sauteed Chicken with Roasted Pepper Pasta (from *Cooking Light*, March 2014)
serves 4 (this was yummy)

6 oz uncooked rotini
12 baby bell peppers
3 oz fresh mozzarella pearls (about ¾ c), *or dice a block of mozzarella*
2 T olive oil
2 t white wine vinegar
2 garlic cloves, minced
½ c chopped parsley
½ t salt, divided
cooking spray
4 (6 oz) skinless, boneless chicken breast halves
½ t black pepper

1. Preheat broiler to high.
2. Cook pasta; drain. Place in large bowl; keep warm.
3. Cut bell peppers in half lengthwise; discard seeds and membranes. Place peppers, skin sides up, on a foil-lined baking

sheet; flatten. Broil 6 minutes or until blackened. Let stand 5 minutes. Peel; cut into strips. Add peppers and cheese to pasta. Combine oil, vinegar, and garlic; stir into pasta mixture. Stir in parsley and ¼ t salt.

4. Heat a large skillet over medium-high heat. Coat pan with cooking spray. Sprinkle chicken with remaining salt and pepper; saute 6 minutes on each side or until done. Slice chicken. Serve over pasta.

Chicken Paprika with Ziti (by Sherilyn Riboldi - *from RS $5 cookbook)*

1 ½ lbs. boneless skinless chicken breast halves
4 scallions, chopped
½ lb small mushrooms, halved
2 T. flour
2 T. paprika
¾ t. salt
¼ t. pepper
2 T butter
3 T. olive oil
3 cloves garlic crushed
½ lb ziti
½ C. sour cream
¼ C. plain yogurt
1 C canned tomatoes, with their juice
½ C. chicken broth

Prepare ziti per package directions. Cut chicken in ¼ in thick pieces. In medium bowl, combine the flour, paprika, salt and pepper. In a large skillet, warm the butter and olive oil until butter is melted. Add scallions and garlic, cook until the scallions are translucent, about 3 minutes. Dredge the chicken. Add the chicken to the skillet and sauté until cooked through, about 5 minutes. Add mushrooms, cook about 5 minutes. In a small bowl, combine the sour cream and yogurt, and stir in the reserved flour mixture. Add the tomatoes and their juices to the skillet. Stir in the broth and sour cream mixture, heat until heated through, about 2 minutes. Serve over pasta

Shrimp Scampi (made and loved by Lizzie and Lee "tasty even if you're not a fan of shrimp")
4 servings

2 T olive oil
4 T butter
4-5 large garlic cloves, minced (or 1 ½ T minced garlic)
1 ¼ lbs large shrimp prawns, shelled with tails on or off
salt and fresh ground pepper to taste
¼ c dry white wine or broth
½ t crushed red pepper flakes or to taste (optional)
2 T lemon juice
¼ c chopped parsley

1. Heat olive oil and 2 T butter in large pan/skillet. Add garlic and saute until fragrant (about 30-60 seconds). Then add the shrimp, season with salt and pepper to taste and saute for 1-2 minutes on one side (until just beginning to turn pink), then flip.
2. Pour in wine (or broth), add red pepper flakes (if using). Bring to a simmer for 1-2 minutes or until wine reduces by about half and the shrimp is cooked through (don't over cook your shrimp).
3. Stir in the remaining butter, lemon juice and parsley and take off heat immediately.
4. Serve over rice, pasta, garlic bread or steamed vegetables (cauliflower, broccoli, zucchini noodles).

Lemon Pasta Chicken (by Trina Smith - *from RS $5 recipes)*

2 chicken breasts
lemon pepper seasoning
2 c bow tie pasta (cooked)
1 T olive oil
1 clove fresh garlic
chopped fresh basil
⅓ c chicken broth
1 c grape tomatoes (or chopped tomatoes)
½ c Parmesan cheese
½ c sour cream
extra basil and Parmesan cheese (for serving, optional)

1. Bake chicken breasts coated in lemon pepper for 1 hour.
2. Cook bow tie pasta, drain and set aside.
3. Saute garlic and chopped fresh basil in olive oil for 2-3 minutes.

4. Add chicken broth and bring to boil.
5. Chop the chicken in pieces, add to the spices and cook 2 additional minutes
6. Add the pasta and toss gently.
7. Add grape/chopped tomatoes, 1/2 c. Parmesan cheese, and sour cream.
8. Toss all gently. Serve with extra basil and Parmesan cheese.

Tips: look for a whole lemon peppered chicken when it goes on sale and bake it, then freeze the rest of the chicken for another casserole to make later. This recipe makes a good summer recipe to use your garden tomatoes and herbs.

Chicken Tetrazzini *(this was tasty)*
makes about 8 servings

1 lb boneless, skinless chicken breasts
¼ c diced onion
¼ c diced celery
1 ½ t salt, divided
1 qt water
8 oz uncooked spaghetti noodles
4 T butter, divided
1 T lemon juice
2 T flour
½ t pepper
¼ t paprika
⅛ t nutmeg
1 c whipping cream (could use ½ and ½ or coconut milk)
⅔ c Parmesan cheese

1. In a 2 qt saucepan on med-high heat, combine chicken, onion, celery, 1 t of the salt, and water. Boil until chicken is done, about 15 minutes. Remove chicken from pan with a slotted spoon, retaining the stock in saucepan.
2. Bring stock to a boil and add spaghetti noodles. Cook according to pkg directions until al dente. If needed, add additional water, one cup at a time, to cover noodles.
3. While pasta is cooking, shred or cut chicken into pieces. Set aside. Preheat oven to 400 degrees F.
4. When spaghetti is done, drain (retaining whatever veggies you can) and put noodles and vegetables in the bottom of a 9x13 pan.
5. In a skillet, heat 2 T butter, lemon juice, and ½ t salt until buter is melted. Pour mixture over cooked spaghetti and toss lightly.
6. In same skillet, slowly heat the remaining 2 T butter, flour, pepper, paprika, and nutmeg, stirring constantly until smooth and thick. Remove from heat. Add whipping cream and stir until smooth. Add chicken and stir. Spoon chicken mixture over the spaghetti and top with grated Parmesan cheese.
7. Cover with foil and bake for 25 minutes.

**Can be assembled the night before and refrigerated until ready to bake.*
**Can also add ½ a red pepper, diced, to the sauce for color.*

Fennel Pasta Pomodoro
serves 4

12 oz spaghetti
2 T olive oil
1 onion, finely chopped
kosher salt and pepper
3 cloves garlic, finely chopped
1 T fresh rosemary, chopped
1 t fennel seeds, coarsely cracked
1 28-oz can whole peeled tomatoes

1. Cook pasta per pkg directions.
2. Heat oil in large skillet on medium. Add onion and ½ t each salt and pepper and saute until tender, 5-6 minutes. Stir in garlic, rosemary and fennel seeds and cook 2 minutes.
3. Using kitchen shears, while tomatoes are still in can, cut them into small chunks and add to pan along with juices, then simmer until slightly thickened, 2-3 minutes. Toss with pasta.

Veggie & Three-Cheese Stuffed Shells
serves 4 - takes 45 minutes total

(entree ingredients)
16 jumbo shells (from 12-oz box)
2 c marinara sauce
10 oz pkg frozen spinach, thawed
8 oz frozen broccoli florets, thawed
15 oz ricotta
2 oz grated Parmesan (½ c)
4 oz mozzarella, grated (about 1 c), divided

(salad ingredients)
2 T olive oil
1 T red wine vinegar
small head romaine lettuce, torn
cucumber, thinly sliced
½ small red onion, thinly sliced

1. Heat oven to 400 degrees. Cook pasta per pkg directions. Drain and rinse under cold water to cool.
2. Spread sauce onto bottom of large broiler-safe baking dish
3. Squeeze spinach of excess moisture, roughly chop and place in large bowl. Chop broccoli and add to bowl. Stir in ricotta, Paresan, ½ c mozzarella and ½ t each salt and pepper. Spoon mixture into shells (~¼ c each) and place on top of sauce. Sprinkle with remaining ½ c mozzarella.
4. Bake until heated through, 10-12 minutes. Increase heat to broil. Broil shells until cheese begins to brown, 2-3 minutes.
5. Meanwhile, in large bowl, whisk together oil, vinegar, and ¼ t each salt and pepper. Toss with lettuce, cucumber, and onion. Serve with shells.
   (Prep ahead up through step 3, then refrigerate up to 3 days. Add 10 minutes to baking time.)

***Baked Macaroni and Cheese** (Uncle John's recipe)
makes 8x8 pan (enough to feed 4-6 people) - double recipe for 9x13 pan

2 c uncooked elbow macaroni
4 T (½ stick) butter
2 ½ c shredded Cheddar cheese, divided
2 large eggs
½ c milk
paprika, for the top *(I don't usually use this.)*

1. Preheat the oven to 350. Grease an 8 inch square baking pan.
2. Cook macaroni in boiling salted water, following package directions. Drain well; return to pot. Add butter and stir until melted. Add 2 c of the shredded cheese.
3. In a medium bowl, whisk eggs with the milk. Add the milk mixture to the macaroni. **Stir until well combined. Spoon into the greased pan. Sprinkle the remaining ½ c cheese on top. Sprinkle with paprika. Bake, uncovered, for 30 minutes or until the cheese has melted and browned and casserole is cooked through.

***We like to serve this with diced ham mixed in. Add the ham at this point in the recipe, if preparing this way.*

***Rainbow Pasta** *(YUM)*
serves 4-6 / 15 minute prep time

12 oz whole-wheat penne pasta
1 green bell pepper, chopped
1 red bell pepper, chopped
2 garlic cloves, minced
2 T olive oil
15 oz can red kidney beans, rinsed and drained
1 t dried basil
1 t dried chives (I've used fresh)
1 t salt
¼ t pepper
¼ c Parmesan cheese, grated
1 ½ c fresh spinach, torn

1. Prepare pasta according to pkg directions. Drain and set aside.

2. In a large skillet, saute the bell peppers and garlic in the olive oil. Stir in the beans and cooked pasta. Add basil, chives, salt, and pepper; mix well.
3. Remove from heat and stir in the cheese. Add spinach and toss to coat. Serve warm. Refrigerate any leftovers.

Crock Pot Italian Chicken Penne (by Arika Moore - *from RS $5 cookbook)*
Makes 6 servings (approximately 1 1/4 cups each).

1 lb. boneless, skinless chicken breasts (mine were still frozen, no need to thaw)
1 can of condensed cream of chicken soup
8 oz. reduced fat cream cheese
1 packet dry Italian dressing mix
1 (15 oz) can of petite diced tomatoes
12 oz. penne pasta

Stir together the soup, cream cheese, tomatoes, and dressing mix in the crock pot. Add the chicken. Cook on low about 6 hours, until chicken shreds easily with a fork. Cook the pasta according to package directions, and drain. Add the pasta to the crock pot mixture and stir to combine.

***Potato Gnocchi** (pronounced NYOH-kee)
Makes 5 servings

<u>For the gnocchi</u>:
1 lb (about 3 medium) gold-fleshed potatoes, such as Yukon gold *(I've used regular russets each time I've made this)*
1 t salt
¼ t black pepper
1 T finely grated Parmesan
1 large egg, lightly beaten
½ c plus 1-2 T flour
<u>For the sauce</u>:
1/3 c finely grated Parmesan
½ c heavy cream

1. Scrub the potatoes and place them in a large pot. Cover the potatoes with a couple of inches of water, add ½ t salt, then boil the potatoes gently until they're cooked through, about 30-35 minutes. (Check doneness by poking with a fork.) Transfer the potatoes to a plate and let them cool, about 20 minutes.
2. Meanwhile, lightly butter a medium-size casserole and set it aside. Put a large, fresh pot of water on high heat, and heat the oven to 400 degrees.
3. Peel potatoes and put through potato ricer or force through sieve with back of large spoon. *(Or, leave unpeeled, and send through applesauce strainer.*) This is what gives the gnocchi its light, fluffy texture.
4. Add the remaining ½ t salt, the pepper, the Parmesan, and the egg to the riced potatoes. Toss gently to mix. Add the ½ c flour and stir well to make a moist dough. Stir in another tablespoon or two or flour, as necessary, to make the dough just firm enough to knead. Turn the dough out onto a floured counter and knead very gently for 1 minute with floured hands. Add a little extra flour to the counter, if necessary, so that the dough doesn't stick.
5. Divide the dough into four pieces. Working with one piece at a time, roll the dough into a rope about ¾ inch thick and 18 inches long. Using a knife or a dough scraper, cut the rope into ¾ inch long pieces.
6. Press the tines of a fork into one side of each piece, just deep enough to leave a mark. Transfer the pieces to a floured plate. Each rope makes about 20 gnocchi.
7. After you've cut and shaped the gnocchi, gently drop about half of them into the lightly boiling water. After 1-2 minutes the gnocchi should rise to the surface. Once they do, cook them at a low boil for another 1 ½ minutes. Be careful; a vigorous boil may cause the gnocchi to fall apart. Remove the gnocchi with a small strainer, let them drip dry for several seconds, then place them into the buttered baking dish. Cook the remaining gnocchi and add them to the dish as well.
8. For a simple creamy sauce, sprinkle the gnocchi with 1/3 c Parmesan and drizzle the heavy cream over the top. Bake the dish on the center oven rack until the sauce is bubbly, about 10-12 minutes. Serve at once.

Alternate serving suggestions:

1. Cook the gnocchi in chicken broth to make a simple dumpling soup. Garnish each serving with a pinch or two of minced scallions.
2. Stir cooked gnocchi into leftover saucy stew.
3. Gently mix cooked gnocchi with Alfredo sauce, marinara sauce, or pesto. Spoon the mixture into a pan, sprinkle with Parmesan, and bake as directed in main recipe.

Chicken Fettucine Alfredo(from *The $5 Dinner Mom Cookbook*, p. 59)
served with mashed sweet potatoes and peas

2 sweet potatoes
16 oz pkg fettuccine
2 boneless, skinless chicken breasts, thinly sliced
3 c Homemade Basic White Sauce (below)
¼ c Parmesan cheese
1 c frozen peas

1. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees. Make a few slits in the sweet potatoes using a small sharp knife. Put the sweet potatoes in a baking dish with ¼ inch of water and cover with aluminum foil. Bake the sweet potatoes in the preheated oven for 1 hour. Remove from the oven and let cool about 10 minutes. Peel off the skins and mash the pulp.
2. Meanwhile in a large pot, cook the fettuccine according to the package directions. Drain.
3. In a skillet, prepare the white sauce. Once the sauce has thickened, add ¼- to ½- cup Parmesan cheese and whisk until it melts into the sauce. Once the sauce has thickened, add the chicken, cover, and cook for 8-10 minutes, or until the chicken pieces have cooked through. Stir frequently.
4. Cook the peas. Add the fettucine (and peas, if you want) to the skillet with the chicken and white sauce. Toss to combine.
5. Serve with mashed sweet potatoes (and peas, if you didn't mix them in)

<u>Homemade Basic White Sauce</u>
4 T butter
6 T flour
3 c milk
Salt and pepper

1. In a medium saucepan, melt the butter over medium heat. Add the flour and whisk with the melted butter until it forms a paste and bubbles.
2. Whisk in the milk (or other specified liquids). Whisk until flour and butter have dissolved into the milk.
3. Cook the sauce over medium heat for 5-6 minutes, stirring continuously. The sauce will begin to thicken as it bubbles and cooks. (To reach the desired consistency of the sauce you need for your meal, add the milk or four, 1 T at a time. To make the sauce thicker, whisk in more flour. To make the sauce thinner, whisk in more milk. Once the sauce reaches the desired consistency, use it in the meal as directed.)

Orecchiette with Roasted Red Pepper Sauce (Family Circle, August 2012)
Makes 6 servings

1 T plus 1 t olive oil
4 large sweet red peppers
1 small yellow onion, peeled and halved
1 head garlic
1 pkg (12 oz) sweet Italian chicken sausage
¾ t salt
1/8 t pepper
2 T cream or half and half
1 lb orecchiette pasta (I've also used bowties)
Fresh chopped parsley (optional)
Grated Parmesan cheese (optional)

1. Heat oven to 450. Rub 1 T of the olive oil on red peppers and onion halves; place on a rimmed baking sheet. Cut off top quarter of the garlic and rub remaining 1 t olive oil on it; wrap garlic in aluminum foil and place on same baking sheet. Roast for 40 minutes, turning peppers every 10 minutes. During the last 10 minutes of cooking, place sausages in oven.

2. When cool enough to touch, remove stem, seeds and skin from peppers. Squeeze head of garlic to remove cloves. Place peppers, garlic cloves and onion in a blender with salt, pepper and cream. Blend until smooth. Slice sausages into coins; set aside.
3. Meanwhile, bring a pot of lightly salted water to boiling. Cook pasta 11 minutes, or according to pkg directions. Drain and return to pot. Stir in sauce and sliced sausage. Garnish with parsley and cheese, if desired.

***Zucchini Parmesan** (Modified from recipe in *Family Circle*, October 2011)
Makes 8 servings

½ c flour
3 eggs, lightly beaten
1 c seasoned bread crumbs
3 large zucchini, about 2 lbs, cut lengthwise into ¼" thick slices
¼ c canola oil
1 jar prepared marinara sauce
2 c shredded reduced fat mozzarella
1 c basil leaves (or a few T dried basil)
¼ c grated Parmesan cheese

1. Heat oven to 375. Coat a 9x13 pan with nonstick cooking spray.
2. Place flour, eggs and bread crumbs in separate shallow bowls. Lightly coat zucchini slices with flour. Dip in egg and coat with bread crumbs. Set aside.
3. Heat 2 T of the oil in a large nonstick skillet over medium high heat. Cook zucchini 1 ½ to 2 minutes per side until golden brown. Cook in as many batches as needed, adding more oil as needed.
4. Spoon ½ cup of sauce in bottom of prepared baking dish. Evenly place 1/3 of the zucchini in dish; top with ¾ c of sauce and 2/3 c mozzarella cheese. Repeat layering twice, adding basil between second and third layers.
5. Sprinkle Parmesan cheese over top and loosely cover with nonstick foil. Bake at 375 for 30 minutes; remove foil and bake for an additional 10 minutes.
6. Cool slightly before slicing. Serve with a green salad if desired.

Bruschetta-Style Thin Spaghetti (served hot)

1 box Thin Spaghetti (recipe suggests Ronzoni Healthy Harvest)
2 T olive oil
2 T minced garlic
3 c fresh tomatoes, diced
2 T balsamic vinegar
To taste: oregano and basil (fresh or dried), shredded Parmesan cheese, cracked pepper, salt

Cook pasta according to package directions. Heat a large sauté pan on medium high with olive oil. Saute garlic until golden. Add tomatoes, balsamic vinegar, and herbs. Heat until warmed (about 2 minutes). Combine pasta and tomato mixture and heat until warm (approximately 2-3 minutes).

**To serve cold, substitute balsamic vinegar, garlic, and olive oil with 1 cup of your favorite salad dressing. Toss together after pasta cools.

[easy] baked ziti (from *Scratch*, by Maria Rodale)
serves 6

1 pound ziti pasta
3 cups tomato sauce, store-bought or homemade
8 ounces low-moisture mozzarella cheese, shredded
8 ounces fresh mozzarella cheese, sliced
1/3 cup grated Romano cheese

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F.
2. Cook the pasta according to package directions. Drain and transfer to a 12 x 8-inch baking dish.
3. Add the tomato sauce and two-thirds of the grated mozzarella to the pasta and mix to combine. Top with the remaining

grated mozzarella as well as the slices of fresh mozzarella and sprinkle with the Romano. Bake for 30 minutes, or until golden and bubbling.

Tip from book: You can sneak in some vegetables if you want, such as chopped spinach, peas, or mushrooms. You can also add ricotta cheese. You can even add cooked ground beef or sausage, which makes it taste like lasagna, but a lot easier to make!

***Baked Ziti** (Cook's Illustrated, March & April 2009, p. 15)
Serves 8-10

1 lb whole milk or 1 percent cottage cheese
2 large eggs, lightly beaten
3 oz grated Parmesan cheese (about 1 ½ c)
Table salt
1 pound ziti or other short, tubular pasta
2 T extra-virgin olive oil
5 medium garlic cloves, minced or pressed through garlic press (about 5 teaspoons)
1 (28 oz) can tomato sauce
1 (14.5 oz) can diced tomatoes
1 t dried oregano
½ c plus 2 T chopped fresh basil leaves
1 t sugar
Ground black pepper
¾ t cornstarch
1 c heavy cream (or substitute whole milk by increasing cornstarch to 2 teaspoons and decreasing cooking time in step 3 by 1-2 minutes)
8 oz low-moisture mozzarella cheese, cut into ¼-inch pieces (about 1 ½ c) (part skim mozzarella can be used, but avoid pre-shredded because it doesn't melt well)

1. Adjust oven rack to middle position and heat oven to 350 degrees. Whisk cottage cheese, eggs, and 1 c Parmesan together in medium bowl; set aside. Bring 4 quarts of water to boil in large Dutch oven over high heat. Stir in 1 T salt and pasta; cook, stirring occasionally, until pasta begins to soften but is not yet cooked through, 5-7 minutes. Drain pasta and leave in colander (do not wash Dutch oven).
2. Meanwhile, heat oil and garlic in 12-inch skillet over medium heat until garlic is fragrant but not brown, about 2 minutes. Stir in tomato sauce, diced tomatoes, and oregano; simmer until thickened, about 10 minutes. Off heat, stir in ½ c basil and sugar, then season with salt and pepper.
3. Stir cornstarch into heavy cream in small bowl; transfer mixture to now-empty Dutch oven set over medium heat. Bring to simmer and cook until thickened, 3-4 minutes. Remove pot from heat and add cottage cheese mixture, 1 c tomato sauce, and ¾ c mozzarella, then stir to combine. Add pasta and stir to coat thoroughly with sauce.
4. Transfer pasta mixture to 13x9 inch pan and spread remaining tomato sauce evenly over pasta. Sprinkle remaining ¾ c mozzarella and remaining ½ c Parmesan over top. Cover baking dish tightly with foil and bake for 30 minutes.
5. Remove foil and continue to cook until cheese is bubbling and beginning to brown, about 30 minutes longer. Cool for 20 minutes. Sprinkle with remaining 2 T basil and serve.

Baked Rigatoni with Meatballs (from *Good Housekeeping* Oct 2020, p. 101)
Takes 35 minutes - serves 4

12 oz mezzi rigatoni
3 c baby spinach
1 large egg
kosher salt and pepper
1 clove garlic, finely chopped
½ c flat-leaf parsley, chopped
¼ c fresh breadcrumbs
¼ c grated Parmesan
8 oz 85% lean ground beef
8 oz Italian sausage
1 24-oz jar marinara sauce
6 oz part-skim mozzarella, coarsely grated, divided
½ c part-skim ricotta, divided

1. Heat broiler. Cook pasta per pkg directions, drain and return to pot.
2. Meanwhile, chop 1 c spinach. In large bowl, whisk together egg, 2 T water and ½ t each salt and pepper. Stir in garlic, parsley, breadcrumbs and Parmesan. Let sit 2 min. Add beef, sausage and chopped spinach and mix to combine.
3. Form mixture into 1 ½ in balls and place on rimmed baking sheet. Broil until cooked through, 6-8 min.

4. Toss pasta with marinara. Fold in 1 c mozzarella, ¼ c ricotta, then meatballs and remaining 2 c spinach. Transfer to 3-qt baking dish. Sprinkle with remaining ½ c mozzarella and dollop with remaining ¼ c ricotta. Broil until golden brown, 2-3 min.

Ham and Cheese Bowties (from allrecipes.com)

8 oz farfalle pasta (bowties)
¼ c butter
1 clove garlic, minced
¼ c all-purpose flour
½ t salt
1/8 t ground black pepper
1 c milk
½ t mustard
1 ½ c shredded Colby cheese
4-oz cooked ham, julienned/diced
¼ c grated Parmesan cheese

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F.
2. Bring large pot of lightly salted water to a boil. Add pasta and cook for 8-10 minutes or until al dente; drain.
3. Meanwhile, in a large saucepan over medium heat, melt butter. Saute garlic 30 seconds. Whisk in flour, salt, and pepper. Cook and stir until smooth. Pour in milk, a little at a time, stirring constantly. Bring to a boil for 1 minute. (To keep it smooth, whisk constantly for 1 minute after it reaches a boil.) Stir in mustard and Colby. Continue to cook, stirring occasionally, until cheese is melted. Remove from heat and stir in pasta and ham.
4. Pour into 2-quart baking dish (8 inch square pan works well). Sprinkle with Parmesan.
5. Bake 20-25 minutes, or until bubbly and golden.

***Mexican Lasagna** (Andrea Vehrs)

1 large green pepper, chopped
1 large onion, chopped
6 oz can tomato paste
8 oz can tomato sauce
15 oz can enchilada sauce
9 lasagna noodles
8 oz cream cheese (I use 4-6 oz)
8 oz sour cream
8 oz cottage cheese
2 cups mozzarella cheese

1. Saute pepper & onion. Then add tomato paste, sauce, and enchilada sauce. *(Use immersion blender to chop veggies more finely at this point, if desired)* While this simmers, cook 9 lasagna noodles.
2. Mix together cream cheese, sour cream, and cottage cheese.
3. In large casserole dish, layer noodles, 1/3 sauce, 1/3 cheese mixture, and a handful of mozzarella cheese. Repeat layers 2 more times. Bake at 350 degrees for 30 minutes.

No-Cook Peanut Chicken Noodles
25 minutes - serves 4

7-8 oz pkg thin rice noodles
⅓ c peanut butter
⅓ c rice vinegar
¼ c low-sodium soy sauce
2 T water
1 T sriracha
¼ t salt
2 c shredded cooked chicken breast
1 c frozen shelled edamame (thawed)
8 oz carrots (about 2 large carrots, coarsely grated)
¼ c cilantro, chopped (plus more for garnish, if desired)
chopped roasted peanuts (if desired, for garnish)

1. Place rice noodles in large bowl, cover with boiling water and let soak until tender, 7-9 minutes; drain.
2. Meanwhile, in large bowl, whisk together peanut butter, rice vinegar, soy sauce, water, sriracha, and salt. Add noodles and toss to coat, adding more water 1 T at a time if noodles seem dry.
3. Fold in chicken breast, edamame, carrots, and cilantro. Toss to combine. Top with peanuts and additional cilantro if desired.

Singapore Noodles (from *Cooks' Illustrated*)
serves 4 to 6

4 T plus 1 t vegetable oil
2 T curry powder
⅛ t cayenne pepper (optional)
6 oz rice vermicelli
2 T soy sauce
1 t sugar
12 oz large shrimp (26-30/lb), peeled, deveined, tails removed, and cut into 1/2 -inch pieces
4 large eggs, lightly beaten
salt
3 garlic cloves, minced to paste
1 t grated fresh ginger
1 red bell pepper, stemmed, seeded, and cut into 2-inch-long matchsticks
2 large shallots, sliced thin
⅔ c chicken broth
4 oz (2 c) bean sprouts
4 scallions, cut into ½-inch pieces
2 t lime juice, plus lime wedges for serving

1. Heat 3 T oil, curry powder, and cayenne, if using, in 12-inch nonstick skillet over medium-low heat, stirring occasionally, until fragrant, about 4 minutes. Remove skillet from heat and set aside.
2. Bring 1 ½ quarts water to boil. Place noodles in large bowl. Pour boiling water over noodles and stir briefly. Soak noodles until flexible, but not soft, about 2 ½ minutes, stirring once halfway through soaking. Drain noodles briefly. Transfer noodles to cutting board. Using chef's knife, cut pile of noodles roughly into thirds. Return noodles to bowl, add curry mixture, soy sauce, and sugar; using tongs, toss until well combined. Set aside.
3. Wipe out skillet with paper towels. Heat 2 t oil in skillet over medium-high heat until shimmering. Add shrimp in even layer and cook without moving them until bottoms are browned, about 90 seconds. Stir and continue to cook until just cooked through, about 90 seconds longer. Push shrimp to 1 side of skillet. Add 1 t oil to cleared side of skillet. Add eggs to clearing and sprinkle with ¼ t salt. Using rubber spatula, stir eggs gently until set but still wet, about 1 minute. Stir eggs into shrimp and continue to cook, breaking up large pieces of egg, until eggs are fully cooked, about 30 seconds longer. Transfer shrimp-egg mixture to second large bowl.
4. Reduce heat to medium. Heat remaining 1 t oil in now-empty skillet until shimmering. Add garlic and ginger and cook, stirring constantly, until fragrant, about 15 seconds. Add bell pepper and shallots. Cook, stirring frequently, until vegetables are crisp-tender, about 2 minutes. Transfer to bowl with shrimp.
5. Return skillet to medium-high heat, add broth to skillet, and bring to simmer. Add noodles and cook, stirring frequently, until liquid is absorbed, about 2 minutes. Add noodles to bowl with shrimp and vegetable mixture and toss to combine. Add bean sprouts, scallions, and lime juice and toss to combine. Transfer to warmed platter and serve immediately, passing lime wedges separately.

Slow-Cooker Sweet and Sour Chicken

1 onion, chopped
1 carrot, chopped
1 celery stalk, chopped
1 green pepper, chopped
1 red pepper, chopped
1 lb boneless, skinless, chicken thighs, cut into bite-sized pieces
½ c Catalina dressing
½ c soy sauce
½ c brown sugar
spoonful of grated ginger
1 can (8 oz) pineapple chunks

1. Place chopped onion, carrot, & celery on bottom of crockpot. Top with chicken pieces.
2. Add Catalina Dressing, soy sauce, brown sugar, grated ginger and the juice from the can of pineapple chunks, (save the pineapple chunks for later).
3. Cover and cook on low for 7-8 hours (or high for 3 1/2 -4 hours). During last 30 minutes of cooking, add pineapple and peppers. Serve over hot, cooked rice.

***Thai Red Curry Chicken** (REAL SIMPLE dinner tonight: done!, p. 83) -*EASY & YUMMY!*
Serves 4

1 c long-grain white rice
2 T canola oil
1 ½ lbs boneless chicken
Salt and pepper
2 red bell peppers
2 T red curry paste
15 oz can coconut milk
1 lime, cut into wedges
¼ c torn fresh basil leaves

1. Cook the rice according to the package directions
2. Meanwhile, heat the oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Season the chicken with ½ t salt and ¼ t pepper. In batches, cook the chicken until golden brown and cooked through, 2-3 minutes per side; remove from the skillet and cut into strips.
3. Add the bell peppers and ¼ c water to the skillet and cook, tossing frequently, until just tender, 3-4 minutes. Add the curry paste and coconut milk and simmer until slightly thickened, 3-5 minutes. Add the chicken and toss to combine.
4. Serve the chicken curry over the rice with the lime wedges and sprinkle with the basil.

Potstickers (From *Cooks Illustrated*, March & April 2006, p. 15)
Makes 24+ dumplings

3 c minced napa cabbage leaves
¾ t salt
¾ lb ground pork
6 T minced scallions, white and green parts
1/8 t ground black pepper
4 t soy sauce
1 ½ t grated ginger
1 medium garlic clove, minced (about 1 t)
2 egg whites, lightly beaten
24 round gyoza wrappers (they work better than wonton wrappers)
4 t vegetable oil

1. Toss cabbage and salt in colander or mesh strainer set over medium bowl. Let stand until cabbage begins to wilt, about 20 minutes; press cabbage gently with rubber spatula to squeeze out excess moisture. Combine cabbage and all other filling ingredients in medium bowl and mix thoroughly. Cover bowl with plastic wrap and refrigerate until mixture is cold, at least 30 minutes and up to 24 hours.
2. Place 4 wrappers flat on work surface (keep remaining wrappers covered with plastic wrap). Place one slightly rounded tablespoon filling in center of each wrapper. Using pastry brush or fingertip, moisten edge of wrapper with water. Fold each wrapper in half; starting in center and working toward outside edges, pinch edges together firmly to seal, pressing out any air pockets. Position each dumpling on its side and gently flatten, pressing down on seam to make sure it lies flat against work surface. Repeat to form all dumplings. (Filled dumplings can be refrigerated overnight in single layer on baking sheet wrapped tightly with plastic wrap.)
3. Add 2 t oil to 12 inch nonstick skillet and quickly spread oil with paper towl to distribute evenly. Arrange 12 dumplings (or ½ total made) in skillet, lying flat on one side, with all seams facing same direction, overlapping just slightly, if necessary. Place skillet over medium-high heat and cook, without moving, until dumplings are golden brown on bottoms, about 5 minutes. Reduce heat to low, add ½ cup water to skillet, and cover immediately. Cook, covered, until most of water is absorbed and wrappers are slightly translucent, about 10 minutes. Uncover skillet and increase heat to medium-high; cook, without stirring, until dumpling bottoms are well browned and crisp, 3-4 minutes more. Turn off burner and slide dumplings from skillet onto double layer of paper towels, browned side down, to blot excess oil. Transfer to platter and serve immediately with Scallion Dipping Sauce. Let skillet cool until just warm, then wipe skillet clean and repeat with remaining dumplings and oil.

**Filled dumplings can be refrigerated overnight in single layer on baking sheet wrapped tightly with plastic wrap. OR to freeze potstickers, place filled, uncooked dumplings in the freezer in a single layer on a plate until frozen, then transfer to a storage bag. There's no need to thaw frozen potstickers; just proceed with recipe.*

"Healthified" Cashew Chicken and Broccoli
Makes 4 servings

2t canola oil
1lb boneless skinless chicken breasts, cut into 1-inch pieces
1t finely chopped ginger root
2c fresh broccoli florets
1 c chicken broth
1/8 t crushed red pepper flakes
2c frozen sugar snap peas
3T soy sauce
2t rice vinegar
1T cornstarch
1 t sugar
2 medium green onions, sliced (2 T)
3 c hot cooked brown rice
¼ c salted roasted cashew halves and pieces

1. In 12-inch nonstick skillet, heat oil over medium-high heat. Add chicken and ginger root; cook and stir 4-5 minutes or until chicken begins to brown.
2. Add broccoli, ½ c of the broth and the pepper flakes. Cover; cook over medium heat 2 minutes, stirring once. Add peas; cook 2-4 minutes longer, stirring once, until vegetables are crisp-tender.
3. In small bowl, mix remaining ½ c broth, the soy sauce, vinegar, corn starch and sugar; stir into chicken mixture. Add onions; cook, stirring frequently, until sauce is thickened and bubbly. Serve over rice; sprinkle with cashews.

Nancy Chen's Fried Rice and Chicken or Beef Stir Fry

Fried Rice*:*
4 c cooked rice
1 c chopped (cooked) sausage
½ c chopped onions
½ c chopped red bell peppers
½ c chopped green onions
½ can drained sweet corn
4 T oil
Soy sauce, salt, and white pepper to taste

1. Put the oil in a hot pan, sauté sausages and onions for 2 minutes. Put the rest of the vegetables in and keep stirring. Add salt, pepper, and bouillon to season, about 5 minutes.
2. Put the rice in and stir well. Add 2 T soy sauce and 1 T sesame oil at the very end. Season to taste.

Stir Fry vegetables*:*
broccoli, carrots/cabbage/zucchini, mushrooms
Chicken (or Beef)*:*
4 chicken breasts, cut into 1/4" slices (or use a chuck cut of beef)

Chicken Marinade*:*
1 T corn starch
2 t cooking wine
Sprinkle bouillon, salt, pepper
Water

Beef Marinade*:*
Same ingredients as chicken, plus 1 or 2 t baking soda and a little soy sauce for color

1. Marinate meat 3 hours.
2. Heat oil.
3. Add prepared vegetables to pan . (Add mushrooms last.)
4. When broccoli absorbs oil, add about ½ c water and enough bouillon. Let cook awhile then add seasonings. Then thicken with 2 T corn starch, and ¼ c cold water.
5. Dump veggies onto platter, then start cooking meat. Keep stirring because it's thinly sliced and there's starch in it. Add more oil if it starts sticking. Use high heat.
6. When about done, season with: 1 t salt, ½ t bouillon, 2 t white pepper, 1 T soy, sprinkle black pepper.
7. Serve on top of veggies and garnish with red pepper and green onion.

Easy Beef-Tomato Curry (by Sherilyn Riboldi - *from RS $5 cookbook)*

1 c rice
1 lbs. beef (inexpensive cut)
1 lbs. tomatoes quartered
1 onion, quartered
1 green pepper, chopped large
1 quarter-size slices fresh ginger, peeled and chopped
2 T. oil
3 cloves garlic, minced
¼ C. curry powder
¼ C. beef broth
3 T. soy sauce
2 t. cornstarch
¼ t. pepper

In a medium saucepan, bring 2 C. water to boil. Add rice, reduce heat to low, cover and simmer about 20 minutes. In a large skillet, warm 1 T. oil over medium-high heat. Add onion, ginger and garlic, sauté until the onion begins to brown, about 3 minutes. Add the beef and 2 T. curry powder and stir-fry until the beef is cooked. Add tomatoes and green pepper, cook for about 3 minutes. Meanwhile, in a small bowl, stir together the beef broth, soy sauce, cornstarch and pepper. Stir in the broth mixture and bring to boil. Cook, stirring constantly, until the beef and vegetables are tender and the sauce is slightly thickened, about 2 minutes. Serve over rice.

***Rice and Lentils with Crispy Onions (Mujaddara)** -from Cook's Illustrated, Sept/Oct 2014
Serves 4-6

<u>Yogurt Sauce</u>
1 c plain whole-milk yogurt
2 T lemon juice
½ t minced garlic
½ t salt
<u>Rice and Lentils</u>
8 ½ oz (1 ¼ c green or brown lentils, picked over and rinsed) *Do not substitute smaller French lentils—not as tender.*
Salt and pepper
1 ¼ c basmati rice
1 recipe Crispy Onions, plus 3 tablespoons reserved oil *(don't forget to save the oil after making the onions!)*
3 garlic cloves, minced
1 t ground coriander
1 t ground cumin
½ t ground cinnamon
½ t ground allspice
1/8 t cayenne pepper
1 t sugar
3 T minced fresh cilantro

1. FOR THE YOGURT SAUCE: Whisk all ingredients together in bowl. Refrigerate while preparing rice and lentils
2. FOR THE RICE AND LENTILS: Bring lentils, 4 c water, and 1 t salt to boil in medium saucepan over high heat. Reduce heat to low and cook until lentils are tender, 15-17 minutes. Drain and set aside. While lentils cook, place rice in medium bowl and cover by 2 inches with hot tap water; let stand for 15 minutes.
3. Using your hands, gently swish rice grains to release excess starch. Carefully pour off water, leaving rice in bowl. Add cold tap water to rice and pour off water. Repeat adding and pouring off cold tap water 4-5 times, until water runs almost clear. Drain rice in fine-mesh strainer.
4. Heat reserved onion oil, garlic, coriander, cumin, cinnamon, allspice, ¼ t pepper, and cayenne in Dutch oven over medium heat until fragrant, about 2 minutes. Add rice and cook, stirring occasionally, until edges of rice begin to turn translucent, about 3 minutes. Add 2 ¼ c water, sugar, and 1 t salt and bring to boil. Stir in lentils, reduce heat to low; cover, and cook until all liquid is absorbed, about 12 minutes.
5. Off heat, remove lid, fold dish towel in half, and place over pot; replace lid. Let stand for 10 minutes. Fluff rice and lentils with fork and stir in cilantro and half of crispy onions. Transfer to serving platter, top with remaining crispy onions, and serve, passing yogurt sauce separately. *(We also pass onions separately so that if there are left overs we don't have soggy onions.)*

<u>Crispy Onions</u> (to go with Mujaddara, above) -from Cook's Illustrated, Sept/Oct 2014
Makes 1 ½ cups

2 lbs onions, halved and sliced crosswise into ¼-inch-thick pieces
2 t salt
1 ½ c vegetable oil

1. Toss onions and salt together in large bowl. Microwave for 5 minutes. Rinse thoroughly, transfer to paper towel-lined

baking sheet, and dry well. *(The recipe notes say that it is important to make sure the onions are dried thoroughly, so a salad spinner is a good tool.)*

2. Heat onions and oil in Dutch oven over high heat, stirring frequently, until onions are golden brown, 25-30 minutes. Drain onions in colander set in large bowl. Transfer onions to paper towel-lined baking sheet to drain. Serve.

***Pancit Bihon** (Filipino noodles)

1 8 oz pack pancit bihon noodles (rice noodles)
1 cooked chicken breast, shredded (we used diced ham)
2 c chicken broth
¼ cabbage, sliced into strips
1 onion, peeled and sliced
3 cloves of garlic, crushed and minced
1/3 c scallions (green onions), cut into pieces
1 carrot, sliced into strips
2 T of cooking oil
¾ c diced celery
3 T soy sauce
Salt and pepper to taste

1. Soak the pancit bihon noodles to soften for 10 minutes
2. Grease a large pan or wok with oil. Saute garlic and onions.
3. Add the chicken broth, the shredded chicken breast and all the vegetables until cooked.
4. Mix in the noodles and add the soy sauce, cook for about 5 minutes or until the noodles are soft.
5. Salt and pepper to taste

Baked Chicken Bacon Ranch Taquitos
makes 16 taquitos

1 (8 oz) pkg cream cheese, softened
4 c cooked shredded chicken
12 slices bacon, cooked and crumbled
2 c shredded Monterey Jack cheese
3-4 T chopped green onion
1 (1 oz) pkt dry ranch dressing mix
20 (6 in) flour tortillas
salt

1. Preheat oven to 425 degrees. Cover a large baking sheet with aluminum foil and coat lightly with nonstick cooking spray.
2. Mix together cream cheese, chicken, bacon, shredded cheese, and green onions. Add in about ½ of the dry ranch dressing mix and taste. Add more for stronger ranch flavor. Mix well. Spoon 2-3 T of the chicken mixture into a flour tortilla and roll it up. Place taquito seam-side down on the baking sheet. Repeat about 15-20 times. Once finished, spray the tops of the taquitos with nonstick cooking spray (or lightly brush olive oil on them) and sprinkle with salt. (I like to use sea salt.)
3. Place pan in oven and bake 10-15 minutes or until edges and tops are golden. Let cool 2-3 minutes. Serve with ranch dressing or bleu cheese dressing for dipping. (My husband also likes to dip them in Salsa Ranch -- just mix equal parts salsa and ranch dressing together.)

Easy Taquitos

shredded, cooked roast beef or chicken
6” tortillas
vegetable oil
salsa, sour cream, guacamole, and cheese for serving

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Line baking sheet with foil. Microwave tortillas, covered with a damp paper towel for 45 seconds, to make them pliable.
2. Put ~¼ c of meat in the center of a warm tortilla. (May also fill or top with cheese.) Roll up filled tortillas & place on baking sheet with seam down.
3. Brush lightly with vegetable oil and bake until lightly browned, 8-12 minutes. Serve hot.

Beef Taco Skillet (Easy, quick meal)
Serves 4-6

1 lb ground beef
1 can condensed tomato soup
½ c picante sauce
1 packet taco seasoning
½ c water
6 flour tortillas (6 inch) cut into 1-inch pieces
½ c cheddar cheese, shredded

Cook the beef in a 10-inch skillet over medium-high heat until well browned, stirring often to separate meat. Drain off excess fat. Stir the soup, picante sauce, taco seasoning, water and tortillas in the skillet, and heat to a boil. Reduce the heat to low. Cook for 5 minutes. Stir the beef mixture. Top with the cheese.

Mexican Haystacks

1 lb ground beef
1 can enchilada sauce
1 can refried beans
1 small can tomato sauce
1 packet enchilada mix

1. Brown ground beef. Put in crock pot and mix in rest of the ingredients. Heat on low to medium for 4 hours.
2. Serve over rice with tortilla chips, lettuce, cheese, tomatoes, onions, peppers, salsa, sour cream, olives, and any other favorite Mexican toppings.

Savory Chicken Tacos
Serves 6

Rotisserie Chicken, savory flavor
12 oz pkg steamable white or brown rice
1 c Mexican/quesadilla shredded cheese
1 can salsa-style fire roasted tomatoes
½ t salt
1 c frozen sweet corn
1 jar (16 oz) verde enchilada sauce
1 pkg crisp taco shells
Sour cream (optional)

1. Preheat oven to 450 degrees. Spray a 13x9 inch baking dish with cooking spray.
2. Mix all ingredients (except taco shells and sour cream) into a large bowl. Spread evenly into baking dish.
3. Bake at 450 for 20 minutes, or until bubbling. Let stand 5 minutes.
4. Spoon into taco shells and serve with sour cream.

Red Mesa Tacos (from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 223)
Serves 9

2 lbs lean ground beef
2 c chopped onion
2 pkgs chili seasoning mix
1 15 oz can tomato sauce
1 14.5 oz can diced tomatoes
2 15 oz cans kidney beans
2 t chopped garlic
2 t sugar
1 t salt
1 t pepper
5 dashes Tabasco sauce
2 c shredded milk cheddar cheese
1 pkg corn taco shells
½ head chopped lettuce
1 chopped tomato
1 c sour cream

1. In large pot, brown the beef with the onions and drain excess fat. Add the ingredients through the Tabasco sauce, and simmer for 30 minutes. If freezing for later, cool and package in a labeled 1 gallon freezer bag. Tape to this a sandwich bag fitted with the shredded cheddar cheese.
2. To serve, thaw the ingredients. Heat the taco mixture in a saucepan on stovetop over medium heat for 20-30 minutes. Meanwhile warm the taco shells. Top the tacos with the chili, cheese, lettuce, tomato, and sour cream.

Crockpot Taco Chicken (from Cassie and Stephanie Neeley)

2-4 chicken breasts
1 can of cream of chicken soup
½-1 c milk
1 packet of taco seasoning
⅓ cup sour cream

1. Put all ingredients except for sour cream in the crockpot. Cook on high for 4 hours or low for 6 hours. After cooking time, shred chicken and stir in sour cream. Serve over rice.

**OR layer rice, chicken mixture, and shredded cheese in a 9x13 pan and cook at 350 for 10-15 minutes or until cheese is melted.

2. Serve with Cool Ranch Doritos.

***Easy enchiladas** *(my made up recipe)*

8 oz (1/2 bottle) salsa (red or green)
1 cup sour cream
1 can cream of chicken soup
1 can enchilada sauce (red or green)
-- You can leave this out because the creamy sauce is yummy on its own, too.
1-2 cups shredded roast beef or chicken
2 cups Colby, Monterey jack, or cheddar cheese
8-10 flour tortillas

1. In a bowl, mix the salsa, sour cream, soup, shredded meat, and 1 cup of the cheese. This is the filling.
2. Pour 1/3 of the can of enchilada sauce in the bottom of a 9x13 pan. Spread evenly. (Or just spread a portion of the cream sauce on the bottom)
3. Fill each tortilla with 1/3-1/2 cup of the filling. Roll up and place in pan. Continue till all filling is used.
4. Cover filled tortillas with remaining enchilada sauce from the can (or just spread the last bit of creamy sauce). Sprinkle with remaining 1 cup of cheese.
5. Bake 20-25 minutes at 350 degrees until bubbly. Serve plain or with shredded lettuce and tomatoes.

***Easy Chicken & Cheese Enchiladas** (Wendy Connors' recipe)

1 can cream of chicken soup
1 ½ c sour cream
1 ½ c Pace Picante Sauce
2-3 c chopped cooked chicken (*my notes say flavor it w/"SeasonAll", bake it in the oven, then shred it)*
6-8 flour tortillas, warmed
1 can red enchilada sauce
2-3 c shredded Monterey Jack (or Mexican blend) cheese
1 small tomato, chopped (optional)
1 green onion, sliced (optional)

1. Pour ¼ of the enchilada sauce into a glass baking dish.
2. Mix the soup, sour cream, picante sauce and chicken in a bowl.
3. Fill each tortilla with a generous portion of the chicken mixture, then top with cheese, and roll up. Repeat until all mixture is used.
4. cover the tortillas with the remaining enchilada sauce and use remaining cheese on top.
5. Bake at 350 degrees for 30-40 minutes or until the cheese melts completely and enchiladas are hot and bubbling. Top with the tomato and onion, if desired.

Alternate: Stir ½ c canned black beans, drained and rinsed, into the chicken mixture before filling the tortillas.

Stacked Chicken Enchiladas (from *Cooking Light*, March 2014, p. 94)
Serves 6

2 T canola oil
8 boneless skinless chicken thighs (about 2 lbs)
1 t ground cumin
½ t kosher salt
¼ t ground red pepper
2 c chopped white onion
8 garlic cloves, minced
1 (15 oz) can whole peeled tomatoes, undrained and crushed
1 c chopped fresh cilantro, divided
3 T fresh lime juice
1 (7 oz) can salsa verde
cooking spray
12 (6 in) corn tortillas
3 oz shredded pepper-Jack cheese (about ¾ c)
6 T Mexican crema *(or sour cream)*

1. Place a small roasting pan in oven. Preheat oven to 425 (leave roasting pan in oven as it preheats).
2. Heat a large skillet over medium-high heat. Add oil to pan; swirl to coat. Sprinkle both sides of chicken evenly with cumin, salt, and pepper. Add chicken to pan; saute 3 minutes. Turn chicken over, and place in the preheated roasting pan. Add onion, garlic, and tomatoes to pan; bake at 425 for 15 minutes or until chicken is done. Cool. Shred chicken; toss with tomato mixture.
3. Combine ¾ c cilantro, juice, and salsa verde; spread ¼ c salsa mixture in the bottom of an 11x7 in dish coated with cooking spray. Top with 4 overlapping tortillas, half of chicken mixture, and ¼ c salsa mixture. Repeat layers. Top with remaining 4 tortillas and remaining salsa mixture; sprinkle evenly with cheese. Bake at 425 for 15 minutes or until golden; sprinkle with remaining ¼ c cilantro Top each serving with 1 T crema.

Honey-Lime Chicken Enchiladas - *Everyone liked these -- yummy tasting chicken, nice mild sauce*
Makes 8-10 servings

6 T honey
5 T lime juice
1 T chili powder
½ t garlic powder
2-3 c cooked, shredded chicken
2 c green enchilada sauce, divided
8-10 flour tortillas
4 c shred. Mont. Jack cheese, divided
1 c heavy whipping cream

1. Whisk the first four ingredients and toss with shredded chicken in a resealable plastic bag. Let chicken marinate in the fridge for at least 30 minutes, but preferably half a day or so.
2. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Pour about ½ c green enchilada sauce on the bottom of a 9x13 inch baking pan. Remove chicken from bag, reserving any leftover marinade, and set aside. Fill the tortillas with chicken and shredded cheese, saving about 1 cup cheese to sprinkle on top of enchiladas. Place rolled tortillas in 9x13 pan as you go.
3. Mix the remaining enchilada sauce with the cream and leftover marinade. Pour sauce on top of the enchiladas. Sprinkle with remaining cheese. Bake 30 minutes, until brown and crispy on top.

Pollo Grande Quesadillas (from *Worldwide Ward Cookbook- Mom's Best Recipes*, p. 123)
Makes 10-12 servings

<u>Quesadillas</u>:
4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts, diced
1 large sweet onion, coarsely diced
5-10 T oil, divided
Fajita seasoning to taste
2 bell peppers (any color), very coarsely chopped
8 oz. mushrooms, sliced (optional)

<u>Jalapeno Cheese Sauce</u>:
4 oz Neufchatel cheese
¼ c fat-free sour cream
½ t garlic
¼ c milk
1-5 T pickled jalapeno peppers, seeds removed (*I used salsa*)

<u>For assembly</u>:
10-12 tortillas
12 oz cheese (Monterrey Jack or cheddar), shredded

In a frying pan, fry chicken and onions in 1-2 T oil and fajita seasoning to taste until chicken is cooked and onions are tender. In a separate pan, fry peppers in 1-2 T oil until crisp-tender, adding the mushrooms to the peppers during the last 4-5 minutes of frying, if desired. In a blender, puree all Jalapeno Cheese Sauce ingredients. To assemble, layer one half of each tortilla with chicken mixture, peppers and mushrooms, 2 T shredded cheese, and 1-2 T Jalapeno Cheese Sauce. Fold over the other half of the tortilla, enclosing all of the filling. On a griddle or pan lightly brushed with the cooking oil (I used cooking spray), fry the quesadilla until the tortilla is light brown and the cheese inside has melted.

Black Bean Quesadillas (from Shannon Nelson - *taken from Light & Tasty Magazine*)
Prep:25 min. Bake:10 min. - *Yield: 5 servings*

1 medium sweet yellow pepper, chopped
1 cup finely chopped onion
2 garlic cloves, minced
1 teaspoon canola oil
2 medium tomatoes, chopped
1 cup frozen corn, thawed
1 can (15 ounces) black beans, rinsed and drained
¼ teaspoon pepper
1/8 teaspoon salt
10 flour tortillas (6 inches)
1 cup (4 ounces) shredded reduced-fat cheddar cheese

1. In a large nonstick skillet coated with nonstick cooking spray, sauté the yellow pepper, onion, and garlic in oil for 2 minutes. Stir in tomatoes and corn, cook 2 minutes longer. Add the black beans, pepper and salt. Cook until vegetables are tender, drain.
2. Spritz one side of each tortilla with nonstick cooking spray; place plain side up on baking sheets coated with nonstick cooking spray. Spoon bean mixture onto half of each tortilla; sprinkle with cheese. Fold tortilla over filling.
3. Bake at 400o for 6 minutes. Carefully turn over; bake 4-7 minutes longer or until cheese is melted.

Nutrition facts: 2 quesadillas equals 381 calories, 12 g fat (3 g saturated fat), 16 mg cholesterol, 820 mg sodium, 53 g carbohydrate, 6 g fiber, 18 g protein. Diabetic Exchanges: 31/2 starch, 1 lean meat, 1 vegetable, 1 fat.

Chicken Quesadillas
serves 3; 5 minute prep time

1 c medium salsa
2 c grilled chicken, diced, or roasted chicken, shredded
1 T chopped green onion
1 T chopped cilantro
3 flour tortillas
1 ½ c mixed shredded Cheddar and mozzarella cheeses
salsa, sour cream and guacamole, for serving

In a bowl, combine salsa, chicken, scallions and cilantro. Place 1 flour tortilla in a saute pan. Heat for 20 seconds on medium-high. Spread ½ c of the mixed cheeses over the tortilla to cover it. Spoon 1 c of the chicken mixture over the tortilla, fold and heat through. Slice and serve. Repeat with 2 more tortillas. If desired, serve with extra salsa, sour cream and guacamole for dipping.

Chicken in Salsa Verde Tamales

<u>For the Salsa Verde:</u>
2 lbs green tomatillos, husks removed and rinsed
2 garlic cloves, peeled
2 serrano chilies, or more to taste
2 T corn oil
1 c cilantro leaves
¼ c white onion, roughly chopped
1 t kosher or sea salt
<u>For the Chicken:</u>
2 c cooked chicken, shredded
<u>For the Tamale Dough or Masa:</u>
¾ c vegetable shortening
½ t kosher or coarse sea salt
1 t cold water, divided
1 t baking powder
1 lb (about 3 ¼ c) instant corn masa for tortillas or tamales
3 ½ c chicken stock (add more if needed)
<u>For wrapping tamales</u>:
25 dried corn husks, soaking in warm water or substitute 5x10" parchment paper rectangles

1. TO MAKE THE SALSA: Place the tomatillos, garlic and chilies in a pot and cover with water; bring to a boil. Simmer at medium for about 10 minutes, or until tomatillos change from bright green to a pale green, are cooked through, and are soft, but not coming apart. Place tomatillos, oil, garlic and chili (add on at a time) and ½ c of the cooking liquid from tomatillos in a blender; puree until smooth. Blend in cilantro, onion, and salt, to taste. Add another chili, as desired. Set aside.
2. TO MAKE THE FILLING: Combine the salsa verde with the cooked shredded chicken.
3. TO MAKE THE TAMALE DOUGH OR MASA: Place shortening in a mixer and beat until very light, about 1 minute. Add salt and 1 t cold water, and continue beating until white and spongy, a couple more minutes. Add baking powder; alternate adding the instant corn masa and the chicken stock. Continue beating until dough is homogeneous and very fluffy. You know the tamale masa is ready if, when you drop ½ t of the masa in a c of cold water, it floats.
4. TO PREPARE THE STEAMER: Place hot water in the bottom pan of a steamer (only enough so the water is just under the basket with the tamales and not touching them) and bring it to a simmer. Line the steamer basket with one or two layers of soaked corn husks.
5. ASSEMBLE ALL THE TAMALES: Soak dried corn husks in hot water for 2 minutes, or until pliable; drain. (1) Lay out a corn husk, tapered end towards you. (2) Spread about 3 T masa into about a 2-3 inch square. The layer should be about ¼ in thick, leaving a border of at least ½ inch on the sides. (3) Place 1 T of filling in the middle of the masa square. Use dough to form about 18 cornhusk-wrapped tamales. (4) Pick up the two long sides of the corn husk and bring them together (you will see how the masa starts to swaddle the filling) and fold the folded sides to one side, rolling them in the same direction around tamale. (5) Fold up the empty section of the husk with the tapering end, from the bottom up. This will form a closed bottom and the top will be left open. (6) Turn folded end to table. (7) With kitchen twine or strip of husk, tie around the center to hold folded husk together. (8) Unwrap after cooking, before eating. (While assembling others, place finished tamales as vertically as you can in a container.)



6. STEAM TO COOK: When you have them all ready, place them, again as vertically as you can, on the prepared steamer, with the open tamale end at the top. If there is space left in the steamer, tuck in some corn husks, so the tamales won't dance around. Cover with more corn husks, and steam, covered for 50-60 minutes. You know the tamales are ready when they come easily free from the husks. They will still be moist, and as they are released from the husks, you will see the moistness, like when you remove good moist muffins from their paper baking cups.
7. Finished tamales will stay warm for about 1-2 hours in the steamer. They can be made several days before and stored in the refrigerator, well wrapped. They can also be frozen for months. In either case, reheat in a steamer. For refrigerated tamales, it will take about 15 minutes, and for frozen tamales about 45 minutes to reheat.

Chicken Quesadillas with Corn and Black Bean Salsa (from *The $5 Dinner Mom Cookbook*, p. 122)
4 servings

1-1½ c cooked black beans
2 chicken breasts (you can use 2 c of leftover shredded, cooked chicken instead of these)
1 t canola oil
1 c frozen corn kernels
1 t vinegar
Salt and pepper
6 whole wheat tortillas
2 c shredded cheddar cheese
sour cream, salsa, guacamole (optional)

1. Saute the chicken in a skillet with oil for 6-8 minutes on each side, or until the chicken is no longer pink in the middle. Remove the chicken from the skillet and let cool. Shred or cut the chicken into ½ inch pieces to be used in the quesadillas.
2. Cook the corn. Drain.
3. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees. In a small bowl, combine the cooked black beans, cooked corn, vinegar, and the remaining oil (left in pan). Season the corn and black bean salsa with salt and pepper to taste.

4. Place a tortilla flat on a baking sheet. Sprinkle with the shredded cheese and shredded chicken. Place another tortilla on top. Repeat to make 3 quesadillas. Bake in the preheated oven for 10-15 minutes, or until cheese has melted.
5. Serve Chicken Quesadillaas with corn and black bean salsa.

Chicken Chili Nachos (*Family Circle*, August 2012)
Makes 8 servings

2 T olive oil
1 medium onion, chopped
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 lb ground chicken
3 T chili powder
½ t salt
½ t ground cumin
1 can (14.5 oz) diced tomatoes with zesty green chiles
1 T tomato paste
16 oz tortilla chips
1 ½ c Mexican cheese blend
Jalapeno peppers, sour cream, guacamole, tomatoes, and cilantro (optional toppings)

1. Heat oven to 400 degrees. Heat oil in a large, lidded nonstick skillet over medium heat. Add onion and cook 5 minutes. Stir in garlic and cook an additional minute. Add ground chicken and increase heat to medium-high. Stir in chili powder, salt, and cumin and cook for 6-7 minutes.
2. Stir in diced tomatoes and tomato paste. Cover and simmer over low heat for 5 minutes.
3. Meanwhile, arrange half of the tortilla chips on an oven-safe platter or rimmed baking sheet. Spoon half the chicken chili over chips and top with ¾ c of the cheese. Repeat layering. Bake at 400 for 8 minutes or until cheese has melted. Garnish with toppings, if desired.

Grilled Chicken Tostadas – From *Family Fun* Magazine
Serves 6-8

1 ½ lbs boneless chicken
8 small corn tortillas
1 ½ c shredded Monterey Jack (or more)
1 ½ c shredded lettuce
Optional: salsa, guacamole, sour cream, cilantro, green onions

<u>Marinade</u>:
½ c fresh lime juice
¼ c soy sauce
¼ c vegetable oil
1 T honey
2 t minced garlic
1 ½ t chili powder

1. Put chicken in Ziploc with marinade in fridge 4 hours or overnight.
2. Heat grill to medium high heat.
3. Remove chicken from bag (throw away extra juice) and grill about 4-5 minutes per side. Let rest about 5 minutes, then cut into ½ inch strips.
4. Lightly brush tortillas with oil then grill until slightly brown, about 1 minute. Sprinkle with 1 T cheese before removing from the grill.
5. To serve, layer with lettuce, chicken, cheese and anything extra.

Mexican Chicken Lasagna (Trina Smith - *from RS $5 recipes)*

1-2 pkg(s) cream cheese
1/4 cup chopped cilantro leaves
2 cups shredded Monterey Jack Cheese
1 28 oz can mild green enchilada sauce
6 corn tortillas
3 cups diced cooked chicken
2/3 cup chopped onion
1 cup corn
1 cup black beans

1. Microwave the cream cheese to very soft and then add 1-1/2 Monterey Jack cheese and cilantro. Mix well.

2. Begin layering by spreading 2/3 cup of enchilada sauce over the bottom of a round or square glass baking dish. Put the remaining sauce in another bowl.
3. Dip 3 corn tortillas in sauce and set it on top the layer of sauce
4. Layer next with cream cheese mixture and spread evenly
5. Next- layer 1 cup of chicken and 1/2 of the onion, 1/2 corn, 1/2 of beans
6. Repeat the layering again: sauce, cream cheese, tortillas, chicken, onion, corn, and beans.
7. Pour another 1/2 cup of sauce over the entire mixture and top with remaining 1/2 cup of Monterey cheese
8. Bake for 30 minutes at 305 degrees or can Microwave-covered on high for 13 minutes. Let stand for 10 minutes and sprinkle with additional chopped cilantro

**Yummy to serve as a dip with large tortilla chips.

Fajitas with Stir-Fried Chicken (by Sherilyn Riboldi - *from RS $5 cookbook)*

1 lb skinless, boneless chicken breast cut in ¼ inch strips
½ C. lemon juice
6 T. chopped cilantro
4 t. cumin
2 t. cornstarch
1 t. salt
½ t. pepper
8 flour tortillas
1 C. mild red or green salsa
8 large lettuce leaves
2 T. oil
½ C. sour cream

Preheat oven to 200 degrees. Place chicken in small bowl. Add 6 T. lemon juice, 2 T. cilantro, cumin, cornstarch, salt and pepper and mix gently until chicken is well coated. Stack tortillas and wrap in foil. Place them in the oven to warm for 5 to 10 minutes. Make the sauce: stir together the salsa, remaining 2 T. lemon juice and 4 T. cilantro. Shred lettuce. In a medium skillet, warm the oil over medium-high heat. Add chicken and sauté until white and firm, about 5 minutes. Place the tortillas, the chicken, shredded lettuce, sauce and sour cream in serving dishes. The diners can assemble their own fajitas.

Enchiladas with Green Sauce
4 servings

<u>Cheese Filling</u>
2 c shredded Monterey Jack cheese (8 oz)
1 c shredded Cheddar cheese (4 oz)
1 medium onion, chopped
½ c sour cream
2 T snipped parsley
1 t salt
¼ t pepper

<u>Green sauce</u>
10 oz fresh spinach or 1 10 oz pkg frozen spinach
2 T margarine or butter
2 T flour
¼ t salt
½ c milk
1 ½ c chicken broth
1-2 T chopped, canned chilies
1 small onion, chopped
1 clove garlic, finely chopped
¾ t ground cumin
2/3 c sour cream
8 six-inch tortillas

1. Prepare cheese filling by mixing all ingredients.
2. To prepare green sauce, wash spinach; cover and cook with just the water that clings to leaves until tender, 3-5 minutes. Drain and pat dry with paper towels (or just drain if frozen spinach); chop coarsely.
3. Heat margarine over low heat until melted. Blend in flour and salt. Cook over low heat, stirring constantly, until smooth and bubbly; remove from heat. Stir in milk and ½ c of the chicken broth; heat to boiling, stirring constantly. Boil and stir 1 minute. Stir in remaining chicken broth. Cook and stir over low heat until hot; remove from heat. Stir in spinach and remaining ingredients.
4. Heat tortillas, one at a time, in ungreased skillet until softened, about 30 seconds. Dip each tortilla into green sauce to coat both sides. Spoon about ¼ c cheese filling onto each tortilla; roll tortilla around filling.
5. Arrange enchiladas seam sides down in ungreased oblong baking dish. Pour remaining sauce over enchiladas. Cook uncovered in 350 degree oven until bubbly, about 20 minutes. Garnish with shredded cheddar or Monterey jack

cheese and lime wedges if desired.

Chicken Enchiladas (recipe from LaRue Jeffs, at Lisa's bridal shower)
makes about 12

3 chicken breasts, cooked and chopped
2 cans cream of mushroom soup
1 c 7 oz ortega chilies, diced
½ medium onion, chopped
1 lb shredded cheddar cheese
2 c sour cream
12 tortillas, fried lightly

Mix all ingredients (except ½ of cheese) and fill tortillas. Pour remaining mixture over top. Bake at 350 for 25 minutes. Cover top with the rest of the cheese and bake 10 more minutes.

Black Bean and Sweet Potato Enchiladas (taken from www.5dollardinners.com)

2 medium sweet potatoes
1 can black beans or 2 cups cooked black beans
½ c salsa
12 corn tortillas
1 can (10-14 oz) red enchilada sauce
2 c shredded cheddar jack cheese

1. Heat oven to 350 degrees
2. Bake sweet potatoes in casserole dish with a little bit of water in the bottom, covered with foil, for one hour. Cool, then peel and cut into bite size chunks. Put in mixing bowl. (THIS STEP CAN BE DONE AHEAD OF TIME SO THAT ALL YOU HAVE TO DO IS PULL THE COOKED SWEET POTATOES OUT OF THE FRIDGE AND ASSEMBLE THE ENCHILADAS.)
3. Add the drained and rinsed black beans to the sweet potatoes. Add salsa. Gently combine.
4. Spoon mixture into tortillas. Roll and place in pan, seam side down. Pour red sauce over top. Sprinkle cheese over top of the red sauce.
5. Bake 25 minutes. Serve with lettuce and sour cream if desired. You could add corn as a side dish…

Ooey Gooey Mexican Chicken (from *365 Days of Slow Cooking)*

3 chicken breasts
1 can cream of chicken soup
1 can cream of mushroom soup
1 c salsa
1 15 oz can black beans, drained and rinsed
1 4 oz can diced green chiles
1 t chili powder
1 t cumin
¼ t pepper
1 ½ c shredded Monterey jack cheese

Combine chicken breasts, soups, salsa, beans, chilies, chili powder, and cumin in slow cooker. Cover and cook on LOW for 5-6 hours and then use 2 forks to shred the chicken. Add in the cheese and pepper and stir. Serve with tortilla chips or over flour tortillas.

Slow Cooker Chicken Taco Bowls (from Smith's ***my****magazine*)
Serves 6

1 jar (16 oz) corn salsa
1 can (4 oz) green chilies
juice of 1 lime
1 pkg taco seasoning
2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken breasts
2 T chopped, fresh cilantro
1 can black beans, drained and rinsed
4 c cooked rice, for serving
For topping: tortilla chips, shredded cheese, sour cream, diced avocado, jalapeno slices, chopped red onion and shredded lettuce

1. Pour salsa, chilies, lime juice and taco seasoning into slow cooker and stir to combine. Add chicken and toss to coat. cook on low for 8 hours or high for 4 hours, until chicken is cooked to a safe internal temperature of 165 degrees. Remove chicken and shred with a fork. Put back in slow cooker, then add cilantro and black beans. Stir and cook 20 additional minutes.
2. Scoop chicken and bean mixture over bowls of rice, add tortilla chips around sides of bowls and serve immediately with toppings.

Crockpot Salsa Chicken (from Cassie & Stephanie Neeley)

2-4 chicken breasts
1 packet taco seasoning
1 cup salsa

Cook in crockpot for 4 hours on high or 6 hours on low. After cooking, shred chicken. Serve in burritos/tacos with tortillas, rice, and beans.

Grilled Fish Tacos (from *Cook's Illustrated*, Sept/Oct 2014)
Serves 6

3 T vegetable oil
1 T ancho chile powder
2 t chipotle chile powder
1 t dried oregano
1 t ground coriander
2 garlic cloves, minced
salt
2 T tomato paste
½ c orange juice
6 T lime juice (3 limes)
2 lbs skinless swordfish steaks, 1 inch thick, cut lengthwise into 1 inch-wide strips
1 pineapple, peeled, quartered lengthwise, cored, and each quarter halved lengthwise
1 jalapeno chile
18 (6-in) corn tortillas
1 red bell pepper, stemmed, seeded, and cut into 1/4 -in pieces
2 T minced fresh cilantro, plus extra for serving
½ head iceberg lettuce (4 ½ oz), cored and thinly sliced
1 avocado, halved, pittled, and sliced thin
lime wedges

1. Heat 2 T oil, ancho chile powder, and chipotle chile powder in 8-in skillet over medium heat, stirring constantly, until fragrant and some bubbles form, 2-3 minutes. Add oregano, coriander, garlic, and 1 t salt and continue to cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds longer. Add tomato paste and, using spatula, mash tomato paste with spice mixture until combined, about 20 seconds. Stir in orange juice and 2 T lime juice. Cook, stirring constantly, until thoroughly mixed and reduced slightly, about 2 minutes. Transfer chile mixture to large bowl and let cool for 15 minutes.
2. Add swordfish to bowl with chile mixture, and stir gently with rubber spatula to coat fish. Cover and refrigerate for 30 minutes to 2 hours.
3. Turn all gas grill burners to high, cover, and heat grill until hot, about 15 minutes. Turn all burners to medium-high.
4. Clean cooking grate, then repeatedly brush grate with well-oiled paper towels until grate is black and glossy, 5-10 times.Brush both sides of pineapple with remaining 1 T oil. Place fish on half of grill. Place pineapple and jalapeno on other half. Cover and cook until fish, pineapple, and jalapeno have begun to brown, 3-5 minutes. Using thin spatula, flip fish, pineapple, and jalapeno over. Cover and continue to cook until second sides of pineapple and jalapeno are browned and swordfish registers 140 degrees, 3-5 minutes. Transfer fish to large platter, flake into pieces, and tent with aluminum foil. Transfer pineapple and jalapeno to cutting board.
5. Clean cooking grate. Place half of tortillas on grill. Grill until softened and speckled with brown spots, 30-45 seconds per side. Wrap tortillas in dish towel or foil to keep warm. Repeat with remaining tortillas.
6. When cool enough to handle, finely chop pineapple and jalapeno. transfer to medium bowl and stir in bell pepper, cilantro and remaining 4 T lime juice. Season with salt to taste. Top tortillas with flaked fish, salsa, lettuce, and avocado. Serve with lime wedges and extra cilantro.

BBQ chicken baked potatoes (*Adapted from www.5dollardinners.com*)

2-3 chicken breasts
½ bottle BBQ sauce
4-8 potatoes, scrubbed and stabbed with a fork once or twice
½ onion, chopped
½ cup cheddar/jack cheese

1. Cook chicken for 4-5 hours on low heat in a crock pot. Shred with two forks (when it is easy to shred, you know it's cooked enough). Add enough BBQ sauce to make it as saucy as you like it.
2. Cook potatoes in oven (400 degrees for 45 minutes) or microwave
3. Dump onions into microwave safe bowl and heat 1-2 minutes until warm.
4. Cut potatoes open and top with chicken, onions, and cheese, as desired.

BBQ chicken Quesadillas (Adapted from www.5dollardinners.com)

2-3 chicken breasts
½ bottle BBQ sauce
1-2 packages tortillas
½-1 cup cheddar/jack cheese
½ onion, chopped

1. Cook chicken for 4-5 hours on low heat in a crock pot. Shred with two forks (when it is easy to shred, you know it's cooked enough). Add enough BBQ sauce to make it as saucy as you like it.
2. Spread meat mixture over a tortilla. Top with cheese and onions and place 2nd tortilla on top. Cook in oven or microwave until cheese is melted. Slice in pie wedges and serve.

Healthy Mama Barbecue Chicken (from Nicole Goble)

3 medium sweet potatoes, cut into ½ inch pieces
2 large green pepper, cut into strips
1 large red pepper, cut into strips
1 zucchini, chopped
1 medium onion, sliced
1 T quick cooking tapioca *(I didn't have any and it turned out ok)*
2 lbs chicken
1 8 oz can of tomato sauce
2 T packed brown sugar
1 T Worcestershire sauce
1 T yellow mustard
1 clove garlic, minced
¼ t salt

1. Dump everything into 2 gallon freezer bags, shake it up, seal, label, and put in the freezer. (Or just make and put directly into the crockpot.)
2. To cook, take out of freezer and set on counter for about 30 minutes, then dump contents of bag into crock pot. Cook on high for 4 hours, or low for 8 hours. Yummy served over rice.

Turkey Sweet Potato Casserole
serves 6

2 c peeled, cooked, and mashed sweet potatoes
2 T packed brown sugar
½ t ground cinnamon
⅛ t ground nutmeg
⅓ c evaporated milk
¼ c chicken broth or stock
¼ c minced onion
1 c Cream of Chicken soup
3 c cubed cooked turkey
3 T water

1. Stir the potatoes, brown sugar, cinnamon, nutmeg, and milk in a medium bowl. Spoon the potato mixture around the inside edge of a 10" round casserole to form a ring.
2. Heat the broth and onion in a 10" skillet over med-high heat to a boil. Reduce the heat to low. Cook until the onion is tender, stirring occasionally. Stir in the soup, turkey and water. Cook until the mixture is hot and bubbling. Spoon the turkey mixture into the center of the potato ring.
3. Bake at 350 F for 30 minutes or until the turkey mixture is hot and bubbling.

Bacon-Wrapped Apple Chicken (from *The $5 Dinner Mom Cookbook*, p. 92)
includes side dish recipes for a complete meal

½ c BBQ sauce
1 Granny Smith apple, peeled and grated
1 T lemon juice
3 boneless, skinless chicken breasts
3 slices bacon, cut in half
2 sweet potatoes
1 c frozen green beans

1. In a small bowl, combine the BBQ sauce with the grated apple and lemon juice.
2. Place the chicken breast in slow cooker, pour the BBQ-apple mixture over the chicken. Wrap 3 pieces of bacon over each sauced chicken breast. Set the slow cooker on low and cook for 8 hours.
3. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees. Make a few slits in the sweet potatoes using a small sharp knife. Put the sweet potatoes in a baking dish with ¼ inch of water and cover with aluminum foil. Bake the sweet potatoes in the preheated oven for 1 hour. Remove from the oven and let cool about 10 minutes. Peel off the skins and mash the pulp.
4. Cook the green beans.
5. Serve the chicken with mashed sweet potatoes and green beans.

Chicken Cordon Bleu Casserole
35 minutes total - Serves 6

1 c reduced fat sour cream
1 ½ c reduced sodium chicken broth
1 T dijon mustard
¼ t ground black pepper
1 ½ c instant rice, uncooked
20 oz fully cooked frozen diced grilled chicken breast, thawed
4 ½ oz deli thin sliced smoked ham, cut into pieces
1 pkg (6 oz) sliced swiss cheese, cut into pieces
1 c frozen peas (optional)
1 c corn flakes (crushed)
½ c grated Parmesan cheese
2 T butter, melted

1. Preheat oven to 400.
2. Whisk together sour cream, broth, dijon mustard, and pepper in a large bowl until smooth. Add rice, chicken, ham, swiss cheese and frozen peas; stir to combine.
3. Pour mixture into 13x9 pan and spread evenly.
4. Mix together crushed corn flakes, Parmesan cheese, and melted butter in a small bowl. Sprinkle evenly over top of the casserole.
5. Bake uncovered on center oven rack for 25 minutes until heated through and topping is golden brown.

Chicken Cordon Bleu (from *365 Days of Slow Cooking)*
Serves 8

8 boneless, skinless chicken breasts
1 tsp salt
1/8 tsp pepper
1 tsp dried thyme leaves
8 thin slices of ham
1 onion, chopped
4 cloves garlic, minced
1 (16 oz) jar alfredo sauce
1 (10 oz) can cream of chicken soup
2 cups shredded swiss cheese

Sprinkle chicken breasts with salt, pepper, and thyme. Wrap a slice of ham around each breast and secure with toothpicks. Place onion and garlic in a 5 to 6 quart slow cooker. Top with wrapped chicken breasts. In a medium bowl, combine remaining ingredients. Pour into slow cooker. Cover and cook on LOW for 6-8 hours or until chicken is thoroughly cooked. Serve with rice.

***Stove-Top One Dish Chicken Bake**
Makes 4 servings

1 pkg (6 oz) Stove Top Stuffing Mix for Chicken
4 boneless skinless chicken breast halves (about 1 ¼ lb)
1 can cream of chicken or cream of mushroom soup
1/3 c sour cream or milk

1. Toss contents of stuffing mix and 1 2/3 c water. Set aside.
2. Place chicken in 13x9 in baking dish or 2 quart casserole. Mix soup and sour cream or milk; pour over chicken. Spoon stuffing evenly over top.
3. Bake at 375 degrees for 35 minutes or until chicken is cooked through. Serve over rice or mashed potatoes.

Crockpot Chicken and Stuffing (served at a RS dinner - very yummy)
Makes 6 servings

14 oz dried seasoned stuffing mix
1 sweet onion diced
½ c diced celery
2 10oz cans cream of chicken soup
½ c chicken broth
½ t ground sage
1 ½ lbs bnls sknls chicken breasts
¼ t salt
¼ t pepper

1. Spray slow cooker with non-stick spray.
2. Add the stuffing mix, onion, celery, cream of chicken soup, and chicken broth to the slow cooker and stir to combine.
3. Sprinkle the sage over the top.
4. Lay the chicken breasts on top of the stuffing mixture and season with salt and pepper.
5. Cover and cook on low for 4 hours 30 minutes or until chicken cooks through.
6. Shred the chicken with two forks or remove to a cutting board and slice into small pieces.
7. Stir everything together and serve.

Easy Dinner Roll Ups

Shake boneless skinless chicken breasts or turkey cutlets in Shake 'N Bake Original Coating Mix.
Mix 1 pkg (6 oz) Stove Top mix with 12/3 c water. Spoon over each chicken piece and roll up. Place seam-side down on foil-lined baking pan.
Toss some vegetables such as squash, carrots, onions, peppers, potatoes, zucchini in Italian Dressing; place on baking pan with chicken. Bake at 400 degrees for 30 min.

***Quiche** (from Better Homes and Gardens Cookbook)
Serves 6

Pastry for a single crust pie
3 beaten eggs
1 ½ c milk
¼ c sliced green onion
¼ t salt
1/8 t pepper
Dash ground nutmeg
¾ c chopped cooked chicken or ham or bacon
1 ½ c shredded swiss, cheddar, Monterey Jack, or Havarti cheese
1 T flour

1. Prepare pie crust. Place crust in pie pan and crimp edges. Back in 450 degree oven for 5-7 minutes, until edges are light brown and crust is nearly done. Remove from the oven. *Reduce oven temperature to 325 degrees.*
2. Meanwhile, in a bowl stir together eggs, milk, onion, salt, pepper, and nutmeg. Stir in meat. Toss cheese with the flour (this keeps it from clumping together in the quiche). Add to egg mixture; mix well.
3. Pour egg mixture into *hot* pastry shell. Bake in the 325 degree oven for 35-40 minutes or until a knife inserted near the

center comes out clean. (This usually takes closer to 50-60 minutes for me…) Let stand 10 minutes before serving (unless you want to burn your mouth!)

***Easy Frittata** (by Arika Moore - *from RS $5 cookbook)*

7 large eggs
1 cup cottage cheese
salt and pepper, Onion & Garlic powders
3/4 cup grated cheddar cheese
3/4 cup grated mozzarella or parmesan cheese

Toss together both cheeses and set aside 1/2 cup. In a large bowl combine all ingredients except for reserved cheese. Grease a 8X8 baking dish with cooking spray and pour egg mixture in. Top with remaining cheese. Bake at 400 F for 35-40 minutes or until eggs are set and cheese is golden. Works as a side dish or a main dish. You can also add in pretty much anything, a little thyme or rosemary, roasted garlic, leftover pasta or ham.

Cheese Souffle (from *Cooks' Illustrated*, January & February 2014)
serves 4-6

1 oz Parmesan cheese, grated (½ c)
¼ c (1 ¼ oz) all-purpose flour
¼ t paprika
¼ t salt
⅛ t cayenne pepper
⅛ t white pepper
pinch ground nutmeg
4 T unsalted butter
1 ⅓ c whole milk
6 oz Gruyere chs, shredded (1 ½ c)
6 large eggs, separated
2 t minced fresh parsley
¼ t cream of tartar

1. Adjust oven rack to middle position and heat oven to 350 degrees. Spray 8-in round (2 qt) souffle dish with vegetable oil spray, then sprinkle with 2 T parmesan.
2. Combine flour, paprika, salt, cayenne, white pepper, and nutmeg in bowl. Melt butter in small saucepan over medium heat. Stir in flour mixture and cook for 1 minute. Slowly whisk in milk and bring to simmer. Cook, whisking constantly, until mixture is thickened and smooth, about 1 minute. Remove pan from heat and whisk in Gruyere and 5 T Parmesan until melted and smooth. Let cool for 10 minutes, then whisk in egg yolks and 1 ½ t parsley.
3. Using stand mixer fitted with whisk, whip egg whites and cream of tartar on medium-low speed until foamy, about 1 minute. Increase speed to medium-high and whip until stiff peaks form, 3-4 minutes. Add cheese mixture and continue to whip until fully combined, about 15 seconds.
4. Pour mixture into prepared dish and sprinkle with remaining 1 T Parmesan. Bake until risen above rim, top is deep golden brown, and interior registers 170 degrees, 30-35 minutes. Sprinkle with remaining ½ t parsley and serve immediately.

Chili Relleno Casserole (from Nancy McLain at our Dutch Oven class)
Serves 8-10

1 lb lean ground beef
1 bell pepper, chopped
1 onion, chopped
1 (4 oz) can chopped green chilies *(I don't think we used these)*
1 t oregano
1 t dried cilantro leaves
¾ t garlic powder
2 (4 oz) cans whole green chilies *(we used fresh Anaheim chilies)*
1 ½ c grated Monterey Jack cheese
1 ½ c grated sharp cheddar cheese
3 large eggs
1 T flour
1 c half-and-half *(I used milk)*

1. Cook meat with bell pepper and onion in skillet
2. Add chopped green chilies, oregano, cilantro, garlic powder and about ½ t each of salt and pepper.
3. Seed and chop Anaheim chilies and spread on bottom of greased 9x13 baking dish (or in bottom of Dutch Oven).

4. Cover with meat mixture and sprinkle with cheeses.
5. Combine eggs and flour and beat with fork until fluffy.
6. Add half-and-half; mix and pour slowly over top of meat in casserole.
7. Bake uncovered at 350 degrees for 35 minutes or until it is light brown.

Chiles Rellenos Casserole (lighter version)
serves 4

4 oz bacon, thinly sliced crosswise
1 medium onion, chopped
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 t ground cumin
1 can (16 oz) pinto beans, rinsed and drained
1 c frozen corn (no need to thaw)
½ t salt, divided
nonstick cooking spray
1 can (10 oz) whole green chilies, drained and cut into thin strips, divided
1 c (4 oz) grated Monterey Jack cheese, divided
3 T all-purpose flour
3 large eggs + 1 egg white
1 c milk

1. Preheat the oven to 350; position a rack in the center.
2. In a medium (10 inch) skillet, cook the bacon over med-lo heat until nearly crisp. Drain on paper towels. Pour off all but 2 t grease and return skillet to the burner; increase to med-high heat. Cook onion until soft and translucent, about 6 minutes. Add the garlic and cumin; cook another minute. Add the pinto beans, corn and cooked bacon; season with ¼ t salt and stir.
3. Grease an 11x7" baking dish (or any similar size shallow baking dish) with non-stick cooking spray. Arrange half of the chilies on the bottom. Top with half the cheese, then all the pinto bean mixture. Arrange the remaining chilies on top; sprinkle with remaining cheese.
4. In a large bowl, combine the flour and remaining ¼ t salt. Add the eggs and egg white, and beat until blended. Beat in the milk. Pour over the casserole. Bake for 45-60 minutes, until set in the center and golden and puffed on top. Cool for 5 minutes before serving.

Chicken Divan Crepes

¼ c butter
¼ c flour
2 c chicken broth
2 t Worcestershire sauce
3 c grated cheddar cheese
2 c sour cream
2 (10 oz) pkgs frozen broccoli, or 1 ½ lbs broccoli, cooked and drained
2 c chopped cooked chicken
12 cooked crepes

1. Over medium heat, melt butter in small saucepan. Stir and cook until bubbly. Add broth and Worcestershire sauce; cook, stirring until thickened. Add 2 c cheese.
2. Empty sour cream into medium bowl; gradually add hot cheese sauce, stirring constantly.
3. In large shallow baking dish, place cooked broccoli and cooked chicken on each crepe. Spoon 1 T sauce over each. Fold crepes over. Pour remaining sauce over all. Sprinkle with remaining cup of cheese. Cover and heat in 350 degree oven for 20-30 minutes.

***Curry of Chicken Breast Crepes**

¼ c chopped onion
¼ c chopped celery
¼ c butter
½ t salt
1 T curry powder
¼ c flour
1 c milk or light cream
1 ½ c chicken broth/bouillon
1 T sherry
3 c chopped cooked chicken
10 cooked crepes
1/3 c grated Parmesan cheese

Saute onions and celery in butter several minutes; mix in salt and curry powder. Add flour; cook until bubbly. Pour in milk and broth; cook on low heat, stirring until smooth and thick. Remove from heat; add sherry. Divide sauce in half; add chicken to half the sauce. Spoon about 3 T of chicken mixture onto center of each crepe; fold over. Place crepes in large shallow baking pan and pour remaining sauce over all. Sprinkle with Parmesan cheese. Heat in 350 degree oven for 20-25 minutes.

Manicotti Crepes

1 c small-curd cottage cheese
3 oz cream cheese, softened
2 T butter, softened
2 T chopped parsley
1 egg, beaten
1 T chopped green onion
1/8 t salt
8 cooked crepes
15 oz Italian-style Marinara Sauce
¼ c grated Parmesan cheese

In medium mixing bowl, combine cottage cheese, cream cheese, butter, parsley, egg, green onion, and salt. Spoon 3 T of cheese mixture into center of each cooked crepe. Roll up; place in shallow baking pan. Pour Marinara Sauce over filled crepes; sprinkle with Parmesan cheese. Bake at 350 degrees for 20-30 minutes.

Beef Enchilada Crepes

Filling:
1 lb ground beef
½ c chopped onion
½ c chopped green pepper (optional)
can of refried beans
½ t salt
⅛ t pepper

Sauce:
3 T flour
½ t salt
¼ t chili powder
¼ t paprika
1 ½ c milk
several dashes bottled hot pepper sauce
¾ c shredded sharp cheese

Cornmeal crepes:
1/3 c flour
1 ½ c milk
2/3 c yellow cornmeal
2 eggs
1 T oil
¼ t salt

1. Cook ground beef, onion, and green pepper and drain off fat. Blend with refried beans, salt, and pepper.
2. Mix together dry sauce ingredients, then add milk and hot pepper sauce. Cook and stir til bubbly. Stir in ¾ c shredded sharp cheese.
3. Fill 12 cooked crepes with ¼ c filling each. Place in 13x9 pan. Cover with sauce. Cover and bake at 375 degrees, 25-30 minute.

***Chicken Pot Pie** (adapted from Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book)
This recipe makes enough for an entire 9x13 pan of pot pie (or 2 regular size pies). Cut ingredients in half for smaller quantity.

Pastry for Double Crust pie (see recipe below or use refrigerated crusts)
2 cups (*or more*) mixed vegetables *(sometimes I use a bag of frozen mixed vegetables or sometimes I just use frozen peas, and cook up some diced carrots and potatoes to go along with it.)*
½ c chopped onion
½ c chopped fresh mushrooms *(I usually don't add mushrooms, though it's yummy either way)*
¼ c margarine or butter *(sometimes I use slightly less than called for)*
1/3 c flour
½ t salt
½ t dried marjoram
1/8 t pepper
2 c chicken broth *(or 2 c water and 2 bouillon cubes)*
¾ c milk
3 c cubed cooked chicken or turkey

1. Prepare pastry; set aside. Preheat oven to 450 degrees.

2. Cook peas and carrots til tender. Drain. In a saucepan cook onion and mushrooms in margarine or butter till tender. Stir in flour; salt; sage, marjoram or thyme; and pepper. Add chicken broth and milk all at once. Cook and stir till thickened and bubbly. Stir in drained vegetables, and chicken or turkey. Heat until bubbly.
3. Pour mixture into 9x13 pan or 2 pie pans. Cover with pastry. Flute edges and cut slits in top for steam to escape. Bake at 450 degrees for 12-15 minutes or until pastry is golden brown.

Pastry for Double Crust Pie

2 c flour
½ t salt
2/3 c shortening
6-7 T cold water

1. Stir together flour and salt in mixing bowl. Cut in shortening with pastry cutter til pieces are size of small peas. Add cold water in with a fork, a little bit at a time, til evenly moistened.
2. Roll out dough between two sheets of wax paper into rectangular shape big enough to cover a 9x13 pan plus a few inches to overlap the edges (or 2 circles slightly larger than the top of the pie pans). Remove one sheet of wax paper and flip crust on to top of pot pie AFTER filling. Then, roll the extra crust under the edge and flute the edges like for a regular pie.

Easy Chicken Pot Pie (taken from Bisquick box)

1 can Cream of Chicken soup
1 ½-2 cups carrots, potatoes, celery, onion (whatever *cooked* veggies you'd like) – chopped
1 cup cooked chicken, diced (about ½-1 chicken breast)
1 cup Bisquick mix
½ cup milk
1 egg

1. Boil chicken and dice when cooked through, about 10-15 minutes
2. Prep veggies and boil until tender, about 10-15 minutes
3. Heat oven to 400 degrees.
4. Mix cooked vegetables, chicken, and soup in ungreased pie pan (or small baking pan)
5. Stir together remaining ingredients with a fork until blended. Pour into pan over top of vegetables, chicken and sauce.
6. Bake 30 minutes or until golden brown.

Tips to modify this when you make it other times:

- *Add more flavor by stirring 1/2 teaspoon of your favorite dried herb into the veggie mixture. Oregano, basil, thyme and dill weed are all great choices.*
- *You can substitute leftover turkey for the chicken and the same amount of thawed frozen vegetables for the cooked vegetables, if you like.*
- *Change the flavor by using another variety of condensed creamy soup.*

Honey-Glazed Pork Tenderloin with Homemade Applesauce (from *Southern Living*, February 2015, p. 123)
Makes 4-6 servings

5 apples (gala or fuji), peeled and chopped
T butter, melted
1 T lemon zest
2 T fresh lemon juice
1 T sugar
1 ¼ t kosher salt, divided
2 (12 oz) pork tenderloins, trimmed
3 T olive oil (more like 2 T)
1 ¼ t ground cumin
1 t black pepper
½ t apple pie spice
2 T honey
1 T butter, melted

1. Preheat oven to 425. Saute apples in 3 T melted butter in a large saucepan over medium-high heat 5 minutes. Stir in zest, juice, sugar, ¼ t salt, and 1 c water; bring to a boil. Reduce heat to medium, and simmer, stirring occasionally, 40 minutes or until apples are tender.

2. Meanwhile, brush pork with oil. Stir together cumin, next 2 ingredients, and remaining salt; rub over pork. Place pork in a roasting pan.
3. Bake at 425 for 12 minutes. Whisk together honey and 1 T melted butter; brush half of mixture over pork, and bake 1 minute. Turn pork, and brush with remaining honey mixture. Bake 2 more minutes or until a meat thermometer inserted in thickest portion registers 145 degrees. Let stand 5 minutes. Mash apple mixture to desired consistency, and serve with pork.

Bruschetta Chicken Bake (from Stovetop Stuffing box)

1 can diced tomatoes, undrained
1 pkg Stovetop mix for chicken
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 ½ lb bnls skinless chicken breasts, cut into bite-size pieces
1 t dried basil leaves
1 c shredded Mozzarella cheese

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Place tomatoes with their liquid in medium bowl. Add stuffing mix, ½ c hot water, and the garlic; stir until stuffing mix is moistened. Set aside.
2. Place chicken in 13x9 baking dish; sprinkle with the basil and cheese. Top with the stuffing mixture.
3. Bake 30 minutes or until chicken is cooked through.

Serve with green beans and a green salad to round out the meal.

Italian Chicken and Rice (oven method)

2 cans cream of chicken soup
1 pkg dry Italian dressing mix
2-4 chicken breasts, cubed
½ c sour cream
Cooked rice

Add all ingredients in a 9x13 pan. Cook at 350 degrees for 1 hour.

Italian Chicken and Rice (crock pot method)

2 cans cream of chicken soup
8 oz cream cheese
1 pkg dry Italian dressing mix
3-5 chicken breasts, cubed
Cooked rice

Add all ingredients (except rice) in a crockpot. Cook for 5-6 hours on low or 3-4 hours on high. Serve over rice.

Garlic-Parmesan Chicken and Rice (from *Raised in the Kitchen* by Carrian Cheney)
Makes 4 to 6 servings

1/2 cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese, plus more for garnishing
4 large cloves garlic, minced and divided
1 teaspoon smoked paprika
1 teaspoon Italian seasoning
2 pounds boneless skinless chicken breasts
Salt and pepper, to taste
4 tablespoons unsalted butter, divided
2 cups brown rice
4 cups chicken broth
Zest of 1 lemon
Juice of 1 lemon
1/4 teaspoon salt
1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley

1. In a shallow dish or pie pan, combine Parmesan cheese, half of the minced garlic, pa-prika, and Italian seasoning. Season each chicken breast to taste with salt and pepper then dredge in Parmesan mixture. Shake off excess and let chicken rest on a plate.

2. Melt 2 tablespoons butter in skillet over medium-high heat. Add remaining garlic and sauté until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Quickly add the rice and stir continuously 1 minute, just until the edges of the rice start to turn translucent. Stir in broth, lemon zest and juice, 1/4 teaspoon salt, and 1/4 teaspoon pepper and bring to a boil.
3. Reduce heat to medium-low, cover, and cook until rice is tender and no liquid remains, about 40 minutes.
4. Meanwhile, in a large skillet, melt remaining 2 tablespoons of the butter over medium-high heat. When butter starts to foam, tilt pan so it evenly coats the bottom. Add chicken to pan and cook until golden brown and cooked through, 4 to 6 minutes per side.
5. Fluff rice with a fork. Nestle chicken atop rice, cover with the lid, and warm everything together.
6. Serve topped with fresh chopped parsley and extra Parmesan cheese.

***Chicken Divan** (Cheryl Josie's recipe)
makes 9x13 pan

2 small or 1 large pkg frozen broccoli (or equivalent fresh)
2-3 c diced chicken, pre-cooked
2 cans cream of chicken soup
1 c mayonnaise
½ t curry powder
½ t lemon juice
½ c grated swiss cheese
½ c bread crumbs (*I don't use these*)

1. Cook broccoli until almost done. Drain and place in bottom of casserole dish. Add chicken.
2. Mix soup, mayo, curry powder, and lemon juice. Pour over chicken.
3. Top with cheese and bread crumbs. Bake at 350 for 45 minutes. Serve hot over rice.

Hawaiian haystacks

Cooked rice
Cooked chicken or turkey
broccoli
1 can cream of chicken soup
10 ounces of milk (just fill the soup can and dump it in)
Optional toppings:
Can of pineapple (crushed or diced – whatever you prefer)
Shredded cheese
slivered almonds
½ bunch green onion

Cook rice (and broccoli if using). Mix cream of chicken soup and milk with turkey and warm on stove until heated through. Serve rice with sauce and other toppings.

Chicken Foil Dinners

1 chicken breast per person
½ zucchini per person
1 red pepper per person (I'd use less)
Lemon pepper
Butter
Heavy-duty aluminum foil

Thinly slice chicken and vegetables. Place in center of foil piece. Add lemon pepper and 1 T butter. Wrap and seal foil. Cook in coals for 30 minutes.

Chicken Cordon Bleu Foil Dinner
Makes 4 servings

4 sheets (12"x18") heavy duty foil
4 boneless skinless chicken breasts
Paprika
4 slices swiss cheese
4 slices smoked ham
1 pkg frozen baby gourmet vegetable blend
1 10 oz four cheese sauce (i.e. Ragu)
1 box instant rice

1. Spray aluminum foil with non-stick cooking spray. Center one chicken breast on each sheet of foil. Sprinkle with

paprika. Layer one slice cheese and top with ham. Place ¼ vegetables around chicken. Spoon cheese sauce over chicken.
2. Bring up foil sides, double fold top and ends to seal packet, leaving room for heat circulation in side.
3. Place foil wrapped dinners on hot coals (not flames) for approximately 19-23 minutes, checking periodically for doneness. Prepare rice according to package directions.

***Beef Stroganoff** *(learned/adapted from babysitting for Dana Derrick)*

¾-1 lb ground beef
½-1 onion, chopped
1 lb egg noodles (or noodle-y pasta)
½-1 cup sour cream
1 can cream of mushroom soup
Milk to thin sauce, if necessary

1. Brown ground beef and onion together. While this is browning, cook pasta.
2. When meat and onion are done, add remaining ingredients and heat on low temperature until heated through. Add salt and pepper to taste.

Beef Stroganoff (Eleanor's recipe)

1 pound beef boneless sirloin or top loin steak, ½ inch thick
2 T butter
1/2 cup water
1 t instant beef bouillon (or don't add water & bouillon and use 1 can of beef broth/consommé)
1/2 teaspoon yellow mustard (opt)
1 t salt
¼ t pepper
1 c sour cream
Snipped parsley
Hot cooked noodles or rice
8 ounces mushrooms, sliced (fresh tastes better)
2 medium onions, sliced
1 clove garlic, finely chopped
2 T butter or oil

1. Cut beef across grain into strips, 1 ½ x ½ inch. (For ease in cutting, partially freeze beef about 1 ½ hours) Heat 2 tablespoons butter in 10 inch skillet until melted. Add mushrooms, onions and garlic. Cover and simmer, stirring occasionally, until onions are tender, 5-10 minutes. Remove any vegetables and any liquid from the skillet.
2. Cook and stir beef in 2 tablespoons of butter or oil over medium heat until brown, about 10 minutes. Add water, bouillon, salt and pepper. Heat to boiling; reduce heat. Cover and simmer until beef is desired doneness, 10 – 15 minutes. Add vegetable mixture. Heat to boiling; reduce heat. Stir in sour cream and mustard. Heat just until hot. Garnish with parsley; serve with noodles. I like the fresh fettucine noodles best.

Slow-Cooker Beef Stroganoff

1 lb cubed stewing beef
few handfuls each of mushrooms and chopped onions
one can (14.5 oz) beef broth
½ tub plain or chive & onion cream cheese spread
½ c sour cream

1. Place stewing beef and a few handfuls each of mushrooms and chopped onions in a crockpot.
2. Add beef broth.
3. Cook on low for 6-8 hours (or high for 3-4 hours). Stir in cream cheese and sour cream just before serving. Toss with hot, cooked pasta.

***Shepherd's Pie** (recipe Nana made when Lisa was growing up)

Mashed potatoes (enough to cover a large skillet, about 1 ½" deep)
¾-1 lb ground beef
½ onion, chopped
1 can tomato soup
1 can green beans
½-1 c grated cheddar cheese

1. Prepare mashed potatoes. Keep warm while sauce is cooking.
2. In a skillet, brown ground beef with the onion, then drain off fat. To this ground beef mixture, add the tomato soup and ½-1 can of the green beans (depending on how beany you want it). You can also add ½ can of water or milk to thin the sauce a little bit (and make it go further).
3. When sauce mixture is warm, scoop and spread mashed potatoes over top. Sprinkle this with grated cheese. Cover with lid or foil and heat over low until cheese is melted.

Steak with Crispy Potatoes and Pistachio Pesto (REAL SIMPLE dinner tonight: done!, p. 159)
Serves 4

1 ½ lbs red new potatoes, sliced ¼ inch thick
¼ c plus 3 T olive oil
Salt and pepper
½ c fresh flat leaf parsley leaves
¼ c shelled roasted pistachios
1 small clove garlic
2 strip or sirloin steaks (1 inch thick; about 1 ½ lbs total)
1 bunch broccoli rabe, about 1 lb (I'm sure broccoli would substitute fine)

1. Heat oven to 425 degrees. On a large rimmed baking sheet, toss the potatoes with 2 T of the oil and ¼ t each salt and pepper. Roast until golden, 25-30 minutes.
2. Meanwhile, in a food processor, process the parsley, pistachios, garlic, ¼ c of the remaining oil, and ¼ t each salt and pepper until finely chopped.
3. Heat the remaining T of oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Season the steaks with ½ t each salt and pepper and cook to the desired doneness, 4-6 minutes per side for medium-rare. Transfer to a cutting board and let rest for at least 5 minutes before slicing.
4. Wipe out the skillet. Add the broccoli rabe and ½ c water and simmer, covered, until tender, 2-3 minutes. Serve with the steak, potatoes, and pesto. (The pesto is the sauce for the meat.)

MEAT DISHES

***Teri Yamada's Teriyaki Chicken**

4-5 boneless skinless chicken breasts, sliced up to whatever size you want
1 c Kikkoman soy sauce
1 c white sugar
5-7 garlic cloves (or equivalent)
5 t. fresh ginger (chopped or grated)

1. Mix all sauce ingredients until the sugar is dissolved or mix and put in microwave for about 1 minute.
2. Pour sauce over uncooked chicken. Bake at 350 degrees, turning chicken after 1st 20 minutes. Bake 10-30 minutes more (varies widely, depending on size of chicken pieces). Extra sauce can be spooned over rice.

Panda Express Orange Chicken (from *CDKitchen*)
serves 6

<u>Orange Sauce</u>
1 tablespoon cornstarch
1 1/2 tablespoon soy sauce
1/3 cup water
5 tablespoons sugar
5 tablespoons white vinegar
3 tablespoons fresh orange zest
1 tablespoon rice wine

<u>Chicken</u>
2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken pieces
1 egg
1 ½ t salt
1 dash white pepper
oil (for frying)
½ c cornstarch PLUS 1 T cornstarch
¼ c flour

1 T minced ginger root
1 t minced garlic
1 dash crushed hot red chilies
¼ c chopped green onions
1 T rice wine
¼ c water
1 t sesame oil

1. Prepare the orange sauce by whisking together the cornstarch, soy sauce, water, sugar, vinegar, orange zest, and rice wine. Set aside.
2. Cut chicken pieces into 2-inch squares and place in large bowl. Stir in egg, salt, pepper and 1 T oil and mix well. Stir cornstarch and flour together. Add chicken pieces, stirring to coat.
3. Heat oil for deep-frying in wok or deep-fryer to 375 degrees. Add chicken pieces, small batch at a time, and fry 3-4 minutes or until golden and crisp. (Do not overcook or chicken will be tough.) Remove chicken from oil with slotted spoon and drain on paper towels. Set aside.
4. Clean wok and heat 15 seconds over high heat. Add 1 T oil. Add ginger and garlic and stir-fry until fragrant. Add and stir-fry crushed chilies and green onions. Add rice wine and stir 3 seconds. Add Orange Sauce and bring to boil. Add cooked chicken, stirring until well mixed.
5. Stir water into remaining 1 T cornstarch until smooth. Add to chicken and heat until sauce is thickened. Stir in 1 T oil and sesame oil. Serve at once. You may want to add grated zest of 1 orange to the sauce for flavor.

Chicken Curry (from Fix, Freeze, Feast, p. 26-27)
6-8 servings

3 lbs boneless skinless chicken
½ c butter
1 c chopped onion (about 1 medium)
1/8 c curry powder
1 T minced ginger
1 T minced garlic
1 T sugar
1 T chicken bouillon granules
1 t salt
½ c flour
2 c water
2 c milk
1 T lemon juice

1. Rinse and trim chicken as desired. Cut chicken into bite-size pieces and cook in a large skillet over medium heat until no longer pink, about 30 minutes. Remove from heat and cool (if freezing for later).

2. While chicken cools, melt butter in a separate large saucepan over medium heat. Add onions and cook, stirring, until soft, about 5 minutes. Add curry powder, ginger, garlic, sugar, bouillon, and salt; cook, stirring, for 2 minutes. Add flour and cook, stirring, 2 minutes longer. Mixture will be like a paste. Gradually add the water and milk; cook, stirring constantly, until the sauce has thickened. Whisk to make a smooth sauce. Add lemon juice only after sauce has thickened. Cool sauce (if freezing for later).
3. Pour sauce evenly over chicken.
4. If freezing for later, label and freeze. When ready to serve, completely thaw in refrigerator. Then, bring to a simmer over medium heat and cook til heated through. Do not boil. Serve over rice.

ADD-ONS: Arrange a platter of toppings to sprinkle over dinner, such as: toasted coconut, toasted almonds, fresh apple pieces, pineapple tidbits, raising, dried cranberries, chopped green onions, etc.

Grilled Chicken Souvlaki (from *Cooks' Illustrated*)
serves 4

<u>Tzatziki Sauce</u>
1 T lemon juice
1 small garlic clove, minced to paste
¾ c plain Greek yogurt
½ cucumber, peeled, halved lengthwise, seeded, and diced fine (½ c)
3 T minced fresh mint
1 T minced fresh parsley
⅜ t salt

<u>Chicken</u>
salt and pepper
1 ½ lbs boneless, skinless chicken breasts, trimmed and cut into 1 inch pieces
⅓ c extra-virgin olive oil
2 T minced fresh parsley
1 t finely grated lemon zest plus ¼ c lemon juice (2 lemons)
1 t honey
1 t dried oregano
1 green bell pepper, quartered, stemmed, seeded, each quarter cut into 4 chunks
1 small red onion, ends trimmed, peeled, halved lengthwise, each half cut into 4 chunks
4 (8 inch) pita breads

1. FOR THE TZATZIKI SAUCE: Whisk lemon juice and garlic together in small bowl. Let stand for 10 minutes. Stir in yogurt, cucumber, mint, parsley, and salt. Cover and set aside.
2. FOR THE CHICKEN: Dissolve 2 T salt in 1 qt cold water. Submerge chicken in brine, cover, and refrigerate for 30 minutes. While chicken is brining, combine oil, parsley, lemon zest, lemon juice, honey, oregano, and ½ t pepper in medium bowl. Transfer ¼ c oil mixture to large bowl and set aside to toss with cooked chicken.
3. Remove chicken from brine and pat dry with paper towels. Toss chicken with remaining oil mixture. Thread 4 pieces of bell pepper, concave side up, onto one 12-inch metal skewer. Thread one quarter of chicken onto skewer. Thread 2 chunks of onion onto skewer and place skewer on plate. Repeat skewering remaining chicken and vegetables on 3 more skewers. Lightly moisten 2 pita breads with water. Sandwich 2 unmoistened pita breads between moistened pita breads and wrap stack tightly in lightly greased heavy duty aluminum foil.
4. Turn all gas grill burners to high, cover, and heat grill until hot, about 15 minutes. Leave primary burner on high and turn off other burners.
5. Clean and oil cooking grate. Place skewers on hotter side of grill and cook, turning occasionally, until chicken and vegetables are well browned on all sides and chicken registers 160 degrees, 15-20 minutes. Using fork, push chicken and vegetables off skewers into bowl of reserved oil mixture. Stir gently, breaking up onion chunks; cover with foil and let sit for 5 minutes.
6. Meanwhile, place packet of pitas on cooler side of grill. Flip occasionally to heat, about 5 minutes.
7. Lay each warm pita on 12-inch square of foil. Spread each pita with 2 T tzatziki. Place ¼ of chicken and vegetables in middle of each pita. Roll into cylindrical shape and serve.

Chicken Tikka Kabobs (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")

1. Marinate cubed chicken thighs in:

1 c plain yogurt
2 T garam masala
½ c chopped cilantro
1 ½ t grated ginger
1 ½ t grated garlic
1 T lime juice
salt
cayenne pepper

2. Skewer & grill.

Quick Tandoori-Style Chicken
total time 40 minutes - makes 4-6 servings

½ c plain Greek yogurt
1 T cider vinegar
2 t Madras (hot) curry powder
1 clove garlic, minced
1 ½ lb skinless, boneless chicken thighs, cut into 1- to 1 ½-inch pieces
basmati rice
mango chutney
chopped fresh mint leaves

1. In a large bowl whisk together yogurt, vinegar, curry powder, garlic, and ½ t kosher salt. Add chicken; toss to coat. Let stand 15 minutes (or cover and chill up to 24 hours).
2. Thread chicken on skewers, leaving ¼ inch between pieces. Grill on the greased rack of a covered grill directly over medium-high heat 8-10 minutes or until chicken is done and no longer pink (175 degrees), turning to brown evenly. Serve over basmati rice with mango chutney. Sprinkle with mint.

Tandoori Chicken (Cooks Illustrated, January & February 2009, p. 7)
Serves 4

2 T veg oil
6 medium garlic cloves, minced or pressed (about 2 T)
2 T grated fresh ginger
1 T garam masala
2 t ground cumin
2 t chili powder
1 c plain whole-milk yogurt (low fat may be substituted)
4 T juice from 2 limes
2 t table salt
3 lbs bone-in, skin-on chicken parts (skin removed and trimmed of excess fat)
***I have used boneless skinless meat and it has turned out fine*

1. Heat oil in small skillet over medium heat until shimmering. Add garlic and ginger and cook until fragrant, about 1 minute. Add garam masala, cumin, and chili powder; continue to cook until fragrant, 30-60 seconds longer. Transfer half of garlic-spice mixture to medium bowl; stir in yogurt and 2 T lime juice and set aside.
2. In large bowl, combine remaining garlic-spice mixture, remaining 2 T lime juice and salt. Using sharp knife, lightly score skinned side of each piece of chicken, making 2 or 3 shallow cuts about 1 inch apart and about 1/8 inch deep; transfer to bowl. Using hands, gently massage salt-spice mixture into chicken until all pieces are evenly coated; let stand at room temperature 30 minutes.
3. Adjust oven rack to upper-middle position (about 6 inches from heating element) and heat oven to 325 degrees. Pour yogurt mixture over chicken and toss until chicken is evenly coated with thick layer. Arrange chicken pieces, scored-side down, on wire rack set in foil-lined, rimmed baking sheet or broiler pan. Discard excess yogurt mixture. Bake chicken until instant –read thermometer inserted into thickest part of chicken registers 125 degrees for breasts and 130 for legs and thighs, 15 to 25 minutes. Transfer chicken pieces to plate as they reach correct temperature.
4. After removing chicken from oven, turn oven to broil and heat 10 minutes. Once broiler is heated, flip chicken pieces over and broil until chicken is lightly charred in spots and instant-read thermometer inserted into thickest part of chicken registers 165 degrees for breast and 175 degrees for legs and thighs, 8-15 minutes. Transfer chicken to large plate, tent loosely with foil, and rest 5 minutes.

Chicken Tikka Masala (from *English Trifle* book by Josi S. Kilpack)
Serves 6

Chicken
1 c plain yogurt
2 T lemon juice
2 t cumin
1-2 t cayenne pepper
2 t black pepper
1 t cinnamon
1 t salt
1 t ground ginger (or ½" piece of ginger root
1 ½ lbs boneless chicken breasts or thighs, cut into bite-size pieces

1. After combining all ingredients in a gallon-size Ziploc bag, seal bag and knead the mixture together by hand. Allow chicken to marinate at least 1 hour in refrigerator. (Can marinate all day or overnight.)
2. After marinating, remove chicken from bag. Grill or broil chicken until cooked through. Marinade will be thick and will cook off. You do not need to save the drippings.

Sauce
1 T butter or margarine
2 garlic cloves, minced
1 jalapeno, minced (leave out for milder flavor) ***I didn't use*
2 t ground coriander
1 t cumin
1 t paprika
1 t garam masala
½ t salt ***The first time was too salty, so I just sprinkled a few shakes of salt for the next attempt and it was better*
1 8 oz can tomato sauce
1 c whipping cream ***I successfully substituted ¼ c greek plain yogurt, ¼ c milk, and 1 c evap milk*

Basmati rice, cooked
Cilantro, for garnish

3. Melt butter in a large skillet, add garlic and jalapeno. Cook 1 minute. Add coriander, cumin, paprika, garam masala, and salt. Add tomato sauce and cover skillet. Simmer 15 minutes. Add cream and simmer until sauce thickens, about 5 minutes. Add cooked chicken to sauce; simmer an additional 5 minutes. Serve over basmati rice. Garnish with cilantro.

Slow Cooker Chicken Tikka Masala (I got this recipe from Julie Woodfield. She got it from *Cooking Classy.*)
Yields 6 servings

5 boneless, skinless chicken breast halves, cut into 1 inch pieces (about 3 lbs)
1/2 large yellow onion, finely diced
4 cloves garlic, minced
2 Tbsp freshly, finely grated ginger
1 jalapeno, stemmed, sliced in half and seeds removed
1 (29 oz) can tomato puree
1 1/2 cups plain yogurt
2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
2 Tbsp lemon juice
2 Tbsp Garam Masala
1 Tbsp cumin
1/2 Tbsp paprika
2 tsp salt, or to taste
3/4 tsp cinnamon
3/4 tsp freshly ground black pepper
1-3 tsp cayenne pepper
2 bay leaves
1 cup heavy cream
1/2 tbsp cornstarch
Prepared Long Grain White Rice or Basmati Rice
Chopped cilantro, for serving

In a large mixing bowl combine chopped onions, minced garlic, grated ginger, sliced jalapeno, tomato puree, plain yogurt, olive oil, lemon juice, Garam Masala, cumin, paprika, salt, cinnamon, pepper and cayenne pepper. Stir until combine. Pour half of sauce mixture into a large slow cooker then add in diced chicken followed then cover chicken with remaining sauce. Add in 2 bay leaves. Cover slow cooker with lid and cook on low heat for 8 hours (or high for 4 hours).
In a mixing bowl, whisk together heavy cream and cornstarch, pour mixture into slow cooker and gently stir. Allow mixture to cook 20 minutes while you prepare the rice. Remove bay leaves and sliced jalapeno and serve warm over rice and sprinkle with chopped cilantro.

Chickpea Tikka Masala
26 minutes prep. Serves 4

1 T veg oil
½ medium onion, diced
2 t grated fresh ginger
1 fresh serrano chile, minced (for milder flavor, scrape out the serrano's seeds and white ribs before using)
1 T garam masala
1 T tomato paste
½ t salt
1 can (28 oz) crushed tomatoes
2 c chickpeas
½ c heavy cream
¼ c chopped fresh cilantro leaves

1. Heat oil over medium heat and add onions. Cook until onions have softened, about 5 minutes. Add ginger, serrano chile, garam masala and tomato paste, and cook 1 minute more.
2. Add salt, crushed tomatoes and chickpeas. Bring to a simmer and cook, covered, 15 minutes. Stir in cream and cilantro and serve immediately. Refrigerate any leftovers.

***Curry Stand Chicken Tikka Masala Sauce** (from allrecipes.com)
Takes a little over an hour to make - Serves 6

2 T ghee *(I have also used unsalted butter)*
1 onion, finely chopped
4 cloves garlic, minced
1 T ground cumin
1 t salt
1 t ground ginger
1 t cayenne pepper
½ t ground cinnamon
¼ t ground turmeric
1 (14 oz) can tomato sauce *(I almost always use 2 8oz cans)*
1 c heavy whipping cream
2 t paprika
1 T white sugar

1 T vegetable oil
4 bnls sknls chic breast halves, cut into bite-size pieces *(I usually use about ½ this amount. I've also used chickpeas.)*
½ t curry powder
½ t salt, or to taste (optional)
1 t sugar, or to taste (optional)

3-4 cups cooked basmati rice

1. Heat ghee in a large skillet over medium heat and cook and stir onion until translucent, about 5 minutes. Stir in garlic; cook and stir just until fragrant, about 1 minute. Stir cumin, 1 t salt, ginger, cayenne pepper, cinnamon, and turmeric into the onion mixture; fry until fragrant, about 2 minutes.
2. Stir tomato sauce into the onion and spice mixture, bring to a boil, and reduce heat to low. Simmer sauce for 10 minutes, then mix in cream, paprika, and 1 T sugar. Bring sauce back to a simmer and cook, stirring often, until sauce is thickened, 10-15 minutes.
3. Heat vegetable oil in a separate skillet over medium heat. Stir chicken into the hot oil, sprinkle with curry powder, and sear chicken until lightly browned but still pink inside, about 3 minutes; stir often. *(If using chickpeas, follow the same process, but it will be shorter since you really just need to warm them.)* Transfer chicken and any pan juices into the sauce. Simmer chicken in sauce until no longer pink, about 30 minutes; adjust salt and sugar to taste.
4. While chicken simmers for 30 minutes, start cooking the rice. Serve over basmati rice.

Chicken Tikka Masala (from video jug online) – *Ahhh... The beginning of the tikka masala journey… my first attempt*

3 chic breasts
4 T olive oil
5 cardamom pods
1 cinnamon stick
1 ½ onions
2 t fresh ginger, minced
2 t fresh garlic, minced
1 t cumin powder
1 t coriander powder
¼ t turmeric
½-1 t cayenne pepper
1 T paprika
1 t garam masala powder
1 large tomato
1 t tomato puree/paste *(I actually put at least 1 T)*
150 ml water
Salt to taste (lots)
1 c yogurt *(optional, but I use it)*
Fresh cilantro to garnish

1. Chop tomato and onion (separately) and set aside. Cube chicken breasts and season with a little salt.
2. Mix all ingredients (ginger to masala). This is the masala paste.
3. Heat oil over medium heat. When hot, add cardamom pods and cinnamon stick. Leave for a few seconds, then remove. *(I actually leave in til after onions.)* Add onions and cook til brown.
4. Add the masala paste and stir 1 min.
5. Add tomato and paste and stir 1 min. Pour in water and simmer gently. Taste sauce and season with salt if needed.
6. Add chicken cubes and mix well. Simmer 10-12 minutes, stirring every few minutes, til chicken is cooked and tender. After this, add ½-1 c yogurt. Mix well and simmer 5 minutes.
7. Serve with coriander leaves for garnish (over rice).

Chicken Makhani (Indian Butter Chicken)
Serves 4

15 cardamom pods (sewn together)
2 lbs bnls, snls chicken thighs
1 onion, sliced
6 garlic cloves, chopped
2 t curry powder
½ t cayenne pepper
2 t garam masala
½ t ground ginger
4 T butter
1 (6 oz) can tomato paste
2 T lemon juice
1 (14 oz) can coconut milk
1 c plain yogurt (to add at the end)
kosher salt

Use a 6 qt or larger slow cooker. Carefully sew together the cardamom pods using a needle and thread. You can put them in a little cheesecloth bundle instead, if you have that in the house. Put the chicken in the stoneware, and add the onion garlic, and all the spices. Plop in the butter and the tomato paste. Add the lemon juice and coconut milk. Cover and cook on low for 8 hours, or on high for 4 hours. The chicken should shred easily with two forks when fully cooked. Stir in the plain yogurt 15 minutes before serving, and discard the cardamom pods. Salt to taste and feel free to tweak the amount of garam masala and curry to your own taste-- it's fine to add more at the end of cooking. Serve with basmati rice.

***Sloppy Joes** (Nana's recipe)

1 lb ground beef
¼ onion
1 c ketchup
1 T brown sugar
1 T dry mustard
2 t chili powder

Brown meat & onion together. Drain off fat. Add remaining ingredients (add more or less ketchup to make it as saucy as you like it). Heat until warmed through.

Sloppy Joes 2.0 (Lisa modified Nana's recipe to make these at camp)

2 lb ground beef
½ c raw onion or 1 T minced, dry onion
2 T apple cider vinegar
1 t salt
4 T mustard (liquid, not dry)
¼ c brown sugar
1 ½ c ketchup
1 t chili powder

Sloppy Joes II (from *allrecipes.com*)

1 lb ground beef
¼ c chopped onion
¼ c chopped green bell pepper
½ t garlic powder
1 t mustard
¾ c ketchup
3t brown sugar
salt and pepper to taste
(also buns to serve it on)

1. In a medium skillet over medium heat, brown ground beef, onion, and green pepper; drain off liquids.

2. Stir in garlic powder, mustard, ketchup, and brown sugar; mix thoroughly. Reduce heat, and simmer for 30 minutes. (Leaving the lid on will make them saucier.) Season with salt and pepper

Beef Taco Burgers
Serves 4

½ c crushed corn tortilla chips
1 T minced, fresh cilantro
1 ½ t cumin
1 ½ t minced garlic
¼ c shredded Monterey Jack cheese
¼ t black pepper
1 lb ground beef

1. Combine all ingredients in a large bowl. Divide mixture into 4 equal portions, shaping each into a ⅓ inch thick patty.
2. Heat grill to med-high. Lightly brush the grill grates with vegetable oil, then grill the patties about 5 minutes. Flip and cook about 4 more minutes, until meat reaches 160 degrees. (If topping with cheese, add in the final minute of cooking.) Serve on toasted buns.

***Suggested toppings, #1*: Melt cheddar cheese on the burgers. Spread on smoky chipotle ketchup (made by mixing ¼ c ketchup with chopped chipotle chilies in adobo, to taste). Then top with tomato and sliced jalapenos.
***Suggested toppings, #2*: Play up the taco flavor with fresh pico de gallo, Cotija cheese, thinly sliced radishes and shredded iceberg lettuce.

Sage & Garlic Turkey Burgers
serves 4

2 T olive oil
1 ½ lbs ground turkey
¼ c chopped Italian parsley
2 t chopped, fresh sage
1 T minced garlic
salt and pepper, for seasoning

1. Mix together olive oil, ground turkey, herbs, garlic, salt and pepper. Divide mixture into 4 equal portions, shaping each into a patty.
2. Heat grill to med-high. Lightly brush the grill grates with vegetable oil, then grill the patties about 5 minutes. Flip and cook about 4 more minutes, until meat reaches 165 degrees. (If topping with cheese, add in the final minute of cooking.) Serve on toasted buns.

***Suggested topping #1*: Top with a smear of olive oil mayo. Then add a sweet and savory topping made by sauteing 1 diced Granny Smith apple and a thinly sliced Vidalia onion in 2 t olive oil until softened and caramelized. Garnish with thin slices of fresh Granny Smith apple for crunch.
***Suggested topping #2*: For an Italian twist, top with a slice of mozzarella cheese, sauteed slices of bell pepper and warm marinara sauce.

***Falafel Burgers**
serves 4

2 cans (15 oz each) chickpeas
½ c rolled oats
4 c (loosely packed) fresh parsley
4 cloves garlic, roughly chopped
½ t finely grated lemon zest
1 tsp kosher salt
½ t black pepper
½ t cayenne pepper
2 t cumin
2 T lemon juice

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Line baking sheet with parchment; spray with baking spray. Reserve 1 T liquid from chickpeas. Drain remaining liquid. Process oats in food processor until powdery. Add parsley through cumin; pulse until roughly chopped.
2. Add chickpeas, lemon juice and reserved 1 T liquid; pulse until chickpeas are finely ground. Form into 4 patties. Place

on prepared sheet; bake 40 minutes, flipping after 20 minutes. Serve on toasted buns.
**_Suggested topping #1_: Create a creamy yogurt-cucumber sauce by mixing together 1 c plain yogurt, ½ seeded, peeled cucumber (finely diced), a minced garlic clove, a little lemon zest and a pinch of cayenne pepper. Add grilled veggies for even more flavor.
**_Suggest topping #2_: Keep things fresh and simple with slices of ripe avocado and juice tomato.

Scott Jurek's Lentil-Mushroom Burgers (from *Runnersworld.com)*
makes 12 4-in burgers

1 c dried green lentils (2 ¼ c cooked)
2 ¼ c water
1 t dried parsley
¼ t black pepper
3 garlic cloves, minced
1 ¼ c finely chopped onion
¾ c finely chopped walnuts
2 c fine bread crumbs
½ c ground flax seed (flax seed meal)
3 c finely chopped mushrooms
1 ½ c destemmed, finely chopped kale, spinach, or winter greens
2 T coconut oil or olive oil
3 T balsamic vinegar
2 T Dijon mustard
2 T nutritional yeast
1 t sea salt
½ t black pepper
½ t paprika

1. In a small pot, bring lentils, water, parsley, 1 garlic clove, and ½ c of onion to a boil. Reduce heat and simmer, partially covered, for 35-40 minutes, until the water is absorbed and the lentils are soft.
2. While the lentils are cooking, combine the walnuts, bread crumbs, and flax seed in a bowl. Add the nutritional yeast, salt, pepper, and paprika and mix well.
3. Saute the remaining onion, remaining garlic, the mushrooms, and the greens in the oil for 8-10 minutes, then set aside. Remove the lentils from the heat, add the vinegar and mustard, and mash with a potato masher or wooden spoon to a thick paste.
4. In a large mixing bowl, combine the lentils, sauteed veggies, and bread crumb mixtures, and mix well. Cool in the refrigerator for 5-10 minutes or more.
5. Using your hands, form burger patties to your desired size and place on waxed paper. Lightly fry in a seasoned skillet, or broil or grill until lightly browned and crisp, 3-5 minutes on each side. Extra uncooked patties can be frozen on wax paper in plastic bags or wrapped individually in aluminum foil, making for a quick dinner or wholesome burger for the next BBQ.

**Per burger: 188 calories, 21g carbs, 6g figer, 8g protein, and 9g fat

Shari Engelhardt's Perfect Turkey (so moist it falls off the bones!)

1. Defrost turkey 3-4 days
2. At 10pm the night before, put turkey in 400 degree oven for hour with breast up. Don't wrap with foil.
3. After an hour, turn oven down to 200 degrees and flip turkey upside down. Wrap with foil.
4. Check at 8 or 9am. Turn down to warm when done (timer pops).
5. Pull out of oven 1 hour before serving. Makes yummy gravy!

"Roasted" whole chicken
For a chicken that is approximately 5 lbs, "roast" it on low in a slow cooker for 8 hours. It will fall off the bones and then the meat can be shredded and frozen for later use.

Fauxtisserie Chicken (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Serves 4-6

1 (3 ½-4 lb) whole chicken | 1 t seasoning salt | 4-5 whole garlic cloves, peeled
Optional: fresh herbs, such as rosemary, oregano, sage, basil, or tarragon.

1. Make 3 balls of aluminum foil about 2 inches in diameter and place them in a triangle on the bottom of your slow cooker. This keeps the chicken off the bottom so hot air can circulate and it doesn't stew in its own juices.
2. Slice garlic cloves lengthwise into thin slices and set aside.
3. Rinse chicken in cold water. Make sure to include the cavity and remove and discard any parts inside the cavity. Pat dry with paper towels.
4. Place the chicken on a plate so it lies with the breast facing up and the legs on the plate. Loosen the skin of the entire chicken and gently separate the skin from the bird while keeping it attached around the edges. Use your hands to place the sliced garlic cloves under the skin.
5. Rub seasoning salt onto the skin of the chicken. Place chicken breast-up on the foil in the slow cooker. Cover with the lid, turn heat to low, and cook for 6-7 hours or until a meat thermometer inserted into the thickest part of the breast registers 160 degrees F.

**Leftovers taste great in taquitos, enchiladas, white chili, chicken salad, etc.

Other seasoning variations:
<u>Classic Roasted Bird</u>
4 T softened butter | 2 T chopped parsley | 1 onion
4 cloves minced garlic | 1 t dried sage | 2 carrots

Combine butter, garlic, parsley, and sage. Use fingers to spread mixture underneath the chicken skin and lightly around the outside of the chicken. Peel one onion and cut into quarters. Peel 2 carrots and cut into 2-inch pieces. Distribute onions and carrots inside the cavity and around the outside of the chicken.

<u>Chili-Lime</u>
2-3 T chopped cilantro | 1 t cumin
1 ½ t chili powder | 1 lime

Spread cilantro under the skin with the garlic called for in the main recipe. Add chili powder and cumin to the seasoning salt mixture. Cut one lime in half and rub both halves all over the outside of the chicken. Place lime halves inside the chicken cavity before cooking.

<u>Lemon-Rosemary</u>
Few sprigs of fresh rosemary | 1 lemon

Place sprigs of rosemary under the skin of the chicken. Cut one lemon in half and rub juices all over the outside of the chicken before applying the seasoning salt. Place both lemon halves inside the chicken cavity before cooking.

Dutch Oven Marinated Chicken Breasts

6 boneless skinless chicken breasts | <u>Marinade</u>: | 1 c soy sauce
1 12 oz pkg bacon | 2 c Sprite | ½ c cooking oil

1. Mix ingredients for marinade. Cover chicken breasts with marinade and refrigerate overnight. You may want to stir the marinade mixture every now and then since the oil tends to separate. (Marinate the chicken at home and bring them

to camp in a plastic bag.)
2. To prepare, cover bottom of Dutch oven with bacon strips. Cook over coals until bacon yields enough grease to brown chicken. Remove bacon and lightly brown chicken breasts in grease, then remove chicken and pour off grease.

Return chicken to Dutch oven (pieces can be piled on top of each other). Place 4 half strips of bacon on top of chicken. Cover and cook over coals until done, about 30-45 minutes.

Creamy Crockpot Fajitas – Heather Wall

4 frozen chicken breast halves
1 ½ c salsa
1/3 c sour cream
Tortillas and toppings, as desired

Place chicken (frozen) in crockpot. Pour salsa over (puree salsa if too chunky for your taste). Cover and cook on high 6-8 hours or low 10-12 hours. During last hour, shred chicken and stir in sour cream. Return to crockpot and warm through. Serve in tortillas with other toppings.

***Creamy Chicken** (via Carrie Tucker from March 2010 Relief Society activity AND Heather Wall at recipe swap)

2 cans cream of chicken soup
1 8 oz package cream cheese
1 envelope dry Italian dressing mix
½-1 cup water/chicken broth/milk
6-8 chicken breasts *(whatever looks like the right amount for the sauce you've added - 1 or 2 of the big chicken breasts is usually more than enough)*

1. Add all ingredients except chicken and mix until soft. Add chicken and cook in crockpot on low all day. (Use less liquid if cooking on low).
2. When done cooking, shred the chicken in the sauce by pulling apart with two forks. Serve over rice. (*I serve with rotini/penne & broccoli or carrots. I've even cooked the carrots along with everything in the crockpot and it is easy and tasty.*)

Southwestern Chicken (from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 69)
Serves 5

1 28 oz can diced tomatoes
1 1/3 c chopped red bell pepper
1 1/3 c chopped green bell pepper
2 c chopped red onion
1 ½ t chopped garlic
2 T lime juice
1/3 c olive oil
½ t salt
½ t pepper
¼ t cayenne pepper
½ t Tabasco sauce; add more for spicier chicken
5 boneless, skinless chicken breasts

Mix all ingredients together and pour over the chicken in a 1 gallon freezer bag (if freezing for later). Label with instructions and freeze. When ready to eat, thaw and pour into a 13x9 pan then bake in a 375 degree oven for 50 minutes.

Zanzibar Chicken (from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 37)
Serves 4

1 c chopped onion
1 T olive oil
4 boneless, skinless chicken breast halves, cut into strips
1 t ground ginger
1 t ground cumin
½ t turmeric
1 14 oz can coconut milk
½ t chopped garlic
1 6 oz can tomato paste
1 T lemon juice
½ t salt
1 ½ c uncooked jasmine rice
2 T chopped fresh cilantro

In a small skillet, sauté the onion in the oil until transparent. Combine the remaining ingredients, except the cilantro and rice, and pour into a 1 gallon freezer bag (if freezing for later). Label with contents and instructions. When ready to serve, thaw the chicken and bake in 350 oven for 50 minutes. Cook the rice according to package directions. Serve chicken over rice. Sprinkle with chopped cilantro.

Chicken Milano
serves 6

6 skinless, boneless chicken breasts (4 oz each)**
½ c all-purpose flour
2 eggs, beaten
1 c Italian bread crumbs
½ c butter or margarine
1 c marinara sauce
1 c half-and-half
½ c mozzarella cheese, shredded
½ c Swiss cheese, shredded
¼ c grated Parmesan cheese

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Roll each chicken breast in flour; dip in beaten egg. Roll in bread crumbs to coat well.
2. Heat butter in large skillet over medium high heat; add chicken pieces. Cook until browned on all sides, about 10 minutes.
3. Mix marinara sauce & half-and-half in small bowl, reserving 2 T. Pour into baking dish. Arrange chicken in dish.
4. Mix mozzarella, Swiss, and Parmesan cheese in a small bowl. Sprinkle over chicken. Top with reserved sauce. Bake, loosely covered, until cooked through, about 30 minutes.

** for faster cooking, pound chicken breasts to ¼ inch thickness, then thinly slice. The chicken will brown more quickly in step 2 and baking time will be reduced to about 20 minutes in step 4.

Chicken Cutlets with Herbed Mushroom Sauce (from *Southern Living*, February 2015, p. 122)
Makes 4 servings

2 (8 oz) boneless skinless chicken breasts
1 t kosher salt
½ t freshly ground black pepper
¼ c flour
2 T chopped fresh thyme
2 t chopped fresh rosemary
1/4 c canola oil, divided
1 (8 oz) pkg fresh button mushrooms, quartered
2 T red wine vinegar
1 ½ c reduced-sodium chicken broth
2 fresh sage sprigs
1 t Dijon mustard
3 T butter

1. Halve each chicken breast lengthwise to form 4 cutlets (I actually also cut them in half so I got 7 or 8). Place each cutlet between 2 sheets of heavy-duty plastic wrap, and flatten to ¼ inch thickness, using a rolling pin or flat side of a meat mallet. Discard plastic. Sprinkle salt and pepper over both sides of chicken.
2. Place flour in a shallow dish, and stir in chopped thyme and rosemary. Dredge chicken in flour mixture; shake off excess. Cook 2 cutlets in 4 ½ t hot oil in a large skillet over medium high heat 2-3 minutes on each side or until done. Remove cutlets from pan, and repeat procedure with 4 ½ t oil and remaining 2 dredged cutlets.
3. Add remaining 1 T oil to drippings in skillet; add mushrooms, and saute over medium-high heat 4-6 minutes or until browned and all moisture evaporates. Stir in vinegar, and cook, stirring occasionally, 1-3 minutes or until liquid evaporates. Stir in broth and sage; bring to a boil. Boil until liquid is reduced to about ¼ c. Remove from heat; stir in mustard. Whisk in butter, 1 T at a time. Spoon sauce over cutlets.

Baked Chicken Dijon (from Aunt Sim & Ann)

10 pieces of chicken (about 1 ½ lbs, cut up)
3-6 T Dijon mustard
1 stick of butter/margarine
1 t minced garlic
⅓ c fresh parsley, chopped
1 cup grated Parmesan cheese
2 cups fresh, soft, breadcrumbs
Salt and black pepper to taste

1. Melt butter in small or medium saucepan until fragrant but not brown. Blend in mustard and garlic. Stir well.
2. Remove from heat and let sit/cook but not solidify.
3. Mix parsley (do not use dried parsley), Parmesan, bread crumbs and salt and pepper if desired.
4. Dip chicken in butter mixture- coating all surfaces- then dip in crumb mixture and coat well. Place in shallow baking dish.
5. Bake at 350 degrees for an hour until golden and tender. (If it gets too dark, put tin foil over the top until chicken is cooked through.

Jamaican Jerk Chicken (KSL recipes, 8/6/04)

4 4-5oz boneless, skinless chicken breasts
2 T brown sugar
1 T ground allspice
1 T dried thyme
1 t ground ginger
1 t ground nutmeg
1 t ground cinnamon
1 t salt
1 t garlic powder
¼ t fresh ground pepper
½ t red pepper paste
2 cloves garlic, minced or pressed

1. In small bowl mix together brown sugar, allspice, thyme, ginger, nutmeg, cinnamon, salt, pepper, garlic powder, red pepper paste, and garlic.
2. Rub mixture onto both sides of each chicken breast, cover and refrigerate 1 hour to over night. Preheat oven to 325 degrees (or heat BBQ grill). Cover a baking sheet with foil (if baking in oven). Place chicken on baking sheet and bake for 15 to 20 minutes; OR wrap seasoned chicken in a tight foil package and cook on grill for 15 to 20 minutes.
3. Remove chicken from foil and grill over open flame 2-3 minutes on each side. Serve with mango chili relish on the side.

Crispy, Creamy Cordon Bleu

4 bnls, skills chicken breasts
salt, to taste
pepper, to taste
1 T garlic powder
1 T onion powder
1 slices Swiss cheese
½ lb sliced ham
1 c flour
4 eggs
2 c panko bread crumbs

<u>Creamy Dijon Sauce</u>
3 T butter
2 cloves garlic, minced
3 T flour
2 c milk
¼ c Dijon mustard
1 c shredded Parmesan cheese

1. Sprinkle the chicken breasts with salt, pepper, garlic powder, and onion powder, tossing to coat evenly.
2. On a cutting board, place a chicken breast between two sheets of plastic wrap and pound until about ½ inch thick.
3. Remove the plastic wrap and lace a layer of Swiss cheese, then ham, then one more layer of Swiss cheese.
4. Evenly roll the chicken, and place onto a new sheet of plastic wrap.
5. Wrap the chicken in the plastic wrap, twist the excess plastic, and roll the chicken while twisting the sides in to tighten and firm up the roll of chicken cordon bleu. Tie the excess and chill in the fridge to set for 30 minutes.
6. After the rolls are set, prepare large, wide dishes with flour, beaten egg, and bread crumbs, and dredge the chicken in the flour, egg, and bread crumbs.
7. Place the breaded chicken cordon bleu in a 325 degree pot of oil, and cook about 5 minutes per side or until the outside is an even golden brown. If a good color is achieved and the chicken's center is still not 165 degrees, you can finish the chicken in an oven at 325 degrees until that temperature is reached.
8. In a small pot on medium heat, melt the butter and cook the garlic until soft.
9. Add in flour, and whisk for 1 minute.
10. Add in the milk, and whisk until fully combined with the roux. Continue whisking until the mixture comes to a simmer and has thickened.
11. Add in the Dijon mustard, salt, pepper, and Parmesan cheese. Whisk to combine. Set aside.

12. Slice chicken and drizzle with Dijon sauce. Enjoy!

Baked Chicken Cordon Bleu(from *Recipes from the Roof)*
6-8 servings

6 sknls, bnls, chicken brsts
12 thin slices ham
12 slices Swiss cheese
1 c flour
3 eggs, beaten
3 c bread crumbs
6 T butter, melted

Alfredo Sauce:
2 t melted butter
1 T diced onion
½ t chopped garlic
1 c heavy cream
1 c whole milk
½ c grated Parmesan cheese
½ t salt
¼ t white pepper

1. For the chicken: Pound each chicken breast with a meat mallet to about ¼ inch thick. Place 2 slices of ham and 2 slices of Swiss cheese on each flattened chicken breast and roll it up jelly roll style. Freeze rolled breasts until completely frozen.
2. Place the flour, eggs, and bread crumbs in three separate shallow containers.
3. Dredge the frozen chicken breast in the flour; next dip it into the eggs; and finally coat it in the bread crumbs. Make sure the entire chicken breast roll is covered evenly. Freeze again.
4. When ready to bake, brush melted butter on the frozen rolled chicken and bake at 350 degrees F. until the meat thermometer registers 165 degrees internally, about 30-45 minutes.
5. For the Alfredo sauce: In a small saucepan, melt butter and sauté onion and garlic for 3 minutes. Add cream and milk. Stir with a whisk and slowly add Parmesan cheese once the cream and milk begin to bubble. Keep stirring until cheese is melted. Add salt and white pepper. Makes 2 cups.
6. To serve, cut chicken roll into wheels for presentation and spoon Alfredo sauce on top.

Southern BBQ Slow-cooked Chicken (from *Key Lime Pie* by Josi Killpack)
Serves 8

1 36 oz bottle ketchup
6 T brown sugar
2 T Worcestershire sauce
2 T soy sauce
2 T cider vinegar
2 t crushed red pepper flakes, or to taste
1 t garlic powder, or 2-3 cloves fresh garlic, pressed
6 boneless, skinless chicken breasts

Combine all ingredients for sauce in slow cooker. Add chicken and coat it well with sauce. Cook on high for 3-4 hours, or low for 6-8 hours, until fully cooked. Use 2 forks to shred chicken. Serve over rice or on rolls for sandwiches.

Crockpot Poppy Seed Chicken (from Cassie & Stephanie Neeley)

2-4 chicken breasts
1 t each: garlic salt, pepper and paprika
20 oz milk (just fill the cream of chicken cans after dumping in the soup)
1 c sour cream
2 cans cream of chicken soup
1 sleeve of crushed Ritz crackers
½ stick (or less) butter (melted)
1 T poppy seeds

Cook chicken in crockpot with seasonings, milk, and cream of chicken. Shred when finished cooking and prepare rice. Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Layer cooked rice on the bottom of a 9x13 greased pan. Stir together chicken mixture, sour cream, and poppy seeds. Layer over cooked rice in pan. In separate bowl, stir together crushed Ritz crackers and melted butter. Pour on top of chicken mixture. Cook for 20-30 minutes until the top is browned and bubbly.

Caprese-Style Grilled Chicken Breasts (from July 2012 Family Circle, p. 134)
Makes 4 servings

2 T red wine vinegar
1 clove garlic, chopped
1 t Dijon mustard
1 t chopped fresh mint
½ t salt
¼ t black pepper
3 T olive oil
3 tomatoes (about 1 lb), seeds removed, cut into bite-size pieces
¼ c fresh basil, torn into small pieces
4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (about 5 oz each)
3 oz shredded mozzarella cheese
3 oz whole wheat angel hair pasta, cooked following package directions

1. Whisk together vinegar, garlic, mustard, mint, ¼ t of the salt and 1/8 t of the black pepper. Gradually drizzle in olive oil, whisking constantly, so mixture emulsifies.
2. In a medium bowl, combine tomatoes, basil and 3 T of the dressing. Cover and set aside.
3. Heat a gas grill to medium-high. Lightly coat grill rack with oil.
4. Brush chicken with remaining dressing and season with remaining ¼ t salt and 1/8 t pepper. Grill 5-6 minutes per side or until internal temperature reaches 160 degrees. Scatter cheese over top during last minute of cooking.
5. Toss cooked pasta with half of the tomato salad. Serve with chicken and remaining tomato salad.

Sheet Pan Chicken Parmesan (originally from *Good Housekeeping* magazine, but quantities adjusted by me)
serves 4

3 T olive oil, divided
½ c all-purpose flour
1 large egg
1 t granulated garlic
salt and pepper
¾ c panko
4 T grated parmesan cheese, divided
4 5-oz boneless, skinless chicken breasts, each split, making 8 small cutlets
2 T fresh lemon juice
1 c marinara sauce
4 oz mozzarella cheese (NOT fresh), coarsely grated
chopped parsley, for serving *(I used dried)*

1. Arrange oven racks so 1 is 6" from broiler and other is in center of oven, then heat oven to 450 degrees. Rub large rimmed baking sheet with 1 T oil. Place flour in shallow bowl. In second shallow bowl, beat together eggs, garlic, 2 T water and ¾ t salt. In third bowl, combine panko with 2 T Parmesan, then toss with remaining 2 T oil.
2. Toss chicken in lemon juice. Dip chicken in flour, then egg mixture (lett excess drip off), then panko mixture, patting to help it adhere; transfer to prepared baking sheet. Roast until chicken is golden and cooked through, 12-18 minutes.
3. Heat broiler. Spoon marinara sauce over chicken and sprinkle with mozzarella and remaining 2 T Parmesan. Broil on top rack until cheese has melted and turned golden brown in spots, 3-4 minutes. Sprinkle with parsley if desired.

Chicken Fingers on a Stick—From *Family Fun* magazine
Serves 6-8

4 boneless skinless chicken breast halves, pounded ½-3/4" thick
Salt and pepper
24 10 inch bamboo skewers, soaked in water 30 minutes
3 T peanut or vegetable oil
2 T BBQ sauce
1 ¼ c plain dried bread crumbs.

1. Cut each chicken breast lengthwise into 1/2" wide strips. Sprinkle with salt and pepper. Fold strips slightly and weave onto skewers.
2. Prepare grill to medium high.
3. Stir oil and BBQ sauce together. Spread bread crumbs on a sheet of wax paper. Lightly brush the sauce mixture over the strips and roll them in bread crumbs.
4. Grill uncovered about 2-4 minutes per side.

Chicken Fingers (aka homemade chicken nuggets) with Honey Mustard (yummy and easy)

1 lb boneless, skinless chicken breasts
1 c flour
½ t salt
¼ t pepper

(*you can vary the seasonings added with the flour to jazz it up a bit)*
¾ c milk
1 c vegetable oil for frying

<u>Honey Mustard</u>
½ c honey
¼ c Dijon mustard

1. Cut chicken into ½ x 2 inch strips. For honey mustard sauce, blend honey and mustard in small bowl. Set aside.
2. Mix flour, salt, and pepper in a shallow bowl. Dip chicken in milk. Roll in flour mixture to coat well. Place on waxed paper (or directly into hot oil).
3. Pour ¼ inch of oil into a large, heavy skillet. Heat over medium-high heat to 350 degrees.
4. Divide chicken into batches (if necessary). Place chicken in an even layer in hot oil. Fry, turning once, for about 3 minutes on each side or until golden brown and crisp. Drain on paper towels. Serve with sauce.

Crockpot Lime Chicken Tacos (from Katie)

1. Put 1 ½ lbs boneless skinless chicken in crockpot on low 5-6 hours.
2. Combine:

3 T lime juice 1 T chili powder 1 c corn 1 c chunky salsa

3. Shred chicken and cool slightly.
4. Stir in corn and salsa mixture
5. Serve in tortillas with lettuce, tomatoes, cheese, and sour cream.

Café Rio Shredded Chicken from Arika Moore *(taken from a brilliant blogger somewhere)*

2 lbs chicken breasts
1 C. Kraft Light Zesty Italian dressing
1/2 Tbsp. minced garlic

1 packet Hidden Valley Ranch dressing mix (mixed with 1/2 cup of water)

1/2 Tbsp. chili powder
1/2 Tbsp. ground cumin

1. Spray your crockpot with cooking spray and add chicken.
2. Mix all sauce ingredients in a small bowl and pour over the chicken.
3. Place all ingredients in a crock pot. Cook on High 5-6 hours OR on Low 8 hours.
4. Shred the chicken with a fork, or shred it like I did.

Arika's notes:

1. *Rather than using a fork, remove the chicken to a bowl, and get your mixer out! It's amazing how quickly the mixer shreds the chicken. Easy peezy!!!*
2. *I moved the chicken back into the crockpot after I shredded it so it could mix back in with the juices produced during the cooking process.*
3. *I ate this chicken all week long… I made salads, I ate some with vegetables. I'm sure it would make insane tacos, burritos, and enchiladas. I also froze about half of the chicken in the freezer to enjoy at a later time.*

Chicken Filling - for tacos, taquitos, and flautas (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
makes ~3 ½ cups - takes 30 minutes

1 T vegetable oil
½ white onion, minced (½ cup)

2 garlic cloves, chopped
1 serrano chile, minced

½ c prepared tomato sauce
1 t ground cumin

½ t salt
3 ½ c shredded, cooked chicken (about 3 breasts)

Heat the oil in a large skillet set over medium heat. Add the onion, garlic, and chile and saute until the onions are translucent, about 6 minutes. Add the tomato sauce, cumin, and salt and continue to cook for one more minute. Add the chicken and cook just until heated through, about 2 minutes. Taste and adjust seasonings if necessary. Serve hot.

Ground Beef Filling - for tacos, taquitos, and flautas (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
takes 35 minutes - much less sodium than a taco seasoning packet

1 T vegetable oil
¾ c finely chopped onion
1 large garlic clove, minced
2 t ground cumin
2 t chili powder
1 ½ lbs lean ground beef
2 T tomato paste
½ t salt
Freshly ground black pepper

Heat the oil in a large skillet over medium-low heat. Add the onion and garlic and saute until the onion has softened, about 6 minutes. Add the cumin and chili powder and cook, stirring, for another minute. Add the beef and cook, stirring and breaking up any lumps until the meat is no longer pink, about 5 minutes. Add the tomato paste, salt, and pepper to taste. Cook the mixture, stirring, until the meat is cooked through, about 5 minutes. Taste and reseason if necessary.

Shredded Beef Filling - for tacos, taquitos, and flautas (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
takes 2 ½ hours

2 ½ lbs boneless beef chuck, trimmed of excess fat and cut into 2-inch pieces
salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 T vegetable oil
1 medium onion, finely chopped
3 garlic cloves, finely chopped
1 serrano chile, seeded and chopped
1 ½ t ground cumin
½ c tomato sauce

1. Season the beef with salt and pepper. Heat the oil in a large, heavy saute pan over medium-high heat. Add the beef and cook, about 5-8 minutes, turning the meat so it browns on all sides. Do not crowd the beef in the pan or it will not brown properly. Work in two batches if necessary. Remove the beef from the pan. Add the onions, garlic, and chile to the pan. Cook until the onions are caramelized, about 10 minutes. Add the cumin and cook 1 minute. Return the beef to the pan and add the tomato sauce and 1 cup water. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat to low, and simmer partially covered, for 1 ½ to 2 hours, or until the beef is tender.
2. Let the beef cool in the liquid. Remove the beef from the pan and shred it using two forks. Return the beef to the pan and stir to combine. Taste and reseason if necessary. Serve hot.

Carnitas Filling - for tacos, taquitos, and flautas (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
takes 2 ½ hours

2 ½ lbs boneless pork butt, shoulder, or boneless country-style pork ribs
½ c fresh orange juice
¼ c milk
2 garlic cloves, chopped
1 t salt
¼ t freshly ground black pepper
grated zest of 1 orange

1. Cut the pork into large 4-inch pieces. Cut off any big chunks of fat and set them aside; leave small pieces of fat attached to the pork. Combine all of the ingredients, including the reserved fat, and 1 c water, in a large, heavy saucepan or Dutch oven. Bring to a boil, then reduce the heat to low, cover, and simmer until the pork is tender, turning occasionally, about 1 hour 45 minutes.
2. Remove the meat from the liquid and turn the heat up to medium. Cook until the liquid is reduced by half, about 10 minutes. Return the meat to the pan (discarding the chunks of fat). Cook until the liquid evaporates and the meat

browns and begins to crisp in the remaining fat, stirring often, about 15 minutes. Using a slotted spoon, transfer the meat to a platter. Using two forks, shred the meat (the meat will begin to shred while you're stirring in the pan). Season with more salt, if desired.

***Café Rio Pork** (from Carrie Tucker)
Yummy just over plain rice or in burritos or salad.

2 T brown sugar
1 t chili powder
2 t cumin
2 t salt
1 can coke
1 c chicken broth
½ sliced onion placed on top of pork
2 cloves of crushed garlic
½ c brown sugar

1. Mix brown sugar, chili powder, cumin, and salt and rub on 4 lb pork loin; place in crock pot. Then add coke, chicken broth, onion, and garlic.

2. Cook on low for 8 hours.
3. Take pork out, remove onions, shred meat.
4. Put pork back in crock pot and add brown sugar. Cook 6-8 more hours.

Pork Chops with Apple-Sage Sauce (from foodmeanderings.com)
Takes 25 minutes; serves 4

4 pork chops, each about ½ inch thick *(I used cuts from a pork tenderloin)*
1 apple, cored, peeled and sliced into small-medium wedges (granny smith is best)
1 T butter
½ t minced garlic
½ c apple juice
1 T Dijon mustard
1 t ground sage leaves
¼ t chili flakes
pinch of salt
(optional) fresh sage leaves for garnishing

1. Melt butter with garlic in a large non-stick frying pan over medium heat. When bubbly, add apple. Turn occasionally, until golden on both side, 2-3 minutes, then remove to a small plate.
2. Add pork to pan and cook until browned, about 3 minutes per side.
3. In a bowl, stir juice and Dijon mustard and seasonings.
4. Once pork is browned, pour in juice mixture and add apples. Reduce heat, cover and simmer, turning pork occasionally, until cooked through for 5-7 minutes.
5. Remove pork and apples from pan and place on plates.
6. Boil sauce, stirring often, until as thick as you desire, 3-5 minutes. Pour over pork chops and apples.

Caribbean Pork Tenderloin (from Fix, Freeze, Feast, p. 128)
Serves 6

1.5 lb pork tenderloin
1 T + 2 t white vinegar
1 T packed brown sugar
1 T soy sauce
1 t dried thyme
1 t ground allspice
1 t salt
¼ t black pepper
¼ t ground cinnamon
1 c chopped scallions
½ c chopped onion
1 T minced ginger
1 t minced garlic

1. Rinse and trim tenderloin as desired. Place in freezer bag (for marinating or freezing for later).

2. Mix vinegar, sugar, and soy sauce. Pour over the pork. Measure dry spices into bag and shake to distribute. Then measure remaining four ingredients (onions through garlic) into the bag.
3. Marinate for an hour or more. Or, if freezing for later, seal and freeze.
4. When ready to cook, thaw completely in refrigerator if frozen. Prepare a medium-low fire in the grill. Lightly coat grill rack with cooking spray. Grill tenderloin until a thermometer inserted in thickest part of the pork reads 160 degrees. Discard extra marinade.
   IDEA: Can also be cut up before grilling and cooked kabob-style with steamed sweet potato and pineapple.

Pork Barbecue (from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 186)
Serves 8

3 lb Boston butt roast (pork shoulder)
2 c chopped onion
3 T dry mustard
3 T brown sugar
¼ t pepper
1 t cayenne pepper
1 c white vinegar
1 ½ c water
½ c ketchup
½ c Worcestershire sauce
8 sandwich buns

If freezing for later, pour all ingredients except for the sandwich buns into a labeled 1 gallon freezer bag and freeze.

To serve, pour the contents of the bag into a slow cooker and simmer 5-6 hours or until thoroughly cooked. Shred the pork and remove the bone. Serve over warmed buns.

Chalupa (from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 84) *aka "Meaty Glob" from Mckay, back in his meat eating days*
Serves 8

1 lb (2 cups) dry pinto beans
½ c chopped onion
1 4 oz can chopped green chilies
1 t chopped garlic
1 ½ T chili powder
1 ½ t ground cumin
1 t dried oregano
1 t salt
2 ½ c shredded mozzarella cheese
3 lb boneless pork loin roast

If freezing for later:
Don't add beans yet. Pour the remaining ingredients, except the cheese, in a 1 gallon freezer bag. Pour the cheese into a sandwich bag. Label the bags, attach them, and freeze.

To serve:
1. Thaw if frozen and rinse dry beans. Drain and pour the beans into the bottom of a slow cooker. Put the pork loin on top, and the remaining ingredients, except for the cheese. Add 3 c water. Cook on high for 6 hours, or until the meat pulls apart easily and the beans have softened.
2. Shred the meat. Return it to the slow cooker and cook another 30 to 60 minutes.
3. Serve in bowls with cheese sprinkled on top.

***Swedish Meatballs** (Cooks Illustrated, January & February, 2009, p.15)
Serves 4 to 6

<u>Meatballs</u>:
1 large egg
¼ c heavy cream (I use evaporated milk for less fat and cheaper)
1 large slice bread, torn into 1-inch pieces
8 oz ground pork
1 small onion, grated on large holes of box grater (about ¼ cup)
1/8 t freshly grated nutmeg
1/8 t ground allspice
1/8 t ground black pepper
1 t packed brown sugar
1 ½ t salt
1 t baking powder
8 oz ground beef
1 ¼ c vegetable oil

<u>Sauce</u>:
1 T unsalted butter
1 T flour

1 ½ c chicken broth
1 T packed brown sugar
½ c heavy cream (I use evaporated milk)
2 t lemon juice
Salt and pepper to taste

1. FOR THE MEATBALLS: Whisk egg and cream together in medium bowl. Stir in bread and set aside. Meanwhile, in stand mixer with paddle attachment (I use food processor with blade – mixing times are about half), beat pork, onion, nutmeg, allspice, pepper, brown sugar, salt, and baking powder on high speed until smooth and pale, about 2 minutes, scraping bowl as necessary. Using fork, mash bread mixture until no large dry bread chunks remain; add mixture to mixer bowl and beat on high speed until smooth and homogeneous, about 1 minute, scraping bowl as necessary. Add beef and mix on medium-low speed until just incorporated, about 30 seconds, scraping bowl as necessary. Using moistened hands (I use my small cookie dough scoop), form generous tablespoon of meat mixture into 1-inch round meatball; repeat with remaining mixture to form 25-30 meatballs.
2. Heat oil in 10-inch straight-sided sauté pan over medium-high heat until edge of meatball dipped in oil sizzles, 3-5 minutes. Add meatballs in single layer and fry (arrange meatballs in a clockwise spiral to keep track of the order they were placed in the pan), flipping once halfway through cooking, until lightly browned all over and cooked through, 7-10 minutes (usually takes less – maybe because cookie dough balls are smaller?). Adjust heat as needed to keep oil sizzling, but not smoking. Transfer browned meatballs to paper towel-lined plate.
3. FOR THE SAUCE: Pour off and discard oil in pan, leaving any fond (browned bits) behind. Return pan to medium-high heat and add butter. When foaming subsides, add flour and cook, whisking constantly, until flour is light brown, about 30 seconds. Slowly whisk in broth, scraping pan bottom to loosen browned bits. Add brown sugar and bring to simmer. Reduce heat to medium and cook until sauce is reduced to about 1 cup, about 5 minutes. Stir in cream and return to simmer.
4. Add meatballs to sauce and simmer, turning occasionally, until heated through, about 5 minutes. Stir in lemon juice, season with salt and pepper, and serve.

**We love to eat these with mashed potatoes (skins on) and "lingonberry" sauce (aka whole cranberry sauce). Yum.*
**The meatballs can be fried and frozen for up to 2 weeks. To continue with recipe, thaw the meatballs in the refrigerator overnight and proceed from step 3, using a clean pan. (You'd lose the benefit of the "fond" this way.)

Mini Meatballs (from *Scratch*, by Maria Rodale)
Serves 6-8 - *This recipe makes a LOT of meatballs so you can freeze them and use whenever needed (or serve now to a crowd).*

2 pounds ground beef
1 pound ground pork
1 cup dried breadcrumbs
1/2 cup finely grated Romano cheese
2 large eggs
1 teaspoon salt
1/2 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
3 tablespoons chopped fresh Italian parsley leaves
Extra virgin olive oil, for cooking

1. In a large bowl, combine the beef, pork, breadcrumbs, Romano, eggs, salt, pepper, and parsley and mix well with your hands to combine.
2. In a large cast-iron skillet, heat a little oil over high heat. Working in batches, pinch off small amounts of the mixture (the size of a marble), roll into mini balls, and add to the pan. Fry the meatballs for a few minutes on each side, or until well browned and cooked through. Drain on paper towels. Repeat until all the mixture has been cooked.
3. To freeze, place the cooled balls in a single layer on a baking sheet and freeze for 2 to 3 hours. Transfer to freezer bags and store in the freezer for up to 3 months.

Mini Meat Loaves

1 jar Prego traditional pasta sauce
1 ½ lbs extra-lean ground beef
1 ½ c herb seasoned stuffing
2 eggs, beaten
1 medium onion, chopped
¼ c chopped green pepper
1 t dried oregano leaves, crushed
4 oz mozzarella cheese, cut into 6 pieces

1. Mix 1 c pasta sauce, the beef, stuffing, eggs, onion, pepper and oregano in a medium bowl. Shape firmly into 6 mini loaves, then insert a piece of cheese into the center of each loaf.
2. Place loaves in a shallow baking dish. Spread 2 T pasta sauce over each loaf.
3. Bake at 400 degrees for 30 minutes or until cooked through; drain fat.
4. Heat remaining pasta sauce; serve with meat loaves. Serves 6.

***George Engelhardt's Jerky Recipe**

1. Cut meat into ¼ inch strips, while still firm or frozen. *(I use rump roast and have the butcher slice it for me.)*
2. Marinade for 1 ½ to 2 lbs of meat:

¼ c soy sauce
1 T Worcestershire sauce
¼ t pepper *(we use coarse ground)*
¼ t garlic powder
¼ t onion powder
1 t hickory smoke salt/liquid smoke

3. Soak 24-30 hours in refrigerator. Bake at 150-200 degrees until dry to touch; dry off each piece.

Better Than A-1 Marinade (from *Cooks Illustrated,* May/June 2007)
makes enough to marinate 2 lbs steak

½ c soy sauce
⅓ c vegetable oil
2 T brown sugar
¼ c Worcestershire sauce
4 medium garlic cloves, minced (about 4 t)
2 T minced chives
1 ½ t ground black pepper
2 t balsamic vinegar

1. Add all but vinegar. Remove ¼ c marinade & combine with vinegar in small bowl. Set aside.
2. Place remaining marinade with steaks in ziploc in refrigerator for 1 hour, flipping to ensure even distribution.
3. Grill as desired. Transfer steaks to shallow pan and pour reserved marinade over top. Tent loosely with foil, rest for 10 minutes.

Mexican-Style Grilled Steak (Carne Asada) (from *Cook's Illustrated*, Sept/Oct 2014)
serves 4-6

2 lb skirt steak *(or sirloin steak tips, or flap meat)* trimmed, pounded ¼ inch thick and cut with grain into 4 equal steaks
2 t kosher salt
¾ t ground cumin
1 garlic clove, peeled and smashed
lime wedges

1. Combine salt and cumin in small bowl. Sprinkle salt mixture evenly over both sides of steaks. Transfer steaks to wire rack in rimmed baking sheet and refrigerate, uncovered, for at least 45 minutes or up to 24 hours.
2. Turn all burners to high, cover, and heat grill until hot, about 15 minutes. Leave all burners on high.
3. Clean and oil cooking grate. Place steaks on grill and cook, uncovered, until well browned on first side, 2-4 minutes. Flip steaks and continue to cook until well browned on second side and meat registers 130 degrees, 2-4 minutes longer. Transfer steaks to carving board, tent loosely with aluminum foil, and let rest for 5 minutes.
4. Rub garlic thoroughly over 1 side of steaks. Slice steaks against grain into ¼ inch thick slices and serve with lime wedges. *(Or serve as tacos with jack cheese, shredded lettuce, and pico.)*

Pepper-Crusted Filet Mignon
Serves 4

5 T black peppercorns, cracked (this can be done by pressing down on them with a skillet)

5 T plus 2 t olive oil
1 T kosher salt
4 center-cut filets mignons, 1 ½-2 inches thick, 7-8 oz each, trimmed of fat and silver skin

1. Heat peppercorns and 5 T oil in small saucepan over low heat until faint bubbles appear. Continue to cook at bare simmer, swirling pan occasionally, until pepper is fragrant, 7-10 minutes. Remove from heat and set aside to cool. When mixture is room temperature, add salt and stir to combine. Rub steaks with pepper mixture, thoroughly coating top and bottom of each steak with peppercorns. Cover steaks with plastic wrap and press gently to make sure peppercorns adhere; let stand at room temperature for 1 hour.
2. Meanwhile, adjust oven rack to middle position, place rimmed baking sheet on oven rack, and heat oven to 450 degrees. Heat remaining 2 t oil in 12-in heavy-bottomed skillet over medium-high heat until faint smoke appears. Place steaks in skillet and cook, without moving steaks, until dark brown crust has formed, 3-4 minutes. Using tongs, turn steaks and cook until well browned on second side, about 3 minutes. Remove pan from heat and transfer steaks to hot baking sheet. Roast 3-5 minutes for rare, 5-7 minutes for med-rare to medium. Transfer steaks to wire cooling rack and let rest, loosely tented with foil, for 5 minutes before serving.

***Jamaican Beef Patties**
Makes 8-12 - *This actually makes twice as much meat filling for the amount of dough, so make ½ the meat unless you want tons.*

DOUGH
5 c flour
1 T turmeric
1 t salt
8 T vegetable shortening
~1 ½ c cold water, 1 T at a time

FILLING
1 T vegetable oil
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 c chopped onion
2 green onions, chopped
1-2 jalapenos, seeded, chopped (or any hot peppers)
¼ t seasoning salt
1-2t barrier reef caribbean seasoning
2 lbs lean ground beef
1T coarse ground pepper
1 c water
2 c bread crumbs
1 ½ t dried thyme
Nonstick cooking spray

1. In large bowl, combine flour, turmeric and salt; blend well with pastry blender (like you're making a pie crust). Add shortening, mix thoroughly. Add just enough cold water, 1 T at a time, to bind dough. Wrap dough in plastic wrap or place in resealable bag and refrigerate overnight.
2. Heat oil in large skillet over medium heat. Add garlic, onion, green onions, hot peppers and beef; sauté for 10 minutes. Add salt and pepper to taste. Add water; simmer 20 minutes. Add bread crumbs and thyme; cook 10 minutes longer, stirring to prevent burning. Remove from heat; allow to cool to room temperature.
3. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Spray 2 baking sheets with nonstick spray. On lightly floured surface, roll out dough. Cut in 6 inch circles.
4. Spoon 2-3 T of beef filling in center of each circle of dough. Fold in half; crimp edges together with a fork. Bake for 30 minutes or until golden brown.

Jamaican Beef Patties (from *butterbeready.com*) - *Dillon made these for Lee's birthday in 2024 and they were tender, flaky, flavorful, and delicious! (Definitely better crust than the other recipe.)*
1 hour prep time + 30 minute cook time
makes 8 large-ish patties



<u>Ingredients</u>
For the dough:
3 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
2 teaspoons kosher salt
1 tablespoon granulated sugar
1 tablespoon Jamaican curry powder
2 tablespoons turmeric powder
1 cup unsalted butter, grated
1 cup ice cold water

For the beef filling mixture:

2 tablespoons olive oil
1 lb ground beef
1 large yellow onion, finely chopped
1 tablespoon minced garlic
1 teaspoon grated ginger
kosher salt & freshly ground black pepper, to taste
1 teaspoon fresh or dried thyme
1 teaspoon ground allspice
1/2 teaspoon Jamaican curry powder
1–2 scotch bonnet peppers *(or other variety, depending on heat)*, deseeded & finely chopped
4 scallions (green onion), chopped
1/2 cup chicken stock or broth, plus more as needed
1/2 cup plain breadcrumbs
3 tablespoons unsalted butter, cubed

Instructions

For the dough:

1. In a large bowl, add the flour, salt, sugar, curry powder, and turmeric powder together. Whisk the dry ingredients well to combine. Then add in (or grate the butter over the bowl) the grated butter. Use your hands (fitted with disposable gloves, if desired) to pinch the butter into the dry mixture until little pea-sized bits form throughout and all the butter is coated with the flour mixture.
2. Then make a small well in the center of the mixture and pour in the ice-cold water. Use your hands, again, to bring everything together as much as you can. Empty out the bowl and all residual bits onto a clean surface. Use your hands to knead the dough together, squeezing the dough onto itself until the dough forms into one cohesive mass with no dry bits.
3. Shape the dough into a ball and then cover with plastic wrap. Transfer the dough into the refrigerator to chill for at least 30 minutes.

For the beef filling mixture:

1. Heat a large skillet over medium heat and coat the bottom of the skillet with the olive oil. Once the oil is shimmering, add in the ground beef. Use a wooden utensil to cook the beef, stirring often, until completely browned. Then add in the chopped onion, and continue cooking, about 3-4 minutes or until the onions are tender.
2. Stir in the garlic and ginger and continue cooking. Then add in the thyme, allspice, curry powder, scotch bonnet, and scallions. Stir together and continue cooking mixture for another 2-3 minutes.
3. Pour the stock/broth into the skillet and stir to combine for 1 minute. Then stir in the breadcrumbs and mix well until they're mostly absorbed by the beef mixture. Add in the cubed pieces of butter and stir well until all butter has melted through. Note: At this point, look for the beef mixture to be juicy and moist. If your mixture is dry, add in a splash more of stock/broth until the mixture is visibly moist (but not watery). Then remove from heat and allow the beef mixture to cool down before assembling beef patties.

Beef patty assembly & cooking:

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Position the oven rack into the center of the oven. Then line a large baking sheet with parchment paper, foil, or a silpat liner and then set the baking sheet aside.
2. Remove the chilled dough from the refrigerator and divide the dough into equal pieces for patties. I like to use a kitchen scale to get a uniform size in each piece of dough (I make mine 5 ounces each, which will result in a total of 8 beef patties). You can make yours smaller for more patties as well.
3. After gathering the pieces of dough, roll them in the palms of your hands into a smooth ball. Then use a rolling pin to flatten the dough into a round shape that is about 3 millimeters-thick, about 6-7 inches.
4. Fill one side of the pastry with about 4 tablespoons of the beef filling mixture. For smaller patties, use 2 tablespoons. Then fold the empty side of the pastry over the beef filling, forming a crescent shape (half-moon). I like to bring the two pastry edges together and tuck/roll them under for extra measure, see video demonstration.
5. Then carefully flip the patty over and use a fork to crimp the edges. Place the patty onto the prepared baking sheet and repeat the process until all patties have been assembled and placed onto the baking sheet with a little space in between each one.
6. Bake the beef patties for 25-30 minutes or until they achieve a light, golden brown color. Allow the patties to cool down for 5 minutes. Then serve immediately. Enjoy!

Taco Puffs (From Taste of Home Simple & Delicious Cookbook, p. 16)
8 servings

1 lb ground beef
½ c chopped onion
1 envelope taco seasoning
2 t large refrigerated flaky biscuits
8 oz cheddar cheese slices (or shredded)

In a large skillet, cook beef and onion over medium heat until meat is no longer pink; drain. Add the taco seasoning and prepare according to package directions. Cool slightly. Flatten half of the biscuits into 4 inch circles; place in greased jelly roll pan. Spoon ¼ c meat mixture onto each; top with two cheese slices or ¼ c shredded cheese. Flatten remaining biscuits. Place on top and pinch edges to seal tightly. Bake at 400 degrees for 15 minutes or until golden brown.

Perfect Empanada Dough
10 min prep/chill overnight - makes 12 empanadas

2 ¼ c flour
1 ½ t salt
¼ c chilled shortening, cut in cubes
4 T chilled butter, cut in cubes
1 egg
1/3 c cold water
1 T white vinegar

1. Combine flour, salt, shortening, and butter in a bowl. Cut with pastry cutter until mixture looks sandy and there are roughly pea-sized pieces of butter remaining.
2. In another bowl, combine the egg, water, and vinegar; whisk to blend well. Drizzle over the flour-butter mixture and stir with a fork until a shaggy dough comes together. Knead on a well-floured surface just enough to bring the dough together. Wrap tightly in plastic wrap and chill overnight.

Tasty Beef and Cheese Empanada Filling
Makes enough to fill 10-12 empanadas

1 T olive oil
1 medium onion, minced
1 T tomato paste
2 medium garlic cloves, minced (about 2 teaspoons)
¼ t dried oregano leaves
1 t ground cumin
Pinch ground cloves
Pinch cayenne pepper

½ pound ground beef
¾ c beef broth *(oops…I used chicken!)*
1 t sugar
Salt and pepper

2 oz (about ½ c) Monterey Jack cheese, shredded
½ c fresh cilantro, chopped
1 egg, beaten

1. Heat the oil in a 12-inch nonstick skillet over medium-high heat until just shimmering. Add the onion and cook until softened, 5-7 minutes. Stir in the tomato paste, garlic, oregano, cumin, cloves, and cayenne and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Stir in the beef and cook, breaking up the clumps with a wooden spoon, until no longer pink, about 4 minutes.
2. Stir in the broth, reduce the heat to low, and simmer until the mixture is moist but not wet, about 4 minutes. Off the heat, stir in the sugar and season with salt and pepper to taste. Transfer the mixture to a medium bowl, cover with plastic wrap, and refrigerate until completely cool, about 1 hour. (I put it in a small bowl, then put the small bowl in a large bowl of ice.) You can keep it in the fridge until needed, up to 3 days.
3. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Divide the dough (recipe above) into 12 pieces and roll out flat, 4-6 inches. Place about 2 T of meat mixture in center of each dough round. Sprinkle a bit of Monterey Jack cheese and fresh cilantro over meat mixture (You could premix the cheese and cilantro into the meat mixture to make assembly simpler). Brush edges with beaten egg. Fold in half and crimp edges with a fork. Place on parchment lined baking sheet. Brush pastry top with beaten egg. Bake for 15-20 minutes until golden brown.

***If you want to skip the step of making your own meat filling, you could also use any pre-cooked meat mixture. We used pork carnitas that we got from the Mexican grocery store and it was SUPER tasty.*

Argentinian Ham and Cheese Empanadas (from *Family Fun*, March 2009)
makes 12 medium-size turnovers

2 T olive oil
1 medium onion, finely chopped
2 T minced fresh parsley
8 oz cooked ham, chopped
2 T bread crumbs
8 oz mild Cheddar or Jarlsberg, shredded
2 T sour cream
1 large egg, lightly beaten
pinch of black pepper
1 pkg empanada wrappers or 2 pkgs frozen puff pastry shells, thawed
Egg wash made from 1 large egg lightly beaten, combined with 1 T water

1. In a medium skillet, heat the oil over medium heat. Add the onion and parsley and cook, stirring occasionally, until the onion is transparent, about 3 minutes. Remove the skillet from the heat, transfer the mixture to a medium-size bowl, and allow it to cool.
2. Add the ham, bread crumbs, cheese, sour cream, egg, and a pinch of black pepper to the bowl, and mix well.
3. To assemble the tournovers: Place 2 heaping T of filling in the center of an empanada wrapper and lightly moisten the edge of the circle with the egg mixture. (If you use a pastry shell, you'll first need to roll it out into a 5-inch circle on a lightly floured work surface.) Fold the pastry in half and press the edges firmly to seal. Crimp the edge with a fork dipped in flour and pierce the top with the fork to allow steam to escape. Repeat with the remaining wrappers and filling, then refrigerate the empanadas for 30 minutes or freeze for later use. **
4. Heat the oven to 375. Brush the turnovers with the egg wash and bake them on a parchment-lined baking sheet on the upper oven rack until golden, about 20-25 minutes. Allow the empanadas to cool for a few minutes before serving.

**To freeze the empanadas, place the unbaked turnovers in the freezer on a baking sheet lined with waxed paper. When frozen, stack them in sealable containers. Pop them in the oven frozen when you're ready to bake them (following step 4). Just increase the baking time by 15 minutes.

Orange Sesame Salmon (or Chicken) -- Ruth Ellis' 1st place recipe from Curves magazine

2 T olive oil
2 10 oz skinless salmon fillets, halved (or equivalent chicken)
2 cloves garlic, finely chopped
1 bunch fresh asparagus, stems removed, and cut into ½" pieces
½ c orange juice
2 T brown sugar
2 T soy sauce
Zest of 1 orange
2 c chicken broth
2 c instant brown rice
2 T toasted sesame seeds

1. In a large, deep nonstick skillet with a lid, heat oil on medium. Add salmon and sprinkle with garlic. Cook for 2 minutes, turn, and cook an additional 2 minutes.
2. Add asparagus, orange juice, sugar, and soy sauce to skillet. Bring to a boil. Cover, reduce heat, and simmer 3-5 minutes until salmon is flaky and asparagus is fork-tender.
3. Transfer only the salmon to a serving platter and cover with foil to keep warm. Gently stir orange zest into pan. Add broth and bring to a boil. Remove from heat, stir in rice, and cover. Allow to stand for 5 minutes.
4. Fluff rice gently with a fork and return salmon to top of rice. Sprinkle with sesame seeds.

SANDWICHES & WRAPS

Classic BLT Wraps

7 oz pouch or canned chicken breast
2 fajita size flour tortillas
Cheddar cheese, shredded
Tomato slices/dices
Ranch dressing
Green leaf lettuce
Bacon, cooked

Spread ranch dressing on tortillas, then cover with cheese. Top with lettuce, sliced tomato, and generous helping of chicken breast. Add bacon and roll up.

Greek Salad Wraps
10 minutes to prepare - serves 4

¼ c olive oil
2 ½ T red wine vinegar
salt and pepper
15 oz can chickpeas, rinsed
2 c cherry tomatoes, halved
1 small English cucumber cut into ¼ in pieces
¼ c Kalamata olives, roughly chopped
¼ small red onion, thinly sliced
¼ c crumbled feta cheese
2 c baby spinach
4 10 inch wraps

1. In medium bowl, whisk together oil, vinegar, and ½ t each salt and pepper. Add chickpeas, tomatoes, cucumber, olives and onion and toss to combine; fold in feta.
2. Divide spinach among wraps; top with chickpea salad and roll.

(each serving has 11 g fat, 14 g protein, 1000mg sodium, 56 g carbs, 10 g fiber)

***Chili's Lettuce Wraps**

1 T oil
4 chicken breasts
3 green onions

<u>Stir Fry Sauce</u>:
¼ c water
1 t cornstarch
1/3 c soy sauce
¼ c sugar
¼ c vinegar
1 T oil
2 t sesame seeds
1 t red pepper flakes
1 t chili oil
½ t minced ginger

For stir fry sauce:
1. Combine water and cornstarch and stir til cornstarch dissolves.
2. Add to other stir fry ingredients in small saucepan over medium heat.
3. Bring to boil. Reduce heat and simmer til thick.

For chicken:
1. Heat 1 T oil on medium in skillet.
2. Cook chicken breasts until done, turning every couple of minutes. Remove and slice into strips.
3. Put chicken back in pan over medium high heat. Add 5 T stir fry sauce and heat 2 minutes, stirring. Sauce should be bubbly.
4. Add remaining sauce and green onions and stir.

Serve on lettuce with Sesame ginger dipping sauce. Also add rice, mandarin oranges, almonds, etc.

Easy Lettuce Wraps (adapted from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 188)
Serves 4

1 c teriyaki sauce
1/3 c honey
½ c chopped green onions
2 c deboned and shredded rotisserie chicken
1 c cashews
1 head Bibb lettuce

Mix teriyaki sauce, honey and green onions together. Heat for 10 seconds and pour over shredded chicken. Sprinkle with cashews. Fill individual lettuce leaves with the mixture, wrap, and serve immediately.

Indian-Spiced Chickpea Wraps
Makes 4 servings (1 ⅓ c sauce)

<u>Raita</u>
1 c reduced-fat plain yogurt
½ c drained unsweetened pineapple tidbits (can substitute diced mango or cucumber)
¼ t salt
¼ t ground cumin

<u>Wraps</u>
2 t canola oil
1 small onion, chopped
1 T minced fresh gingerroot
2 garlic cloves, minced
½ t curry powder
¼ t each, salt, ground cumin and ground coriander
¼ t cayenne pepper (optional)
1 can (15 oz) chickpeas or garbanzo beans, rinsed and drained
1 c canned crushed tomatoes
4 whole wheat tortillas (8 in), warmed
3 c fresh baby spinach

1. In a small bowl, mix raita ingredients; set aside.
2. For wraps, in a nonstick skillet coated with cooking spray, heat oil over medium-high heat. Add onion; cook and stir until tender. Add ginger, garlic and seasonings; cook and stir 1 minute longer.
3. Stir in chickpeas and tomatoes. Bring to a boil. Reduce heat; simmer, uncovered, for 5-8 minutes or until slightly thickened, stirring occasionally.
4. Near the center of each tortilla, arrange spinach and chickpea mixture; top with raita. Roll up tightly; serve immediately.

South of the Border Tuna Wrap

1 pouch (3 oz or 7 oz) Albacore or Light Tuna in Water
2 burrito size flour tortillas
1 can black beans, drained
¾ c shredded lettuce
½ c salsa
½ c shredded cheese

Split all ingredients between the tortillas. Top with the tuna. Roll tightly and cut in half diagonally.

Vegetable Hummus Tortilla Wraps (from *Family Circle*, July 2014)
Makes 2 wraps

1 t sugar
1 ½ t white vinegar
¼ c carrots, julienned
1/3 c seedless cucumber, julienned
2/3 c red onion, julienned
Pinch of salt
Pinch of pepper
2 multi-grain tortillas
1/3 c roasted red pepper hummus
2/3 c bean sprouts
1 c alfalfa sprouts
(I substituted turkey slices and spinach leaves for both of the sprouts varieties)

1. Dissolve sugar in vinegar. Mix with carrots, cucumber and onion. Season with salt and pepper and refrigerate for 3

hours.
2. Drain veggies.
3. Spread ¼ c of the hummus across each tortilla. On bottom third, add half the marinated vegetables, top with sprouts and roll up. *(Or put spinach and turkey slices on after hummus and top with veggies, then roll up.)*

Honey-Dijon Chicken and Spinach Wraps (Family Circle, Aug 2012)
Makes 4 servings

½ c reduced-fat mayo
2 T honey-Dijon mustard
2 T milk
2 c cubed rotisserie chicken
1 c chopped celery
1 c halved red seedless grapes
½ c chopped walnuts
4 whole wheat tortillas
Baby spinach

In a large bowl, whisk together mayo, mustard, and milk. Stir in chicken, celery, grapes, and walnuts. Wrap tortillas in damp paper towels and microwave for 30 seconds. Scatter spinach over each tortilla and spoon about ¾ c of the chicken mixture down the center. Roll up tightly and cut diagonally in half.

Easy wraps

1. Spread a few spoonfuls of the sauce in the center of a large 10 inch tortilla. Top with meat and add-ins.
2. Fold bottom edge of tortilla over filling and then roll from one side to the other, leaving one end open.
3. Heat in microwave on high for 1 minute, or until heated through.

**Wraps can be made ahead of time, covered in plastic wrap and stored in fridge for up to 4 hours. Heat in microwave (without plastic wrap) for 1 ½ minutes.

Ingredient suggestions:

Meat	**Add-ins**	**Sauce**
Chicken breast strips or cuts	Coleslaw and sliced green onions	Miracle Whip and peanut butter mixed together evenly
Cooked bacon	Chopped lettuce and tomatoes	Garden Vegetable Cream Cheese Spread
Turkey	Stuffing and cranberry sauce	Miracle Whip
None	Prepared rice, salsa, corn	Cheese dip

Pita Sandwiches (from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 93)
Serves 6

1 lb lean ground beef
1 t chopped garlic
½ t paprika
1 t ground cumin
1 t ground allspice
¼ t salt
¼ t cayenne pepper
6 pita breads-opened & lightly grilled
3 sliced plum tomatoes
1 small sliced cucumber

<u>Yogurt sauce</u>:
1 6 oz carton plain yogurt
1 T chopped fresh parsley
2 t chopped fresh cilantro
½ t dried mint
Salt and ground pepper to taste

In medium skillet, sauté the ground beef. Drain excess fat, and add the remaining ingredients through the cayenne. If freezing for later use, pour into labeled 1 quart freezer bag and freeze.

To serve, thaw and warm the filling. Open the end of the pitas to form a sandwich pocket and lightly grill, if desired. Prepare the yogurt sauce. Serve the filling on the pita pockets with the yogurt sauce, diced tomatoes, and sliced cucumbers.

Greek-Style Chicken Pitas

1 c bottled Italian salad dressing
4 skinless, boneless chicken breasts, cubed (about 1 lb)
4 pita breads (or use tortillas, if no pitas)
1 medium red onion, thinly sliced
2 tomatoes, chopped

Sauce:
1 c plain yogurt
1 cucumber, peeled, deseeded, shredded
2 T fresh lemon juice
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 t dried mint

1. Preheat broiler. Mix dressing and chicken in a medium bowl. Thread chicken on presoaked skewers; brush with dressing. Broil chicken until cooked through, about 5 minutes per side
2. Meanwhile, for sauce, combine yogurt, cucumber, lemon juice, garlic and mint in a small bowl; mix well. Set aside.
3. Divide chicken among pitas. Top chicken with onion and tomatoes; drizzle with sauce. Serve immediately.

**You can grill the chicken up to 24 hours ahead and refrigerate until ready to prepare remainder of recipe.*

Chicken Gyros (Family Circle, Aug 2012)
Makes 4 servings

7 oz 2% Greek yogurt
1/3 c crumbled feta cheese
4 pita flatbreads
2 c shredded rotisserie chicken
Shredded iceberg lettuce
Sliced/diced cucumber
Sliced/diced tomato
Sliced/diced red onion

Combine yogurt, and feta. Cut pitas in half. Into each half spoon an equal amount of yogurt mixture, ¼ c chicken, lettuce, cucumber, tomatoes, and red onion.

To make these into veggie gyros, eliminate shredded chicken and increase tomato and cucumber amounts. Replace plain feta cheese with 2/3 c tomato-basil-flavored feta.

Chicken Shawarma Pitas (from *Cooking Light*, July 2008)
takes 45 minutes - serves 4

<u>Chicken</u>
2 T fresh lemon juice
1 t curry powder
2 t extra virgin olive oil
¾ t salt
½ t ground cumin
3 garlic cloves, minced
1 lb skinless, boneless chicken breast, cut into 16 (3 in) strips

<u>Sauce</u>
½ c plain 2% reduce-fat Greek yogurt
2 T tahini
2 t fresh lemon juice
¼ t salt
1 garlic clove, minced

<u>for serving</u>
4 (6 inch) pitas
1 c chopped romaine lettuce
8 (¼ inch thick) tomato slices

1. Preheat grill to medium-high heat.
2. To prepare chicken, combine first 6 ingredients in a medium bowl. Add chicken to bowl; toss well to coat. Let stand at room temperature 20 minutes.
3. To prepare sauce, combine yogurt and next 4 ingredients (through 1 garlic clove), stirring with a whisk.
4. Thread 2 chicken strips onto each of 8 (12 inch) skewers. Place kebabs on a grill rack coated with cooking spray; grill r minutes on each side or until done.
5. Place pitas on grill rack; grill 1 minute on each side or until lightly toasted. Place 1 pita on each of 4 plates; top each serving with ¼ c lettuce and 2 tomato slices. Top each serving with 4 chicken pieces; drizzle each serving with 2 T sauce. Serve with chopped vegetable salad *(recipe in green salad section of this cookbook)*

Italian Meatball Hoagies (from *The $5 Dinner Mom Cookbook*, p. 151)

1 c spaghetti sauce
1 lb ground beef
½ c bread crumbs
1 egg
2 T olive oil
4 hoagie rolls
4 slices provolone cheese

Serve with:
2 apples, sliced
1 pkg sweet potato chips

1. Preheat the oven to 400 degrees. In a medium bowl, combine ½ c of the spaghetti sauce, the ground beef, bread crumbs, and egg. Mix well with your hands or a spoon. Form into 1-1 ½ inch meatballs.
2. In a large skillet, warm the olive oil. Add the meatballs and brown the edges, about 2 minutes on each side. Transfer the meatballs to a 9x13 baking dish. Bake the browned meatballs in the oven for about 15 minutes.
3. Meanwhile, in a small saucepan, heat up the remaining sauce.
4. Slice the hoagie rolls lengthwise and lay out open-faced. Spread a spoonful of the spaghetti sauce along the bottom bun. Place 4 cooked meatballs over the sauce and add a few more spoonfuls of sauce over the meatballs. Cut the cheese slice in half and place the 2 halves next to each other. Put halves together quickly to allow the cheese to melt.

Meatball Sliders (from Smith's *mymagazine*)
Serves 4 - Takes 15 minutes prep + 20 minutes cook

¼ c corn flakes, finely crushed
1 T fresh flat-leaf parsley, chopped
1 egg, lightly beaten
1 ½ t olive oil
2 T favorite marinara sauce, plus more for topping
2 T Romano cheese, grated, plus more for topping
¼ t salt
¼ t black pepper
8 oz ground beef, 96% lean
12 small dinner rolls or slider buns, halved
Fresh basil or arugula leaves, for topping

1. Preheat oven to 375 and line baking sheet with parchment paper. In a medium bowl, combine corn flakes, parsley, egg, oil, 2 T marinara, 2 T Romano cheese, salt and pepper. Add ground beef and mix together. With clean or gloved hands, roll mixture into 12 meatballs, placing on prepared baking sheet as you go.
2. Place on rack in center of oven and bake for 20 minutes, until cooked through to a safe internal temperature of 165 degrees. Set aside and let cool for 5-10 minutes. Place basil on bottom half of each roll, top with a meatball, drizzle with reserved marinara sauce, sprinkle with cheese and cover with roll top.

***Falafel Burgers with Hummus** (from allyou.com) -- THESE ARE REALLY GOOD
Serves 4

2 15-oz. cans chickpeas, drained, rinsed
5 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
4 cloves garlic, chopped
1 tablespoon tahini
1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
1 cup chopped parsley
4 teaspoons ground cumin
1/2 cup panko
2 large eggs, beaten
2 scallions, chopped
1/2 teaspoon salt
1/4 teaspoon pepper
Toasted pitas, lettuce, pickles, sliced tomato, red onion, for serving

1. In a food processor (I use the small blendtec jar), combine 1/2 cup chickpeas, 3 Tbsp. oil, 2 cloves garlic, tahini, lemon juice and 2 Tbsp. water. Purée until spreadable. Scrape hummus into a small bowl.
2. Wipe out food processor. Add remaining chickpeas and garlic, parsley and cumin. Pulse until finely chopped. (Since using small jar, do this in 3 batches.) Transfer chickpea mixture to a bowl. Stir in panko, eggs, scallions, salt and pepper. Form into 4 1/2-inch-thick burgers.
3. In a large nonstick skillet, heat remaining 2 Tbsp. oil over medium heat. Cook burgers, turning once, until golden and crisp, about 10 minutes. Spread hummus into toasted pitas and fill with burgers. Add lettuce, pickles, tomato and

onion. Serve with sweet potato fries if you like.

Kentucky Hot Browns - YUM!
Takes about 35 minutes. Makes enough for 6 regular slices of bread

5 slices bacon (*or equivalent, pre-cooked bacon)*
1 small onion, chopped
2 T flour
1 ¼ c milk
1 ¼ c low-sodium chicken broth
1 ¼ c grated muenster or monterey jack cheese
kosher salt & freshly ground pepper
6 thick slices white bread, toasted (I also used wheat)
Dijon mustard, for spreading
1 tomato, sliced (1 large or two smallish)
3 c shredded or sliced roast turkey (or ~ 9 oz deli sliced sandwich meat)
¼ c chopped fresh parsley

1. Preheat the broiler. Cook the bacon in a large skillet over medium heat until crisp. Transfer to a paper towel-lined plate. Pour out all but about 1 T fat from the skillet. *(If using pre-cooked bacon, just use 1 T butter in next step.)*
2. Make the sauce: Add the onion to the skillet and cook, stirring until softened, about 3 minutes. Add the flour and cook, stirring, 1 more minute. Increase the heat to medium high, add the milk and chicken broth and bring to a boil, stirring. Reduce the heat to medium low and simmer, stirring, until slightly thickened, about 6 minutes. Remove from heat and stir in 1 c cheese. Season with salt and pepper.
3. Arrange the bread on a baking sheet. Spread each slice with mustard, then drizzle with some of the sauce and top with the tomato. Add the turkey to the skillet with the remaining sauce and toss to coat. Divide the turkey among the bread, then sprinkle with the remaining ¼ c cheese. Broil until golden, about 2 minutes.
4. Crumble the bacon over the sandwiches. Sprinkle with the parsley.

Egg McMuffins

English muffins
Eggs
Ham/bacon/sausage
Cheese

1. Fry eggs, heat meat, toast muffins
2. Assemble ham and eggs on muffins and sprinkle cheese on top. You may want to zap them in the microwave to melt the cheese. You may also like to spread a little bit of butter on the muffins before assembling.

English Muffin Pizzas

English muffins Pasta Sauce Shredded Mozzarella or pizza blend
Toppings: pepperoni, ham, pineapple, olives, peppers, etc. (whatever your family likes)

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Separate English muffins and place on a cookie sheet.
2. Assemble pizzas. Bake for 5-10 minutes, until cheese melts.

Panini ideas (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")
Turkey w/ pesto, mozzarella, tomato, basil, salt & pepper
Caprese: olive oil, fresh mozzarella, tomato, basil, salt & pepper

SEASONING MIXES

Chicken Shake Dry Mix
(1/4 of this will coat 2 lbs of split chicken breast on the bone. Entire recipe makes about 16 servings.)

½ c dry bread crumbs
¼ c flour
2 t paprika
2 t Italian seasoning
¼ t garlic powder
1 t salt

1. Combine dry mix ingredients
2. Preheat oven to 450 degrees. Transfer mix to Ziploc bag with chicken pieces. Close bag and shake until chicken is completely coated. Store remaining mix at room temperature for up to two months.
3. Transfer chicken, skin side up, to a nonstick baking pan. Bake uncovered 30-35 minutes or until chicken is cooked through and crisp

Meat Loaf Magic Mix

1 egg, lightly beaten
¼ t dried garlic powder
2 T dried bread crumbs
1/3 c chopped fresh parsley (optional)
½ t salt
1 ½ lbs ground beef
½ c ketchup

1. Preheat oven to 450 degrees. Combine egg, garlic powder, bread crumbs, parsley, and salt. Work mixture into the beef.
2. Turn meat loaf into a coated nonstick loaf pan and bake for 15 minutes. Reduce heat to 350 degrees and bake for 30 minutes more.
3. Remove from oven, pour off excess moisture, and spread ketchup over the top. Bake for 15 minutes longer or until cooked through. Remove from the oven and let stand 15 minutes before serving.

Power Potatoes Dry Mix
(Use ½ this dry mix with 2 lbs of potatoes to make 4 servings)

4 t cornstarch
2 T onion powder
4 t paprika
2 t salt
4 t dried tarragon, oregano, or seasoning of your choice

1. Preheat oven to 450 degrees. In a mixing bowl, combine cornstarch, onion powder, paprika, salt and tarragon.
2. Wash potatoes and cut into 1 inch cubes. Combine with seasoning in Ziploc bag and shake until potatoes are well coated. (May coat better if done in smaller batches.) Transfer potatoes to nonstick baking pan.
3. Bake 40-45 minutes or until potatoes are tender.
4. Store extra mix at room temperature for up to 2 months.

Tantalizing Taco Dry Mix
(Use this with 4 cups of cooked beans, or 1 pound of ground poultry instead of beef.)

<u>Dry Mix</u>
4 T dried onion powder
1 t dried garlic powder
1 T dried oregano
3 T chili powder
1 T ground cumin
2 t salt
¼ c flour

<u>Filling</u>
2 T ketchup
¼ c water
1 T vegetable oil
1 lb lean ground beef

1. Combine dry ingredients in a small bowl. Mix well.
2. For filling, transfer a quarter of the dry mix to a bowl and blend with ketchup and water. Store extra mix at room temperature in airtight container.
3. Heat oil in a large skillet over medium heat. When hot, add beef and stir for about 5 minutes, or until beef has crumbled and browned. Add ketchup mixture and stir, over low heat, for about 5 minutes or until ingredients are cooked through and consistency is thick.

Apple Pie Spice Blend

4 T ground cinnamon
½ t ground allspice
1 ½ t ground cardamom
1 ½ t ground nutmeg
1 t ground ginger

SALADS

GREEN SALADS

***Craisin Almond Salad** (Heather Wall's recipe, with alterations/suggestions by Lisa)

½ head iceberg lettuce, washed and broken in pieces
½ bunch romaine lettuce, washed and broken up *(You can really use any combination of greens. Spinach goes well in this salad, too. And your eye will tell you when you have the right proportions of greens to other stuff.)*
1 apple, chopped
½ lb swiss cheese, grated
Craisins, to liking
½ c sugared slivered almonds (**Recipe below -- don't mix in til right before serving or they'll get soggy)

<u>Dressing</u>:
2 T poppy seeds
2/3 c sugar
2/3 c vinegar
1 ½ c vegetable or canola oil
1 ½ t salt

Don't mix dressing into salad until just before serving (or just let people pour their own). Also, you may only want to make half because it makes a lot (but it does store well in the fridge).

**To sugar slivered almonds, just put a few tablespoons of sugar and the almonds in a frying pan over medium heat until it becomes brown and carmelish. Stir constantly *(and use a spoon that can withstand high temperatures or you'll end up melting it)* so it doesn't burn. It takes nearly 5 minutes. *(Once the sugar starts melting, it goes fast.)* Put on waxed paper to cool and then break into salad before serving.

***Sarah Salad** (from *The Lion House Cookbook*)

head of lettuce
3 strips of pre-cooked bacon, cut into bits
5 oz frozen peas
¼ t sugar
½ t salt
¼ t pepper
½ c shredded swiss (or cut into strips)
⅔ c chopped green onion
¼ c mayo
¼ c miracle whip

Cut lettuce and top with all other ingredients except bacon. Mix just before serving and sprinkle with bacon.

Sweet Cabbage Apple Salad (Lindsey Fellars)

2 apples, chopped
1 c shredded cabbage
2 T chopped pecans

<u>Dressing</u>:
One 5 oz container greek yogurt *(I use regular yogurt)*
2 T brown sugar
1 t vanilla

Mix dressing, pour over salad and chill for 30 minutes or longer.

Oriental Cabbage Slaw with Chicken
6-8 servings

2 c diced cooked chicken
4 c shredded cabbage
1 pkg chicken flavored ramen noodles
4 green onions, sliced
2 T sesame seeds
¼ c vinegar
¼ c salad oil
2 T sugar
½ t salt
1 flavoring packet from ramen
½ c slivered almonds

Place chicken and cabbage in mixing bowl. Break noodles up and place in colander. Pour boiling water over them to soften slightly. Add to cabbage with onions and sesame seeds. Combine vinegar, salad oil, sugar, salt, and contents of flavoring packet. Pour over cabbage, mixing well. Cover and refrigerate overnight or for several hours. Just before serving, stir in slivered almonds. Add drained mandarin oranges at this point, if you'd like.

Delicious Cabbage Salad (from Trina Smith)

1 large cabbage, chopped (or 2 bags shredded)
2 pkg chicken flavor Ramen noodles, broken up (reserve flavor packets for later)
4 green onions, chopped
4 T sesame seeds
1 pkg sliced almonds
2 whole chicken breasts, cooked and cubed

Dressing
4 T vinegar
4 T honey
½ c oil
½ t accent (flavoring)
1 T soy sauce
½ t worcestershire
2 t salt
½ t pepper
1 pkg of chicken seasoning from Ramen

Combine all salad ingredients & toss. Mix the dressing ingredients well and pour over salad. Mix well. Refrigerate 1 hour before eating.

***"Healthified" Crunchy Asian Salad**
Makes 15 servings

Dressing:
1/3 c canola oil
1/3 c rice vinegar
3 T sugar
¾ t salt
½ t pepper

Salad:
1 pkg (3 oz) ramen (any flavor)
1 bag (16 oz) coleslaw mix (shredded cabbage and carrots)
8 medium green onions, sliced (1/2 cup)
½ c sliced almonds (2 oz)
1 medium red bell pepper, cut into 1x1/8-inch strips
2 seedless oranges, peeled, coarsely chopped (1 ½ cups) – *I use canned mandarin oranges*
2 c coarsely chopped fresh baby spinach leaves

1. In large bowl, beat dressing ingredients with whisk until sugar is dissolved and mixture is well blended.
2. Break up ramen noodles in bag before opening. Discard seasoning packet from soup package. Add noodles and all remaining salad ingredients except oranges and spinach to dressing; toss to mix well. Stir in oranges and spinach.
3. Serve immediately or refrigerate up to 8 hours.

Middle Eastern Chopped Salad "Fattoush" (from *Family Circle*, July 2013, p. 142)
Makes 6 servings

5 large pitas, brushed with olive oil
1/4 c olive oil
2T lemon juice
2t lemon zest
2T white wine vinegar
1 clove garlic, minced
¾ t salt
¼ t pepper
6 c chopped romaine
1 c cherry tomatoes, halved
1 large English cucumber, halved and sliced into half-moons
1 c sliced scallions
1 c fresh parsley, chopped
¾ c fresh mint, chopped

1. Heat grill to medium-high heat. Grill pitas on medium-high heat for 1-2 minutes/side, until lightly charred. Set aside to cool.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together olive oil, lemon juice, zest, vinegar, garlic, ¼ t of the salt and the pepper. Toss dressing with romaine, tomatoes, cucumber, scallions, parsley, mint, and remaining ½ t salt. Tear cooled pita into bite-size pieces and toss with rest of salad.

Chopped Vegetable Salad (from *Cooking Light*, July 2008)
serves 4

2 c chopped cucumber
1 c chopped red bell pepper
1 c chopped tomato
½ c chopped green bell pepper
½ c chopped red onion
½ c chopped fresh parsley
2 T red wine vinegar
1 T extra virgin olive oil
½ t salt
¼ t pepper

Cashew-Curry Chicken Salad
Makes 4 servings

¼ c low-fat plain yogurt
¼ c mayonnaise
½ c cashews, roughly chopped
½ t curry powder
2 T red onion, diced small
¾ t kosher salt
¾ t fresh ground black pepper
2 dashes hot sauce (optional)
1 lb cooked chicken breast, chopped into ¼ inch pieces
¼ c raisins (optional)
8 Boston lettuce leaves
Carrot shaving, for optional garnish

Blend yogurt, mayo, cashews, curry, red onion, salt, pepper and hot sauce (if using) until well combined. Add chicken and raisins (if using) and mix until well coated. Spoon into Boston lettuce leaves, a pita pockets with spinach leaves, over lettuce in a salad with naan bread on the side. Garnish with carrot shavings if desired.d Refrigerate any leftovers.

Mini Tostada Salads (From *Savoring the Seasons with Our Best Bites*, p. 18)
Makes 6-8 mini salads

6-8 small flour tortillas
2 c shredded romaine lettuce
1 tomato, diced
¼ c frozen corn, thawed
¼ c canned black beans, rinsed
2 T sliced green onions
2 T chopped cilantro
½ c shredded or finely diced grilled chicken, optional

Vinaigrette
3 T white wine vinegar
2 T canola oil
2 t honey
1/8 t salt
2-3 cracks black pepper
½ t ground cumin
½ t smoked paprika
½ t garlic powder
Dash hot sauce

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees.
2. Warm tortillas in microwave for 20-30 seconds until soft and pliable. Quickly press each one into the well of a muffin tin or jumbo muffin tin, carefully overlapping the sides if necessary and making the bottom as flat as possible. Bake 10-15 minutes, until golden brown.
3. While tortillas are baking, combine lettuce, tomato, corn, beans, green onions, and cilantro.
4. FOR THE VINAIGRETTE: Place all ingredients in a jar with a tight-fitting lid and shake vigorously for 1 minute. Dressing can be prepared up to several days in advance and stored in the refrigerator.
5. When tortillas are done, remove from the muffin tin and set on a wire rack to cool. Once cooled completely, toss salad and desired amount of dressing together and fill each tortilla cup.

my greek salad (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale)
serves 4

Greek Dressing
1 tablespoon red wine vinegar
1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
1/4 cup extra virgin olive oil
1/4 clove garlic, crushed in a press
1/4 teaspoon dried oregano (or 5 fresh leaves, chopped)
Salt and freshly ground black pepper

Salad
1 head romaine or iceberg lettuce, leaves torn
1 green bell pepper, thickly sliced
1 or 2 tomatoes, cut into wedges
1 cucumber, sliced
1/2 red onion, thinly sliced
1/2 cup kalamata olives
1/2 cup crumbled feta cheese
2 tablespoons pine nuts (optional), toasted

1. To make the dressing: In a small bowl, combine the vinegar, lemon juice, oil, garlic, oregano, and salt and black pepper to taste and whisk with a fork to combine.
2. For the salad: In a large bowl, combine the lettuce, bell pepper, tomatoes, cucumber, onion, and olives. Drizzle the dressing over the salad and toss to combine. Before serving, sprinkle with the feta and pine nuts (if using).

blt salad (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale - adapted from recipe at Manhattan's *Aretsky's Patroon.*)
serves 4

8 slices bacon
4 slices stale bread, cut into cubes
Pinch of salt
2 tomatoes
1 head iceberg lettuce, leaves separated and coarsely torn

Dressing ingredients
1 tablespoon red wine vinegar
1 tablespoon mayonnaise
3 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil

1. In a large cast-iron skillet, cook the bacon over medium-high heat until crispy. Drain on paper towels and set aside. Pour off all but 2 tablespoons of bacon drippings from the pan.
2. In the same skillet, cook the bread cubes in the bacon drippings over medium heat, turning, until golden and crunchy. Sprinkle with the salt and set aside.
3. Chop 1 ½ of the tomatoes. Squeeze the seeds and juice from the remaining tomato half into a bowl and reserve for the dressing (discard the tomato flesh).
4. Divide the lettuce leaves and chopped tomatoes among 4 bowls. Crumble the bacon and divide among the bowls.
5. To make the dressing: To the bowl with the reserved tomato pulp, add the vinegar, mayonnaise, and oil and whisk to combine.
6. To serve, drizzle the dressing over the salads and top with the croutons.

BLT Salad with Creamy Chive Dressing (from *Better Homes & Gardens*, August 2016)
takes 25 minutes -- makes 4 servings

12-14 slices smoked bacon
2 T cider vinegar
1 clove garlic, minced
¾ c sour cream
¼ c chopped fresh chives
2 T extra-virgin olive oil
1-2 T milk
1 head green leaf or Bibb lettuce, broken into leaves
3 large ripe tomatoes, cut into wedges
2 large croissants or one 8-oz baguette, sliced and toasted

1. In a large skillet cook bacon until crisp; drain on paper towels. Meanwhile, for dressing, in a small bowl combine vinegar, garlic, and a pinch of kosher salt; let stand 10 minutes. Whisk in sour cream, chives, and olive oil. Thin with milk to desired consistency.
2. On a platter arrange lettuce, tomatoes, croissant slices, and bacon. Season with ¼ t each kosher salt and black pepper; drizzle with dressing. Sprinkle with additional chopped fresh chives. (Serve salads from this arranged platter.)

Red and Green Salad (from Josi Kilpack's *Candy Cane Caper*)

2 bunches fresh raw broccoli, cut into bite-sized pieces
1 cup sunflower seeds
½ cup chopped red onion (optional)
1 cup dried cranberries or pomegranate seeds
1 cup grated Swiss or mozzarella cheese
1 pound bacon, cooked crisp, cooled, drained, and chopped

Mix all ingredients together in large mixing bowl.

Dressing

1 cup mayonnaise
1 tablespoon red wine vinegar
1 tablespoon sugar

In a small bowl, mix all ingredients together with wire whisk and pour over vegetable mixture, stirring to coat thoroughly. Add salt and pepper to taste.

PASTA SALADS

***Shauni's Chicken Bowtie Salad**
Makes 13-15 servings

1. Cool cooked stuff, then add all this together:

3 ½ c cooked bowtie pasta
5 chic breast halves cooked and cut into bite-sized pieces
3 small cans pineapple tidbits, drained
3 c halved red grapes
1 ½ c diced celery

2. Mix separately and add to rest:

1 c mayonnaise
2 c cool whip
¾ t salt

3. Add at end:

1 can mandarin oranges, drained
¾ c slivered almonds

***Pepperoni Pasta Salad**

8 c cooked spiral pasta (*or any small pasta)*
2 c chopped *(or mini)* pepperoni
2 c cubed mozzarella cheese
1 small can olives *(optional)*
½ c red onion
1 diced cucumber
1 large tomato, diced
1 bottle of zesty Italian dressing *(I use Olive Garden brand)*

BLT Bow Tie Pasta Salad (Light and Tasty Magazine via Shannon Nelson)
Yield: 11 servings

2-1/2 c. uncooked bow tie pasta
6 c. torn romaine
1-1/2 c. cubed cooked chicken breast
1 medium tomato, diced
4 bacon strips, cooked and crumbled
1/3 c. reduced-fat mayonnaise
¼ c. water
1 Tbsp. barbeque sauce
1-1/2 tsp. white vinegar
¼ tsp. pepper

Cook pasta according to package directions. Drain and rinse under cold water. In a large serving bowl, combine pasta, romaine, chicken, tomato, and bacon. In a small bowl, whisk together the mayonnaise, water, barbecue sauce, vinegar, and pepper. Pour over pasta mixture, toss to coat evenly. Serve immediately.

Minestrone Pasta Salad
yields 13 servings

3 c uncooked medium pasta shells
1 can (16 oz) kidney beans, rinsed and drained
1 can (15 oz) garbanzo beans, rinsed and drained
1 can (14.5 oz) Italian diced tomatoes, drained
1 medium green pepper, chopped
⅔ c fat-free Italian salad dressing
½ c grated Parmesan cheese
1 c (2.25 oz) sliced ripe olives, drained
¼ c chopped green onions

Cook pasta according to package directions. In a large bowl, combine the remaining ingredients. Drain pasta and rinse in cold water; add to bean mixture and toss to coat. Cover and refrigerate for 3-4 hours before serving.

Tortellini Salad – From *Family Fun* Magazine
Prep 30 minutes - Serves 6

1 lb cheese tortellini
18 cherry tomatoes, cut in half
1 cucumber, thinly sliced
½ lb mozzarella, cubed
2 T chopped fresh basil
1 avocado, sliced
¼ c olive oil
Juice of 1 lime
3 T balsamic vinegar
Salt and pepper

1. Cook tortellini and rinse in cold water.
2. Put in bowl and add tomatoes, cucumbers, cheese, basil, and avocado.
3. Combine olive oil, lime juice, and balsamic vinegar; add salt and pepper to taste.
4. Drizzle over salad and toss to combine.

***Orzo Salad with Spicy Buttermilk Dressing** (from *Southern Living*, July 2015) - *This was really yummy*
Yield: 4 servings - Total time: 30 Minutes

1 cup uncooked orzo
1 cup frozen whole-kernel corn, thawed and drained
12 cherry tomatoes, quartered
3 green onions, sliced
1 (15-ounce) can black beans, rinsed and drained
1/4 cup low-fat buttermilk
3 tablespoons chopped fresh cilantro, divided
3 tablespoons fresh lime juice
2 tablespoons light sour cream
2 tablespoons canola mayonnaise
1 teaspoon chili powder
1/2 teaspoon kosher salt
1/4 teaspoon black pepper
1/4 teaspoon ground red pepper
2 garlic cloves, crushed
1 peeled avocado, cut into 8 wedges
1 tablespoon chopped fresh parsley

1. Cook orzo according to package directions, omitting salt and fat. Drain and rinse; drain well. Place orzo, corn, and next 3 ingredients (through beans) in a large bowl; toss.
2. Combine buttermilk, 2 tablespoons cilantro, and next 8 ingredients (through garlic) in a small bowl, stirring well with a whisk. Drizzle over orzo mixture; toss. Top with avocado; garnish with remaining cilantro and parsley.

(I didn't use the avocado or parsley because I didn't have avocado and didn't want to take the time to chop the parsley. It was divine anyway! Mckay thought it was tasty served in a burrito.)

Pasta Salad with Pesto (from *Cooks' Illustrated*)
Serves 8-10 as a side dish

¾ c pine nuts
2 medium garlic cloves, unpeeled
Table salt
1 lb farfalle (bow-tie) pasta
¼ c plus 1 T extra-virgin olive oil
3 c packed fresh basil leaves (~4 oz)
1 c packed baby spinach (~ 1 oz)
½ t ground black pepper
2 T juice from 1 lemon
1 ½ oz Parmesan cheese, finely grated (~¾ c), plus extra for serving
6 T mayonnaise
1 pint cherry tomatoes, quartered, or grape tomatoes, halved (optional)

1. Bring 4 qts water to rolling boil in large pot. Toast pine nuts in small dry skillet over medium heat, shaking pan occasionally, until just golden and fragrant, 4-5 minutes.
2. When water is boiling, add garlic and let cook 1 minute. Remove garlic with slotted spoon and rinse under cold water to stop cooking; set aside to cool. Add 1T salt and pasta to water, stir to separate, and cook until tender. Reserve ¼ c cooking water, drain pasta, toss with 1 T oil, spread in single layer on rimmed baking sheet, and cool to room temperature, about 30 minutes.

3. While cooling, combine all remaining ingredients (including garlic and pine nuts) *except tomatoes* in a blender until smooth. Toss with pasta and tomatoes. Serve chilled.

BBQ Macaroni Salad *(from Six Sisters?)*
Makes 12 servings

1 (16 oz) box elbow macaroni
1 c mayonnaise
½ c BBQ sauce
⅛ t garlic powder
½ t chili powder
¼ t hot sauce
2 T apple cider vinegar
1 red bell pepper, seeded and finely chopped
1 rib celery, finely chopped
½ c cubed cucumber
½ c shredded carrots
2 T finely chopped green onions
4 T finely chopped purple onion
½ c Colby Jack cheese cubed

Cook macaroni according to pkg directions. Drain the noodles, rinse in cold water and drain again. In a large bowl, combine mayonnaise, BBQ sauce, seasonings, hot sauce, and vinegar. Add the drained noodles, chopped veggies, and cheese. Stir to combine and refrigerate before serving.

OTHER SALADS

Wild Rice-Chicken Curry Salad (from Once-a-Month Cooking Family Favorites, p. 187)
Serves 4

1 6 oz pkg Uncle Ben's Long-Grain and Wild Rice
2 c deboned and shredded rotisserie chicken
¼ c chopped celery
¼ c chopped green onion
¼ c dried cranberries
1 ½ t curry powder
1 t lemon juice
2/3 c mayonnaise
¼ c toasted sliced almonds

1. Cook the wild rice according to pkg directions. Meanwhile combine remaining ingredients, except mayonnaise and almonds, in a small mixing bowl. Add the wild rice and package it (if freezing for later) in a labeled gallon bag and freeze, with almonds in a sandwich bag attached.
2. To serve, thaw mixture. Toast almonds spread in a pie tin in preheated 350 degree oven for 5-8 minutes. Stir mayonnaise into curry-chicken mixture. Sprinkle with toasted almonds.

Bombay Chicken Salad (from *Family Circle,* July 2013, p. 132)
Makes 4 servings

<u>Salad</u>:
1 ½ t curry powder
½ t salt
¼ t sugar
¼ t ground cumin
1/8 t black pepper
1 lb boneless, skinless chicken breasts, pounded to an even thickness
1 c pearl couscous
1 mango, peeled, pitted and diced
½ c golden raisins
3 scallions, trimmed and sliced
¼ c sliced almonds, toasted
<u>Dressing</u>:
2 T lemon juice
1 t honey
¼ t salt
1/8 t curry powder
1/8 t black pepper
2 T olive oil

1. <u>Salad</u>: In a small bowl, combine curry powder, salt, sugar, ground cumin and black pepper. Rub onto chicken. Heat grill to medium-high heat.
2. Meanwhile, bring a medium saucepan of lightly salted water to a boil. Add couscous and cook for 9 minutes. Drain and rinse with cool water.
3. Grill chicken for 5-6 minutes per side, depending on thickness. Remove to a cutting board and cut into ½ inch pieces.
4. <u>Dressing</u>: In a small bowl, whisk together lemon juice, honey, salt, curry powder and pepper. While whisking, add oil in a thin stream.
5. <u>Assembling</u>: Place couscous in a large bowl. Add mango, raisins, scallions, almonds, and cubed chicken. Drizzle with dressing and toss to coat. Refrigerate unless serving immediately.

Chicken Waldorf Salad (From September 2020 Food Network Magazine)

¼ c mayonnaise
¼ c sour cream
¼ c buttermilk
3 T cider vinegar
3 T chopped dill
3 T sliced scallions
2 C shredded rotisserie chicken
2 diced celery stalks
1 diced apple
1 c halved red grapes
1 c chopped walnuts
½ c golden raisins *(I used regular)*
salt and pepper
8 Bibb lettuce leaves
opt garnishes: chopped chives and celery leaves

1. Whisk together mayo, sour cream, and buttermilk with cider vinegar, dill, and scallions. Fold in chicken, celery, apple, grapes, walnuts, and raising. Season with salt and pepper.

2. Divide among lettuce leaves and serve topped with chives & celery leaves, if desired.

***Insalata Caprese**

3 lrg tomatoes, sliced
1 pkg (9 oz) fresh mozzarella cheese (6 balls), drained, sliced
1/3 c fresh basil
3 T olive oil
2 T balsamic vinegar
¼ t each: salt and pepper

Arrange tomatoes, cheese, and basil alternately on platter. Beat oil and vinegar with wire whisk until well blended. Drizzle over tomatoes. Sprinkle with salt and pepper.

Mexican Skirt Steak and Avocado Salad (from *Good Housekeeping,* April 2021)
serves 4 - takes 20 minutes

½ medium red onion, finely chopped
6 T lime juice (about 4 limes)
¼ c pepitas (pumpkin seeds)
1 T oil
1 ½ lbs skirt steak, cut crosswise into 4-in pieces
1 t chili powder
¼ t kosher salt
¼ t pepper
1 lb plum tomatoes (about 4), cut into large chunks
¼ t salt
1 avocado, diced
½ c cilantro, roughly chopped
crumbled cotija cheese (for serving)

1. In large bowl, toss red onion with lime juice.
2. Place pepitas in large cast-iron skillet and cook on medium, tossing occasionally, until golden brown, 5 min; transfer to bowl.
3. Increase heat to med-high and add oil. Season steak with chili powder, salt, and pepper, and cook to desired doneness, 2-3 minutes per side for med-rare. Transfer to cutting board and let rest at least 5 min before slicing.
4. Meanwhile, add tomatoes and salt to bowl with onion; toss to combine. Fold in avocado, cilantro, and pepitas. Serve with steak and sprinkle with crumbled cotija cheese, if desired.

Italian Wheat Berry Salad (from *FamilyCircle*, Feb 2014)
serves 4

3 c cooked wheat berries
2 ½ T olive oil
¼ c white balsamic vinegar
½ t Dijon mustard
1 t chopped oregano
salt
black pepper
1 pint cherry tomatoes, halved
⅓ c chopped pitted Kalamata olives
1 c packed basil, roughly chopped
½ c baby bocconcini (small mozzarella balls)

In a bowl, whisk together oil, vinegar, mustard, oregano and ⅛ t each of the salt and pepper. Pour ⅓ c of the dressing into a large bowl. Toss with wheat berries, tomatoes, olives, basil, mozzarella, ½ t salt, ⅛ t pepper. For an easy meal, serve with grilled chicken.

Barley Salad with Strawberries and Buttermilk Dressing (from *Good Housekeeping,* June 2021)
Serves 4, as a main dish

1 c quick-cooking pearl barley
½ t kosher salt
8 oz fresh peas
¼ c sour cream
¼ c low-fat buttermilk
1 t Dijon mustard
1 t poppy seeds
1 shallot, finely chopped
5 oz baby spinach
1 lb strawberries, hulled and sliced
2 oz shaved Parmesan cheese

1. Cook barley per pkg directions. Drain and run under cold water to cool.
2. Meanwhile, bring a small pot of water to a boil. Add the salt and peas; cook until just tender, 3 minutes; drop in bowl of ice water to cool.
3. In bowl, whisk together sour cream, buttermilk, mustard and poppy seeds; then stir in the shallot.
4. In large bowl, combine spinach, strawberries, Parmesan cheese, peas and barley, then gently toss with half of the dressing. Serve with remaining dressing.

Rainbow Fruit Salad
Serves 12

<u>For fruit salad</u>:
1 large mango, peeled and diced
2 c fresh blueberries
2 bananas, sliced
2 c halved fresh strawberries
2 c seedless grapes
2 nectarines, unpeeled and sliced
1 kiwi, peeled and sliced

<u>For honey-orange sauce</u>:
1/3 c unsweetened orange juice
2 T lemon juice
1 ½ T honey
¼ t ground ginger
1 dash nutmeg

Prepare and combine fruit. Combine all the ingredients for the sauce and mix. Just before serving, pour the sauce over the fruit.

Pistachio Salad (aka "Green Slime" -- Mom's favorite)

1 large can crushed pineapple, undrained
1 pkg (3 oz) pistachio instant pudding mix
1-2 c mini marshmallows
8 oz cottage cheese (I use low fat)
8 oz cool whip (I use light)

Mix together pineapple and pudding until it thickens then add remaining ingredients

Honey-Lemon Chicken Salad (from allyou.com)
Serves 4

2 boneless, skinless chicken breast halves (~ 6 oz. each)
Salt
1/2 cup mayonnaise
2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
2 tablespoons lemon juice
2 teaspoons honey
1 sweet, tart apple (such as Honeycrisp), cored, cut into 1/2-inch dice (about 1 1/2 cups)
2 ribs celery, thinly sliced (about 1/2 cup)
1/2 small red onion, thinly sliced (about 1/2 cup)
1/4 cup sliced almonds
6 cups mixed greens

1. Place chicken breasts in a large pot and cover with salted cold water. Bring to a boil, reduce heat to low and simmer until chicken is cooked through, 8 to 10 minutes. Remove to a cutting board to cool. When cool enough to handle, dice.

2. In a small bowl, whisk together mayonnaise, parsley, lemon juice, honey and 1/4 tsp. salt.
3. In a large bowl, combine chicken, apple, celery, onion and almonds. Add dressing and toss well. Cover and chill for 1 hour. Toss chicken mixture with greens and serve.

***Panzanella** (Italian Bread Salad)
10-12 side dish servings or 6-10 main dish servings

French bread or baguette loaves, cut into 1-inch cubes (you'll need 8 cups)**
3 T olive oil
1 cucumber, peeled, seeded, and diced
1 yellow pepper, diced
4-5 large tomatoes, diced
1 small red onion, diced
1 ½ c fresh mozzarella cheese cut into ½-inch cubes
1/3 c chopped fresh basil

Vinaigrette:
½ c extra-virgin olive oil
2 T balsamic vinegar
2 T red wine vinegar
1 t Dijon mustard
1 clove garlic, pressed or finely minced
¼ t kosher salt
1/8 t black pepper

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Toss the bread cubes with 3 T olive oil and lay in a single layer on a baking sheet. Bake in preheated oven for 10 minutes. Remove from oven and cool to room temperature. *This step is optional and isn't necessary if you don't want to heat up your house during the summer.*
2. Combine the cucumber, yellow pepper, tomatoes, onion, mozzarella, and basil in a large bowl. Set aside.
3. Place the vinaigrette ingredients in a jar with a tight-fitting lid. Seal the jar and shake vigorously until combined. Pour over vegetables and add bread cubes. Combine well. Refrigerate for 15-20 minutes before serving, stirring periodically.

**Day old bread soaks up the vinaigrette more easily.
**Serve with grilled chicken for a light meal.

***Fiesta Wheat and Bean Salad**

Fresh Ingredients
1 orange or red pepper, diced
1 green pepper, diced
1 small red onion, diced
1 bunch fresh cilantro, leaves chopped
1 small jalapeno pepper, cored and diced
juice of 1 lime

Storage Ingredients
3 c. cooked wheat berries (directions below)
1 can corn, drained (16 oz.)
1 can black beans, drained (15 oz.)
2 tsp. chili powder
2 tsp. ground cumin
1/4 c. cider vinegar
1 T. sugar
1/2 c. vegetable oil
1 tsp. salt

Combine all ingredients in a bowl and toss well. Chill for at least 1 hour before serving.

How to Cook Wheat Berries
4 c raw whole wheat
10 c water
1 T salt

Oil a large (4 qt or larger) slow cooker and fill with wheat, water, and salt. Cover and cook on low all night, 8-10 hours. Cooked wheat may be bagged and stored in the refrigerator for a week or in the freezer for several months.

OR
Basic Cooked Wheat Berries:
2/3 cup wheat
4 cups water
1 tsp salt

Place wheat, water, and salt in 4-6 quart slow cooker. Cover and cook on HIGH for 3-4 hours or until the wheat is chewy. (You

could also cook it overnight on low.) The wheat can be refrigerated for 3 days or up to 2 months in the freezer.

Quinoa Grape and Feta Salad
serves 4

1 c uncooked Quinoa
1.3 c water
1 c seedless red grapes, washed
½ c crumbled feta cheese
½ c fresh lemon juice
8 fresh mint leaves coarsely chopped
green onion (scallions) tops, sliced for garnish

1. Rinse the quinoa and put it in a medium saucepan with the water. Bring to a boil. Reduce the heat and simmer, covered, for 12 minutes. Remove from heat and let stand for 10 minutes. Remove the cover and fluff with a fork. Cover and refrigerate until chilled.
2. Stir together the chilled quinoa, grapes, cheese, lemon juice, and mint in a large bowl. Top with green onions, if desired.

Bacon-Ranch Potato Salad (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")

⅔ c mayonnaise
¼ c buttermilk
2 T cider vinegar
1 minced garlic clove
½ c chopped celery
2 chopped scallions
1 t sugar
1 t salt
1 t pepper

Mix all ingredients and toss with 2 lbs boiled, cubed red potatoes & 6 slices crumbled cooked bacon.

SAUCES & DIPS

***Pesto Sauce** (combination of recipes from Eleanor Jensen and Lena Dalley)

1. Put in blender:

½ c grated Parmesan cheese
2 garlic cloves
2 c fresh basil (or 2 c fresh spinach and 2T dry basil)
1 t salt
¼ t ground nutmeg

2. While blending add:

2/3-1 cup Olive oil, depending on how much you need to blend it all. *(⅓ c is enough)*

Tip: freeze Pesto in ice cube trays, then store frozen cubes in plastic bags in the freezer. Just throw them in sauce to add flavor or thaw and serve over plain pasta. Also yummy as a marinade on grilled chicken.

Classic Pesto (Cooks Illustrated *Best Soups & Stews*, p.134)
Makes about ¾ cup

¼ c pine nuts, walnuts, or almonds
3 medium cloves garlic, unpeeled
2 c packed fresh basil leaves
2 T fresh parsley leaves (optional)
7 T extra-virgin olive oil
Salt
¼ c finely grated Parmesan cheese

1. Toast the nuts in a small, heavy skillet over medium heat, stirring frequently, until just golden and fragrant, 4-5 minutes. Transfer the nuts to a plate.
2. Add the garlic to the empty pan. Toast, shaking the pan occasionally, until fragrant and the color of the cloves deepens slightly, about 7 minutes. Transfer the garlic to a plate, cool, peel, and chop.
3. Place the basil and parsley (if using) in a heavy-duty, gallon-sized, zipper-lock plastic bag. Pound the bag with the flat side of a meat pounder or rolling pin until all the leaves are bruised.
4. Place the nuts, garlic, herbs, oil, and ½ t salt in the workbowl of a food processor. Process until smooth, stopping as necessary to scrape down the sides of the bowl. Transfer the mixture to a small bowl, stir in the cheese, and adjust the salt. (The surface of the pesto can be covered with a sheet of plastic wrap or a thin film of oil and refrigerated for up to 3 days.)

Homemade Gravy (from *THANKSGIVINGPOINT.ORG*)

1 c white wine (or non-alcoholic cooking wine)
⅓ c fat (from roasting pan, augmented with butter, margarine or vegetable oil, as needed)
3 T flour
3 c pan juices (de-fatted pan juices plus enough stock or broth to make 3 cups)

1. Remove pan juices from roasting pan to a heatproof measuring cup or bowl. Allow fat and juice to separate.
2. Deglaze roasting pan by placing it over medium high heat (use more than one stove burner if necessary). Pour in white wine and cook for 2 to 3 minutes, scraping fond from bottom of pan. continue cooking until liquid has reduced by half, and then remove from heat.
3. Place fat in large saucepan over medium heat and add flour. Stir with a spoon or whisk for 1-2 minutes or until all flour has been absorbed and liquid in pan is a smooth paste with no lumps.
4. Add white wine/fond mixture from roasting pan and reserved pan juices. Stir well, then cook over medium heat for 5-10 minutes or until gravy thickens slightly. Add salt and pepper to taste, and serve.

***Perfect Turkey Gravy**

1 pkg McCormick Turkey Gravy Mix
2 T all-purpose flour
1 ½ c cold water
½ c turkey pan drippings or turkey broth

Combine Turkey Gravy Mix and flour in medium saucepan. Using a whisk, gradually stir in water and turkey drippings. Bring to boil over medium heat, stirring occasionally. Reduce heat and simmer 5 minutes or until thickened.

Gravy from Scratch

2 T butter
2 T flour
1 ½-2 cups pan drippings & broth

1. Bubble and stir butter and flour constantly until the color of gravy you want. Then whisk in pan drippings.
2. Salt and pepper to taste. You can also add cream, lemon juice, or sour cream, if too salty.

Mojo (marinade)
for 1 lb of chicken or beef

2 garlic cloves, minced
½ jalapeno, diced
½ handful finely chopped cilantro
salt and pepper
1 lime, juiced
½ orange, juiced
1 T vinegar
¼ c olive oil

Blend and marinate 1-8 hours.

Arika's Pasta Sauce (from Arika Moore)

½ block cream cheese
1 c mozzarella, shredded
¼-½ c parmesan, shredded
1 jar marinara-style sauce, any flavor

Mix altogether for a rich and creamy red sauce.

basic tomato sauce (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale)
Makes 1 quart

5 pounds tomatoes (about 15-20) (*Taking off the skins and removing the seeds makes the sauce too sweet and it's not worth the effort. Putting in the whole tomato makes the sauce too watery. Using the whole tomato, but squeezing out some of the juice, makes it just right.)*
1 clove garlic, peeled
1 teaspoon salt
Leaves from 1 sprig fresh basil
1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil

1. Cut out any brown spots from the tomatoes, core, halve through the equator, and gently squeeze the juice from the tomatoes. (Don't squeeze too hard; you still want a bit of juice in there.)
2. Working in batches, place the tomatoes in a food processor or blender with the garlic, salt, and basil and process to combine. If you prefer a chunky tomato sauce, simply cut the tomatoes into quarters and roughly mash with a potato masher.
3. In a large saucepan, heat the oil over medium heat. Add the tomato pulp, stir, and reduce the heat to low. Simmer, stirring occasionally, for 2 hours, until the sauce has reached your desired consistency.

4. Pour the hot sauce into wide-mouthed glass jars, leaving 1 inch of space at the top for the sauce to expand. Let the jars cool before you put them in the freezer to freeze for up to 10 months (be sure to label and date them!).

Tips from recipe book: *This basic recipe can be used as a base to make other sauces. I like to add a little butter and serve with pasta and Romano cheese. The best way to maximize your efforts is to quadruple this recipe and make a big batch.*

my dad's spaghetti sauce (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale)
This makes a thick, meaty sauce. Great for Bolognese or for hearty pizzas/calzones.
Serves 4+

¼ cup extra virgin olive oil
1 white onion, chopped
1 green bell pepper, chopped (opt.)
4 cloves garlic, chopped
1 pound ground beef *(or sausage)*
3 cups tomato sauce, store-bought or homemade
1 can (6 ounces) tomato paste
1 tablespoon Italian seasoning
1 T maple syrup
salt, to taste

(Optional: ⅓ cup red wine, added with step 3. Tastes great without. Maybe a T of red wine vinegar would add some flavor?)

1. In a large saucepan, heat the oil over medium-high heat. Add the onion and bell pePper (if using) and cook, stirring, for 5 to 6 minutes, until starting to brown and soften. Add the garlic and cook, stirring, for 1 minute, or until golden.
2. Add the ground beef and cook for 5 minutes, stirring, or until browned.
3. Add the tomato sauce and paste, Italian seasoning, maple syrup, and salt to taste and bring to a simmer. Cook for 20 minutes, or until thickened slightly.
4. While the sauce is simmering, cook the spaghetti according to package directions (or prepare crust for pizza/calzone)

Simple Italian-Style Meat Sauce (from *Cooks' Illustrated*, March & April 2008)
makes about 6 cups -- enough for ~2 lbs of pasta

4 oz white mushrooms, cleaned, stems trimmed, and broken into rough pieces
1 large slice high-quality white sandwich bread, torn into quarters
2 T whole milk
table salt and ground black pepper
1 lb 85% lean ground beef (80% will make it greasy and 90% will make it fibrous)
1 T olive oil
1 large onion, chopped fine (about 1 ½ c)
6 medium garlic cloves, minced or pressed through a garlic press (about 2 T)
¼ t red pepper flakes
1 T tomato paste
1 (14.5 oz) can diced tomatoes, drained, ¼ c liquid reserved
1 T minced fresh oregano leaves or 1 t dried
1 (28 oz) can crushed tomatoes
½ oz grated Parmesan cheese (about ¼ c)

1. Process mushrooms in food processor until finely chopped, about eight 1-second pulses, scraping down side of bowl as needed; transfer to medium bowl. Add bread, milk, ½ t salt, and ½ t pepper to now-empty food processor and process until paste forms, about eight 1-second pulses. Add beef; pulse til mixture is well combined, about six 1-second pulses.
2. Heat oil in large saucepan over medium-high heat until just smoking. Add onion and mushrooms; cook, stirring frequently, until vegetables are browned and dark bits form on pan bottom, 6-12 minutes. Stir in garlic, pepper flakes, and tomato paste; cook until fragrant and tomato paste starts to brown, about 1 minute. Add ¼ c reserved tomato liquid and 2 t fresh oregano (if using dried, add full amount here), scraping bottom of pan with wooden spoon to loosen browned bits. Add meat mixture and cook, breaking meat into small pieces with wooden spoon, until beef loses its raw color, 2-4 minutes, making sure that meat does not brown.
3. Stir in crushed tomatoes and drained diced tomatoes and bring to simmer; reduce heat to low and gently simmer until sauce has thickened and flavors have blended, about 30 minutes. Stir in cheese and remaining teaspoon fresh oregano; season with salt and pepper to taste.

Ragu Bolognese (thick, meaty sauce)
serves 4 - takes 3:20 total

2 T unsalted butter
2 T extra-virgin olive oil
1 large onion, very finely diced
2 medium carrots, very finely diced
2 ribs celery, very finely diced
2 cloves garlic, minced
2 T tomato paste
1 lb ground beef
¾ c dry white wine or beef broth
1 c milk
1 c (28 oz) whole peeled Italian San Marzano-style tomatoes, crushed, juice reserved *(I used crushed tomatoes plus ~½ t italian seasoning)*
pinch nutmeg
½ t freshly ground black pepper
½ t salt
1 lb dry pasta, such as tagliatelle, rigatoni, penne, or fusilli, prepared according to package directions
grated parmesan cheese (optional)

1. In large, heavy-bottomed pan or deep skillet (preferably NOT nonstick), heat butter and oil over medium heat. When butter is melted, add onion, carrots and celery. Cook, stirring occasionally, until soft and just beginning to brown, 6-8 minutes. Add garlic; cook 1 minute.
2. Add tomato paste; cook, stirring constantly. Add ground beef. Cook, breaking into small chunks with wooden spoon, until all liquid is evaporated and a brown (not burned) residue forms on bottom of pan.
3. Add wine or broth; scrape brown bits from bottom of pan. Cook, stirring occasionally, until wine or broth fully evaporates and beef reaches a safe internal temperature of 160 degrees, 8-10 minutes.
4. Add milk, reduce heat to medium-low, and cook, stirring occasionally, until milk is completely evaporated, 20-30 minutes. Add crushed tomatoes, along with juice. Add nutmeg, pepper and salt. Cook, stirring occasionally, until thick enough that spoon leaves trail in sauce, 1-2 hours.
5. To serve, toss sauce with pasta; sprinkle with parmesan cheese, if desired.

Sandra Rittmanic's Pasta Sauce

24 oz tomatoes
6 oz tomato paste
8 oz tomato sauce
1 T parmesan cheese
1 bay leaf
2 t sugar
½ t salt
¼ t pepper
¼ t garlic powder
½ t oregano
1 t basil, dried
1 t parsley, dried
½ medium onion, diced
½ bell pepper, diced
1 lb ground beef, cooked and drained
1 c water
1 beef bouillon cube

1. Chop or blend tomatoes.
2. Dissolve bouillon in water.
3. Add all ingredients in sauce pan and boil. (***Only add the meat now if pressure cooking. Otherwise, add meat when heating to serve.*)
4. Reduce heat and simmer 1 ½-2 hours.
5. Serve, freeze, or can.

Blender Tomato Sauce (like the kind you'd put on pasta) – From *Family Fun* Magazine
Makes 3 cups

4 c tomatoes, seeded and chopped
1 t dried basil
1 t oregano leaves
¼ c tomato paste
1 T olive oil
1 t minced garlic
2 t sugar
¼ t salt
¼ t pepper
½ c yellow or Vidalia onion, diced

Put all ingredients into a blender. Cover and pulse to mix until just blended (small chunks). Heat in a saucepan over low heat

and serve.

Marinara Sauce (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
takes 40 minutes - yields ~3 cups

2 T extra-virgin olive oil
3 garlic cloves, minced
½ small onion, finely chopped
1 carrot, peeled and finely chopped
1 stalk celery, finely chopped
½ t dried oregano
½ t dried thyme
2 T tomato paste
1 (28 oz) can crushed tomatoes
salt and pepper

Heat the oil in a medium skillet over medium-low heat. Add the garlic, onions, carrots, and celery and cook about 5 minutes. Add the oregano, thyme, and tomato paste and cook, stirring frequently, for another 5 minutes or until the paste turns a brownish color. Add the tomatoes and cook over medium heat for about 20 minutes, or until the sauce thickens slightly and the flavors develop. Season with salt and pepper to taste.

Variations:
MARINARA BASIL SAUCE: Add 3 T fresh basil, torn into bite-size pieces, to the sauce at the end of cooking.
MARINARA CREAM SAUCE: Add ½ c heavy cream to sauce, reheat over medium heat, and reduce down to sauce consistency.

Pizza Sauce (from *Raised in the Kitchen)*
makes 24 oz

2 t extra virgin olive oil
1 T butter
4 garlic cloves, minced
1 ¾ t onion powder
¼-½ t red pepper flakes
1 ½ t chopped fresh basil (or ¾ t dried)
1 t chopped fresh oregano (or ½ t dried)
5 T freshly grated Parmesan cheese
2 t brown sugar
2 (8 oz) cans tomato sauce
4 T tomato paste
⅔ c warm water
salt and pepper, to taste

1. Heat oil and butter in a large pot over medium heat until almost shimmering. Add garlic and stir briefly. Quickly add onion powder, red pepper flakes, basil, and oregano. Stir briefly to allow the herbs to bloom.
2. Stir in Parmesan cheese and brown sugar, followed quickly by tomato sauce, tomato paste, and water.
3. Bring sauce to a simmer, reduce heat to low, and season with salt and pepper, to taste. Sauce can be served immediately but will develop a deeper, richer flavor if simmered 1-2 hours.

NOTE: Sauce can be cooled and stored in a sealed jar in the refrigerator for up to 3 weeks, or in the freezer for up to 3 months.

Super Pizza Sauce (from Lisa's roommate, Michelle Cowan)
makes enough for 2-3 big pizzas

8 oz tomato sauce
6 oz tomato paste
2 T oil
1 T minced onion
½ t basil
½ t Italian seasoning
6 oz water

Cook 20 minutes covered. (Be careful! It's messy!)

***Pico de Gallo Salsa** (my favorite pico recipe)

2 T diced onion
2 c tomatoes, chopped into ¼ inch cubes
2 jalapeno chiles, finely chopped
2 T finely chopped cilantro
¼ c Ginger Ale
Juice of one lime
2 t sugar
2 t salt

Combine all ingredients and mix well. Let sit in refrigerator for at least 30 minutes before serving. Yields 2 cups.

****Kim's Blender Salsa** (easy and tasty)
(I usually just make ½ recipe so that I have ~1 qt jar of salsa)

28 oz can whole plum tomatoes
½ white onion
1 T garlic salt
½ bunch of cilantro
1 roasted jalapeno

Roast jalapeno by broiling until the skin starts to pop. Chop jalapeno, onion and cilantro so that they blend nicely. Pulse all ingredients in a blender until desired salsa consistency.

Blender Salsa (recipe from Alaina Jensen)
makes 5 cups

6 Roma tomatoes, quartered
1-2 jalapenos, seeded and chopped
½ red onion, roughly chopped
juice from 1 ½ limes
2 cloves garlic, sliced
1 (14.5 oz) can fire-roasted diced tomatoes
½ t granulated sugar
½ t chili powder
½ t ground cumin
½ bunch cilantro, roughly chopped
kosher salt, to taste

Place all ingredients in blender jar, cover with lid, and pulse until salsa is slightly chunky in texture. *Stores well up to 1 week in the refrigerator.*

Rockin' Guacamole
serves 8-10

3 ripe avocados, pitted, peeled and mashed
1 can (10 oz) diced tomatoes & green chilies, drained (Ro-tel)
½-¾ c onion, chopped
1 t lime juice or lemon juice
½ t salt
ground black pepper, to taste
tortilla chips, optional

Mix avocados, drained tomatoes & green chilies, onion, lime juice and salt in medium bowl until blended. Season with pepper to taste. Serve with tortilla chips, if desired.

Spicy Black Bean Salsa
serves 12

1 can black beans, drained and rinsed
1 can Ro-tel original diced tomatoes & green chilies, drained
½ c canned corn
¼ c finely chopped red onion
¼ c finely chopped fresh cilantro
1 T lime juice

Mix all ingredients in a bowl. Cover and refrigerate for 30 minutes before serving.

Red Bean Veggie Dip

1 can drained kidney beans
½ c Greek yogurt
1 T olive oil
1 t cumin
1 T sliced scallion
½ c diced avocado
salt and pepper

Blend until smooth.

Fresh Pumpkin Puree

Cut out tops and remove seeds from sugar pumpkins. Put tops back on and place in roasting pan with enough water to cover bottom of the pan. Bake in a slow oven (300 degrees) til tender. – an hour or two. Take from the oven, remove top and cut into 5 or 6 wedges each. Take paring knife, and separate pumpkin from shell. Put pumpkin in a blender and puree. Pumpkin sauce can be stored for several weeks in a glass container in the refrigerator.

Caramel Toffee Fruit Dip (from *Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen) - This recipe makes A LOT so maybe make 1/2*

1 (8 oz) pkg cream cheese, softened (I used light)
¾ c brown sugar *(I have another recipe that uses ½ c brown sugar with ¼ c regular sugar)*
1 t vanilla (you can add more to taste)
Toffee bits

Combine cream cheese, brown sugar, and vanilla. Sprinkle desired amount of toffee bits on top, or mix in if preferred.

**Kids liked this dip, but only Sam was crazy about the toffee bits, so make it without for greater success.

***Buttermilk Syrup**

¾ c sugar
1 cube butter
½ c buttermilk
1 t vanilla
1 t baking soda

1. Boil sugar, butter, and buttermilk together in a saucepan. Take off the heat and add vanilla and baking soda.
2. Stir together and serve warm over waffles or pancakes with fresh fruit. Store the remaining syrup in the fridge.

Homemade Maple Syrup (from *Pumpkin Roll* by Josi Kilpack)

2 c sugar
1 c water
1 t Mapleine or maple extract
(For a butter flavor, add 1 t butter extract. For a vanilla flavor, add 1 t vanilla extract. For a tangy flavor, add ½ t lemon extract.)

Microwave directions: Combine all ingredients in a 3-cup capacity microwave-safe measuring cup or bowl. Cook 3 minutes. Remove from microwave and stir for 30 seconds for sugar to dissolve.
Stovetop directions: In a saucepan, bring ingredients to a boil on medium-high heat, stirring consistently. Boil 1 minute, stirring constantly.

Cool slightly before serving. Store leftovers in an airtight container.

***Cocoa-Nut Almond Butter** (*Blendtec* recipe)

1 ¼ c roasted, unsalted almonds
2 T cocoa or cocoa powder
2 T unsweetened coconut flakes
3 T granulated sugar
1/16-⅛ t kosher salt

Add ingredients to Twister Jar in order listed and place Twister Lid on the jar. Hold Twister Lid and with other hand, press "Speed Up" to Speed 7. Run for 40 seconds and press "Pulse" to stop. Turn Twister Lid counter-clockwise during blending.

Note: To make with raw almonds, use raw almonds instead of roasted and substitute the shredded coconut with coconut oil. Follow directions accordingly, but blend for a total of 50-60 seconds at Speed 7. *(raw almonds make a sweeter vanilla-y blend)*

Easy Crockpot Apple Butter

4 lbs apples (12-15 apples)
½ c water or apple juice
1 T vanilla extract
1 T cinnamon
¼ t allspice
⅛ t nutmeg
juice of 1 lemon

1. Wash and slice apples
2. Add apples, spices, lemon juice, and water to crockpot
3. Put the lid on and cook until apples are soft. Then puree the mixture with an immersion blender (until everything is smooth and lump-free).
4. Heat, stirring often, until mixture thickens and desired consistency is achieved. (If you drag a spoon through the mixture and the "line" holds for 5 seconds before the apple butter merges back together, it's finished cooking.)
5. Let mixture cool. Store in fridge for a week or freeze.

SURE JELL Apple Butter
makes about 8 (1 cup) jars

4 ½ lb Granny Smith apples
1 ½ c water
¼ c fresh lemon juice
2 t ground cinnamon
1 box SURE JELL fruit pectin
½ t butter or margarine
6 c sugar, measured in separate bowl

1. Bring boiling water canner, half full with water, to simmer. Wash jars and screw bands in hot soapy water; rinse with warm water. Pour boiling water over flat lids in saucepan off the heat. Let stand in hot water until ready to use. Drain well before filling.
2. Remove blossom and stem ends from unpeeled apples. Core apples; cut into quarters. Place in 4-quart saucepan. Add water and lemon juice; stir. Bring to boil; cover. Simmer on medium heat 20 minutes or until apples are tender, stirring occasionally. Force mixture through food mill or strain through coarse sieve, using wooden spoon to force apples through mill; discard peels. Measure exactly 5 c of the prepared fruit into 6 or 8 quart stockpot. Stir in cinnamon. Discard any remaining prepared fruit.
3. Stir pectin into prepared fruit in stockpot. Add butter to reduce foaming. Bring mixture to full rolling boil on high heat, stirring constantly. Stir in sugar. Return to full rolling boil and boil exactly 1 minute, stirring constantly. Remove from heat. Skim off any foam with metal spoon.
4. Ladle immediately into prepared jars, filling to within ⅛ inch of tops. Wipe jar rims and threads. Cover with two-piece lids. Screw bands tightly. Place jars on elevated rack in canner. (Water must cover jars by 1-2 inches. Add boiling water, if necessary.) Cover; bring water to gentle boil. Process 10 minutes. Remove jars and place upright on towel to cool completely. After jars cool, check seals by pressing centers of lids with finger. (If lids spring back, lids are not sealed and refrigeration is necessary.)

CERTO Grape Juice Jelly
makes about 4 (1 cup) jars

2 c bottled grape juice
3 ½ c sugar, in separate bowl
½ t butter or margarine
1 pouch CERTO fruit pectin

1. Bring boiling-water canner, half full with water, to simmer. Wash jars and screw bands in hot soapy water; rinse with warm water. Pour boiling water over flat lids in saucepan off the heat. Let stand in hot water until ready to use. Drain jars well before filling.
2. Pour juice into 6 or 8 quart saucepot. Add sugar; mix well. Add butter to reduce foaming. Bring mixture to full rolling boil on high heat, stirring constantly. Stir in pectin. Return to full following boil and boil exactly 1 minute, stirring constantly. Remove from heat. Skim off any foam with metal spoon.
3. Ladle immediately into prepared jars, filling to within ⅛ inch of tops. Wipe jar rims and threads. Cover with two-piece lids. Screw bands tightly. Place jars on elevated rack in canner. Lower rack into canner. (Water must cover jars by 1-2 inches.) Cover; bring water to gentle boil. Process 5 minutes. Remove jars and place upright on a towel to cool completely. After jars cool, check seals by pressing middles of lids with finger.

SURE JELL Mixed Berry Freezer Jam
makes about 7 (1 cup) containers

1 ½ c crushed strawberries
½ c EACH crushed blueberries and crushed raspberries
4 ½ c sugar
¾ c water
1 box SURE JELL fruit pectin

1. Rinse clean plastic containers and lids with boiling water. Dry thoroughly.
2. Mix fruit and sugar until well blended. Let stand 10 minutes, stirring occasionally.
3. Add water to pectin in small saucepan; stir. Bring to boil on high heat, stirring constantly. Boil and stir 1 minute. Add to fruit mixture; stir 3 minutes or until sugar is dissolved and no longer grainy. (A few sugar crystals may remain.)
4. Pour immediately into containers, filling each to within ½ inch of top. Wipe off top edges of containers; immediately cover with lids. Let stand at room temperature 24 hours. Store in refrigerator up to 3 weeks or freeze up to 1 year. Thaw in refrigerator before using.

Raspberry-Chia Jam (***each 1 T has about 20 calories/3 g carbs/2 g fiber)*
makes 1 cup - takes 30 minutes total

2 c raspberries
1 T fresh lemon juice
1 T pure maple syrup
2 T black chia seeds

In small saucepan, cook raspberries on medium, stirring occasionally, until fruit breaks down and liquid becomes syrupy, about 8 minutes. Remove from heat and stir in lemon juice and maple syrup, then stir in chia seeds and let sit 20 minutes. Mixture should thicken slightly.

Raspberry Honey Butter

¾ c softened butter
¼ c honey
½ c raspberry jam
1 t vanilla

Cinnamon Honey Butter

¾ c softened butter
¼ c honey
1 t cinnamon
1 t vanilla

Apple Cider Syrup (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes about 2 ½ cups

2 c apple juice
2 T lemon juice
2 T cornstarch
1 c sugar
½ t cinnamon
¼ t nutmeg
½ t ground cloves

Combine all ingredients and cook over medium heat just until thickened and clear. Refrigerate the leftovers for up to 1 week.

Strawberry Sauce (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen") Drizzle over ice cream, waffles, pancakes, cheesecake, or blend with vanilla ice cream and milk for strawberry milkshakes. Or add a few spoonfuls to a glass of lemonade.
Makes about 2 cups

1 pint strawberries, washed, hulled, and roughly chopped
1/3 c granulated sugar
1 t almond extract or vanilla

1. Combine berries, sugar, and vanilla in medium saucepan and bring to a simmer over medium heat. Cook for 5 minutes, stirring constantly and breaking strawberries up with a spoon.
2. After 5 minutes, remove from heat and allow to cool before blending. When cool enough, transfer the mixture to blender and pulse until desired consistency is reached. Refrigerate unused sauce for up to 1 week or freeze for up to 3 months.

***Tzatziki – Cucumber Yogurt Dip** - Good for grilled meats and veggies, or with warm pita bread triangles, or as a condiment for Greek food. *(This recipe makes a lot. I usually cut it in half for gyros.)*

3 T olive oil
1 T vinegar or lemon juice
2 cloves garlic, minced finely
½ t salt
¼ t white pepper
1 c Greek yogurt, strained *(I don't strain it and I usually use regular plain yogurt.)*
1 c sour cream
2 cucumbers, peeled, seeded, and diced
1 t chopped fresh dill
Optional: a little bit of fresh mint, minced

Combine olive oil, vinegar, garlic, salt, and pepper in a bowl. Mix well until combined. Using a whisk, blend the yogurt with the sour cream. Add the olive oil mixture to the yogurt mixture and mix well. Finally, add the cucumber and chopped fresh dill. Chill for at least 2 hours before serving.

Café Rio Dressing

1 ½ c sour cream
¾ c mayo
1 bunch cilantro
1 pkg dry buttermilk ranch dressing
4 T salsa verde (green sauce)
2 cloves garlic
1/8 t Tabasco sauce
Juice of 1 lime

Mix in blender and refrigerate.

Kimberly Morris' Cafe Rio Cilantro Lime Dressing
1 batch = 15-18 servings

½ bunch cilantro
1 c buttermilk (or milk)
1 c mayo
2 tomatillos
1 jalapeno
1 packet ranch dressing mix
1 clove garlic
1 lime (or equivalent lime juice)

Mix all in blender. Store refrigerated.

Creamy Cilantro-Lime Ranch Dressing (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes about 2 cups

1 c mayonnaise
½ c milk or buttermilk
1 lime, juiced (about 2 T lime juice)
1 packet of Hidden Valley Ranch dressing mix (ignore the directions on the packet)
2 cloves garlic, roughly chopped
½ c roughly chopped cilantro
¼ c green salsa (i.e. Herdez brand)
Hot sauce (like Tabasco) to taste

Combine mayonnaise, milk, lime juice, and the contents of the packet of ranch dressing in a blender. Add garlic, cilantro, and green salsa and blend to thoroughly mix all the ingredients. Season with hot sauce, if desired. If possible, refrigerate for several hours to allow the dressing to thicken and the flavors to meld.

Buttermilk Ranch Dressing (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes 1 ¾ cups

1 c mayonnaise (preferably no substitute)
2/3 c buttermilk
¼ t white vinegar
1 t parsley
1/8 t dill
¼ t garlic powder
¼ t onion powder
1 ½ t dried chives
1/8 t black pepper
¼ t seasoned salt
1/8 t dry mustard

Whisk together the mayonnaise and buttermilk until the mixture is lump-free. Whisk in remaining ingredients. For best results, refrigerate for at least 4 hours before serving.

Scallion Dipping Sauce (*Cooks Illustrated*, March & April, 2006, p. 15)
Makes ¾ cup

¼ c soy sauce
2 T rice vinegar
2 T mirin
2 T water
1 t chili oil (optional)
½ t toasted sesame oil
1 medium scallion, white and green parts, minced

Combine all ingredients in bowl and serve.
(The sauce can be refrigerated overnight.)

***Yogurt** (from Shannon Nelson)
Makes 4qts + 1pt

1 gallon milk (the more fat, the better it sets. I usually use 2%)
1 c powdered milk (I use this to set up since I don't use whole milk)-optional
2 Tbsp vanilla
1 c. sugar
1 c. yogurt start (I've liked the Dannon All Natural the best so far. Save some from each batch to use from here on out.)

Preheat oven to lowest setting. Whisk the liquid and powdered milk together in a pot. Continue to stir while heating to 190 degrees F. Turn off oven when heated so it can begin to cool. Remove milk from heat and stir in the vanilla and sugar. Cool to 130 degrees F. (I fill the bottom of my sink with ice, set the hot pot on top and stir to speed up the process. It only takes a couple of minutes with the ice.) Once cooled, whisk in the yogurt. Mix well so it's evenly distributed. Ladle into 4 quart jars and one pint jar. Wide mouth jars are a little easier to serve from later on, but any type will do. Screw on the jar lids. Place the jars close together on a cookie sheet or 9 in x 13 in pan (anything to keep them from tipping over in the oven. I've had the best luck with the pint jar by putting it in the middle of all the quart jars, otherwise it cools too fast and the yogurt doesn't set in the small jar.). Cover with a towel and place in the back corner of the oven near the light. Turn the light on and let it sit there for 8-9 hours. *Make sure the oven is off!* Place jars in the fridge when done. At our house, the pint jar is the one I save to make the next batch of yogurt with. Everyone knows to leave it alone.

**There's always a little warm yogurt milk left. It's everyone's favorite treat after I've filled the jars.
**You can make plain yogurt by leaving out the vanilla and sugar.
**You can make greek yogurt by putting the set yogurt into a colander lined with cheese cloth. Let the whey run out until it's the consistency you want. You will lose up 1/2 your total volume doing this.

Do-it-yourself Ricotta (from Cooks' Illustrated, Sept & Oct 2009, page 31)
yields 3 ½ cups

1 gallon whole milk 1 t salt ⅓ c lemon juice (+ more if needed)

Heat milk and salt to 185 degrees over medium-high heat; remove from the heat and slowly stir in 1/3 c lemon juice. Allow the mixture to stand, undisturbed for 5 minutes. If the milk hasn't separated into solid white curds and translucent liquid whey, gently stir in 1 more T of lemon juice and let stand again, repeating the process if necessary. Spoon the curds into a fine colander and drain without pressing or disturbing, overnight in the refrigerator. This technique will yield a superior-tasting ricotta facsimile that can be substituted in all recipes.

Homemade Basic White Sauce (from *The $5 Dinner Mom Cookbook*, p. 276)

4 T butter
6 T flour
3 c milk
Salt and pepper

1. In a medium saucepan, melt the butter over medium heat. Add the flour and whisk with the melted butter until it forms a paste and bubbles.
2. Whisk in the milk (or other specified liquids). Whisk until flour and butter have dissolved into the milk.
3. Cook the sauce over medium heat for 5-6 minutes, stirring continuously. The sauce will begin to thicken as it bubbles and cooks. (To reach the desired consistency of the sauce you need for your meal, add the milk or four, 1 T at a time. To make the sauce thicker, whisk in more flour. To make the sauce thinner, whisk in more milk. Once the sauce reaches the desired consistency, use it in the meal as directed.)

Basic White Sauce Variations:
Cream of Chicken: Use 2 c of milk and 1 c of chicken broth in place of the 3 c of milk.
Cream of Mushroom: Add 1 can (6 oz) chopped mushrooms to the basic white sauce.
Cream of Celery: Use 2 c of milk and 1 c of vegetable broth in place of the 3 c milk, and add 1 c of finely chopped celery.

***Alfredo Sauce** (from Aunt Heather)
serves ~4 -- takes ~½ hour

¼ lb real (sweet) butter
1 c heavy cream
parsley flakes (for color)
¾ c Parmesan
salt to taste
freshly ground pepper
fresh crushed garlic, optional
fresh sweet basil, optional *(I use dried)*

In saucepan: add all (start with butter) and stir "constantly" over *low* heat until it thickens. Add starch if necessary for thickening.

Alfredo Sauce (from *The Take-Out Menu Cookbook)*
makes ~ 2 ¾ cups - takes 15 minutes

¼ lb (1 stick) unsalted butter
2 c heavy cream
2 T fresh lemon juice
⅛ t ground nutmeg
½ t salt
¼ t freshly ground black pepper
1 c finely grated Parmigiano-Reggiano cheese
Flat-leaf parsley, for garnish

1. Melt the butter in a large skillet over medium heat. Add the cream and bring to a boil. Cook until the sauce has reduced slightly, about 3 minutes. Remove from the heat. Stir in the lemon juice, nutmeg, salt, and pepper.
2. To serve with pasta: Add the cooked pasta to the skillet, along with half the cheese, and toss to combine. Adjust the seasonings if necessary. Sprinkle with the remaining cheese and garnish with parsley. Serve immediately.

Restaurant-style Hummus (from Cooks' Illustrated, May & June 2008, p. 19)
Makes about 2 cups

3 T lemon juice
¼ c water
6 T tahini, stirred well (Joyva brand is recommended)
2 T extra-virgin olive oil
1 14 oz can chickpeas, drained and rinsed
1 small garlic clove, minced or pressed through garlic press (about ½ t)
½ t table salt
¼ teaspoon ground cumin
Pinch cayenne
1 T minced fresh cilantro or parsley leaves

1. Combine lemon juice and water in small bowl or measuring cup. Whisk together tahini and 2 T oil in second small bowl or cup. Set aside 2 T chickpeas for garnish.
2. Process remaining chickpeas, garlic, salt, cumin, and cayenne in food processor until almost fully ground, about 15 seconds. Scrape down bowl with rubber spatula. With machine running, add lemon juice-water mixture in steady stream through feed tube. Scrape down bowl and continue to process for 1 minute. With machine running, add oil-tahini mixture in steady stream through feed tube; continue to process until hummus is smooth and creamy, about 15 seconds, scraping down bowl as needed.
3. Transfer hummus to serving bowl, sprinkle reserved chickpeas and cilantro over surface, cover with plastic wrap, and let stand until flavors meld, at least 30 minutes. Drizzle with olive oil and serve.

Hummus (Julie Parker's recipe)
Makes about 3 cups

2 16 oz cans garbanzo beans, drained and rinsed
3 cloves garlic, peeled
1/3 c tahini
1 t salt
Juice of one lemon
¼ t cayenne pepper, ground
¼ t cumin, ground
¼ t black pepper, ground
1/3 c extra virgin olive oil
1 handful of parsley
3-4 green onions, cut into 1" pieces
Water as needed, approx. 1/3 c

1. Place all ingredients in food processor or blender. Add water as needed to form smooth paste. Adjust seasonings to taste.
2. Garnish with parsley if desired. Serve with pita bread wedges and fresh vegetables.

Meri's Hummus (from Shannon Nelson)

1 16 oz can garbanzo beans, drained
2 T water
3-4 T olive oil
3 T lemon juice
2 cloves garlic
½ t salt
2 t cumin

Throw all ingredients into food processor and blend til smooth. Can modify amounts of spices (reducing cumin makes it less spicy).

Hummus (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Makes about 1 ½ cups

1 (15.5 oz) can garbanzo beans, drained and rinsed
1 large clove garlic, minced
3 T fresh lemon juice
3 T tahini
½ t kosher salt
1/8 t black pepper
½ t cumin
1/8 t ground red pepper
4-6 T water, divided
3 T extra-virgin olive oil
1 T minced fresh parsley, optional

1. Combine chickpeas, garlic, lemon juice, tahini, salt, pepper, cumin, red pepper, and 3 T of the water in a food processor. Process until smooth. With processor running, pour in olive oil. Process until just combined. Add additional water by tablespoon until you reach the consistency you like.
2. Place in an airtight container and store in the refrigerator. For optimal flavor, refrigerate for at least 2 hours before serving. Right before serving, top with a drizzle of extra-virgin olive oil and chopped fresh parsley.

Roasted Red Pepper Hummus (from *Family Circle*, July 2014)
Makes 2 cups

1 can (14 oz) garbanzo beans
1 roasted red pepper (30-40 minutes at 400 degrees)
1 T lemon juice
2 cloves garlic
1 t tahini paste
1 t sea salt
1 t paprika
1/8 c water
1 t chili flakes

Place all ingredients in a blender. Whirl until smooth. Make sure to scrape down sides of blender pitcher to get any lumps.

***Crock Pot Applesauce** (Trina Smith)

5 large apples, peeled, cored, and diced
¼ c water
½ t pumpkin pie spice
½ c sugar
1 t vanilla
1 T lemon juice
½ t cinnamon
4 T brown sugar
1 t honey

Turn crock pot on high and put 2 t butter in bottom. Butter melts as you're preparing your apples. Mix all ingredients and pour in crock pot. Bake 3 hours on high, or turn on medium before bed and wake up to delicious, warm applesauce for breakfast!

Optional: Can put cinnamon red hots in for a pink look.

Slow Cooker Applesauce
Makes about 4 cups

8-10 apples, peeled, cored, and quartered
2 T fresh lemon juice
2 t water, as needed
Sugar to taste

1. Put the apples in a medium or large round slow cooker and toss with the lemon juice. If the apples seem unusually dry, add the water to the cooker. Cover and cook until the apples are extremely tender and falling apart, on HIGH for 3-3.5 hours or on LOW for 5-6 hours.
2. Puree the cooked apples in a food processor, or in the cooker with a handheld immersion blender, or pass them through a food mill fitted with the medium or large blade. Add sugar to taste, if desired. Serve immediately or refrigerate and serve cold. The applesauce will keep, tightly covered, for 2 weeks in the refrigerator.

Variation: Cinnamon applesauce – Put one 4-6 inch cinnamon stick in the cooker along with the apples. After cooking, discard the cinnamon stick before pureeing the apples.

Melanie's Applesauce

20-25 apples, peeled and cored
2 c water
1 ½ c sugar
pinch of cinnamon
pinch of nutmeg
2-3 c more water

1. Boil prepared apples with 2 c water until soft. Turn off heat and mash/blend this mixture. Then add spices. Add additional water, as needed, depending on desired thickness.
2. Put into jars while still hot; they will seal from the heat as they cool, but store them in the fridge or freezer.

SIDE DISHES

***Cilantro-Lime Rice** (from Heather Jensen)

1 c. uncooked long-grain, white rice
1 tsp. butter or margarine
2 cloves garlic, minced (*I used 1 t pre-minced garlic and it was a little powerful, so maybe reduce quantity a bit?)*
1 tsp. freshly squeezed lime juice
1 can (15 oz) chicken broth
1 cup water
1 Tbsp. freshly squeezed lime juice
2 tsp. sugar
3 tablespoons fresh chopped cilantro

In a saucepan combine rice, butter, garlic, 1 tsp. lime, chicken broth and water. Bring to a boil. Cover and cook on low 15-20 minutes, until rice is tender. Remove from heat. In a small bowl combine lime juice, sugar and cilantro. Pour over hot cooked rice and mix in as you fluff the rice.

Green Rice
Serves 4 - Takes 25 minutes

1 poblano pepper, roasted, seeded and peeled
¼ c fresh cilantro
2 T fresh parsley
2 green onions cut into 1 inch chunks
1 garlic clove, crushed
1 T chicken flavor bouillon powder
2 c water
1 T corn oil
1 c medium grain rice, rinsed and well drained

Puree first seven ingredients in a blender. Heat oil over medium-high heat; add rice and saute 2-3 minutes or until slightly golden. Stir in puree; bring to a boil. Reduce heat to low, cover and simmer 15-18 minutes or until liquid is absorbed. Remove from heat; let stand 3-5 minutes Fluff rice with fork; serve immediately.

yellow rice (from Maria Rodale's *Scratch*)
Serves 4

1 tablespoon butter
1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
1 tablespoon onion powder
1 teaspoon garlic powder
1 teaspoon ground turmeric
1 cup long-grain rice or basmati rice
1/2 teaspoon salt
2 cups chicken stock, store-bought or homemade

1. In a saucepan, melt the butter in the oil over medium heat. Add the onion powder, garlic powder, and turmeric and cook briefly until foaming.
2. Add the rice and salt and stir to coat the rice with the spices.
3. Add the stock and bring to a boil. Cover, reduce the heat to low, and simmer for 15 to 20 minutes, until the liquid has been absorbed and the rice is tender. Fluff with a fork and serve.

Basmati Rice, Pilaf-Style (Cook's Illustrated, Jan 1997)
Serves 4

1 T canola oil, veg oil, or corn oil
3 inch piece cinnamon stick, halved
2 green cardamom pods
¼ c thinly sliced onion (green?)
2 whole cloves
1 c basmati rice
1 t table salt (reduce salt)
1 ½ c water

1. Heat oil in medium saucepan over high heat until almost smoking. Add whole spices and cook, stirring until they pop. Add onions and cook, stirring until translucent, about 2 minutes. Stir in rice and cook, stirring until fragrant, about 1 minute.

2. Add 1 ½ c water and salt; bring to a boil. Reduce heat, cover tightly, and simmer until all water has been absorbed, about 17 minutes. Let stand, covered, at least 10 minutes. Fluff with fork and serve.

Black Beans and Rice (from Shannon Nelson - *taken from Julie Woodfield's blog saladsandsuch.blogspot.com*)

1 lb. black beans (about 2-3 cups)
5-6 cups water
3 large stalks celery, chopped
3 large cloves garlic, chopped
1 large onion, chopped
1 jalapeno pepper
1 tsp. dried basil (or handful of fresh)
ham, sausage, or bacon (if desired)
cooked rice

1. The night before you plan to serve them, place beans (rinsed and picked through) in a large saucepan and add water. Bring to a boil then turn off the heat and soak beans overnight.
2. The next day bring the beans to a boil and add remaining ingredients.
3. Simmer (covered) approximately 5-6 hours until the beans are soft. Add more water as needed. (I usually add several more cups.) Just before serving, remove the jalapeno and add 1-2 tsp. salt and 1/2 tsp. black pepper.
4. Serve over rice.

Julie's Notes: My black beans taste the best when I add a ham bone or chopped up ham slices to the beans as well. The ham is usually left over from some type of holiday feast. Just let the bone simmer with the beans all day, and remove it before serving. Tiny pieces of meat literally fall off the bone into the beans and flavor it deliciously.

Shan Notes:
1) You can quickly soak the beans. Bring them to a boil for 1-2 minutes, then let soak for an hour or two. Drain. Bring another pot of water to a boil. Add the beans and gently boil for a couple of hours with the rest of the ingredients.
2) We liked it with bacon instead of ham and oregano instead of basil, too.

Brown Rice with Black Beans and Cilantro (From Cooks' Illustrated March & April 2009, p. 21) **–** *This was yummy**!***
Serves 4-6

4 t olive oil
1 medium onion, chopped fine (about 1 cup)
1 green bell pepper, chopped fine
3 minced garlic cloves
1 c low-sodium chicken broth
2 ¼ c water
1 ½ c brown rice
1 t table salt
1 can (15 oz) black beans, drained and rinsed
¼ c chopped fresh cilantro leaves
¼ t ground black pepper
1 lime, cut into wedges

1. Adjust oven rack to middle position; heat oven to 375 degrees. Heat oil in large Dutch oven over medium heat until shimmering. Add bell pepper and onion and cook, stirring occasionally, until well browned, 12-14 minutes. Stir in garlic and cook until fragrant, 30 seconds.
2. Add broth and water; cover and bring to boil. Remove pot from heat; stir in rice and salt. Cover and bake rice until tender, 65-70 minutes. (I made it on the stovetop, cooking in 45 minutes.)
3. Remove pot from oven, uncover, fluff rice with fork, stir in black beans, and replace lid; let stand 5 minutes. Stir in cilantro and black pepper. Serve, passing lime wedges separately.

Flavored black beans *(this is the recipe I created to use for Cafe Rio salads at YW camp)*

3 cans black beans
½ can (4 oz) tomato sauce
½ T cumin
½ T dried onion
½ t chili powder
¾ t dried cilantro

Black Beans
makes 10 servings

4 c canned black beans
2 ⅔ c tomato juice
4 cloves garlic, minced
2 T olive oil
2 t cumin
4 T cilantro

Saute garlic, olive oil and cumin until fragrant. Add beans and tomato juice. Simmer til hot and thick. Add cilantro and serve.
**If using dry beans, cook 2 c dry with 1 quart of water. This yields (after MANY hours) 5 c cooked beans.*

Corn & Black Bean Salsa (aka Cowboy Caviar) (from *People*, August 4, 2014)
makes about 6 cups

2 c fresh corn kernels (about 4 ears)
¼ c olive oil, divided
½ c diced red onion
1 c diced red bell pepper
½ c chopped cilantro
6 T lime juice
2 cups black beans, rinsed & drained
kosher salt
freshly cracked black pepper
tortilla chips

1. Preheat boiler. Toss corn in 2 T olive oil; place on an aluminum-foil-lined baking sheet. Broil 8 in away from heat about 5 minutes or until golden brown and tender. Set aside.
2. Toss together red onion, red bell pepper, cilantro, lime juice, 2 c black beans, corn and remaining olive oil in a large bowl. Season to taste with salt and pepper. Serve with tortilla chips.

Refried Beans
serves 10

2 c dried pinto beans, sorted
2 t ground cumin
1 t ground coriander
1 ½ yellow onions
1 ½ red onions
10 whole garlic cloves
butter, olive oil, or lard (optional)

1. Use a 4-qt slow cooker. (You need to soak the beans overnight to soften them, and to help release gas.) Rinse the beans well in a colander, and pour into your slow cooker. Add enough water so that the beans are fully immersed with an additional 2-3 inches of water on top. Put the lid on the slow cooker. Do not turn on the cooker.
2. In the morning, drain and rinse the beans under cold running water. Put them back in the crockpot with enough clean water to cover the beans with about 1 inch of water. Stir in the cumin and coriander. Peel and cut the onions in half, and put them in, too. Peel all of the garlic and toss it in whole. Cover and cook on low for 8-10 hours, or until the beans are tender.

Fish out the onions and garlic cloves. If you want to keep some of the garlic in for flavor, you may; it's your choice. If the beans are soft and you still have a bit of liquid left, carefully drain, saving a little liquid to help with the smooshing and for added flavor. Use a potato masher, or handheld mixer to mash the beans.

Simple Refried Beans (from *Cook's Illustrated*, Sept/Oct 2014)
makes about 1 ½ cups

2 slices bacon
1 small onion, chopped fine
2 garlic cloves, minced
1 (15 oz) can unrinsed pinto beans
¼ c water
kosher salt

1. Heat bacon in 10-inch nonstick skillet over medium-low heat until fat renders and bacon crisps, 7-10 minutes, flipping bacon halfway through. Remove bacon and reserve for another use.

2. Increase heat to medium, add onion to fat in skillet, and cook until lightly browned, 5-7 minutes. Add garlic and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds.
3. Add beans and their liquid and water and bring to simmer. Cook, mashing beans with potato masher, until mixture is mostly smooth, 5-7 minutes. Season with salt to taste, and serve.

Refried Beans & cheese

1 c dried pinto beans (red, kidney, or pink beans can be used instead)
2 ½ c water
1 clove garlic, minced
1/3 c onion, chopped
1 T bacon drippings, or shortening
1 t salt
2 T bacon drippings, or shortening
½ c shredded Monterey jack or cheddar cheese

1. Sort and soak beans by one of these two methods: 1) Soak in water to cover 8-10 hours, or 2) Cover beans with water, bring to boil and cook 2 minutes; remove beans from heat; cover and let stand for 1 hour. Drain.
2. In medium saucepan, combine drained soaked beans with water, garlic, onion, 1 T bacon drippings or oil, and salt. Bring to boil; reduce heat. Cover; simmer until beans are tender, 1 1/2 -2 hours. Beans should easily mash against the side of pot with wooden spoon. Drain beans in colander, reserving liquid.
3. In large skillet, melt 2 T bacon drippings or shortening and add remaining beans, mashing them also. Leave some beans whole or half-mashed, if desired. Continue cooking and stirring until all shortening is absorbed. If thinner consistency is desired, stir in reserved cooking liquid, a small amount at a time. Add cheese. Cook and stir until cheese melts. Serve with a dob of sour cream, if desired.

"Secret Recipe" for Super Easy and Really Good Refried Beans (Sandra Rodriquez, Provo Council PTA)

1. The night before, sort and thoroughly rinse 5 c of dried pinto beans. (Remove any tiny rocks and shriveled beans, then put them in a strainer and rinse until water runs clear.) Put beans in a large crockpot and add 10 cups of cold water. Add 1 small onion, chopped, and 2 dried Serrano peppers, whole.
2. Cover and cook on high all night. First thing in the morning, check water level. It should still just cover the beans. Add water as needed. Beans should be a little soft. Turn off heat, but keep covered and allow to cool slowly.
3. Just before serving, add 3 T salt to the beans. In a large frying pan, heat 2 T vegetable oil. Add a few cups of drained beans and cook several minutes, stirring constantly. Add ½ c of liquid from the beans. Turn down the heat and mash the beans (use a hand-held blender, or a potato masher or fork would work, too). Add liquid or beans as required to get the desired consistency, and add more salt to taste. Remove from heat. Serve hot.

***Aunt Lola's Baked Beans**

4 slices chopped bacon (uncooked)
1 big onion, minced
1/3 t garlic powder
2 large or 3 small cans pork and beans
14 oz ketchup
Dash Tabasco sauce
Few drops Worcestershire sauce
3-4 t table mustard
¼ c brown sugar
½ c molasses

1. Combine and fry bacon, onion, and garlic powder til tender. Drain.
2. Add pork and beans. Then add ketchup, tabasco sauce, worcestershire sauce, mustard, brown sugar, and molasses.
3. Mix sauce, beans, and meat mixture together. Bake 350 degrees for 1 hour.

Mexicali Beans (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale) - *Yummy served with tacos, huevos rancheros, or as a side. Also tasty spooned on top of nachos.*
Serves 2

Olive oil, for the pan
1 teaspoon ground cumin
1 teaspoon ground chili powder
1 can (14 to 19 ounces) black or pinto beans, drained and rinsed
2/3 cup water
Salt and freshly ground black pepper
Hickory smoke flavoring (optional)

1. In a saucepan, heat a little oil over medium-high heat. Add the cumin and chili powder and stir to combine. Cook, stirring, for 30 seconds, or until foamy.
2. Add the beans and stir to combine. Add water, salt and pepper to taste, and a drop or two of hickory flavoring (if using). Reduce the heat to low and simmer for 20 minutes.

Aloo Matar (from *allrecipes.com*)
takes 45 minutes

¼ c vegetable oil
2 medium onions, finely chopped
1 T ginger garlic paste (*or make your own 50/50 blend from fresh or jar*)
1 bay leaf
4 large potatoes, peeled and chopped
1 c frozen peas
½ c tomato puree (*I have used tomato paste - which makes it very rich - or diced tomatoes, blended in a blender)*
1 ½ t garam masala
1 ½ t paprika
1 t white sugar
1 t salt
2 T chopped cilantro

1. Heat the oil in a wok over medium heat. Stir in the onions, ginger garlic paste, and bay leaf. Cook until the onions are tender. Mix in the potatoes and peas. Cover and cook until the potatoes are tender, about 15 minutes. REmove the bay leaf.
2. Stir the tomato puree, garam masala, paprika, sugar, and salt into the vegetable mixture. Continue cooking about 10 minutes. Mix in the cilantro and continue cooking about 2 minutes.

Spanikopita – Greek Spinach and Feta Pie (Cooks Illustrated, January & February 2011, p.23)
Serves 6-8 as main dish or 10-12 as an appetizer

<u>Filling</u>:
2 (10 oz) bags curly leaf spinach, rinsed
¼ c water
12 ounces feta cheese, rinsed, patted dry, and crumbled into fine pieces (about 3 cups)
¾ c whole-milk Greek yogurt (or full fat sour cream)
4 medium green onions, sliced thin (about ½ cup)
2 large eggs, beaten
¼ c minced fresh mint leaves
2 T minced fresh dill leaves
3 medium garlic cloves, minced or pressed through garlic press (about 1 T)
1 t grated zest, plus 1 T juice from 1 lemon
1 t ground nutmeg
½ t ground black pepper
¼ t table salt
1/8 t cayenne pepper

<u>Phyllo layers</u>:
7 T unsalted butter, melted
½ lb (14x9 inch) phyllo, thawed (thaw in fridge overnight or on counter for 4-5 hours)
1 ½ ounces Pecorino Romano cheese, grated fine (about ¾ cup)
2 t sesame seeds (optional – just for garnish)

1. FOR THE FILLING: Place spinach and water in large microwave-safe bowl. Cover bowl with large dinner plate. Microwave on high power until spinach is wilted and decreased in volume by half, about 5 minutes. Using potholders, remove bowl from microwave and keep covered, 1 minute. Carefully remove plate and transfer spinach to colander set

in sink. Using back of rubber spatula, gently press spinach against colander to release excess liquid. Transfer spinach to cutting board and roughly chop. Transfer spinach to clean kitchen towel and squeeze to remove excess water. Place drained spinach in large bowl. Add remaining filling ingredients and mix until thoroughly combined. (Filling can be made up to 24 hours in advance and stored in the refrigerator.)

2. FOR THE PHYLLO LAYERS: Adjust oven rack to lower-middle position and heat oven to 425 degrees. Line rimmed baking sheet with parchment paper. Using pastry brush, lightly brush 14x9 inch rectangle in center of parchment with melted butter to cover area same size as phyllo. Lay 1 phyllo sheet on buttered parchment, and brush thoroughly with melted butter. Repeat with 9 more phyllo sheets, brushing each with butter (you should have a total of 10 layers of phyllo).
3. Spread spinach mixture evenly over phyllo, leaving ¼ inch border on all sides. Cover spinach with 6 more phyllo sheets, brushing each with butter and sprinkling each with about 2 T Pecorino cheese. Lay 2 more phyllo sheets on top, brushing each with butter (these layers should not be sprinkled with Pecorino).
4. Working from center outward, use palms of your hands to compress layers and press out any air pockets. Using sharp knife, score pie through the top 3 layers of phyllo into 24 equal pieces. Sprinkle with sesame seeds (if using). Bake until phyllo is golden and crisp, 20-25 minutes. Cool on baking sheet 10 minutes, or up to 2 hours. Slide spanakopita, still on parchment, to cutting board. Cut into squares and serve.

Roasted Asparagus with Creamy Feta (from *Good Housekeeping*, April 2020)
Serves 6, Prep time about 15 minutes

2 lbs asparagus, trimmed
2 T olive oil
kosher salt and pepper
8 oz feta cheese
½ c plain whole-milk yogurt
1 lemon

1. Heat oven to 425 F. On rimmed baking sheet, toss asparagus with oil and ½ t each salt and pepper. Transfer half to second sheet and arrange both in single layer.
2. Roast, shaking both trays once, until asparagus is lightly charred and just tender, 10-12 minutes.
3. Meanwhile, in food processor, puree feta and yogurt until smooth. Spread half of mixture onto platter.
4. Over each sheet of asparagus, grate zest from half of lemon and toss to combine. Arrange asparagus on top of feta mixture and serve with remaining feta mixture.

**These are very good, but rich. I'd use about ½ the feta mixture.

Tuscan-Style Roasted Asparagus (from *Taste of Home*)
makes 8 servings - takes 20 minutes

1 ½ lbs fresh asparagus, trimmed
1 ½ c grape tomatoes, halved
3 T pine nuts
3 T olive oil, divided
2 garlic cloves, minced
1 t kosher salt
½ t pepper
1 T lemon juice
⅓ c grated Parmesan cheese
1 t grated lemon peel

1. Put asparagus, tomatoes and pine nuts on a foil-lined 15x10x1 inch pan. Mix 2 T oil, garlic, salt and pepper; toss with asparagus (& tomatoes & pine nuts).
2. Bake at 400 degrees for 15-20 minutes or until asparagus is just tender. Drizzle with remaining oil and lemon juice; sprinkle with cheese and lemon peel. Toss to combine.

Garlic-Balsamic Asparagus (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")
Serves 4-6

1 lb asparagus
½ t kosher salt
¼ t freshly ground black pepper
1 T olive oil
1 T balsamic vinegar
1 t minced or pressed garlic

1. Preheat oven to 425 degrees F (or BBQ grill to medium-high heat).
2. Wash asparagus and snap the woody ends off the bottom.
3. In a small bowl, combine salt, pepper, oil, vinegar, and garlic. Drizzle over asparagus and toss to coat.
4. Line a baking sheet with aluminum foil and spray with nonstick cooking spray. Arrange the asparagus in a single layer on the baking sheet. Drizzle any remaining oil and vinegar mixture over the asparagus. (If grilling, reduce heat to low, lightly grease the grill, and place on grill, perpendicular to slats, drizzling with remaining oil.)
5. Roast for 10 minutes, turning once. (Or grill for 8-10 minutes til bright green and still slightly crisp, turning frequently.)

Vegetable Roasting 101 (from *Good Housekeeping*, March 2010, p. 203)
Vegetables benefit from the high, dry heat of the oven. Their flavor becomes concentrated and their natural sugars caramelize. For every 2 lbs of vegetables, toss with 1 T olive oil prior to roasting. Spread in a single layer, with space in between pieces, if possible, or they'll steam instead.

Vegetable	How to Cut	Roasting time at 450 F	Suggested Seasoning
Asparagus - 2 lbs	Trimmed	10-15 minutes	Sprinkle with 1 t freshly grated lemon peel after roasting
Beets - 2 lbs, without tops	Whole, unpeeled, pricked with a fork, then peeled after roasting	1 hour	Chop; sprinkle with salt, pepper, and 1 t freshly grated orange peel after roasting
Brussels Sprouts - 2 lbs	Trim and halve through stem end	15-20 minutes	Sprinkle with salt and pepper and serve immediately
Butternut Squash - 2 lbs	2-in pieces	40 minutes	Toss with ½ t dried rosemary, crumbled, before roasting
Carrots - 2 lbs	1-in pieces	30-40 minutes	Toss with ½ t pumpkin pie spice before serving
Cauliflower - 1 ½ lbs (1 medium)	1 ½-in florets	20-30 minutes	Sprinkle with 2 T chopped fresh parsley after roasting
Green beans - 2 lbs	Trimmed	20-30 minutes	Toss with 2 T each fresh lemon juice and chopped fresh dill after roasting.
Onions - 2 lbs (2 jumbo)	Each cut into 12 wedges	20-30 minutes	Brush with mixture of 1 T brown sugar, 1 T cider vinegar; roast 5 minutes more
Potatoes - 2 lbs unpeeled	2-in pieces	45 minutes	Sprinkle with ½ t freshly grated orange peel after roasting
Sweet peppers - 2 lbs	1-in wide strips	30 minutes	Sprinkle with 3 large fresh basil leaves, thinly sliced, after roasting

Sweet potatoes - 2 lbs	Cut crosswise in half, then lengthwise into 1-in wedges	30 minutes	Toss with 2 T chopped fresh rosemary before roasting
Zucchini - 2 lbs	Trimmed and cut in half crosswise, then each half quartered	15-20 minutes	Top with 1 T freshly grated Parmesan

Roots at 500 degrees (Suzette Asplund)

Peel and cut 3 or 4 medium sized yams (garnet ones are sweetest). Cut them like ½" fries, toss them with oil and salt and cook them at 500 degrees for 20 minutes, stirring after 10 minutes. Can also use baby carrots, potatoes, beets, red onion. If cooking regular potatoes, put them in for 15 minutes BEFORE adding other veggies (for a total of 35 minutes on the potatoes).

***"Funeral Potatoes"** (Nana's Potato Casserole recipe)
Makes 8-10 servings

5 large potatoes
3 T butter or margarine, melted
1 can cream of chicken soup
1 c sour cream
1 c milk
3 T finely chopped green onions
¾ c shredded cheddar cheese
¾ c cornflake crumbs
2 T butter, melted
3 T parmesan cheese

Boil potatoes until tender. Drain and peel. Shred. Place in 2 or 3 quart casserole. Pour 3 T melted butter over potatoes. Mix together soup, sour cream, milk, onions, and cheese. Pour evenly over potatoes. Do not mix. Cover the top with premixed cornflake crumbs, 2 T melted butter and parmesan cheese. Bake 30 minutes at 325 degrees.

Baked Potato Casserole

8 medium potatoes (about 2.5-3 lbs total), peeled and cut into 1 inch chunks
1 c evaporated milk
½ c sour cream
1 t salt
½ t ground black pepper
2 c (8 oz pkg) shredded cheddar cheese, divided
6 slices bacon, cooked and crumbled, divided
sliced green onions (optional)

1. Place potatoes in large saucepan. Cover with water; bring to a boil. Cook over medium-high heat for 15-20 minutes or until tender; drain.
2. Preheat oven to 350. Grease 2 ½ to 3 quart casserole dish.
3. Return potatoes to saucepan; add evaporated milk, sour cream, salt, and pepper. Beat with hand-held mixer until smooth. Stir in 1 ½ c cheese and half of bacon. Spoon mixture into prepared casserole dish.
4. Bake 20-25 minutes or until heated through. Top with remaining ½ c cheese, remaining bacon and green onions. Bake an additional 3 minutes or until cheese is melted.

Crusty Potato Wedges
makes 4 servings

1 lb red potatoes (about 8 potatoes), scrubbed
1 T Dijon mustard
1 ½ t paprika
¾ t ground cumin
½ t garlic salt

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Spray shallow baking dish with cooking spray. Cut potatoes into wedges. Combine mustard, paprika, cumin and garlic salt in a large bowl; mix well.
2. Add potatoes to bowl; toss until coated well with mustard mixture.
3. Spread potato wedges in a single layer in prepared baking dish, leaving a little space between wedges.
4. Bake potato wedges for 10 minutes, turning once. Bake for 10 minutes longer or until tender and crusty.

"Crock Pot" Mashed Potatoes

3 lbs cubed peeled potatoes
1 pkg (8 oz) cream cheese, softened
1 c (8 oz) sour cream
½ c butter, cubed
¼ c milk
½ lb bacon strips, cooked & crumbled
1 ½ c shredded cheddar cheese
1 ½ c pepper jack cheese
4 green onions, sliced thin
½ t onion powder
½ t garlic powder
salt & pepper to taste

1. Precook potatoes 10-15 minutes. Drain, return to pan. Mash with dairy products. Stir in rest. Refrigerate overnight.
2. Transfer to greased slow cooker & heat on low 3-3 ½ hours.

Buttery Potato Fans
Serves 3

3 large baking potatoes, scrubbed
2 T melted butter or margarine
2 T vegetable oil
½ t salt
½ c sour cream

1. Preheat oven to 450 F. Lightly grease a baking sheet. Cut unpeeled potatoes into ¼ inch slices but do not cut all the way through (like you're making a fan)
2. Place potatoes on prepared baking sheet. Spread slices slightly apart (fan it out).
3. Mix butter and oil in a small bowl; lightly brush over potato skins and between slices. Sprinkle with salt.
4. Bake for 40 minutes or until potatoes are tender and edges are brown. (*To speed up cooking time, microwave the potatoes for about 8 minutes (after step 3). Then you only need to bake them in the oven for 15 minutes.)* Spread with sour cream or serve sour cream on the side.

**For flavor variations, sprinkle with different spices in step 3.*

Herb-Infused Mashed Potatoes (from *Good Housekeeping*, November 2019)
serves 8

4 lbs golden potatoes (about 8), peeled and quartered
kosher salt
2 c heavy cream or half and half
4 T unsalted butter
8 sprigs thyme
2 springs fresh flat-leaf parsley
1 bay leaf
6 black peppercorns
freshly grated nutmeg, for serving

1. Place potatoes in large pot, add enough cold water to cover and bring to a boil. Add 2 t salt, reduce heat and simmer until just tender, 15-18 min. Drain potatoes and return to pot.
2. Meanwhile, place cream, butter, thyme, parsley, bay leaf, and peppercorns in small saucepan and bring to a boil. Reduce heat and simmer 3 min., then remove from heat.
3. Strain cream mixture into pot with potatoes. Add ¾ t salt and mash to desired consistency. Sprinkle with nutmeg before serving, if desired.

Savory Herb Stuffing (from *Good Housekeeping*, November 2019)
serves 8

3 T unsalted butter, plus more for dish and foil
1 small loaf country bread (about 1 lb), cut into ½-in pieces (about 10 cups)
2 ½ c low-sodium chicken broth
2 large eggs, beaten
2 medium onions, chopped
kosher salt and pepper
2 stalks celery, cut into ¼-in pieces
2 t fresh thyme
1 c fresh flat-leaf parsley, chopped

1. Heat oven to 375. Grease 2 ½ qt casserole dish. Place bread on baking sheet and bake until beginning to turn golden brown, 20-25 min.; transfer to large bowl. Pour broth over bread and let sit, tossing occasionally, until absorbed; fold in eggs.
2. Meanwhile, heat butter in large skillet on medium. Add onions, season with ¾ t salt and ½ t pepper and cook covered, stirring occasionally, 12 min.
3. Add celery and cook, uncovered, stirring occasionally, until vegetables are tender, 10-12 min. Stir in thyme and cook 1 min. Remove from heat and stir in parsley.
4. Add vegetable mixture to bread and toss to combine. Transfer mixture to prepared baking dish. Cover loosely with greased foil and bake 25 min. Uncover and bake until golden brown, 15-20 min. more.

Dutch Oven Bacon-Cheese Potatoes

8 small-medium potatoes
Salt and pepper to taste
2 large onions
1 lb cheddar cheese
½ lb bacon
¼ t chopped fresh garlic or 1/8 t garlic powder

1. Peel potatoes; quarter then slice into 1/8-1/4-inch slices. Chop or slice onion.
2. Cut bacon into one inch squares and fry in the hot dutch oven. Brown onion pieces in bacon grease and add garlic. Add potatoes and stir. Season with salt and pepper. Bake until potatoes are cooked. Check often to ensure that vegetables are not sticking to bottom of oven, but minimize stirring.
3. When potatoes are cooked, grate cheese over the top. Replace oven lid, allow cheese to melt.

***Use 8 coals on the bottom and 8-10 coals on top.*

Slow Cooker Mashed Potatoes with Skins
Serves 5-7

5 medium potatoes
1 t garlic salt
2 oz cream cheese, softened
¼ c milk
¼ c sour cream
salt and pepper to taste

Cut up potatoes (with the skins on) into little cubes. Place in slow cooker along with cream cheese and garlic salt. Stir to coat. Cover and cook on LOW for 7 hours, or until very soft. Use a hand mixer to cream the potatoes. Blend in milk and sour cream. Salt and pepper to taste. Serve with or without gravy.

***Au Gratin Potatoes** (Family Circle magazine, February 2008, p. 166)
Makes 6 servings

2 lbs potatoes, peeled
3 T flour
1 t salt
2 green onions, trimmed and sliced
4 ounces Gruyere or Emmentaler cheese, shredded (about 1 ½ c) – *I've used cheddar*
2 c half and half – *I've used milk or evaporated milk*
Pinch ground nutmeg
2 T grated Asiago or Parmesan cheese

1. Heat oven to 375 degrees. Coat a 1 ½ quart oval or round baking pan with nonstick spray.
2. Slice potatoes into 1/8-inch slices. Sprinkle flour and salt over potato slices, and toss with your hands to coat potatoes.
3. Begin layering: Spread 1/3 of the potato slices over bottom of prepared pan, then sprinkle with half the scallions. Top with 1/3 the shredded Gruyere cheese, about ½ cup. Repeat with more potato slices, the remaining scallions and ½ c shredded cheese. Top with remaining potato slices.
4. In a small saucepan, combine the half and half and the nutmeg. Bring to a simmer and remove from heat. Carefully pour over potatoes, then cover pan with foil. Bake at 375 for 30 minutes. Carefully remove foil, sprinkle with remaining ½ cup shredded cheese and the Asiago or Parmesan. Return to oven and bake for 25 minutes, until top is lightly browned and potatoes are tender. Let stand 15 minutes before serving.

Sweet Potato Fries (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")

½ t cumin
½ t oregano
½ t coriander
1 t kosher salt
1 t parsley
1/8 t black pepper
1 lb peeled sweet potatoes cut into ¼ inch matchsticks
2 T extra-virgin olive oil

1. Preheat oven to 425 degrees F.
2. In a small bowl, combine cumin, oregano, coriander, salt, parsley, and pepper.
3. Place the sweet potatoes in a pile directly on a baking sheet and drizzle with olive oil. Use your hands to toss until all pieces are well coated. Sprinkle seasoning mixture on top and toss again with your hands to coat.
4. Arrange sweet potatoes in a single layer so that pieces are not touching each other. Place the pan in the preheated oven and bake for 15 minutes. Use a metal spatula to gently flip fries and then return pan to oven. Cook for an additional 15-20 minutes or until fries are starting to lightly brown and crisp. Remove pan from oven and cool 5 minutes. Serve immediately with Honey-Lime Dip.

Honey-Lime Dip (from "Our Best Bites -- Mormon Moms in the Kitchen")

1 (6 oz) container plain, low-fat yogurt
1 T mayonnaise
½ T honey
1 T fresh lime juice
¼ t cumin
1/8 t oregano
1 t parsley
½ t onion powder
½ t kosher salt

Whisk together all the ingredients and chill until ready to serve.

cheesy grits (from Maria Rodale's *Scratch) - yummy as breakfast (with some ham or bacon added) or for dinner with chicken & vegetables*
serves 4

1 cup grits
1/2 cup whole milk
2 tablespoons butter
1 cup shredded cheddar cheese
Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1. Cook the grits according to the package directions.
2. Add the milk, butter, cheddar, and salt and pepper to taste and stir until the cheese has melted and is combined.

Caroline's Zambian Collard Greens

Collard greens, washed
olive oil
diced tomatoes, fresh or canned
diced onions
salt

1. Prepare collard greens by cutting just ½" off the hard end. Stack the leaves and roll them up like a scroll; then slice them up REALLY small, like as thin as a coin.
2. Put a little bit of olive oil in a frying pan. Put sliced collard greens in hot oil. Cover & simmer & stir occasionally.
3. Add diced tomatoes and onions to the collard greens.
4. Mix with salt and cook until tomato is cooked/crushed. (simmer about 45 minutes to an hour)

**Can also be prepared in the opposite order (onions & tomatoes first in oil, then make it to a paste, add salt, then greens)

Caroline's Nshima ("Sheema")

white corn meal
cold water
boiling water

1. In a medium sized saucepan, mix 2 c cold water with 1 c corn meal. Heat this mixture on the stove then add about 3 cups boiling water. Add ½ c corn meal at a time, while mixture is cooking (about 1 cup total). Whisk/stir to keep mixture smooth. Try to keep covered because it splats a lot.
2. Continue stirring and cooking until mixture thickens. Ideally, it will become thick enough to pick it up in your hands and use it to serve/eat the collard greens.

Fruit Leather (*demonstrated by Sherilyn Riboldi at a Relief Society activity)*

frozen fruit (a little thawed)
1 T lime/lemon juice

1. Blend fruit and juice in a blender until smooth..
2. Line cookie sheet with parchment or wax paper (hanging 1" over). Pour pureed fruit mix onto prepared pan. Bake in 150-200 degree oven for 6-8 hours
3. Take out and roll with extra 1" of parchment first. Cut with scissors (looks like fruit by the foot)
4. Store in fridge.

Gourmet Macaroni and Cheese
Serves 8

1 T butter
1 T flour
1 t salt
¼ t pepper
1 ¼ c milk
1 T minced onion (dried)
2 t dry mustard
1 t Worcestershire sauce
1 lb mix of shredded Cheddar, fontina and feta cheese
3 ⅓ c cooked macaroni (1 ¾ c raw)
buttered bread crumbs

1. Melt butter in a 2 qt skillet over low heat. Stir in flour, salt and pepper until smooth. Remove from heat. Gradually stir in milk. Add onion, mustard and Worcestershire sauce. Cook over medium heat until thickened. Stir in cheese until melted.
2. Combine cooked macaroni with cheese sauce, and place in 1 ½ qt greased baking dish. Sprinkle with buttered bread crumbs. Bake in oven at 350 for 30-35 minutes. Refrigerate any leftovers.

SOUPS & STEWS

BEAN SOUPS

Black Bean Soup
Serves 4

¾ c onion
1 T Olive Oil
½ c green or red pepper, chopped
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 can diced tomatoes, with juice (can use varieties with chiles in them)
¾ t ground cumin
7-8 oz chicken broth
2 cans black beans, drained, rinsed

1. Heat oil in large, deep saucepan. Saute onion, bell pepper, and garlic until tender.
2. Add remaining ingredients and simmer for 10 minutes.
3. Serve garnished with sour cream.

Black Bean Soup (Cooks' Illustrated, *Best Soups and Stews*, p. 159)
Serves 6

BEANS
1 lb (2 ¼ c) dried black beans, rinsed and picked over
1 smoked ham hock (about 2/3 lb), rinsed (I used a small bone from a pork roast)
1 medium green bell pepper, stemmed, seeded, and quartered
1 medium onion, minced
6 medium cloves garlic, minced
2 bay leaves
1 ½ t salt

SOFRITO
2 T olive oil
1 medium onion, minced
1 small red bell pepper, stemmed, seeded, and minced
¾ t salt
8 medium cloves garlic, minced
2 t dried oregano
1 T ground cumin

FINISHING THE SOUP
2 T cornstarch
1 T lime juice
¼ c sour cream
¼ c roughly chopped fresh cilantro leaves
½ small red onion, minced
Hot red pepper sauce (optional)

1. FOR THE BEANS: Place the beans, ham hock, green pepper, and 13 c water in a large stockpot or Dutch oven. Bring to a boil over medium-high heat, reduce the heat to low, and skim the surface as scum rises. Stir in the onion, garlic, bay leaves, and salt and bring back to a simmer. Cook, partially covered, until the beans are tender but not splitting (taste several, as they cook unevenly), about 2 hours. (*Mine simmered for almost 4 hours and were still not soft…maybe overnight in a crockpot on low would be better?*) Remove the ham hock from the pot. When cool enough to handle, remove and cut the meat into bite-sized pieces, discarding the bone, skin, and fat. Stir the meat back into the pot of beans.
2. FOR THE SOFRITO: Meanwhile, heat the oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Add the onion, red pepper, and salt, and sauté until the vegetables soften, 8-10 minutes. Add the garlic, oregano, and cumin and sauté until fragrant, 1 minute longer.
3. TO FINISH THE SOUP: Scoop 1 ½ c beans and 2 c cooking liquid into the pan with the sofrito. Mash the beans with a potato masher or fork until smooth. Simmer, uncovered, over medium heat, until the liquid is reduced and thickened, about 5 minutes. Return the sofrito mixture to the bean pot. Simmer, uncovered, until the flavors meld, about 15 minutes.
4. Blend the cornstarch and 2 T cold water together in a small bowl to form a smooth paste. Stir paste into the soup and simmer until thickened, about 5 minutes. (Soup can be refrigerated in an airtight container for up to 3 days. Bring the soup to a simmer over low heat.) To serve, remove and discard the green pepper and bay leaves. Stir in lime juice and adjust seasonings. Ladle soup into individual bowls, and garnish each bowl with a spoonful of sour cream, a generous sprinkling of cilantro, and some red onion. Serve immediately, passing hot red pepper sauce at the table if desired.

**This soup tastes best if made a day ahead so flavors can meld. The ham hock only holds about 2-3 T meat, but it is worth taking the time to remove it and add it back to the soup. Can also be garnished with Monterey jack cheese, diced tomatoes, and minced jalapenos. Serve either variation with cornbread.

Moroccan Spiced Lentil, Chickpea & Chorizo Soup (by Sherilyn Riboldi - *from RS $5 recipe book*)

1 C. Lentils
2 T. olive oil
2 oz. chorizo, chopped
1 onion, finely chopped
2 cloves garlic, crushed
1 ½ t. ground cumin
2 t. ground coriander
¼ t. ground cinnamon
¼ t. crushed dried red pepper
4 tomatoes, peeled, seeded, and chopped
14 oz. can chickpeas, rinsed and drained
1 T. tomato paste
5 C. chicken stock
Salt and pepper
Juice of ½ lemon

Heat the oil in a large pot and gently fry the chorizo onion and garlic for 4 minutes. Stir in the cumin, coriander, cinnamon and chili, followed by the tomatoes, chickpeas, tomato paste, stock and lentils. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat, cover and simmer for 45 minutes. Add salt, pepper and lemon juice. Serve with crusty bread.

***Rotel Crock Pot Soup** (by Brandi Ivory - *from RS $5 recipe book*)
This is one of my favorite things to eat. I crumble chips over it and can eat it as leftovers for several days without tiring.

1 Can Rotel Tomatoes
1 Can Corn
1 Can Black Beans
8oz Cream Cheese
2 Chicken Breasts
1 Packet Dry Ranch Dressing
1 Tablespoon Cumin
1 teaspoon Onion Powder
1 teaspoon Chili Powder

Put all ingredients in crock pot and cook 6-8 hours. Shred Chicken, and enjoy.

Beef and Barley Soup (by Sherilyn Riboldi - *from RS $5 recipe book*) YUM

2 T. olive oil
1 lb. lean tender steak, cubed
1 onion, finely chopped
2 garlic cloves, crushed
½ C. pearled barley
5 ½ C. beef stock
1 t. fresh thyme leaves
3 carrots
3 celery stalks, sliced
1 large potato, diced
Salt and pepper

1. Heat the oil in a large nonstick saucepan, Add the beef and cook quickly until browned all over. Add onion and garlic to pan and sauté about 4 minutes, then add the barley, stock and thyme.
2. Bring to the boil, reduce the heat, cover and simmer for about 45 minutes. Add the carrots, celery and potato and simmer for a further 15 minutes, until the meat and vegetables are tender. Season the soup to taste, serve.

Barley Mushroom Lentil Soup *(this was a hearty and flavorful simple soup)*
Serves 8

9 c water
5 beef or vegetable bouillon cubes
4 c sliced fresh mushrooms
¾ c uncooked barley
¾ c dried lentils
¼ c dried onion flakes
3 garlic cloves, minced
1 t thyme
¼ t sage
3 bay leaves
1 t dried basil
½ t pepper
salt to taste

Dissolve the bouillon cubes in the water. Then, mix all the ingredients in a large slow cooker. Cover and cook on LOW for 8 hours (until barley and lentils are tender). Remove the bay leaves and serve.

Lentil Soup (Cooks' Illustrated, *Best Soups and Stews*, p. 162)
Serves 4-6

2 T vegetable oil
4 slices (about 4 oz) bacon, diced
2 medium-large onions, chopped fine
2 medium carrots, peeled and chopped medium
3 medium cloves garlic, minced
1 bay leaf
1 t minced fresh thyme leaves *(I used dried – about ¼ t)*
1 (14.5 oz) can diced tomatoes, drained and liquid reserved
1 c lentils, rinsed and picked through
1 t salt
Ground black pepper
¾ c white wine *(I used apple juice)*
4 c chicken stock
1 T balsamic vinegar

1. Heat the oil in a large stockpot or Dutch oven over med-high heat. When the oil is shimmering, add the bacon and cook, stirring occasionally, until the fat is fully rendered and the bacon is crisp, 3-4 minutes. Add the onions, carrots, garlic, bay leaf, thyme, and drained tomatoes, and cook until the vegetables begin to soften, about 2 minutes.
2. Stir in the lentils, salt, and a few grindings of pepper. Cover, reduce the heat to medium-low, and sweat the vegetables until softened and the lentils have become darker, 8-10 minutes. (My lentils actually lightened, but I used yellow ones instead of brown, so maybe that's why.)
3. Uncover, increase the heat to high, add the wine, and simmer for 1 minute. Add the stock, the juice from the canned tomatoes, and 1 ½ c water. Bring to a boil, partially cover, and reduce the heat to low, simmering until the lentils are cooked but still hold their shape, 30-35 minutes. Remove and discard the bay leaf.
4. Place 3 c soup in a blender and puree until smooth. Add the pureed soup back to a saucepan and stir in the vinegar. (Soup can be refrigerated in an airtight container for 2 days.) Warm over low heat until very hot. Serve immediately.

Curried Lentil Soup (from Family Circle, Jan 2009, page 129)
Makes 4 LARGE servings - Prep 10 minutes - Cook 55 minutes

1 T olive oil
1 large onion, chopped
1 large carrot, peeled and chopped
2 t curry powder
1 can (14.5 oz) diced tomatoes, drained
1 c dried lentils, picked over
4 ½ c low-sodium chicken broth
1 c water
½ t black pepper
¼ t salt
1 bunch (about ¾ lb) fresh kale, rinsed, tough stems removed, leaves coarsely chopped (about 8 cups)
¼ cup 2% Greek yogurt

1. Heat olive oil in large pot over med high heat. Cook onion and carrot, stirring occasionally, 5 minutes. Stir in curry powder and cook 1 minute more.
2. Add tomatoes, lentils, broth, water and ¼ t pepper to pot. Bring to a boil, then partially cover. Reduce heat to med low and simmer for 45 min or until lentils are tender (my old ones took several hours!).
3. In batches, puree soup (or use immersion blender) in a blender until smooth; return to pot and gently reheat. Stir in remaining ¼ t pepper, salt and kale. Cook 5 min or until kale is wilted and tender. Dollop each serving with 1 T yogurt.

Creamy Chicken Tortilla Soup
Serves 6

2 cans (14.5 oz each) Rotel
2 cans chicken broth
1 can Rosarita no-fat refried beans
½ c whole kernel corn
2 c shredded cooked chicken
Fried corn tortilla strips or chips
Shredded Monterey jack cheese

1. Combine tomatoes and broth in medium saucepan. Stir in beans and corn. Bring to a boil; reduce heat to low and simmer 5 minutes, stirring frequently.
2. Add chicken; heat through.
3. Top with tortilla strips and cheese.

***Winter Comfort Food – Italian Pasta and Bean Soup**
Serves 6-8

2 T olive oil
1 c onion, diced
2 ribs celery, diced
2 T garlic, minced
2 c canned diced tomatoes (15 oz can)
6 c chicken broth
2 large bay leaves
1 t dried oregano
1 t salt
½ t black pepper
15 oz can white northern beans
15 oz can garbanzo beans
1 c ditalini pasta or other small pasta such as orzo, patina or miniature shells
Garnish: grated Romano or parmesan cheese, chopped fresh parsley

1. In large stockpot, heat oil. Add onion and celery. Cook 2 minutes on low until soft; add garlic; cook 1 minute. Add tomatoes, broth, bay leaves, oregano, salt, pepper, and the beans. Cover soup; simmer for 30 minutes.
2. Add pasta, cook another 10 minutes. Taste for seasoning. Remove bay leaves before serving. If soup is too thick, thin with a little more broth or with water; use a little at a time to test the consistency. Warm soup after adding liquid.
3. Serve soup in large bowls with crusty bread and topped with grated cheese and chopped fresh parsley.

***Southwest White Chili**
Makes 4 cups

1 T olive oil
1 ½ lb boneless, skinless chicken
¼ c chopped onion
1 c chicken broth
1 can (4 oz) chopped green chilis (I've used fresh/froz jalapenos)
1 can (19 oz) white kidney beans (cannellini), undrained
2 green onions, sliced
<u>Spice blend</u>:
1 t garlic powder
1 t cumin
½ t oregano leaves
½ t cilantro leaves
1/8 t ground red pepper

1. Heat oil in large saucepan over medium-high heat. Add chicken and onion; cook 4-5 minutes.
2. Stir in broth, green chilies and spice blend; simmer 15 minutes
3. Stir in beans. Simmer 5 minutes. Top with green onions. Garnish with Monterey Jack cheese, if desired.

3-bean chili (from *Family Circle*, Sept 2008, p. 181)
makes 8 cups

1 T olive oil
1 medium onion, chopped
2 garlic cloves, peeled & chopped
3 T chili powder
2 sweet bell peppers, cored & diced
1 medium zucchini, trimmed & diced
1 can (14.5 oz) diced tomatoes
1 can (8 oz) no-salt-added tomato sauce
¼ c ketchup
½ t dried oregano
1 can (15 oz) black beans, drained & rinsed
1 can (15 oz) small white beans, drained & rinsed
1 can (15 oz) red kidney beans, drained & rinsed
grated cheddar cheese (optional)

1. Heat oil in a large nonstick pot over medium heat. Add onion, garlic and chili powder and cook 3 minutes.

2. Add peppers and zucchini and continue to cook 5 minutes, stirring occasionally.
3. Stir in tomatoes, tomato sauce, ketchup and oregano. Cook 8 minutes.
4. Gently stir in the beans. Cover pot and continue to cook 3 minutes. Serve with grated cheese, if desired.

Cracked Wheat Chili

2 onions, chopped fine
1 c celery, chopped
1 green pepper, chopped
2 T olive oil
1 can tomato sauce
1 T chili powder
½ T cumin
Salt to taste
1 lb ground meat, browned and drained (optional)
1 T sugar
6 c cracked wheat, cooked *(bulgur wheat is parboiled; regular cracked wheat takes a bit longer to cook – see below)*

Saute onion, celery, and green pepper in olive oil until limp but not browned. Add tomatoes and tomato sauce, spices, and sugar. Add meat if desired. Cook for 20 minutes to blend flavors together. Add cracked wheat and cook ½ hour, stirring occasionally. Top with grated cheese.

***To crack wheat in a blender, you simply put in about 1/4-1/3 cups of wheat and pulse it until it looks like little cracked kernels. These kernels will cook much faster than regular wheat, and cook up in the same way that you cook rice on the stove or in the microwave.*

Slow-Cooker Chili *(YUMMY!)*—From *Family Fun* magazine
Serves 4

2 t oil
1 lb London Broil or round steak, cut into ¼" cubes
1 medium onion, finely chopped
3 garlic cloves, minced
1 t paprika
2-3 t chili powder
1 t ground cumin
1 t dried oregano
½ t salt
1 14.5 oz can diced tomatoes
1 c water *(or ginger ale)*
1/3-1/2 jalapeno, finely chopped (optional)
1 15 oz can kidney beans, drained and rinsed

1. Heat oil, then brown meat, onion, and garlic over medium-high heat (8 min)
2. Put this beef mixture in crock pot then add remaining ingredients and stir.
3. Cook on low 8-10 hours.
4. Serve with minced onion and grated cheese, if desired.

Really Good Chili (from Month of Meals, p. A-5)
Serves 4-6

2 c extra-lean ground beef, browned
1 c green pepper, chopped
1 ½ c onion, chopped
2 15.25 oz cans kidney beans, drained
1 14.5 oz can cut tomatoes
1 6 oz can tomato paste
1 15 oz can tomato sauce
1 T olive oil
1 T Worcestershire sauce
1/8 t cinnamon (optional)
1 ½ t chili powder (more if desired)
1/8 t garlic powder
1 t salt
¼ t pepper

In a large pot, sauté green pepper and onion in oil until soft. Add remaining ingredients. Simmer for 2 hours over low heat, stirring occasionally. Eat now or freeze til later.

Pesto Bean Soup (from "1,000 Easy Recipes")

5 sliced garlic cloves
pinch of red pepper flakes
2 cans cannelini beans
1 c water
3 T pesto
2 T grated parmesan
3 c chicken broth
1 c chopped celery
½ c chopped olives
½ c roasted red peppers

1. Saute garlic & red pepper flakes in olive oil (maybe 1 T?)
2. Add beans and water and simmer until thick, about 8 minutes.
3. Stir in pesto, parmesan, broth, and celery. Cook 15 minutes.
4. Stir in olives and red peppers. Warm through. Then serve.

Split Pea and Ham Soup (from *Cook's Illustrated*)
serves 6-8

2 T unsalted butter
1 large onion, chopped fine (~ 1 ½ c)
table salt
2 medium garlic cloves, minced or pressed (~ 2 t)
7 c water
1 ham steak (about 1 lb), skin removed, cut into quarters
3 slices (~ 4 oz) thick-cut bacon (can use *regular cut bacon, but thinner slices are harder to remove from soup)*
1 lb green split peas (~ 2 c), picked through and rinsed
2 sprigs fresh thyme
2 bay leaves
2 medium carrots, peeled and cut into ½-inch pieces (~ 1 c)
1 medium celery rib, cut into ½-inch pieces (~ ½ c)
ground black pepper

1. Heat butter in large pot over medium high heat. When foaming subsides, add onion and ½ t salt; cook, stirring frequently, softened, about 3-4 minutes. Add garlic and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Add water, ham steak, bacon, peas, thyme, and bay leaves. Increase to high and bring to simmer, stirring frequently to keep peas from sticking to bottom. Reduce heat to low, cover, and simmer until peas are tender but not falling apart, about 45 minutes.
2. Remove ham steak, cover with foil or plastic wrap to prevent drying out, and set aside. Stir in carrots and celery; continue to simmer, covered, until vegetables are tender and peas have almost completely broken down, about 30 minutes longer.
3. When cool enough to handle, shred ham into small bite-size pieces with two forks. Remove and discard thyme sprigs, bay leaves, and bacon strips. Stir ham back into soup and return to simmer. Season to taste with salt and pepper; serve.

***Serve soup sprinkled with butter croutons (recipe below), fresh peas, and chopped mint and drizzled with balsamic vinegar.*

<u>Buttery Croutons</u> (from *Cook's Illustrated*)
makes about 2 cups

3 T unsalted butter
1 T olive oil
3 large slices high-quality sandwich bread, cut into ½" cubes (~ 2 c)
table salt

Heat butter and oil in 12-inch skillet over medium heat. When foaming subsides, add bread cubes and cook, stirring frequently, until golden brown, about 10 minutes. Transfer croutons to paper towel-lined plate and season with salt to taste.

[slow cooker] split pea soup with ham
makes 10 servings

1 lb dried split green peas, picked over and rinsed
2 russet potatoes, peeled and diced
1 medium-size onion, chopped
2 garlic cloves, minced
2 ham hocks
3 large vegetable bouillon cubes
8 c water
1 bay leaf
¼ t salt
3 small carrots, diced
3 ribs celery, sliced
½ t dried thyme
¼ t black pepper

1. Combine peas, potatoes, onion, garlic, ham hocks, bouillon cubes, water, bay leaf and salt in slow cooker, stirring to break up bouillon cubes. Cover and cook on HIGH for 2 hours or LOW for 3 hours.
2. Remove cover and stir in carrots, celery and thyme. Cover and cook about 2 hours on HIGH or 3 hours on LOW; peas and potatoes should be very tender.
3. Remove ham hocks and bay leaf from slow cooker; discard. Soup is very hot so puree carefully in batches in a blender until completely smooth. Stir in black pepper.

clean-out-the-fridge minestrone soup (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale)
serves 8

2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
1 large onion or leek, chopped
1 cup chopped carrot
1 cup chopped celery
3 cloves garlic, finely chopped
1/2 cup chopped turnip (optional)
1/2 cup chopped celeriac (optional)
1 cup chopped tomatoes
6 cups chicken stock, store-bought or homemade
2 cups Basic Tomato Sauce
8 ounces small pasta such as ditalini
1 can (14 to 19 ounces) white beans, drained and rinsed
Salt and freshly ground black pepper
Chopped fresh basil and/or Italian parsley leaves, for serving
Grated Romano cheese, for serving

1. In a large soup pot, heat the oil over medium-high heat. Add the onion, carrot, and celery and cook, stirring, for 5 minutes, or until softened. Add the garlic and cook, stirring, for 1 minute.
2. Add the turnip and celeriac, if using. Add the tomatoes, stock, and tomato sauce and stir to combine. Cover and simmer for 25 minutes, until the vegetables are tender.
3. Meanwhile, in a separate saucepan, cook the pasta according to package directions. *(It seems you could add a bit of extra water to the soup and just cook the pasta directly in the soup here...)*
4. Drain the pasta and add to the soup along with the beans and salt and pepper to taste. Cook for 1 to 2 minutes to warm through. Ladle into bowls, sprinkle with the herbs, and pass grated Romano at the table.

HEARTY SOUPS

***Mulligatawny**
Makes about 8 cups

4 T butter (or 2 T olive oil)
1 onion, chopped
2 carrots, chopped
1 celery stalk, chopped
1 green pepper, chopped
1 apple, cored, peeled, and chopped
1 ½ lbs boneless, skinless chicken breast, chopped
½ c flour
2-3 t curry powder
5 c chicken broth
1 (14.5 oz) can diced tomatoes, drained
Salt and pepper
2 c hot cooked rice *(we use more)*

1. Melt butter or heat oil in large pot over medium heat. Add all veggies and chicken and sauté for about 15 minutes. Turn heat to low.
2. In a small bowl, mix together the flour and curry powder. Add to pot, then stir and cook 3-5 minutes. Add chicken broth and tomatoes. Partially cover the pot and simmer the soup for about an hour, stirring occasionally. Add salt and pepper to taste.
3. Serve with about ¼ c rice in a bowl with soup ladled over. *(We serve with more rice and eat it more as an entrée.*)

Slow-Cooker Chicken Mulligatawny Soup (from Cook's Country, February/March 2014)
Serves 8

3T unsalted butter
2 onions, chopped
3 carrots, peeled and cut into ½ inch pieces (or they won't cook through)
1 celery rib, minced
1 ½ T grated fresh ginger
4 garlic cloves, minced
1 T tomato paste
1 T curry powder
2 t garam masala
Salt and pepper
¼ t cayenne pepper
1/3 c all-purpose flour
5 c chicken broth
1 ½ lbs skinless chicken thighs, cut into 1 ½ inch pieces *(I used bnls skinless chicken breasts)*
1 (13.5 oz) can coconut milk *(this flavor was unrecognizable after 4 hours cooking)*
½ c brown lentils, picked over and rinsed *(I used green lentils)*
Plain yogurt
Chopped fresh cilantro leaves
Lime wedges

1. Melt butter in large saucepan over medium heat. Add onions, carrots, and celery and cook until onions are softened and just beginning to brown, 10-14 minutes. Add ginger, garlic, tomato paste, curry powder, garam masala, 1 teaspoon salt, and cayenne and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Stir in flour and cook for 1 minute. Slowly whisk in broth, scraping up any browned bits. Bring to boil, reduce heat to medium-low, and simmer until thickened, about 5 minutes. Transfer to slow cooker. Stir in chicken, coconut milk, and lentils.
2. Cover and cook until chicken and lentils are tender, 4-5 hours on low. Let sit, uncovered, for 5 minutes. Using large spoon, skim fat from surface of soup (I didn't have this problem). Season soup with salt and pepper to taste. Ladle into serving bowls. Garnish with yogurt and cilantro. Serve with lime wedges.

* *I served with basmati rice. I used homemade plain yogurt made with 2% milk and it added a perfect zing to the spicy soup, as well as toning down the spiciness.*

Pork Vindaloo (Cooks Illustrated *Best Soups & Stews*, p.219-220)
Serves 6-8

3 lb boneless Boston butt roast (or 5 lb bone-in picnic/shoulder roast will yield ~3lb meat), trimmed and cut into 1 1/2-inch cubes
Salt and ground black pepper
3 T vegetable oil
3 medium-large onions, chopped coarse (about 5 cups)
8 medium cloves garlic, minced
3 T flour
1 T sweet paprika
¾ t ground cumin
½ t ground cardamom
¼ t cayenne pepper
¼ t ground cloves
1 ½ c chicken stock/broth
1 (14.5 oz) can diced tomatoes
2 bay leaves
1 t sugar
2 T red wine vinegar
1 T mustard seeds
¼ c minced fresh cilantro leaves

1. Adjust the oven rack to lower-middle position (so pan will fit) and heat oven to 300 degrees. Season the meat generously with salt and pepper. Heat 1 T oil in a large ovenproof Dutch oven over medium-high heat until shimmering, about 2 minutes. Add half of the meat to the pot so that the individual pieces are close together but not touching. Cook, not moving the pieces until the sides touching the pot are well-browned, 2-3 minutes. Using tongs, turn each piece and continue cooking until most sides are well-browned, about 5 minutes longer. Transfer the meat to a medium bowl, add another 1 T oil to the pot, and swirl to coat the pan bottom. Brown the remaining meat; transfer the meat to the bowl and set aside.
2. Reduce heat to medium, add the remaining tablespoon oil to the empty Dutch oven, and swirl to coat the pan bottom. Add the onions and ¼ t salt and cook, stirring frequently and vigorously, scraping the bottom of the pot with a wooden spoon to loosen browned bits, until the onions have softened, about 5 minutes. Stir in the garlic and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Add the flour, paprika, cumin, cardamom, cayenne, and cloves. Stir until the onions are evenly coated and fragrant, 1-2 minutes.
3. Gradually add the stock, scraping the pan bottom and edges with a wooden spoon to loosen the remaining browned bits and dissolve the flour. Add the tomatoes, bay leaves, sugar, vinegar, and mustard seeds and bring to a simmer. Add the browned pork and accumulated juices, submerging the meat under the liquid. Return to a simmer, cover, and place in the oven. Cook for 2 hours.
4. Remove the pot from the oven. If serving immediately, spoon off any fat that rises to the top. Remove the bay leaves, stir in the cilantro, and adjust the seasonings. Serve immediately with basmati rice.

Thai Chicken and Coconut Soup (Cooks Illustrated *Best Soups & Stews*, p.68)
Serves 8

1 T canola oil
1-2 stalks lemon grass, outer sheath removed, bottom 3" trimmed and minced (3 T) – or you can use 1 t grated lemon zest
2 T minced fresh ginger
1 large clove garlic, minced
2-3 t Thai red curry paste
6 c chicken broth
3 T fish sauce or soy sauce
1 T sugar
2 (14 oz) cans unsweetened coconut milk
1 bnls sknls chicken breast (about 12 oz), cut into 1 by ¼ inch strips
1 (15 oz) can straw mushrooms, drained and rinsed
3 T lime juice
Salt
½ c loosely packed whole fresh cilantro leaves
3 scallions, greens only, sliced thin on an angle (optional)

1. Heat the oil in a large stockpot or Dutch oven over medium heat. Add the lemon grass, ginger, and garlic and cook, stirring constantly, until aromatic, 30 to 60 seconds. Add the curry paste and cook, stirring constantly, for 30 seconds.
2. Add ½ c chicken stock to the pot and stir to dissolve the curry paste. Add the remaining stock, fish sauce, and sugar and bring to a boil over medium-high heat. Reduce the heat to low, partially cover, and simmer to blend flavors, about 20 minutes.
3. Stir in the coconut milk (shake first!), chicken, mushrooms, and lime juice. Bring back to a simmer and cook until the stock is hot and the chicken is no longer pink, about 5 minutes. Taste for seasoning and add salt if desired. Serve

immediately, garnishing each bowl with cilantro and scallions.
4. Serve over jasmine or basmati rice

***Easy Potato Soup (Makes 4 servings)** *My recipe from Jr. High Home Ec class*

4 T chopped onion
3 T butter or margarine
6 T flour
½ t salt
2 c milk
½ c chicken bouillon
2 c pre-cooked potatoes, cubed
½ c shredded cheese
4 strips of bacon, fried and broken into small pieces (or ½ c diced ham or bacon bits)

Sauté onion in butter until tender. Stir in flour and salt. Remove from heat. Gradually add in milk. Cook and stir until thick over low-medium heat. Add bouillon, potatoes, and bacon bits (or ham). Stir over low heat until warmed through. Top each serving with cheese.

Second-Chance Baked Potato Soup (From *Blackberry Crumble* by Josi Kilpack)
Serves 6

½ c butter *(be careful not to brown)*
½ c flour
5 c milk
4-5 large, leftover baked potatoes, peeled and mashed (or 3 cups mashed potatoes)
1 t salt (add more to taste, if necessary)
½ t pepper
4 green onions, chopped and divided *(I used half as much)*
12 slices bacon, cooked, crumbled and divided *(I used half as much)*
1 ½ c shredded cheddar cheese, divided *(I used half as much)*
8oz sour cream

1. Melt butter in a heavy pot over low heat. Add flour, stirring until smooth. Cook for about 1 minute, stirring constantly.
2. Increase heat to medium and gradually add milk, stirring constantly until mixture is thick and bubbly.
3. Add potatoes, salt, pepper, half of the green onions, half of the bacon, and 1 c of the cheddar cheese. Cook until thoroughly heated. Stir in sour cream (add extra if necessary for desired thickness).
4. Serve soup with remaining portion of onions, bacon, and cheese sprinkled on top.

Sweet Potato Soup with Bacon and Chives (from *Cook's Country*)
serves 4

6 slices bacon, chopped
1 onion, chopped fine
1 t packed brown sugar
salt and pepper
3 garlic cloves, minced
2 lbs sweet potatoes, peeled, quartered lengthwise, and sliced thin
4 c low-sodium chicken broth
1 c water
2 T minced fresh chives

1. Cook bacon in Dutch oven *(large soup pan)* over medium heat until crisp, 6-8 minutes. Transfer bacon to paper towel-lined plate; set aside. Discard all but 2 T bacon fat from now-empty pot. Add onion, sugar, and 1 t salt and cook, stirring occasionally, until onion is softened, 5-7 minutes. Stir in garlic and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Add potatoes, broth, and water; bring to boil. Reduce heat to med-low; simmer til potatoes are tender, about 10 minutes.
2. Working in batches, process soup in blender until smooth, 1-2 minutes. Season with salt and pepper to taste. Serve soup, sprinkled with bacon and chives.

Vichyssoise (Potato and Leek Soup) - can be served either hot or cold
4 servings - takes 45 minutes

2 T olive oil
3 leeks, white and light green parts only, trimmed and thinly sliced
1 lb Yukon Gold potatoes (these are best, but any potato will work), peeled and thinly sliced
4 c chicken stock, plus more for thinning the soup if necessary
1 t minced fresh thyme (or ½ t dried thyme)
½ c heavy cream
1 t white wine vinegar
pinch of cayenne pepper
pinch of ground nutmeg
salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 T finely minced fresh chives

1. Heat the olive oil in a large pot over medium heat and add the leeks. Cook until the leeks soften, about 4 minutes. Add the potatoes, chicken stock, and thyme. Bring to a boil, then turn the heat to low. Simmer for about 25 minutes, or until the potatoes are tender.
2. Using an immersion blender, regular blender, or food processor, blend the soup so that it is creamy and thick. (If you are using a blender or food processor, make sure not to overfill the jar or work bowl, and always put a kitchen towel over the top so if pressure from the steam builds and soup escapes, you are not burned.) Add the cream, vinegar, cayenne pepper, and nutmeg and taste for seasoning, adding salt and pepper if desired.
3. Serve the soup hot or chilled with a sprinkling of fresh chives. (If you are serving the soup chilled, you may want to thin it a bit with a bit of extra stock or milk.)

***Chicken and Dumplings** (Shannon Nelson - *from RS $5 cookbook)*

<u>Soup</u>
3 boneless, skinless chicken breasts (frozen or thawed) **
5 carrots, sliced (2-3 cups)
5 stalks of celery, chopped (1-2 cups)
1 onion, chopped
½-1 tsp. thyme
1 large bay leaf
3 chicken bouillon cubes
salt and pepper to taste, optional

<u>Dumplings</u>
2 c. flour
3 tsp. baking powder
1 tsp. salt
1 tsp. parsley (optional)
¼ shortening
1 c. milk

1. Make the soup first. Place chicken into pot, cover with water by at least an inch. Add the rest of soup ingredients. Bring to a boil and cook until chicken is done and the vegetables are soft. (***This is a great meal for using leftover cooked chicken or turkey. Just cook the veggies without the meat here and add it cooked and cut in step 2.)*
2. Once cooked, remove chicken and cut into small pieces. Return to pot and bring to gentle boil. Make sure there is enough liquid to make soup look somewhat thin like soup and not thick like a stew. It will thicken after the dumplings are added.
3. Prepare the dumplings: Sift dry ingredients. Cut in shortening. Mix in milk, stirring as little as possible. Once soup is gently boiling, drop dumpling dough by spoonfuls into soup. Reduce heat to medium low-medium, but keep gently boiling. Cook 10 minutes uncovered and then 10 minutes covered. Remove the bay leaf before serving.

Shan Notes-
1) This recipe works great with any kind of chicken- thighs, legs, etc. Chicken breasts are usually easiest for me and have less fat. Recipe also does well when boiling left over chicken bones. Just boil to obtain meat then remove the bones.
2)The carrots and celery amounts are approximations. Adjust to personal taste.
3) This soup is a great one to hide pureed veggies in. I usually add a cup of pureed zucchini.

Chicken and Dumplings (Taste of Home, October 2011, p.19)
(6 servings)

6 c chicken broth
3 bay leaves
5 fresh thyme sprigs *(I used dried)*
4 garlic cloves, peeled *(I used minced)*
1 t crushed red pepper flakes
1 c chopped carrots
1 c chopped celery
3 T olive oil
2 T butter
3 garlic cloves, minced
2 T flour
1 c frozen peas
1 rotisserie chicken, shredded
¼ c heavy whipping cream *(I used milk)*

<u>Dumplings</u>:
2 c flour
1 T baking powder
1 t salt
1 t cayenne pepper
1 c buttermilk
2 eggs, lightly beaten
¼ c minced chives *(I didn't use these)*

1. In a large saucepan, combine the first 5 ingredients. Bring to a boil. Reduce heat; simmer, uncovered, for 30 minutes. Strain and set aside.
2. In a Dutch oven, sauté carrots and celery in oil and butter until tender. Add minced garlic; cook 1 minute longer. Stir in flour until blended; gradually add prepared broth. Bring to a boil; cook 2 minutes or until thickened, stirring frequently.
3. Add peas; return to a boil. Cook 3-5 minutes or until peas are tender. Stir in chicken and cream; heat through.
4. For dumplings, combine the flour, baking powder, salt and cayenne in a large bowl. In another bowl, combine buttermilk and eggs; stir into dry ingredients just until moistened.
5. Drop by tablespoonfuls onto simmering chicken mixture. Cover and simmer for 15-20 minutes or until a toothpick inserted in a dumpling comes out clean (do not lift cover while simmering). Garnish with chives before serving.

Chicken Soup with [Gyoza] Dumplings (From September 2020 Food Network Magazine)
This was yummy. Everyone liked it. Makes 4 servings

2 T chopped ginger
2 sliced garlic cloves
2 scallions, sliced
2 celery stalks, sliced
vegetable oil *(just enough to saute the above vegetables)*
4 c low-sodium chicken broth
2 c water
8 frozen dumplings (gyoza) or 16 frozen mini wontons
2 heads baby Bok choy (*I used 3 leaves from regular Bok Choy),* trimmed and chopped
1 c shredded rotisserie chicken
1 t soy sauce

1. Cook ginger, garlic, scallions, celery stalks in vegetable oil in a saucepan over medium high heat until softened, about 3 minutes.
2. Add broth and water. Bring to a simmer and cook until the vegetables are tender, 5 minutes.
3. Add dumplings/wontons, Bok Choy, chicken, and soy sauce. Simmer until warmed through, 3-5 minutes; season with salt.
4. Divide among 4 bowls; drizzle with sesame oil and top with scallions.

***Taco Soup** (from Julie Bowlden)

1 lb ground beef
1 medium onion
1 pkg taco seasoning
1 16 oz can kidney beans, drained and rinsed
1 16 oz can corn
1 28 oz can diced or stewed tomatoes (or 2 14 oz cans)
1 8 oz can tomato sauce
Tortilla chips
Grated cheese

Brown ground beef and onion together. Drain off fat.
Stir in taco seasoning, corn, kidney beans, tomatoes and tomato sauce.
Simmer 20-30 minutes.

Southwest Chicken Tortilla Soup (from *Recipes from the Roof)*
6-8 servings

1/8 c melted butter
2 c diced skinless, bnls chicken brsts
2 t minced garlic
1/8 c diced yellow onion
2 (4 oz) cans diced green chiles
2 c tomato puree
1 c frozen corn (thawed)
2 c diced yellow corn tortillas
4 c water
2 c heavy cream
½ t cumin
2 t salt
½ t Cajun seasoning *(salt, pepper, thyme, red pepper, paprika, garlic, onion)*
1 diced tomato, for garnish
1 c sour cream, for garnish
10-16 tortillas chips or 3 c tortilla strips, for garnish

1. In a soup pot, melt butter and sauté raw chicken until almost cooked. Add garlic and onion, cooking for 4 minutes. Add chilies, tomato puree, corn, tortillas, water, and cream; simmer. Blend with an immersion blender until smooth. (***Sam & Lee didn't like the chicken pureed.)* Season with cumin, salt, and Cajun seasoning.
2. To serve, place in bowl and garnish with diced tomato, sour cream, and tortilla chips or strips.

Chicken Tortilla Soup (Made by Heather Jensen after Taylor's baptism)
Serves: 8 - Prep. Time: about 20 minutes

1/4 cup butter OR margarine
¼ c. finely chopped onion
3/4 cup all-purpose flour
3 cups chicken broth
2 cup milk
8 oz. Velveeta process cheese - cubed
10 oz. can Ro*Tel® tomatoes and chilies
2 cups cooked, shredded chicken
1 tsp. cumin
1 tsp. chili powder
salt and pepper – to taste
flour tortillas – as needed, about 4 – 6 (I just use tortilla chips)
shredded Colby Jack cheese OR Mexican blend cheese
Sour cream for topping

1. In a pot, melt butter over medium heat, add in onions. Stir in flour and milk, whisk until smooth, and cook, stirring often, for 3 minutes.
2. Slowly whisk in small amounts of chicken broth at a time.
3. Reduce heat to low and stir in Velveeta cubes; stir until melted. Stir in Ro*Tel, chicken, and spices.
4. Once soup is heated through, it is ready to serve at this point. However, if you wish to make tortilla strips, it can sit over low heat while they are made. Stir the soup occasionally.
5. For tortilla strips, cut tortillas into strips and deep-fry in 350 degree vegetable or peanut oil until golden, then drain on cooling racks.
6. Spoon a ladleful of soup into a bowl, add a handful of shredded cheese, then spoon another ladleful of soup over cheese. Sprinkle tortilla strips over soup and a little sour cream on top. Repeat for remaining servings.

Notes: If you want to save a lot of time, use crumbled tortilla chips instead of tortilla strips. As a substitute for Ro*Tel, you can use 1 1/2 cups of salsa. Spiciness can be easily adjusted by using spicy Ro*Tel or salsa and/or adding cayenne pepper to the soup.

Extra adjustments made by Heather:
1. And Lisa, I forgot to tell you that I blended the tomatoes and chilies. More kid friendly.
2. I cooked the chicken in the crock pot so it would shred nicely.

Extra adjustments made by Lisa:
1. I added a can of corn and a can of black beans to make it heartier.

Chicken Tortilla Soup (from *Raised in the Kitchen* by Carrian Cheney)
Makes 8 to 10 servings

1 tablespoon olive oil
1/2 onion, chopped
1 large carrot, peeled and chopped
1 stalk celery, chopped
1 red bell pepper, chopped
1 ½ teaspoons garlic powder
3 teaspoons taco seasoning
2 Roma tomatoes, quartered
1 (15-ounce) can fire-roasted diced tomatoes, drained
1 (4-ounce) can fire-roasted diced green chiles, drained
1/2 avocado, plus more (sliced) for serving
1/3 cup shredded Monterey Jack or Mexican cheese, plus more for serving
1 (15-ounce) can black beans, drained and divided
10 tortilla chips, plus more for serving
3 cups cooked and shredded chicken
1 ½ to 2 cups frozen corn
2 cups low-sodium chicken broth
2 cups water
1 ½ teaspoons kosher salt
¼ cup chopped fresh cilantro

1. In a large Dutch oven or soup pot, heat oil over medium heat until it begins to shimmer. Add onions, carrots, celery, and bell pepper. Reduce heat to low and cook until veggies are tender, about 10 minutes.
2. Stir in garlic powder, taco seasoning, Roma tomatoes, canned tomatoes, and green chiles. Cook, stirring occasionally, 8 to 10 minutes to allow flavors to meld.
3. Transfer veggie mixture to the jar of blender. Add avocado and cheese. Puree until completely smooth, about 1 minute. Add 1/2 of the black beans and 10 tortilla chips. Pulse just a few times so there are some chunks left.
4. Pour mixture back into the pot. Add cooked chicken, remaining black beans, corn, broth, water, and salt. Cook and simmer over medium heat 30 minutes, stirring occasionally and reducing heat as needed if soup starts to boil.
5. Just before serving, stir in the cilantro. Serve topped with avocado slices, chips, and cheese.

***4 hour stew** (from my roommate, Chris Moss)

1 ½ lbs cubed round steak
2 t salt
2 t basil
2 chopped medium sized onions
2 stalks celery, chopped
4 carrots, chopped
3 potatoes, chopped
2 cans tomato soup
2 cans (use the soup cans) water

1. In an oven safe pot or in a crock pot, layer ingredients in the order listed.
2. Cover and bake at 300 or 325 degrees for 4 hours. (Or put in crockpot on high for 4-5 hours)

***Creamy Chicken Noodle Soup** - *from Gayelynn Watson, who got it from Linda Phillips*
(This will make a big pan of soup, so cut the recipe in half if you don't want as much)

3 boneless skinless chicken breasts
4-5 carrots, chopped
4-5 celery stalks, chopped
1 onion, chopped
1 small bag of noodles, any kind
1-2 cans cream of chicken soup
enough water to make it feel "soupy"
milk
3-4 tablespoons of flour

1. Boil chicken in enough water to cover, then remove and dice. Next add veggies to chicken water. (Sometimes I do them both at the same time.) Add more water if needed. Also add a bouillon cube or two (or equivalent) if the broth doesn't look very flavorful.
2. Boil veggies until soft. Then add noodles. Boil noodles until cooked. Then add chicken pieces back to the mixture. Then add cream of chicken soup.
3. Fill the empty cream of chicken soup can with milk. Mix flour into this with a fork until smooth and add to soup. (This is called a "roux" and will help thicken the soup.) Heat soup on low until it starts to thicken.

mom's chicken noodle soup (from *Scratch* by Maria Rodale)
serves 4

1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
1 cup chopped onion
1/2 cup chopped celery
1/2 cup chopped carrot
Salt
6 cups chicken stock
1 ½ cups egg noodles
1 ½ cups shredded cooked chicken
1/4 c chopped Italian parsley leaves
Freshly ground black pepper

1. In a large soup pot, heat the oil over medium heat. Add the onion, celery, carrot, and a pinch of salt. Cook, stirring, for 8 minutes, until the vegetables are softened.
2. Add the stock and bring to a boil. Reduce to a simmer, partially cover, and cook for about 20 minutes.
3. Meanwhile, cook the noodles according to package directions. Drain.
4. Add the chicken and noodles to the soup and cook for 5 minutes to warm through. Stir in the parsley and season with salt and pepper to taste. Ladle into bowls to serve.

Butternut Squash Soup (Cooks Illustrated *Best Soups & Stews*, p.114-115)
Serves 4-6

4 T unsalted butter
1 large shallot, chopped fine
3 lbs butternut squash (about 1 large squash), cut in half lengthwise, and each half cut in half widthwise; seeds and strings scraped out and reserved (about ¼ cup)
6 c water
Salt
½ c heavy cream
1 t dark brown sugar
Pinch freshly grated nutmeg

1. Melt the butter in a large Dutch oven over medium-low heat until foaming. Add the shallot and cook, stirring frequently, until translucent, about 3 minutes. Add the squash scrapings and seeds, and cook, stirring occasionally, until the butter turns saffron color, about 4 minutes.
2. Add water and 1 t salt to the pot and bring to a boil over high heat. Reduce the heat to medium-low, place the squash cut-side down in a steamer basket, and lower the basket into the pot. Cover and steam until the squash is completely tender, about 30 minutes. Take the pot off the heat, and use tongs to transfer the squash to a rimmed baking sheet. When cool enough to handle, use a large spoon to scrape the flesh from the skin. Reserve the squash flesh in a bowl and discard the skins.
3. Strain the steaming liquid through a mesh strainer into a second bowl; discard the solids in the strainer. (You should have 2 ½ to 3 c liquid.) Rinse and dry the pot.
4. Puree the squash in batches in the blender, pulsing on low and adding enough reserved steaming liquid to obtain a smooth consistency. Transfer the puree to the pot and stir in the remaining steaming liquid, cream, and brown sugar. Warm the soup over medium-low heat until hot, about 3 minutes. Stir in the nutmeg and adjust the seasonings, adding salt to taste. Serve immediately.

savory spiced pumpkin soup (from *Scratch*, by Maria Rodale)
serves 4

4 tablespoons (1/2 stick) butter
1 white onion, chopped
2 cloves garlic, finely chopped
1 teaspoon ground turmeric
1 teaspoon ground ginger
1 teaspoon curry powder
1 T chopped fresh Italian parsley leaves
2 lbs pumpkin, peeled, seeded and chopped
2 c vegetable or chicken stock, store-bought or homemade
2 T fresh lime juice
½ c heavy cream or coconut milk, plus extra for serving
Salt and freshly ground black pepper

1. In a large soup pot, melt the butter over medium-high heat. Add the onion and cook, stirring, for 5 minutes, or until translucent. Add the garlic, turmeric, ginger, curry powder, and parsley and cook, stirring, for I minute.
2. Add the pumpkin and stock, bring to a simmer, and cook for 30 minutes, or until the pumpkin has softened completely.
3. In batches, transfer the soup to a blender and process until smooth. Return the soup to the pot and add the lime juice, cream, and salt and pepper to taste. Stir to combine and cook until warmed through. Ladle into bowls and drizzle with a little cream to serve.

Slow Cooker Broccoli Cheese Soup (from *Raised in the Kitchen*)
makes 6 servings

¼ cup butter
1/2 yellow onion, minced
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 carrot, peeled and grated
¼ cup all-purpose flour
4 ounces cream cheese, softened
3 cups chicken broth
1 cup heavy cream
2 cups whole milk
¼ teaspoon Worcestershire sauce
1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg
1/2 teaspoon ground mustard
1/2 teaspoon dried thyme
3 teaspoons salt *(this was WAY too much – maybe just 1 t?)*
1/2 teaspoon ground black pepper
4 cups chopped broccoli florets
2 cups shredded sharp cheddar
1/3 cup grated Parmesan cheese
Bread bowls for serving (optional)

1. In a large saucepan over medium heat, melt butter until it foams. Add onion, garlic, and carrots and sauté, stirring occasionally, until onions are softened, about 5 minutes. Whisk in flour and cook 30 seconds. Add cream cheese and stir until melted.
2. Transfer mixture to the insert of a slow cooker. Add chicken broth, cream, milk, Worcestershire sauce, nutmeg, mustard, thyme, salt, pepper, and broccoli. Give it a quick stir, cover, and cook on low 5 to 6 hours or high 3 hours.
3. Ladle half of the soup into the jar of a blender and pulse 3 or 4 times. Return pureed mixture to slow cooker, stir in the cheeses, and serve.

Cream of Broccoli Soup (from Heather Jensen)

3 c water
3 stalks broccoli
2 bay leaves
3 chicken bouillon cubes
¾ c butter
¾ c flour
salt and pepper
1 qt half and half
1 c cheese

1. In one pan, boil first 4 ingredients until broccoli is tender.
2. In another pan, combine butter, flour, salt & pepper, and half & half. Heat and stir until thickened.
3. Remove bay leaf. Smash/puree half of the broccoli and then add everything from step 1 to everything from step 2. Heat through. Cheese can be melted in along with broccoli, or can be served sprinkled on top.

Cheese Broccoli Soup (from *ksl tv News at Noon* in 1997)
serves 6-8

2 c potatoes, diced
1 c carrots, sliced
½ c celery, diced
½ c onion, diced
1 ¼ c water *(I used almost 2 cups)*
1 pkg frozen broccoli (about 16 oz)
½ cube butter
3 chicken bouillon cubes
1 c milk
1 lb velveeta cheese, cubed
salt and pepper to taste
2 T flour, optional

1. In large pan, bring to a boil: potatoes, carrots, celery, onion, and water. Simmer for 20 minutes.
2. Stir in broccoli and simmer 7 minutes more. Add butter, bouillon cubes, milk, and cheese. Stir to blend.
3. Add salt and pepper to taste. To make thicker, mix flour with ½ c milk or water and stir into hot soup until thickened.

the simplest tomato soup (from Maria Rodale's *Scratch* -- recreated from the restaurant *The Kitchen*, in Boulder, CO)
Serves 2

4 tomatoes, chopped
4 tablespoons (1/2 stick) butter
Salt
Extra virgin olive oil, for serving
Can also add cream if you want it creamy; or fresh herbs such as basil and parsley

1. If you prefer a smooth soup, puree the tomatoes in a blender until smooth.
2. In a medium saucepan, melt the butter over medium heat. Add the tomatoes and salt to taste and simmer for 10 minutes. Divide between bowls and drizzle with a little oil

Tomato Green Bean Soup - *by Shannon Nelson (taken from Stephanie Nelsen 5-23-05)*
Shannon made this for me after my neck surgery and it was surprisingly tasty. It also stored well in the freezer.
Yield: 9 servings

1 c chopped onion *(Shannon used a Vidalia)*
1 c chopped carrots. *(Shannon used two cups)*
2 t butter or margarine
6 cups chicken broth
1 lb fresh green beans cut in 1 inch pieces *(Shannon used 1 pound frozen)*
1 garlic clove, minced
3 cups fresh tomatoes *(Shannon uses a big can of diced tom.)*
¼ c. minced fresh basil or 1 T. dry basil
½ t salt
¼ t pepper

In a large saucepan, sauté onion and carrots in butter for 5 minutes. Stir in the broth, beans and garlic; bring to a boil. Reduce heat; cover and simmer for 20 minutes or until vegetables are tender. Stir in the tomatoes, basil, salt and pepper. Cover and simmer 5 minutes longer.

Nutritional analysis: One serving (1 cup) equals 71 calories, 1 g fat (1 g saturated fat), 2 mg cholesterol, 779 mg sodium, 12 g carbohydrate, 4 g fiber, 3 g protein. Diabetic Exchanges: 2 vegetable, ½ fat

***Tomato-Basil Parmesan Soup** (from 365 Days of Slow Cooking) YUM!
Makes about 2 quarts

2 (14 oz) cans diced tomatoes, with juice
1 cup finely diced celery
1 cup finely diced carrots
1 tsp dried oregano
4 cups chicken broth
1 cup finely diced onions
1 T dried basil
½ bay leaf
½ cup flour
½ cup butter
1 cup Parmesan cheese
2 cups half and half, warmed
1 tsp salt
¼ tsp black pepper

1. Add tomatoes, celery, carrots, oregano, chicken broth, onions, basil, bay leaf to a large slow cooker. Cook on LOW for 6-7 hours.
2. About an hour before serving prepare a roux. Melt butter over low heat in a skillet and add flour. Stir constantly with a whisk for 5-7 minutes. Slowly stir in 1 cup hot soup. Add another 3 cups and stir until smooth. Add all back into slow cooker. Stir and add the parmesan cheese, warmed half and half, salt and pepper. Cover and cook on LOW for another hour until ready to serve.

***I like this soup pureed. After fully cooked, and before adding the parmesan cheese, etc, REMOVE the bay leaf, then puree with immersion blender until mostly smooth. Then proceed with remaining ingredients and instructions.*

***Lasagna Soup**
Makes about 13 cups

2 t olive oil
1 ½ lbs Italian sausage
2 onions, finely chopped
4 garlic cloves, minced
2 t oregano
½ t red pepper flakes
2 T tomato paste
1 (28 oz) can diced tomatoes
6 c chicken broth
2 bay leaves
8 oz fusilli pasta
½ c finely chopped fresh basil
8 oz ricotta
½ c grated Parmesan
¼ t salt
Pinch of pepper
2 c shredded mozzarella

1. In a large pot, heat oil over medium heat. Add sausage and sauté, breaking it up into small pieces with a wooden spoon, until the sausage is no longer pink, about 5-7 minutes. Drain excess fat from pot. Add onions and sauté until softened, about 6 minutes. Add garlic, oregano, and red pepper flakes and sauté for 1 minute. Add the tomato paste and sauté until the paste turns a rusty brown, about 5 minutes. Add the tomatoes with their juice, the broth, and the bay leaves and bring the soup to a boil. Reduce the heat and simmer for about 30 minutes.
2. Add the pasta, then increase heat to medium-high and boil the soup until the pasta is tender to the bite, following the time recommendations on the pasta package. Discard bay leaves, then stir in the basil. If desired, season with salt and pepper to taste.
3. Combine ricotta, Parmesan, ¼ t salt and pinch of pepper in small bowl. To serve, place about 1 ½ T of ricotta mixture in each bowl, sprinkle with some of the mozzarella, and ladle the soup on top.

***Minestrone Soup** (from Debbie Otteson, at my grocery bridal shower)

1 regular size can pork and beans
2 cans minestrone soup
1 can water
½ lb fried hamburger
1 t oregano
Garlic powder

Cook in crockpot about 4 hours. (or on stove til bubbly)

Slow Cooker Tuscan Tortellini Soup *(I made ½ the recipe and it was plenty for a normal meal)*
~4 hours - serves 12

3 28-oz cans crushed tomatoes
6 c chicken broth
1 yellow onion, finely chopped
1 ½ lbs sweet or spicy Italian sausage
2 T garlic, minced
2 t dried basil
2 t dried oregano
2 t salt to taste (author of recipe uses 1 t)
1 t crushed red pepper
2 T Italian seasoning
½ t black pepper
2 c kale, roughly chopped
1 c heavy cream or half-n-half (milk would work, too)
1 c grated parmesan cheese, plus more for topping
20 oz pkg refrigerated cheese tortellini *(I used frozen)*

1. In a large pan, add sausage, onion, and garlic. Roughly chop while the sausage is cooking and cook over medium-high heat until the sausage is completely cooked through; about 8-10 minutes.
2. Once sausage is cooked, remove from heat and drain excess grease if you desire.
3. In a 6 qt slow cooker add chicken broth, crushed tomatoes, cooked sausage and all of the seasonings.
4. Add lid onto slow cooker and cook on high for 2-3 hours or low 4-5 hours.
5. Add heavy cream, shredded parmesan cheese, and tortellini and cook for another 20 minutes.
6. Then add chopped kale and cook another 10 minutes.
7. Once cooked, serve and garnish with more cheese if you so desire.

One-Pot Creamy Tomato Tortellini Soup (*easy and yummy)*
takes ~40 minutes - serves 8

1 medium onion, diced
3 garlic cloves, minced
1 t olive oil
1 sprig of fresh rosemary chopped or ½ t dried
28 oz can diced tomatoes
15 oz can tomato sauce
½ t dried oregano
4 large fresh basil leaves or ½ t dried basil
½ t salt
¼ t pepper
4 c chicken stock
½ c heavy cream
20 oz three-cheese tortellini
½ c shredded parmesan cheese + extra for garnish
fresh basil, to garnish

1. Place the onion, garlic, and olive oil, and fresh rosemary in a 6 qt soup pot or dutch oven. Saute over medium heat for 5 minutes or until the onions are translucent.
2. Add in the diced tomatoes, tomato sauce, oregano, basil, salt, pepper, chicken stock, and heavy cream and stir to combine. Simmer for 20 minutes.
3. Place the three-cheese tortellini into the soup and cook for 12-15 minutes or until the tortellini are tender and cooked through.
4. Stir in the parmesan cheese.
5. Serve and garnish with fresh basil and shredded parmesan cheese.

Chicken Alfredo Tortellini Soup
8 servings - 30 minute total prep time

2 T unsalted butter
½ medium yellow onion, diced
4 oz baby carrots, halved lengthwise and sliced into half-moons
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 lb boneless skinless chicken breasts, cut into bite-size cubes
1 t kosher salt
½ t freshly ground black pepper
¼ c all-purpose flour
4 c reduced-sodium chicken stock
1 c half-and-half *(I used evaporated milk)*
1 t crushed red pepper flakes *(this makes it VERY spicy, so ½ t might be better for a general audience)*
9 oz cheese tortellini, frozen or fresh
2 c freshly shredded Parmesan cheese
2 oz fresh baby spinach

1. Warm a large pot over med-high heat. Add the butter and let it melt. Add the onions and carrots. Cook the vegetables until the onions are translucent, about 3 minutes. Add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
2. Then add the chicken, salt, and pepper. Stir to combine. Cook for 3 minutes, just to get a little color on the chicken, stirring occasionally. Don't worry about the chicken being cooked through because we are going to continue cooking it.
3. Sprinkle the flour over the chicken and veggies. Stir to coat everything and continue cooking for 2-3 minutes to cook out the floury taste. Stir in the chicken stock, half-and-half and red pepper flakes. Continue cooking until the soup thickens, 5-10 minutes.
4. Add the tortellini to the pot and cook until al dente, 5-7 minutes (frozen takes longer). Remove the pot from the heat. Sprinkle a handful of cheese over the soup and stir. Once it has melted into the soup, add another handful. Slowly melting the cheese will give the soup a smooth consistency. Taste for seasoning and add salt and pepper as necessary. Pour into bowls and garnish with the spinach.

***Pittsburgh Wedding Soup** (from *Cooks' Illustrated Soups & Stews*, 2009)
serves 6-8

Meatballs
2 slices hearty white sandwich bread, torn into pieces
½ c whole milk
1 large egg yolk
1 oz Parmesan cheese, grated (~½ c)
3 T chopped fresh parsley leaves
3 med. garlic cloves, minced (~ 1 T)
¾ t table salt
½ t ground black pepper
½ t dried oregano
1 lb meatloaf mix (or 1 lb 85% lean ground beef)

Soup
1 T extra-virgin olive oil
2 med. garlic cloves, minced (~2 t)
¼ t red pepper flakes
3 quarts low-sodium chicken broth
1 large bunch kale or Swiss chard, washed and stemmed, leaves chopped
1 c orzo
3 T chopped fresh parsley leaves
table salt and ground black pepper

1. FOR THE MEATBALLS: using potato masher or fork, mash bread and milk in large bowl until smooth. Add remaining ingredients, except meat, and mash to combine. Add meatloaf mix and knead by hand until well combined. Using melon baller, form mixture into 1-in meatballs (you should have about 55 meatballs) and arrange on rimmed baking sheet. Cover with plastic wrap and refrigerate until firm, at least 30 minutes. (Meatballs can be made up to 24 hours in advance.)
2. FOR THE SOUP: Heat oil in Dutch oven over medium-high heat until shimmering. Add garlic and red pepper flakes and cook until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Add broth and bring to boil. Stir in kale and simmer until softened, 10-15 minutes. Stir in meatballs and pasta, reduce heat to medium, and simmer until meatballs are cooked through and pasta is tender, about 10 minutes. Stir in parsley and season with salt and pepper. Serve. (Leftover soup can be refrigerated for up to 3 days.)

USEFUL COOKING INFORMATION

NUTRITION INFORMATION/SUGGESTIONS

Non-Dairy Calcium Containing Foods:

Cheerios	tofu	white beans
Other fortified cereals	oatmeal (fortified)	kale
Almonds	oranges	broccoli
Soy/almond milk	OJ (fortified)	molasses

Non-Dairy Vitamin D foods:

cereals	OJ (some)	1 egg

INGREDIENT SUBSTITUTIONS

Ingredient	Amount	Substitution
Allspice	1 t	½ t cinnamon plus ¼ t ginger & ¼ t cloves
Buttermilk	1 c	1 c plain yogurt OR 1 T lemon juice or vinegar plus enough milk to make 1 c
Cornstarch, for thickening	1 T	2 T flour (approximately)
Egg	1 egg	1 t unflavored gelatin in 2 T boiling water. Whisk to dissolve. Mix in 2 T water.
Egg	1 egg	2 ½ T powdered egg substitute plus 2 ½ T water
Egg	1 egg	3 T mayonnaise (not light)
Fats for baking	1 c	1 c applesauce (it's least noticeable to substitute HALF the fat with applesauce, instead of ALL)
Garlic	1 clove	⅛ t garlic powder
Ketchup	1 cup	1 c tomato sauce plus 1 t vinegar and 1 T sugar
Sour cream	1 c	1 c plain yogurt OR 1 T lemon juice or vinegar plus enough cream to make 1 c OR ¾ c buttermilk mixed with ⅓ c butter
Unsweetened chocolate	1 square (1 oz)	3 T cocoa plus 1 T shortening

BAKING SODA & BAKING POWDER -- What do they do?

INGREDIENTS: Baking Soda and Baking Powder What do they do?

Biscuits and cornbread, as well as muffins, cookies, cakes, pancakes, and waffles, get their rise from chemical leaveners—baking soda and baking powder—rather than yeast. Chemical leavenings react with acids to produce carbon dioxide, the gas that causes these baked goods to rise.

To do its work, baking soda relies on an acid in the recipe, such as buttermilk or molasses. It's important to use the right amount of baking soda. Use more baking soda than can be neutralized by the acidic ingredient, and you'll end up with a metallic-tasting, coarse-crumbed quick bread or cake. One cup of buttermilk will neutralize ½ teaspoon of baking soda.

Baking powder is nothing more than baking soda (about one-quarter to one-third of the total makeup) mixed with a dry acid and double-dried cornstarch. The cornstarch absorbs moisture and keeps the two elements apart during storage, preventing premature production of the gas. When baking powder becomes wet, the acid comes into contact with the baking soda, producing carbon dioxide. Most commercial baking powders are "double-acting." In other words, they contain two kinds of acid—one that produces a carbon dioxide reaction at room temperature, the other responding only to heat.

In contrast, baking soda is only single-acting, as is homemade baking powder, which contains only one acid, cream of tartar. Baking soda reacts immediately on contact with an acid.

In a cake, for example, it is important to have an early release of carbon dioxide during the batter preparation so that small bubbles will be created to form the foundation of the cell structure. These cells expand during baking because of additional carbon dioxide production caused by the action of the second leavening acid, and the dough firms up into the final cake structure. Therefore, a double-acting agent is essential. In a cookie batter, however, especially one that has a good deal of structure from butter and eggs, the double-acting issue is less critical.

Since baking powder is nothing more than baking soda and acid, it's easy to convert a recipe from baking powder and milk to baking soda and buttermilk. Just divide the amount of baking powder by four to determine how much baking soda you should use and substitute buttermilk. For example, in a recipe calling for 2 teaspoons of baking powder and 1 cup of milk, you could substitute ½ teaspoon of baking soda and 1 cup of buttermilk. There would be taste and textural differences, it is true, but the leavening action would be about the same.

One final note about baking soda: You may not want it to neutralize all the buttermilk's acidity. If you want to taste the buttermilk, you can substitute baking powder for some or all of the baking soda. Since baking powder has its own built-in acid to react with, the acidity of the buttermilk is allowed to come through. For example, in a recipe that calls for ½ teaspoon of baking soda and 1 cup of buttermilk, the baking soda could be replaced with two teaspoons of baking powder. The leavening result would be the same, but the baked good would have a tangier flavor.